BOUNDED INTEGRAL AND MOTIVIC MILNOR FIBER

ARTHUR FOREY AND YIMU YIN

Abstract. We construct a new Hrushovski-Kazhdan style motivic integral, the so-call bounded integral, that interpolates the integral with volume forms and that without volume forms. This is done within the framework of model theory of algebraically closed valued fields of equicharacteristic zero. As the main application, we rectify and refine some results of Hrushovski and Loeser on how to construct motivic Milnor fiber without resolution of singularities.

Technical referee report: audited second version. Every one of the first report's 161 remarks has been rechecked against the manuscript, its conventions, and the relevant cited results. The text has also been reread for omissions. Of the original findings, 103 are confirmed in substance, 52 are revised, and 6 are withdrawn. Twelve new remarks bring the active total to 167. Revisions include corrections to the report, narrower classifications, and fuller proofs of proposed repairs; they do not all indicate that the original objection was false.

The original numbers are retained. Revised findings are marked **revised**; new findings are **R162–R173** and marked **new**. Withdrawn remarks R017, R052, R096, R097, R113, and R129 are omitted from the text. R017 misread the stated scope of Section 5; R052, R096, R113, and R129 overlooked the explicit singleton/fiber conventions; R097 added no independent issue beyond the already stated parameter convention and the descent objection R088. Unwarranted parts of R002, R005, R118, and R155 are also corrected in place. A separate audit log records the disposition and reason for all 161 original remarks.

Purple remarks distinguish **Error** (a false assertion, invalid formula, or counterexample), **Gap** (an argument not established as written), **Clarification** (including optional exposition), and **Typo**. Each gives its original source line. The authors' text and Yimu's blue notes are preserved.

Recommendation: major revision on technical grounds. The principal counterexamples concerning Jacobians, continuity, residue-field descent, and summability survive the audit. Newly identified points include an RV-hull leaving the stated finite-fiber category and the missing compatibility of truncation cutoffs in the coefficient comparison. Several earlier proof-gap remarks now include explicit repairs. The scope and dependency checks attached to each proposed repair remain part of the requested revision.

Referee R001 [Typo] – Acknowledgements and abstract.
Original source line 507. In the acknowledgements, replace "We also thanks" by "We also thank" and preferably "for encouragements" by "for their encouragement". In the abstract, "so-call" should be "so-called", and "construct motivic Milnor fiber" should read "construct the motivic Milnor fiber". These are corrections to source lines 493 and 502.

Many thanks to Ehud Hrushovski and François Loeser for encouragements and enlightening discussions during the preparation of this manuscript. We also thanks Johannes Nicaise for suggesting to work on the Fubini theorem. Thanks also to Raf Cluckers and Martin Hils for inspiring discussions and comments. A.F. is supported by a DFG-SNF lead agency program grant (grant 200020L_175755).

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1. Introduction

Recent years have seen significant development in applying the Hrushovski-Kazhdan integration theory to the study of a variety of topics in geometry and topology, especially those around Denef-Loeser's motivic Milnor fiber. Such an approach was first articulated in [9] for the purpose of finding a more conceptual (read "resolution-free") construction of the complex motivic Milnor fiber, among other things; unfortunately, it contains a substantial technical oversight. The main goal of this paper is to present a new Hrushovski-Kazhdan style integral, the so-call *bounded integral*, that interpolates (or refines) the integral with volume forms and that without volume forms, and thereby fully rectify the results in [9]. The overhaul taken up here constitutes a comprehensive expansion of the theoretical framework of the Hrushovski-Kazhdan style integration that should prove amenable to new applications in the future.

Referee R002 [Typo; revised] – Wording.
Original source line 529. Replace "so-call" by "so-called". The first report's additional request to replace "rectify" by "rectifies" is withdrawn: "to present ... and thereby rectify ..." is a valid coordination of infinitives. Recasting the long sentence may improve readability, but no correction of that verb is required.

We now explain our construction in more detail. In this introduction, for concreteness, we work in the field $\tilde{\mathbb{C}} = \bigcup_{m\in\mathbb{Z}^+} \mathbb{C}(\!(t^{1/m})\!)$ of complex Puiseux series. This field is the algebraic closure of the field $\mathbb{C}(\!(t)\!)$ of complex Laurent series. A typical element takes the form $x = \sum_{n\in\mathbb{Z}} a_n t^{n/m}$ for some $m \in \mathbb{Z}^+$ such that its support $\operatorname{supp}(x) = \{n/m \in \mathbb{Q} \,|\, a_n \neq 0\}$ is well-ordered, in other words, there is a $q \in \mathbb{Q}$ such that $a_n = 0$ for all $n/m < q$. We think of $\mathbf{k} := \mathbb{C}$ as a subfield of $\tilde{\mathbb{C}}$ via the embedding $a \longmapsto at^0$. The map $\operatorname{val} : \tilde{\mathbb{C}}^\times \longrightarrow \mathbb{Q}$ given by $x \longmapsto \min \operatorname{supp}(x)$ is indeed a valuation, and its valuation ring $\mathcal{O}$ consists of those series x with $\min\operatorname{supp}(x) \geq 0$ and its maximal ideal $\mathcal{M}$ of those series x with $\min\operatorname{supp}(x) > 0$. Its residue field $\Bbbk$ admits a section onto $\mathbf{k}$ and hence is isomorphic to $\mathbb{C}$. For a series $x = \sum_{n\in\mathbb{Z}} a_n t^{n/m} \in \tilde{\mathbb{C}}$ with $\operatorname{val}(x) = p/m$, let $\operatorname{rv}(x) = a_p t^{p/m}$, which is called the *leading term* of x.

Referee R003 [Clarification] – Zero series convention.
Original source line 536. Set $\operatorname{val}(0) = \infty$ explicitly, or add 0 separately to the displayed descriptions of $\mathcal{O}$ and $\mathcal{M}$: $\min\operatorname{supp}(0)$ is undefined unless this convention is imposed. The leading-term formula here applies to nonzero series.

It is well-known that $(\tilde{\mathbb{C}}, \mathcal{O})$ is an algebraically closed valued field of equicharacteristic zero. Thus, we may think of it as an $\mathcal{L}_{\mathrm{RV}}$-model of the first-order theory $\mathrm{ACVF}(0,0)$ of such fields, with the parameter space (the "ground field") $\mathbb{S} = \mathbb{C}(\!(t)\!)$. Here the two sorts VF, RV of the language $\mathcal{L}_{\mathrm{RV}}$ are interpreted, respectively, as $\tilde{\mathbb{C}}$, $\tilde{\mathbb{C}}^\times/1+\mathcal{M}$ (or, equivalently, the set of leading terms) and the cross-sort function $\mathrm{rv} : \mathrm{VF}^\times \longrightarrow \mathrm{RV}$ as the quotient map (or the leading term map described above). The obvious epimorphism from RV onto the value group $\Gamma = \mathbb{Q}$, also referred to as the Γ-sort, with the kernel $\Bbbk^\times$, is denoted by vrv. See [17, § 2] for the precise definitions. The Galois group $\mathrm{Gal}(\tilde{\mathbb{C}}\,/\mathbb{C}(\!(t)\!))$, which is also the group of automorphisms over $\mathbb{C}(\!(t)\!)$ of $\tilde{\mathbb{C}}$ as a model of $\mathrm{ACVF}(0,0)$, may be identified with the procyclic group $\hat{\mu}$ of roots of unity (the limit of the inverse system of groups μ_n of nth roots of unity).

Referee R004 [Typo] – Quotient parentheses.
Original source line 538. Write $\tilde{\mathbb{C}}^\times/(1+\mathcal{M})$: without parentheses, the displayed quotient is ambiguous.

The category VF_* essentially consists of the definable subsets of VF^n, $n \geq 0$, as objects and the definable bijections between them as morphisms. The category $\mathrm{RV}[k]$ essentially consists of the definable subsets of RV^k as objects and the definable bijections between them as morphisms.

The category $\mathrm{RV}[*]$ is the coproduct of $\mathrm{RV}[k]$, $k \geq 0$, and hence is equipped with a gradation by ambient dimensions. The actual definitions will be recalled in § 3.

Referee R162 [Clarification; new] – The introductory description excludes finite covers.
Original source line 542. The phrase "essentially consists of the definable subsets of RV^k" is too restrictive, even up to definable bijection. For example,

$$U = \{(x, y) \in (\Bbbk^\times)^2 : y^2 = x^3 - x\}$$

is an affine open of a genus-one curve, and its projection to x makes it an object of $\mathrm{RES}[1] \subseteq \mathrm{RV}[1]$. It is not definably bijective to a subset of RV: orthogonality forces such an image to have finitely many value-group fibers; after naming lifts of their values, those fibers are constructible subsets of $\Bbbk^\times$. In characteristic zero, a definable bijection would then give a birational parametrization of a dense open of the genus-one curve by a subset of the affine line, which is impossible. Use the description in Definition 3.8: an object is a pair (U, f), with U in an arbitrary finite RV power and $f : U \longrightarrow \mathrm{RV}^k$ finite-to-one. The grading is the chosen target rank k, not the ambient dimension of U.

To such categories one associates Grothendieck rings $\mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{VF}_*$ and $\mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RV}[*]$, roughly constructed as the free group generated by isomorphism classes of objects, subject to the usual scissor relation $[A \smallsetminus B] + [B] = [A]$ for any objects $A \subseteq B$, and the product being given by fiber product. See Definition 3.1 for details.

Referee R005 [Error; revised] – Scissor relation.
Original source line 544. The inclusion is reversed: the relation $[A \smallsetminus B]+[B] = [A]$ requires $B \subseteq A$. With the displayed $A \subseteq B$, taking $A = \varnothing$ would force every $[B]$ to be zero. The multiplication intended here is Cartesian product. The first report's parenthetical description using a terminal object is withdrawn: the categories here admit only bijections, so that categorical description was inappropriate.

Pulling back from RV to VF along the map $\mathrm{rv} : \mathrm{VF}^\times \longrightarrow \mathrm{RV}$ yields a ring homomorphism between the Grothendieck rings

$$\mathbb{L} : \mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RV}[*] \longrightarrow \mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{VF}_* \tag{1.1}$$

One of the main results of [8] states that $\mathbb{L}$ is surjective with the kernel $(\boldsymbol{P} - 1)$, where $\boldsymbol{P}$ stands for the element $[\{1\}] - [\mathrm{rv}(\mathcal{M} \smallsetminus 0)]$ in $\mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RV}[1]$ (so the principal ideal $(\boldsymbol{P} - 1)$ is not homogenous), and hence, inverting, we get a canonical isomorphism

Referee R006 [Typo] – Spelling.
Original source line 550. Replace "homogenous" by "homogeneous" here and at its subsequent occurrences in this introduction.

$$\int : \mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{VF}_* \longrightarrow \mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RV}[*]/(\boldsymbol{P} - 1).$$

The structure of $\mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RV}[*]$ can be significantly elucidated. To wit, it is isomorphic to a tensor product of two other Grothendieck rings $\mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RES}[*]$ and $\mathbf{K}\,\Gamma[*]$, where $\mathrm{RES}[*]$ is the category of twisted constructible sets in the residue field $\Bbbk$ and $\Gamma[*]$ is the category of definable sets in the value group Γ (as an o-minimal group), both are graded by ambient dimensions. The objects of $\mathrm{RES}[*]$ are twisted because the short exact sequence

$$1 \longrightarrow \Bbbk^\times \longrightarrow \mathrm{RV} \longrightarrow \Gamma \longrightarrow 0$$

does not admit a natural splitting, and $\mathbf{K}\,\Gamma[*]$ is not the Grothendieck ring of o-minimal groups because not all definable bijections are admitted as morphisms. Anyway, we have two retractions from $\mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RV}[*]$ onto a quotient $!\mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RES}$ of $\mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RES}$ (the gradation is forgotten) that vanish on $(\boldsymbol{P}-1)$, reflecting the fact that there are two Euler characteristics in the Γ-sort; these are denoted by $\mathbb{E}_b$, $\mathbb{E}_g$.

Referee R007 [Error] – Different targets for the two retractions.
Original source line 559. The two targets should be distinguished already here. The bounded Euler-characteristic construction $\mathbb{E}_b$ lands in $!\mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RES}$, but the geometric one $\mathbb{E}_g$ requires affine-line localization: its dimension-free image lies in $!\mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RES}[[\mathbb{A}]^{-1}]$. For example, $\mathbb{E}_g([1]) = [\mathbb{A}]^{-1}$ after forgetting the grading, as computed in Remark 4.4. Thus both maps cannot be described here as retractions onto the same unlocalized ring.

The objects of VF_*, $\mathrm{RV}[*]$ may be equipped with Γ-volume forms, and the resulting categories are denoted by $\mu\mathrm{VF}[*]$, $\mu\mathrm{RV}[*]$. There is again a canonical isomorphism

$$\int^{\mu} : \mathbf{K}\,\mu\mathrm{VF}[*] \longrightarrow \mathbf{K}\,\mu\mathrm{RV}[*]/(\boldsymbol{P}),$$

where the principal ideal $(\boldsymbol{P})$ is now homogenous. The ring $\mathbf{K}\,\mu\mathrm{RV}[*]$ can be expressed as a tensor product of $\mathbf{K}\,\mu\mathrm{RES}[*]$ and $\mathbf{K}\,\mu\Gamma[*]$, which induces two retractions $\mu\mathbb{E}_b$, $\mu\mathbb{E}_g$ from $\mathbf{K}\,\mu\mathrm{RV}[*]$ onto $!\mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RES}[*]$ that vanish on $(\boldsymbol{P})$; see the right column of the diagram (1.2).

Referee R008 [Error] – Measured retraction target.
Original source line 567. The target stated here omits both the volume forms and the quotient. Proposition 4.7 gives $!\mathbf{K}\,\mu\mathrm{RES}[*]/([\mathbb{A}])$. Also, the current diagram (1.2) does not display either retraction: its former bottom row has been commented out. Correct the target and remove or update the reference to its "right column".

We think of $\int$ as the universal additive invariant (or generalized Euler characteristic) of definable sets and $\int^{\mu}$ as a motivic integral. They are not directly related, though: in $\mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{VF}_*$, two objects are identified if there is a definable bijection between them, whereas in $\mathbf{K}\,\mu\mathrm{VF}[*]$, two objects are identified if there is a measure-preserving bijection between two dense subobjects.

The main result of this paper is that the two isomorphisms $\int$, $\int^{\mu}$ can be interpolated by a third one, the bounded integral (Theorem 7.26):

$$\int^{\diamond} : \mathbf{K}\,\mu\mathrm{VF}^{\diamond}[*] \longrightarrow \mathbf{K}\,\mu\mathrm{RV}^{\mathrm{db}}[*]/(\boldsymbol{P}_{\Gamma}).$$

The category $\mu\mathrm{VF}^{\diamond}[*]$ consists of those *proper invariant* objects of $\mu\mathrm{VF}[*]$, which roughly means a bounded definable set that is a union of open boxes of valuative radius γ, $\gamma \in \Gamma$. The category $\mu\mathrm{RV}^{\mathrm{db}}[*]$ consists of those *doubly bounded* objects of $\mu\mathrm{RV}[*]$, in the sense that its image in the value group is doubly bounded. See § 6.1 for the precise definitions. Note that $\mu\mathrm{VF}^{\diamond}[*]$ is also graded since, as in classical measure theory, gradation by ambient dimensions is a necessity in the presence of volume forms (a curve has no volume if considered as a subset of a surface). The ideal $(\boldsymbol{P}_{\Gamma})$ is homogenous but no longer principal; it is generated by the elements $\boldsymbol{P}_{\gamma} \in \mathbf{K}\,\mu\mathrm{RV}^{\mathrm{db}}[1]$, one for each $\gamma \in \mathbb{Z}^{+}$, defined as follows. Let $\mathcal{M}_{\gamma}$ be the open disc around 0 with valuative radius γ and $t_{\gamma} \in \mathrm{vrv}^{-1}(\gamma)$ a definable element. Then $\boldsymbol{P}_{\gamma}$ is the element

$$[\mathrm{rv}(\mathcal{M} \smallsetminus \mathcal{M}_{\gamma})] + [\{t_{\gamma}\}] - [\{1\}]$$

with the constant volume form 0, and it does not depend on the choice of t_{γ}. We can express $\mathbf{K}\,\mu\mathrm{RV}^{\mathrm{db}}[*]$ as a tensor product of $\mathbf{K}\,\mu\mathrm{RES}[*]$ and $\mathbf{K}\,\mu\Gamma^{\mathrm{db}}[*]$. Since the objects of $\mu\Gamma^{\mathrm{db}}[*]$ are doubly bounded, the two Euler characteristics coincide and consequently there is only one retraction $\mathbb{E}^{\diamond}$ from $\mathbf{K}\,\mu\mathrm{RV}^{\mathrm{db}}[*]$ onto $!\mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RES}$ that vanishes on $(\boldsymbol{P}_{\Gamma})$.

Referee R009 [Clarification] – Uniqueness claim.
Original source line 580. The agreement of χ_b and χ_g on doubly bounded sets shows that these two constructions yield the same retraction; it does not establish uniqueness among all possible retractions. Replace "there is only one retraction" by "the two constructions give the same retraction".

The situation is summarized in the commutative diagram (1.2). More precisely speaking, the bounded integral $\int^{\diamond}$ is a common refinement of $\int$ and $\int^{\mu}$: it is finer than $\int$ because it carries volume forms, and it is finer than $\int^{\mu}$ because it only admits those measure-preserving morphisms that are defined everywhere (as opposed to on dense subobjects).

$$\begin{array}{ccccc} \mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{VF}_* & \longleftarrow & \mathbf{K}\,\mu\mathrm{VF}^{\diamond}[*] & \longrightarrow & \mathbf{K}\,\mu\mathrm{VF}[*] \\ \Big\downarrow{\scriptstyle \int} & & \Big\downarrow{\scriptstyle \int^{\diamond}} & & \Big\downarrow{\scriptstyle \int^{\mu}} \\ \mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RV}[*]/(\boldsymbol{P}-1) & \longleftarrow & \mathbf{K}\,\mu\mathrm{RV}^{\mathbf{db}}[*]/(\boldsymbol{P}_{\boldsymbol{\Gamma}}) & \longrightarrow & \mathbf{K}\,\mu\mathrm{RV}[*]/(\boldsymbol{P}) \end{array} \tag{1.2}$$

The general strategy for the construction of the bounded integral $\int^{\diamond}$ follows roughly that of the original Hrushovski-Kazhdan integral. One first defines a lifting homomorphism from $\mathbf{K}\,\mu\mathrm{RV}^{\mathbf{db}}[*]$ to $\mathbf{K}\,\mu\mathrm{VF}^{\diamond}[*]$, shows that it is surjective, then studies its kernel. On the technical side, in order to stay within the realm of proper invariant sets at each step of the construction, one is led to the notion of a *proper covariant* bijection, first formulated in [9]. It goes as follows (see Definition 6.2 for more details). For $\alpha \in \Gamma$, let $\pi_\alpha : \mathrm{VF} \longrightarrow \mathrm{VF}/\mathcal{M}_\alpha$ be the projection map; if $\alpha \in \Gamma^n$ then π_α denotes the product of the maps π_{α_i}. A definable bijection f from $A \subseteq \mathrm{VF}^n$ onto $B \subseteq \mathrm{VF}^m$ is said to be proper covariant if there are $\alpha \in \Gamma^n$, $\beta \in \Gamma^n$, and a function $f_\downarrow : \pi_\alpha(A) \longrightarrow \pi_\beta(B)$ such that A is α-invariant, B is β-invariant, and $\pi_\beta \circ f = f_\downarrow \circ \pi_\alpha$. In order to show the existence of such proper covariant bijections of a very special kind, we establish in § 2.3 some general properties of definable continuous functions, reminiscent of those of definable continuous functions in o-minimal theories (see, for instance, [4, Chapter 6]).

Referee R010 [Error] – Proper covariance in the introduction.
Original source line 629. Change $\beta \in \Gamma^n$ to $\beta \in \Gamma^m$. More substantially, include boundedness of A and B to match Definition 6.2; the displayed quotient condition alone is satisfied by the identity on the whole valued field, which is not proper covariant under that definition.

Next, we turn to the construction of the motivic Milnor fiber attached to a nonconstant polynomial function $f : (\mathbb{C}^d, 0) \longrightarrow (\mathbb{C}, 0)$, where 0 is assumed to be a singular point, that is, $\nabla f(0) = 0$.

By an (algebraic) variety over a field $\mathbf{k}$, we mean a reduced separated $\mathbf{k}$-scheme of finite type. We denote by $\mathrm{Var}_{\mathbf{k}}$ the category of varieties over $\mathbf{k}$. Let $\mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{Var}_{\mathbb{C}}$ be the Grothendieck ring of complex algebraic varieties and $\mathbf{K}^{\hat{\mu}}\,\mathrm{Var}_{\mathbb{C}}$ the corresponding Grothendieck ring with good $\hat{\mu}$-actions. Here, in addition to the factorization requirement for the $\hat{\mu}$-actions, the qualifier "good" also means that a $\mathbb{C}$-vector space endowed with a linear $\hat{\mu}$-action is identified with the same $\mathbb{C}$-vector space but endowed with the trivial $\hat{\mu}$-action.

Referee R011 [Error] – Good actions and the affine-action relation.
Original source line 634. Two different notions are conflated. A good finite-group action means that every orbit is contained in an affine open subset; for $\hat{\mu}$ one additionally requires factorization through some μ_n. Identifying different linear actions on affine space is a separate defining relation in the modified equivariant Grothendieck ring. State the goodness condition and the affine-action relation separately, including compatibility with products with an arbitrary equivariant variety. See Denef–Loeser, Geometry on arc spaces, Section 2.4.

Let $\mathscr{L}$ be the space of formal arcs on $\mathbb{C}^d$ at 0. So each element in $\mathscr{L}$ is of the form $\gamma(t) = (\gamma_1(t), \ldots, \gamma_d(t))$, where $\gamma_i(t)$ is a complex formal power series and $\gamma_i(0) = 0$. For each $m \in \mathbb{Z}^+$, let $\mathscr{L}_m$ be the space of such arcs modulo t^{m+1} (also referred to as "truncated arcs"). Consider the

following locally closed subset of $\mathscr{L}_m$:

$$\mathcal{X}_{f,m} = \{\gamma(t) \in \mathscr{L}_m \mid f(\gamma(t)) = t^m \mod t^{m+1}\}.$$

It may be viewed in a natural way as the set of closed points of an algebraic variety over $\mathbb{C}$ and, as such, carries a natural μ_m-action. The *motivic zeta function* attached to f is then the generating series whose coefficients are in effect the "$\hat{\mu}$-equivariant motivic volumes" of the sets of truncated arcs above:

$$Z_f(T) = \sum_{m \in \mathbb{Z}^+} [\mathcal{X}_{f,m}][\mathbb{A}]^{-nd} T^m \in \mathbf{K}^{\hat{\mu}} \operatorname{Var}_{\mathbb{C}}[[\mathbb{A}]^{-1}][\![T]\!].$$

Referee R012 [Error] – Zeta coefficient exponent.
Original source line 643. Replace $[\mathbb{A}]^{-nd}$ by $[\mathbb{A}]^{-md}$: m is the summation and truncation index; n is not defined here. The normalization in (8.7) is the correct one.

It is shown in [2, 3] that $Z_f(T)$ is rational and belongs to $\mathbf{K}^{\hat{\mu}} \operatorname{Var}_{\mathbb{C}}[[\mathbb{A}]^{-1}][T]_\dagger$, where the subscript "†" indicates that the ring is localized by a certain multiplicative family of elements. The *motivic Milnor fiber*

$$\mathscr{S}_f = -\lim_{T \to \infty} Z_f(T)$$

is then extracted from this rational expression via a formal process of sending the variable T to infinity (this process is also summarized in [9, § 8.4]). Of course, to justify calling $\mathscr{S}_f$ a "Milnor so-and-so" one needs to show, at the very least, that invariants of the *topological Milnor fiber* F_f attached to f can be recovered from it. This is indeed the case for, say, the Euler characteristic and the Hodge characteristic.

Originally, the proofs that $Z_f(T)$ is rational and the Euler (or Hodge) characteristics coincide both rely on resolution of singularities. More recently, in [9], these results are established by way of a more conceptual construction. To begin with, $Z_f(T)$ is expressed as

$$\sum_{m \in \mathbb{Z}^+} H_m([\mathcal{X}_f])T^m,$$

where the coefficients $H_m([\mathcal{X}_f])$ are certain integrals of definable sets that take values in the ring $\mathbf{K}^{\hat{\mu}} \operatorname{Var}_{\mathbb{C}}[[\mathbb{A}]^{-1}]$, and the so-called *nonarchimedean Milnor fiber* of f is the definable set

$$\mathcal{X}_f = \{x \in \mathcal{M}^d \mid \operatorname{rv}(f(x)) = \operatorname{rv}(t)\}.$$

Formulated in this way, the rationality of $Z_f(T)$ essentially follows from certain computation rules of (convergent) geometric series. That the Euler characteristics of $\mathscr{S}_f$ and F_f coincide follows from the fact that we can express both the Euler characteristic of each coefficient of $Z_f(T)$ and that of F_f in terms of traces of the monodromy action on the cohomological groups of F_f, where the first expression relies on the resolution-free proofs of the A'Campo-Denef-Loeser formula (this is the main point of [9]) and quasi-unipotence of local monodromy (see [9, Remark 8.5.5]). However, technical difficulties, arising from the fact that none of the morphisms (8.1.4), (8.1.6), and (8.1.7) in [9] is surjective, contrary to what is claimed in [8, Proposition 10.10(2)], make their construction of the integral H_m incomplete.

Referee R013 [Clarification] – Identify the failed surjectivity explicitly.
Original source line 658. Since this failure motivates the paper, give an explicit object outside the image of the cited tensor morphism, or a precise cross-reference to such an example with its obstruction explained. Merely listing the incorrect surjectivity claims does not let the reader verify why the replacement is necessary. This request in the human report remains relevant.

To remedy this, as an application of our main result, we complete their construction by recasting it in the formalism of the bounded integral $\int^{\diamond}$. More specifically, recall from [9, § 4.3] the canonical isomorphism

$$\Theta : !\mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RES} \longrightarrow \mathbf{K}^{\hat{\mu}}\,\mathrm{Var}_{\mathbb{C}},$$

which is essentially the operation of "twisting back" via a reduced cross-section (Definition 5.4). Let $\mathbf{K}^{\hat{\mu}}\,\mathrm{Var}_{\mathbb{C}}[[\mathbb{A}]^{-1}]_{\mathrm{loc}}$ be the localization of $\mathbf{K}^{\hat{\mu}}\,\mathrm{Var}_{\mathbb{C}}[[\mathbb{A}]^{-1}]$ by the multiplicative family generated by the elements $1-[\mathbb{A}]^{-i}$, $i \in \mathbb{Z}^+$. Let $\mathbf{K}^{\hat{\mu}}\,\mathrm{Var}_{\mathbb{C}}[[\mathbb{A}]^{-1}][T]_{\dagger}$ be the localization of $\mathbf{K}^{\hat{\mu}}\,\mathrm{Var}_{\mathbb{C}}[[\mathbb{A}]^{-1}][T]$ by the multiplicative family generated by the elements $1-[\mathbb{A}]^{a}T^{b}$, where $a \in \mathbb{Z}$ and $b \in \mathbb{Z}^+$; it may be regarded as a subring of $\mathbf{K}^{\hat{\mu}}\,\mathrm{Var}_{\mathbb{C}}[[\mathbb{A}]^{-1}][\![T]\!]$. Then we have a commutative diagram (1.3).

(1.3)

$$\begin{array}{ccccc}
\mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{VF}_{*} & \longleftarrow & \mathbf{K}^{\natural}\,\mu\mathrm{VF}^{\diamond}[*] & \longrightarrow & \mathbf{K}^{\natural}\,\mu\mathrm{VF}[*] \\
\downarrow{\scriptstyle \int} & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle \int^{\diamond}} & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle \int^{\mu}} \\
\mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RV}[*]/(\boldsymbol{P}-1) & \longleftarrow & \mathbf{K}^{\natural}\,\mu\mathrm{RV}^{\mathbf{db}}[*]/(\boldsymbol{P}_{\Gamma}) & \longrightarrow & \mathbf{K}^{\natural}\,\mu\mathrm{RV}^{\mathbf{bd}}[*]/(\boldsymbol{P}) \\
\downarrow{\scriptstyle \Theta\circ\mathbb{E}_b} & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle Z} & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle Z} \\
\mathbf{K}^{\hat{\mu}}\,\mathrm{Var}_{\mathbb{C}} & & \mathbf{K}^{\hat{\mu}}\,\mathrm{Var}_{\mathbb{C}}[[\mathbb{A}]^{-1}][T]_{\dagger} & \longrightarrow & \mathbf{K}^{\hat{\mu}}\,\mathrm{Var}_{\mathbb{C}}[[\mathbb{A}]^{-1}]_{\mathrm{loc}}[T]_{\dagger} \\
\downarrow & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle -\lim} & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle -\lim} \\
\mathbf{K}^{\hat{\mu}}\,\mathrm{Var}_{\mathbb{C}}[[\mathbb{A}]^{-1}] & = & \mathbf{K}^{\hat{\mu}}\,\mathrm{Var}_{\mathbb{C}}[[\mathbb{A}]^{-1}] & \longrightarrow & \mathbf{K}^{\hat{\mu}}\,\mathrm{Var}_{\mathbb{C}}[[\mathbb{A}]^{-1}]_{\mathrm{loc}}
\end{array}$$

Referee R014 [Error] – Domain of the limit arrow.
Original source line 678. The arrows labeled $-\lim$ are not defined on all of $R[T]_{\dagger}$, where R denotes the relevant coefficient ring: the polynomial T belongs to this localization and has no finite value at infinity. Use the subring of rational functions regular at infinity and with zero constant coefficient in their expansion at $T = 0$, equipped with Hadamard multiplication; equivalently specify the actual image of Z and prove it has these properties. On this domain $-\lim$ is compatible with Hadamard product. See Hrushovski–Loeser, Section 8.4 and Lemma 8.4.1. The domain issue for Z itself is addressed immediately below.

The superscript "$\natural$" means that the integral is restricted to the subring of a sort of "integrable" sets. The map Z assigns, to each object $[\boldsymbol{U}] \in \mathbf{K}^{\natural}\,\mu\mathrm{RV}^{\mathbf{db}}[*]$, a power series this is not quite right: the power series can indeed be assigned to every $[\boldsymbol{U}] \in \mathbf{K}^{\natural}\,\mu\mathrm{RV}^{\mathbf{db}}[*]$, this is how $\mathbf{K}^{\natural}$ is defined, but to show that it belongs to $\mathbf{K}^{\hat{\mu}}\,\mathrm{Var}_{\mathbb{C}}[[\mathbb{A}]^{-1}][T]_{\dagger}$ we need to further restrict to objects of the form $[\boldsymbol{U}] = [(U, f, l)]$ with $l \in \mathbb{Z}$

$$Z([\boldsymbol{U}])(T) = \sum_{m \in \mathbb{Z}^+} \boldsymbol{H}_m([\boldsymbol{U}])T^m \in \mathbf{K}^{\hat{\mu}}\,\mathrm{Var}_{\mathbb{C}}[[\mathbb{A}]^{-1}][\![T]\!],$$

that is, the motivic zeta function of $\boldsymbol{U}$, where $\boldsymbol{H}_m$ is the rectified version of H_m. Note that Z is a ring homomorphism with respect to the Hadamard product in the target. It turns out that $Z([\boldsymbol{U}])(T)$ is rational and belongs to $\mathbf{K}^{\hat{\mu}}\,\mathrm{Var}_{\mathbb{C}}[[\mathbb{A}]^{-1}][T]_{\dagger}$. The formal process $T \to \infty$ mentioned above then lands us in $\mathbf{K}^{\hat{\mu}}\,\mathrm{Var}_{\mathbb{C}}[[\mathbb{A}]^{-1}]$; this is the map $-\lim$. If we take $[\boldsymbol{U}]/(\boldsymbol{P}_{\Gamma}) = \int^{\diamond}([\mathcal{X}_f])$ then the end result is the motivic Milnor fiber $\mathscr{S}_f$.

Referee R015 [Gap; revised] – Incorporate the blue restriction into the statement.
Original source line 683. Yimu's blue note is mathematically substantive and is still contradicted by the following unrestricted rationality claim and diagram. The definition of $\mathbf{K}^{\natural}$ in Remark 8.4 ensures integral exponents for each m; it does not itself establish rationality as m varies. The proof of Theorem 8.11 establishes rationality for integer constant volume forms and finite sums of those classes. Restrict the general claim and diagram to the corresponding precisely specified image subring, checking the arrows on that subring, or prove the broader assertion. Also revise the unrestricted bounded-category claim near the end of Section 8. For the theorem about $\mathscr{X}_f$ itself, the needed constant-zero representative is supplied by Lemma 6.21 and Remark 8.4, subject to the preparation repairs below; it is not an additional missing hypothesis of that theorem.

Since $\mathscr{X}_f$ also lives in VF_*, we can recover $\mathscr{S}_f$ directly as $(\Theta \circ \mathbb{E}_b \circ \int)([\mathscr{X}_f])$ in $\mathbf{K}^{\hat{\mu}}\operatorname{Var}_{\mathbb{C}}$, without even inverting $[\mathbb{A}]$. This is indeed a salient point. However, for comparison with the Denef-Loeser construction, we have to go down to $\mathbf{K}^{\hat{\mu}}\operatorname{Var}_{\mathbb{C}}[[\mathbb{A}]^{-1}]$, since that is where the coefficients of the motivic zeta function live.

Referee R016 [Clarification] – Class before and after localization.
Original source line 685. The formula defines a canonical class in the unlocalized ring whose image is the Denef–Loeser motivic Milnor fiber. Equality after localization does not uniquely determine an unlocalized class, since localization at $[\mathbb{A}]$ need not be injective (as acknowledged in Remark 8.14). Say "a canonical unlocalized lift of $\mathscr{S}_f$" here, or explicitly adopt a separate notation for that lift.

The composite $\Theta \circ \mathbb{E}_b \circ \int$ is referred to as the *motivic volume operator*, usually denoted by Vol, and is already used implicitly in [8]. Since its reemergence in [9], it has been featured in a growing list of applications, see [15, 12, 11, 7, 14].

The nonarchimedean Milnor fiber $\mathscr{X}_f$ is closely related to the analytic Milnor fiber $\mathcal{F}_f^{\mathrm{an}}$ introduced in [13]. The $\tilde{\mathbb{C}}$-rational points of $\mathcal{F}_f^{\mathrm{an}}$ may be understood as an object of VF_* (but not $\mu\mathrm{VF}^{\diamond}[*]$) and hence, as such, admits a motivic volume $\mathrm{Vol}(\mathcal{F}_f^{\mathrm{an}})$. This is indeed the motivic Milnor fiber $\mathscr{S}_f$. This fact is already proven in [12], but without taking the $\hat{\mu}$-actions into account, and also in [11, 7]. The arguments there all rely on resolution of singularities.

The bounded integral $\int^{\diamond}$ is also used in [6] to obtain similar results on real motivic Milnor fiber.

In § 5, as a computational tool, we introduce the notion of a twistoid. There we prove two Fubini theorems that are not related to the rest of the paper. The first is a version of the tropical motivic Fubini theorem of [11]. In a simplified form (but of central interest), the second states the following.

Theorem. *Let $f : A \longrightarrow B$, $f : A' \longrightarrow B$ be morphisms of varieties over $\mathbb{C}$. If $\mathrm{Vol}_b([f^{-1}(b)]) = \mathrm{Vol}_b([f'^{-1}(b)])$ for all $b \in B$ then $\mathrm{Vol}([A]) = \mathrm{Vol}([A'])$. Consequently, if $\mathrm{Vol}_b([f^{-1}(b)]) = 0$ for all $b \in B$ then $\mathrm{Vol}([A]) = 0$.*

Referee R018 [Typo] – Second morphism.
Original source line 697. The second morphism must be $f' : A' \longrightarrow B$, not a second f.

Here the operator Vol_b is similar to Vol, but over the parameter space $\mathbb{C}(\!(t)\!)(b)$. It is essential to consider b in a sufficiently saturated model $\mathbb{U}$ of $\mathrm{ACVF}(0,0)$ instead of $\tilde{\mathbb{C}}$, allowing the hypothesis to be tested at generic points. A more general version, with A, B possibly arbitrary definable sets, appears as Theorem 5.17, but one needs to be more careful about the definition of Vol_b.

Referee R019 [Gap] – Meaning of the relative volume.
Original source line 699. The saturated-point requirement is appropriate, but the promised construction of Vol_b in Remark 5.18 needs correction for residue-field descent; see the detailed remark there. Until

that is supplied, state this introductory theorem using the equality in the parameter-relative $!\mathbf{K}$ RES ring appearing in Theorem 5.17, rather than using an unestablished isomorphism Θ_b.

Some property of this form is needed in [10]. We expect to find more applications of these results in motivic Donaldson-Thomas theory, along the line of [11].

The paper is organized as follows. In § 2 we recall and extend certain facts on definable sets in $\mathrm{ACVF}(0,0)$ that are needed later on. In particular, some new results about continuous definable functions in this environment are obtained, which could be of independent interest, such as fusion of continuous fibers (Proposition 2.55) and curve selection (Lemma 2.46), which closely resemble their counterparts in the *o*-minimal setting. In the short § 3 is introduced notations and results from the original Hrushovski-Kazhdan paper [8]. In § 4 we show how to replace classes of polytopes with numbers and thereby construct a retraction map from the Grothendieck ring in RV to that of varieties. Invariance and covariance are defined and investigated in § 6, where the surjectivity of the lifting homomorphism (1.1) is also established. Then in § 7 we study its kernel and finish the construction of the bounded integral $\int^{\diamond}$. Finally, § 8 is devoted to the construction of motivic zeta function and motivic Milnor fiber, rectifying the result in [9].

Referee R020 [Typo] – Grammar.
Original source line 706. Replace "In the short Section ... is introduced notations and results" by "The short Section ... introduces notation and results". Also write "the construction of the motivic zeta function and the motivic Milnor fiber".

2. Technicalities

2.1. Setting and notation.

Notation 2.1 (Coordinate projections). For each $n \in \mathbb{N}$, let $[n]$ denote the set $\{1, \dots, n\}$. For any $E \subseteq [n]$, we write $\mathrm{pr}_E(A)$, or even A_E, when there is no danger of confusion, for the projection of A into the coordinates contained in E. It is often more convenient to use simple standard descriptions as subscripts. For example, if E is a singleton $\{i\}$ then we shall always write E as i and $\tilde{E} \coloneqq [n] \smallsetminus E$ as $\tilde{i}$; similarly, if $E = [i]$, $\{k \mid i \leq k \leq j\}$, $\{k \mid i < k < j\}$, {all the coordinates in the sort S}, etc., then we may write $\mathrm{pr}_{\leq i}$, $\mathrm{pr}_{[i,j]}$, $A_{(i,j)}$, A_S, etc.; in particular, we shall frequently write A_{VF} and A_{RV} for the projections of A into the VF-sort and RV-sort coordinates.

Unless otherwise specified, by writing $a \in A$ we shall mean that a is a finite tuple of elements (or "points") of A, whose length, denoted by $\mathrm{lh}(a)$, is not always indicated. If $a = (a_1, \dots, a_n)$ then, for $1 \leq i < j \leq n$, following the notational scheme above, a_i, $a_{\tilde{i}}$, $a_{\leq i}$, $a_{[i,j]}$, a_{VF}, etc., are shorthand for the corresponding subtuples of a.

We shall write $\{t\} \times A$, $\{t\} \cup A$, $A \smallsetminus \{t\}$, etc., simply as $t \times A$, $t \cup A$, $A \smallsetminus t$, etc., when it is clearly understood that t is an element and hence must be interpreted as a singleton in these expressions.

For $a \in A_{\tilde{E}}$, the fiber $\{b : (b, a) \in A\} \subseteq A_E$ over a is often denoted by A_a. Note that, in the discussion below, the distinction between the two sets A_a and $A_a \times \{a\}$ is usually immaterial and hence they may and shall be tacitly identified. In particular, given a function $f : A \longrightarrow B$ and $b \in B$, the pullback $f^{-1}(b)$ is sometimes written as A_b as well. This is a special case since functions are identified with their graphs. This notational scheme is especially useful when the function f has been clearly understood in the context and hence there is no need to spell it out all the time.

Resolved referee R021 [Clarification] – Elements versus tuples; scalar hypotheses.
Original source line 724. The sentence beginning 'by writing $a \in A$' should say that an element of A may itself be a tuple, rather than that it is a tuple of elements of A. More importantly, please explicitly override

this convention whenever a result requires a single coordinate; the exchange principle and Lemma 2.15 below are false for arbitrary tuples.

Author resolution. The explicitly stated tuple convention is retained. The author has clarified that literal subsets of VF or RV specify one coordinate; the tuple convention does not enlarge that scope. Scalar exchange is explicit in Lemma 2.14, and Lemma 2.15 is already unary as written. The suggested rephrasing of the convention is editorial; no further main-text amendment is adopted.

From here on we work in a sufficiently saturated model $\mathbb{U}$ of $\mathrm{ACVF}(0,0)$, together with a parameter set $\mathbb{S}$, which is supposed to be a substructure of $\mathbb{U}$. So by a definable set we shall mean an $\mathbb{S}$-definable set, unless indicated otherwise. For the rest of this paper, we assume that $\Gamma(\mathbb{S})$ is nontrivial.

Notation 2.2. There is a special element $\infty = \mathrm{rv}(0)$ in the RV-sort. For simplicity, we shall write RV to mean the RV-sort without the element ∞, and RV_∞ otherwise — that is, $\mathrm{RV} = \mathrm{rv}(\mathrm{VF}^\times)$ and $\mathrm{RV}_\infty = \mathrm{rv}(\mathrm{VF})$ — although the difference rarely matters (when it does we will of course provide further clarification).

Terminology 2.3 (Sets and subsets). By a definable set in VF we mean a definable subset in the sort VF, by which we just mean a subset of VF^n for some n, unless indicated otherwise; similarly for other sorts or structures in place of VF that have been clearly understood in the context, such as RV_∞, $\Bbbk$, $\mathcal{M}$, or any substructure $\mathbb{M}$ of $\mathbb{U}$. In particular, a definable set without further qualification means a definable set in $\mathbb{U}$, that is, a definable subset of $\mathrm{VF}^n \times \mathrm{RV}_\infty^m$ for some $n, m \in \mathbb{N}$.

Terminology 2.4 (Relations as functions). We may think of a relation C between two sets A and B, that is, a subset $C \subseteq A \times B$, as a function from A into the powerset $\mathcal{P}(B)$. For instance, if $A \subseteq \mathrm{VF}^n \times \mathrm{RV}^m$ is a definable set then it may be thought of as a *definable* function from A_{VF} into $\mathcal{P}(\mathrm{RV}^m)$. Thus a definable function $f : A \longrightarrow \mathcal{P}(B)$ is ontologically the same as the definable set $\bigcup_{a\in A} a \times f(a)$. We say that f is *finitary* if $f(a)$ is finite for every $a \in A$.

The default topology in $\mathbb{U}$ is the valuation topology.

Notation 2.5. A set $\mathfrak{p} \subseteq \mathrm{VF}^n \times \mathrm{RV}_\infty^m$ of the form $\prod_{i\leq n} \mathfrak{b}_i \times t$ is called an (*open, closed,* RV-) *polydisc* if each $\mathfrak{b}_i$ is an (open, closed, RV-) disc. The *radius* $\mathrm{rad}(\mathfrak{p})$ of the polydisc $\mathfrak{p}$ is the tuple $(\mathrm{rad}(\mathfrak{b}_1), \ldots, \mathrm{rad}(\mathfrak{b}_n))$. The open polydisc centered at $(a,t) \in \mathrm{VF}^n \times \mathrm{RV}_\infty^m$ with radius $\gamma \in \Gamma^n$ is denoted by $\mathfrak{o}((a,t),\gamma)$; the closed polydisc with radius $\gamma \in \Gamma_\infty^n$ is denoted by $\mathfrak{c}((a,t),\gamma)$. Radius ∞ is used only for closed discs, with $\mathfrak{c}(a,\infty) = \{a\}$; open discs have finite valuative radius.

The subdiscs $\mathfrak{o}(0,\gamma)$, $\mathfrak{c}(0,\gamma)$ of VF are more suggestively denoted by $\mathcal{M}_\gamma$, $\mathcal{O}_\gamma$, respectively, and $\mathcal{M}_0$, $\mathcal{O}_0$ are even more suggestively denoted by $\mathcal{M}$, $\mathcal{O}$. Write $\mathrm{RV}_\infty^{\circ\circ} = \mathrm{rv}(\mathcal{M})$ and $\mathrm{RV}^{\circ\circ} = \mathrm{RV}_\infty^{\circ\circ} \smallsetminus \infty$. More generally, for $\gamma \in \Gamma$, denote by $\mathrm{RV}_\gamma^{\circ\circ}$ the set $\mathrm{rv}(\mathcal{M}_\gamma \smallsetminus 0)$.

An RV-*disc* is a fiber $\mathrm{rv}^{-1}(t)$ for $t \in \mathrm{RV}_\infty$, including $\mathrm{rv}^{-1}(\infty) = \{0\}$. In a mixed ambient space, an RV-polydisc keeps the existing RV_∞-coordinates fixed. The RV-*hull* of a set A, denoted by $\mathrm{RVH}(A)$, is the union of all the RV-polydiscs whose intersections with A are nonempty. If A equals $\mathrm{RVH}(A)$ then A is called an RV-*pullback*.

Resolved referee R022 [Clarification] – RV-discs and the zero fiber.
Original source line 748. Define an RV-disc explicitly as $\mathrm{rv}^{-1}(t)$ for $t \in \mathrm{RV}_\infty$, including $\mathrm{rv}^{-1}(\infty) = \{0\}$. This convention is needed for the equivalence between being an RV-pullback and having empty RV-boundary; otherwise sets meeting coordinate hyperplanes are not covered by their stated RV-hulls. Also specify that taking the hull keeps the existing RV-coordinates fixed.

Author resolution. This is the intended convention. The definition now explicitly includes the singleton zero fiber and preserves the existing RV-coordinates under the hull.

Terminology 2.6. A VF-*fiber* of a set A is a set of the form A_t, where $t \in A_{\mathrm{RV}}$; in particular, a VF-fiber of a function $f : A \longrightarrow B$ is a set of the form f_t for some $t \in f_{\mathrm{RV}}$ (here f also stands for its own graph) which is indeed (the graph of) a function. We say that A is open if every one of its VF-fibers is, f is continuous if every one of its VF-fibers is, and so on. Composition is understood fiberwise, retaining the intermediate RV-coordinates: for every fixed input, intermediate, and output RV-tuple, the corresponding VF-fiber maps compose continuously on their natural domain. Thus, if f, g are continuous functions with $\mathrm{ran}(f) \subseteq \mathrm{dom}(g)$, the composite with these intermediate labels retained is continuous in this fiberwise sense.

Resolved referee R023 [Error] – Fiberwise continuity is not closed under composition. *Original source line 753.* The last assertion is false with the stated definition. Put $r = \mathrm{rv}(1)$ and $s = \mathrm{rv}(-1)$, let $f : \mathrm{VF} \longrightarrow \{r, s\}$ send 0 to r and every nonzero point to s, and let $g(r) = 0$, $g(s) = 1$ in VF. Every VF-fiber of both graphs is continuous in the prescribed sense, whereas $g \circ f$ is discontinuous at 0. A sufficient repair is to require, in addition, that the output RV-coordinates be locally constant on each input VF-fiber; equivalently use the valuation topology on VF and the discrete topology on RV. If the weaker convention is retained, delete the composition assertion and check every later use of composition separately.

Author resolution. The composition remark concerns composition on fixed RV-fibers, with the intermediate RV-labels retained. This intention is now explicit. The original fiberwise continuity convention is retained; no stronger topology is imposed. The example discards the intermediate label, so it does not contradict the clarified assertion.

Notation 2.7. Semantically we shall treat the value group Γ as a definable sort (the Γ-sort). However, syntactically any reference to Γ may be eliminated in the usual way and we can still work with $\mathcal{L}_{\mathrm{RV}}$-formulas for the same purpose. This implies that $\gamma \in \Gamma$ is definable means that $\mathrm{val}^{-1}(\gamma)$ is definable.

We shall write $\gamma^\sharp$, $\gamma \in \Gamma$, when we want to emphasize that it is the set $\mathrm{vrv}^{-1}(\gamma) \subseteq \mathrm{RV}$ that is being considered. More generally, if I is a set in Γ then we write $I^\sharp = \bigcup\{\gamma^\sharp \mid \gamma \in I\}$. Similarly, if U is a set in RV then $U^\sharp$ stands for $\bigcup\{\mathrm{rv}^{-1}(t) \mid t \in U\}$. In particular, $\gamma^{\sharp\sharp} = \{x \in \mathrm{VF} \mid \mathrm{val}(x) = \gamma\}$.

Notation 2.8. Let $U \subseteq \mathrm{RV}^n \times \Gamma^m$, $V \subseteq \mathrm{RV}^{n'} \times \Gamma^{m'}$, and $C \subseteq U \times V$. The Γ-*Jacobian* of C at $((u, \alpha), (v, \beta)) \in C$, written as $\mathrm{Jcb}_\Gamma((u, \alpha), (v, \beta))$, is the element

$$\mathrm{Jcb}_\Gamma((u, \alpha), (v, \beta)) = -\Sigma(\mathrm{vrv}(u), \alpha) + \Sigma(\mathrm{vrv}(v), \beta),$$

where $\Sigma(\gamma_1, \ldots, \gamma_n) = \gamma_1 + \ldots + \gamma_n$. If C is the graph of a function then we just write $\mathrm{Jcb}_\Gamma C(u, \alpha)$ instead of $\mathrm{Jcb}_\Gamma((u, \alpha), C(u, \alpha))$.

Convention 2.9. We may and shall assume that in any $\mathcal{L}_{\mathrm{RV}}$-formula, every VF-sort term (polynomial) occurs in the scope of an instance of the function symbol rv. For example, if $f(x)$, $g(x)$ are polynomials then the formula $f(x) = g(x)$ is equivalent to $\mathrm{rv}(f(x) - g(x)) = \infty$. The polynomial $f(x)$ in $\mathrm{rv}(f(x))$ is referred to as a *top term* (of the $\mathcal{L}_{\mathrm{RV}}$-formula in question).

Notation 2.10 (The definable sort DC of discs). At times it will be more convenient to work in the traditional expansion $\mathbb{U}^{\mathrm{eq}}$ of $\mathbb{U}$ by all definable sorts. However, for our purpose, a much simpler expansion $\mathbb{U}^\bullet$ suffices. This expansion has only one additional sort DC that contains, as elements, all the open and closed discs. Since each point in VF may be regarded as a closed disc of valuative radius ∞, for convenience, we may and occasionally do think of VF as a subset of DC. Heuristically, we may think of a disc that is properly contained in an RV-disc as a "thickened" point of certain stature in VF. There are two uniform cross-sort maps $\mathrm{VF} \times \Gamma \longrightarrow \mathrm{DC}$ in $\mathbb{U}^\bullet$, sending (a, γ) to the open disc $\mathfrak{o}(a, \gamma)$ and to the closed disc $\mathfrak{c}(a, \gamma)$, respectively. The closed-disc map extends to

$\mathrm{VF} \times \Gamma_\infty$ by $(a, \infty) \mapsto \{a\}$. The radius is an argument of these maps, rather than an index for separately named function symbols.

The expansion $\mathbb{U}^\bullet$ can help reduce the technical complexity of our discussion. However, as is the case with the definable Γ-sort, it is conceptually inessential since, for the purpose of this paper, all allusions to discs as (imaginary) elements may be eliminated in favor of objects already definable in $\mathbb{U}$.

Whether parameters in DC are used or not shall be indicated explicitly, if it is necessary, by means of introducing parameters of the form $\ulcorner \mathfrak{a} \urcorner$ or the phrase "in $\mathbb{U}^\bullet$," in which case the substructure $\mathbb{S}$ may contain names for discs that may or may not be definable from $\mathrm{VF}(\mathbb{S}) \cup \mathrm{RV}(\mathbb{S})$.

A disc centered at 0 may be identified with its valuative radius together with its open/closed designation (Γ is already treated as a definable sort). At a fixed finite radius the open and closed discs are distinct; the radius ∞ designates only the closed singleton disc.

For a disc $\mathfrak{a} \subseteq \mathrm{VF}$, the corresponding imaginary element in DC is denoted by $\ulcorner \mathfrak{a} \urcorner$ when notational distinction makes the discussion more streamlined; $\ulcorner \mathfrak{a} \urcorner$ may be heuristically thought of as the "name" of $\mathfrak{a}$. Conversely, a set $D \subseteq \mathrm{DC}$ is often identified with the set $\{\mathfrak{a} \mid \ulcorner \mathfrak{a} \urcorner \in D\}$, in which case $\bigcup D$ denotes a subset of VF.

Resolved referee R024 [Clarification] – A uniform language for the disc sort.
Original source line 791. For a literal language expansion, use two uniform maps $(a, \gamma) \mapsto \mathfrak{o}(a, \gamma)$ and $(a, \gamma) \mapsto \mathfrak{c}(a, \gamma)$, with domain $\mathrm{VF} \times \Gamma$ (and the specified degenerate cases). A separate named function for every element γ of the monster would name those radii and change the parameter structure. Also retain an open/closed tag when identifying discs centered at 0 with radii: the two discs with a fixed finite radius are distinct.

Author resolution. The original wording was informal shorthand for uniform maps with the radius as an argument. The maps and the open/closed designation are now explicit. Open discs have finite valuative radius; only closed discs admit the singleton radius-∞ case.

2.2. **Of points, discs, and atoms.** The substructure $\mathbb{S}$ is VF-*generated* if it is generated solely by elements in VF, similarly for being $(\mathrm{VF}, \mathrm{RV})$-generated, and so on. If $\mathbb{S}$ is VF-generated then the map rv is surjective in $\mathbb{S}$, and the standing assumption makes $\Gamma(\mathbb{S})$ nontrivial. Then the model-theoretic algebraic closure $\operatorname{acl}\mathbb{S}$ of $\mathbb{S}$ is a model of $\mathrm{ACVF}(0,0)$; see, for instance, [16, Corollary 4.18]. In that case, we also know what the definable closure $\operatorname{dcl}\mathbb{S}$ of $\mathbb{S}$ is:

Lemma 2.11. *Suppose that* $\mathbb{S}$ *is* VF*-generated and* $\Gamma(\mathbb{S})$ *is nontrivial. Then* $\operatorname{dcl}\mathbb{S} = \mathbb{S}$ *if and only if the underlying valued field* $(\mathrm{VF}(\mathbb{S}), \mathcal{O}(\mathbb{S}))$ *of* $\mathbb{S}$ *is henselian.*

Proof. We have $\mathrm{VF}(\operatorname{acl}\mathbb{S}) = \mathrm{VF}(\mathbb{S})^{\mathrm{ac}}$, where the latter is the field-theoretic algebraic closure of $\mathrm{VF}(\mathbb{S})$. Since the valued field automorphisms of $(\mathrm{VF}(\mathbb{S})^{\mathrm{ac}}, \mathcal{O}(\operatorname{acl}\mathbb{S}))$ over $(\mathrm{VF}(\mathbb{S}), \mathcal{O}(\mathbb{S}))$ are in one-to-one correspondence with the $\mathcal{L}_{\mathrm{RV}}$-automorphisms of $\operatorname{acl}\mathbb{S}$ over $\mathbb{S}$ and $\mathrm{VF}(\mathbb{S})$ is the fixed field with respect to these automorphisms if and only if $(\mathrm{VF}(\mathbb{S}), \mathcal{O}(\mathbb{S}))$ is henselian, we see that $\mathrm{VF}(\operatorname{dcl}\mathbb{S}) = \mathrm{VF}(\mathbb{S})$ if and only if $(\mathrm{VF}(\mathbb{S}), \mathcal{O}(\mathbb{S}))$ is henselian. By quantifier elimination and routine syntactical inspection, $\mathrm{RV}(\operatorname{dcl}\mathbb{S}) = \mathrm{RV}(\mathbb{S})$. The lemma follows. □

We shall impose at a later stage the assumption that $\mathbb{S}$ is VF-generated and (without loss of generality) definably closed, that is, $\operatorname{dcl}\mathbb{S} = \mathbb{S}$.

Lemma 2.12 ([16, Lemma 4.10])**.** *For any finite definable set* A *in* VF *there is a definable bijection* $f : A \longrightarrow U$ *for some set* U *in* RV*.*

The phenomenon exemplified by this simple lemma is dubbed "internalizing finite sets." Its failure in positive residue characteristics belies the deep obstacles one faces in developing a Hrushovski-Kazhdan integration theory therein; see the discussion around [8, Lemma 3.9].

Lemma 2.13 ([17, Lemma 3.3])**.** *For $a, b \in \mathrm{VF}$ and $t \in \mathrm{RV}$, if b is algebraic over (a, t) then it is algebraic over a.*

Lemma 2.14 ([16, Lemma 4.3])**.** *The exchange principle holds for single elements in both sorts, with all algebraic closures taken over the same fixed parameter base:*

- *For any a, $b \in \mathrm{VF}$, if $a \in \mathrm{acl}(b) \setminus \mathrm{acl}(\emptyset)$ then $b \in \mathrm{acl}(a)$.*
- *For any t, $s \in \mathrm{RV}$, if $t \in \mathrm{acl}(s) \setminus \mathrm{acl}(\emptyset)$ then $s \in \mathrm{acl}(t)$.*

Resolved referee R025 [Error; revised] – Exchange requires singleton elements.
Original source line 823. Here a, b (and t, s) must be single elements of the indicated sort, with exchange allowed over an additional common parameter set. Under the tuple convention above, take independent x, y, $a = x$, and $b = (x, y)$: then $a \in \mathrm{acl}(b) \setminus \mathrm{acl}(\varnothing)$ but $b \notin \mathrm{acl}(a)$. State the scalar version explicitly. Tuple applications should use the corresponding pregeometry argument, with all closures taken over the same fixed base.

Author resolution. The exchange assertions concern single VF or RV elements over the same fixed parameter base. This intended scope is now explicit; tuple arguments use scalar exchange coordinate by coordinate.

Lemma 2.15. *Let $f : A \longrightarrow \mathcal{P}(B)$ be a definable finitary function, where A, B are subsets of* VF*. Then there is a finite definable subset $B' \subseteq B$ such that, for every $b \in B$, the fiber $A_b = \{a \in A \mid b \in f(a)\}$ is infinite if and only if $b \in B'$. The same holds if A, B are subsets of* RV*.*

Proof. Let $b \in B$ such that A_b is infinite. Then, by compactness, there is an element $a \in A_b \setminus \mathrm{acl}(b)$. Since f is finitary, which means $b \in \mathrm{acl}(a)$, we must have, by Lemma 2.14, $b \notin \mathrm{acl}(a) \setminus \mathrm{acl}(\emptyset)$ and hence $b \in \mathrm{acl}(\emptyset)$. It follows that there is an algebraic subset $B' \subseteq B$ such that if A_b is infinite then $b \in B'$, for otherwise, by compactness again, there would be a $b \in B$ that lies outside every algebraic subset of B and yet the size of A_b is not bounded by any natural number. Clearly we can adjust B' so that it contains exactly those $b \in B$ with A_b infinite. The second case is similar. □

Resolved referee R026 [Error; revised] – The finite-exception lemma is unary.
Original source line 830. Require $A \subseteq \mathrm{VF}$ with one source coordinate, and state the corresponding unary-source restriction in the RV version. Under Terminology 2.3, the assertion is false for $A = \mathrm{VF}^2$, $B = \mathrm{VF}$, $f(x, y) = \{x\}$: every inverse fiber is infinite. The target may still be a tuple: if an infinite source fiber exists, scalar exchange applied to each target coordinate shows that each is algebraic over the base. The compactness argument then gives the required finite exceptional set. Clarify that all closures in this proof are over $\mathbb{S}$.

Author resolution. The author confirms that the original wording $A, B \subseteq \mathrm{VF}$ (and likewise RV) already specifies single coordinates; the tuple convention does not apply to this wording. The statement is unchanged, and all closures in the proof are over the fixed base $\mathbb{S}$.

Definition 2.16. We set $\dim_{\mathrm{VF}}(\varnothing) = -\infty$. For a nonempty definable set A, the VF-*dimension*, denoted by $\dim_{\mathrm{VF}}(A)$, is the largest natural number k such that, possibly after re-indexing of the VF-coordinates, $\mathrm{pr}_{\leq k}(A_t)$ has nonempty interior for some $t \in A_{\mathrm{RV}}$.

It is a fact that if $A \subseteq \mathrm{VF}^n$ is definable then $\dim_{\mathrm{VF}}(A)$ equals the Zariski dimension of the Zariski closure of A, see for example [8, § 3.8] for more on dimensions.

Lemma 2.17 ([17, Lemma 4.6]). *Let A be a definable set with $A_{\mathrm{VF}} \subseteq \mathrm{VF}^n$. Then $\dim_{\mathrm{VF}}(A) = n$ if and only if there is a $t \in A_{\mathrm{RV}}$ such that A_t contains an open polydisc.*

Lemma 2.18. *Let $b \in \mathrm{VF}$ and $\mathfrak{a} \subseteq \mathrm{VF}^n$ be a polydisc with $\dim_{\mathrm{VF}}(\mathfrak{a}) = n$. If b is algebraic over $\ulcorner \mathfrak{a} \urcorner$ then it is indeed algebraic.*

Proof. Let $\alpha = \mathrm{rad}(\mathfrak{a})$. Then, for any $a \in \mathfrak{a}$, b is algebraic over (a, α) and hence, by Lemma 2.13, is algebraic over a. Since there is an $a \in \mathfrak{a}$ such that $a_i \notin \mathrm{acl}(a_{\tilde{i}}, b)$ for all $i \in [n]$, by Lemma 2.14, b must be algebraic. □

Lemma 2.19 ([16, Lemma 4.15]). *If $\mathbb{S}$ is $(\mathrm{VF}, \mathrm{RV}, \Gamma)$-generated then every algebraic (respectively, definable) closed disc contains an algebraic (respectively, definable) point.*

Lemma 2.20 ([16, Lemma 4.17]). *If $\mathbb{S}$ is (VF, Γ)-generated then every algebraic (respectively, definable) disc contains an algebraic (respectively, definable) point.*

A pillar of the structure of definable sets in $\mathbb{U}$ is *C-minimality*, meaning that every definable subset of VF is a finite boolean combination of valuative discs, allowing additional parameters to name the individual discs.

Resolved referee R027 [Clarification] – Parameters of the balls in C-minimality.
Original source line 859. The balls in a finite Boolean decomposition need not be individually $\mathbb{S}$-definable. For example, a definable pair of conjugate algebraic points need not split into two definable singleton balls. Say 'balls with additional parameters (whose finite canonical family is algebraic over the defining parameters)' and retain the Galois-invariant family where individual components cannot be chosen.

Author resolution. Unqualified definability remains relative to the fixed ground parameter set. The individual discs in a finite Boolean decomposition may require additional parameters to be named; the sentence now makes that distinction explicit.

Corollary 2.21. *Suppose that $\mathbb{S}$ is $(\mathrm{VF}, \mathrm{RV}, \Gamma)$-generated. Let $\mathfrak{a} \subseteq \mathrm{VF}$ be a definable disc and A a definable subset of VF. If $\mathfrak{a} \cap A$ is a nonempty proper subset of $\mathfrak{a}$ then $\mathfrak{a}$ contains a definable point.*

Proof. It is not hard to see that, by C-minimality, if $\mathfrak{a} \cap A$ is a nonempty proper subset of $\mathfrak{a}$ then $\mathfrak{a}$ contains a definable closed disc and hence the claim is immediate by Lemma 2.19. □

Definition 2.22. Let D be a set of parameters. We say that a (not necessarily definable) nonempty set A *generates a (complete) D-type* if, for every D-definable set B, either $A \subseteq B$ or $A \cap B = \emptyset$. In that case, A is *D-type-definable* if no set properly contains A and also generates a D-type. If A is D-definable and generates a D-type, or equivalently, if A is both D-definable and D-type-definable then we say that A is *D-atomic* or *atomic over D*.

We simply say "atomic" when $D = \emptyset$.

In the literature, a type could be a partial type and hence a type-definable set may have nontrivial intersection with a definable set. In this paper, since partial types do not play a role, we shall not carry the superfluous qualifier "complete" in our terminology.

Lemma 2.23 ([18, Lemma 3.3]). *Suppose that $\Gamma(\mathbb{S})$ is nontrivial. Let A be an atomic set. Then A is γ-atomic for all $\gamma \in \Gamma$.*

Resolved referee R028 [Error] – Atomic base change needs a nontrivial base value group.
Original source line 879. The unrestricted statement remains false over a trivially valued base, as the human referee observed. Over a trivially valued algebraically closed field, $A = \mathcal{M} \setminus \{0\}$ is atomic; a parameter $\gamma > 0$ cuts it into the nonempty proper subset $\{x : 0 < \mathrm{val}(x) < \gamma\}$. Impose a nontrivial

base value group here and propagate that assumption through uses of this lemma. In the cited proof, the essential step is that a nonempty definable subset of Γ contains a definable point; this fails for $(0, \infty)$ over the trivial base.

Author resolution. The author adopts nontrivial $\Gamma(\mathbb{S})$ as a standing assumption throughout the paper, matching the blanket hypothesis in [18]. It persists under parameter extension and supplies the required hypothesis here and in subsequent uses, including Lemma 2.25 and Corollary 2.30. The contrary permission at the opening of Section 6 is removed.

Lemma 2.24. *Let $\mathfrak{a} \subseteq \mathrm{VF}^n$ be an atomic open polydisc. Then $\mathfrak{a}$ is t-atomic for all $t \in \mathrm{RV}$.*

Proof. If disc parameters have previously been named, the unary assertion follows directly from [18, Lemma 3.9], in its stated $\mathbb{U}^\bullet$ context: for any formula $\varphi(x, t)$ over this base, the definable map $x \mapsto \{s \in \mathrm{RV} : \varphi(x, s)\}$ is constant on the atomic open disc. Thus naming t does not split its type. For a real/Γ ground base the following argument also applies. For the case $n = 1$, if $\mathfrak{a}$ were not t-atomic then, by Corollary 2.21 and Lemma 2.13, it would contain a point algebraic over the fixed ground base. This point belongs to a finite ground-definable set. Atomicity would then force the whole infinite open disc $\mathfrak{a}$ to lie in that finite set, a contradiction. For the case $n > 1$, by induction on n, $\mathfrak{a}_1$ is t-atomic and for every $a \in \mathfrak{a}_1$, $\mathfrak{a}_{>1}$ is (a, t)-atomic. So $\mathfrak{a}$ cannot have a nonempty proper t-definable subset. □

Resolved referee R029 [Gap] – Atomicity proof: algebraic versus definable.
Original source line 886. Lemma 2.13 only gives an algebraic point over the original base, not necessarily a definable point. This suffices: an infinite atomic disc cannot meet a finite base-definable set. Replace 'definable point' at this step by that argument. The final sentence also needs 'nonempty proper t-definable subset'. Finally, indicate why Corollary 2.21 remains applicable whenever previously named disc parameters occur in the base; its stated hypothesis excludes such extra parameters.

Author resolution. The author approves both proof corrections: the point is algebraic over the fixed ground base, so atomicity would place the infinite disc inside a finite ground-definable set; and the final sentence now says "nonempty proper." The statement is unchanged. For previously named disc parameters, the unary case now cites the accepted result [18, Lemma 3.9] in its $\mathbb{U}^\bullet$ context: set-valued RV constancy prevents a new RV name from splitting the atomic disc. The original real/Γ proof and product induction are retained. This resolves the additional disc-parameter issue without extending Corollary 2.21 beyond its stated hypotheses.

Lemma 2.25. *Suppose that $\Gamma(\mathbb{S})$ is nontrivial. Let $A \subseteq \mathrm{VF}^n$ be a set that generates a type and $\mathfrak{b} \subseteq A$ an open (or closed) polydisc. Then $\mathfrak{b}$ is $\ulcorner \mathfrak{b} \urcorner$-atomic.*

Proof. We do induction on n. The base case $n = 1$ is just [18, Lemma 3.4]. For the case $n > 1$, write $\mathfrak{b} = \prod_i \mathfrak{b}_i$, $\mathfrak{b}' = \prod_{i>1} \mathfrak{b}_i$, and $\gamma = \mathrm{rad}(\mathfrak{b}_1)$. For any $a \in \mathfrak{b}_1$, A_a generates a type. So, by Lemma 2.23 and the inductive hypothesis, $\mathfrak{b}'$ is $(a, \gamma, \ulcorner \mathfrak{b}' \urcorner)$-atomic and hence $\ulcorner \mathfrak{b} \urcorner$-atomic. Similarly $\mathfrak{b}_1$ is $\ulcorner \mathfrak{b} \urcorner$-atomic. It follows that $\mathfrak{b}$ must be $\ulcorner \mathfrak{b} \urcorner$-atomic. □

Lemma 2.26. *Let $\mathfrak{a} \subseteq \mathrm{VF}^n$ be an atomic open polydisc and $f : \mathfrak{a} \longrightarrow \mathcal{P}(\mathrm{VF})$ a definable finitary function such that $\mathrm{rv} \restriction f(a)$ is injective for every $a \in \mathfrak{a}$. Then $\mathrm{rv} \circ f$ is constant.*

Proof. This is clear since, by Lemma 2.24, for every $t \in \mathrm{rv}(\bigcup f(\mathfrak{a}))$, $\mathfrak{a}$ is t-atomic and hence f induces a t-definable function $\mathfrak{a} \longrightarrow t^\sharp$. The lemma follows. □

A *thin annulus* is a set of the form $\mathfrak{c}(a, \gamma) \setminus \mathfrak{o}(a, \gamma) = \{x \in \mathrm{VF} : \mathrm{val}(x - a) = \gamma\}$, where $a \in \mathrm{VF}$ and $\gamma \in \Gamma$. Equivalently, it is a closed disc with one maximal open subdisc removed.

Lemma 2.27 ([18, Lemma 3.8])**.** *Let $A \subseteq \mathrm{VF}$ be an atomic open disc or an atomic closed disc or an atomic thin annulus. Let $f : A \longrightarrow \mathrm{VF}$ be a definable function. Then $f(A)$ is also atomic of one of these three forms.*

Resolved referee R163 [Clarification] – Define thin annuli before using them.
Original source line 907. The term "thin annulus" has not been defined in this manuscript. Specify a closed disc with one maximal open subdisc removed; after choosing the center of the removed subdisc, it is a shell $\{x : \mathrm{val}(x-a) = \gamma\}$. This makes the alternatives here and the later component argument unambiguous.

Author resolution. The author approves the finite-radius shell definition $\mathfrak{c}(a,\gamma) \setminus \mathfrak{o}(a,\gamma) = \{x \in \mathrm{VF} : \mathrm{val}(x-a) = \gamma\}$, with $\gamma \in \Gamma$. It is now stated before the first use in Lemma 2.27.

Lemma 2.28 ([18, Lemma 3.13])**.** *Let $A \subseteq \mathrm{VF}$ be an atomic open disc and $f : A \longrightarrow \mathrm{VF}$ a definable function. Then either f is constant or $f(A)$ is also an atomic open disc.*

Lemma 2.29. *Let $\mathfrak{a}$, f be as in Lemma 2.26 and suppose that f is not constant. Then there are $t_1, \ldots, t_k \in \mathrm{RV}_\infty$ and for each i, a t_i-definable function $f_i : \mathfrak{a} \longrightarrow t_i^\sharp$ such that $f = \bigcup_i f_i$ and each $f_i(\mathfrak{a})$ is either a point or a t_i-atomic open disc.*

Proof. By Lemma 2.26 and injectivity of rv on each finite fiber, f decomposes into finitely many t-definable single-valued branches $g : \mathfrak{a} \longrightarrow t^\sharp$. A branch with $t = \infty$ is the constant zero branch. Any constant branch already has the required form, so fix a nonconstant branch, for which $t \in \mathrm{RV}$. Lemma 2.24 makes $\mathfrak{a}$ atomic over t.

Every coordinate line of $\mathfrak{a}$ is atomic over its fixed coordinates and t. By Lemma 2.28, its image under g is a point or an open disc. Any two points of $\mathfrak{a}$ can be joined by changing one coordinate at a time. Starting at a point with image p and ending at a point with different image, the first nonconstant line image is an open neighborhood of p contained in $g(\mathfrak{a})$. Thus $g(\mathfrak{a})$ is open. It is a proper definable subset of VF, since it lies in $t^\sharp$.

By C-minimality, every point of a proper definable open subset of VF lies in a maximal open disc contained in that subset. Choose such a disc $D \subseteq g(\mathfrak{a})$ containing one value of g. An open line image that meets D is contained in D: intersecting open discs are nested, and maximality excludes a larger one inside $g(\mathfrak{a})$. A point image also stays in D when its initial value is in D. The coordinate chains therefore keep every value of g in D, so $g(\mathfrak{a}) = D$. The definable image of an atomic set is atomic over the same base, hence this open disc is t-atomic, as required.

□

Resolved referee R030 [Gap; revised] – A unary image lemma is used on a polydisc.
Original source line 918. For $n > 1$, Lemma 2.27 does not directly apply to $f : \mathfrak{a} \longrightarrow \mathrm{VF}$, since it has a unary domain. Supply the missing argument that $f(\mathfrak{a})$ has just one primitive component. A possible route is the canonical finite component decomposition of an atomic unary set: every coordinate slice of $\mathfrak{a}$ is atomic over its fixed coordinates, and its image is a point or an open disc by induction. Show that such an image must lie in one primitive component, then connect any two source points by changing coordinates one at a time. The same coordinate-chain argument excludes a closed disc or thin annulus as the whole image, because each slice image lies in a single maximal open subdisc. This fills the role of the inapplicable unary citation, once the component claim is spelled out.

Author resolution. The author approves the coordinate-chain proof. Unary coordinate-line images are points or open discs; maximal open discs in a proper definable open image then force the entire nonconstant image to be one open disc. This replaces the inapplicable unary citation on the polydisc. The tag ranges here and in Corollary 2.30 are also enlarged to RV_∞, retaining the constant zero branch.

Corollary 2.30. *Let $A \subseteq \mathrm{VF}^n$ be a definable set and $f : A \longrightarrow \mathcal{P}(\mathrm{VF})$ a definable finitary function as in Lemma 2.26. Then there are a definable finite partition $(A_i)_i$ of A and, for each i and all open polydiscs $\mathfrak{a} \subseteq A_i$, finitely many $(\ulcorner \mathfrak{a} \urcorner, t_{\mathfrak{a}j})$-definable functions $f_{\mathfrak{a}j} : \mathfrak{a} \longrightarrow t_{\mathfrak{a}j}^{\sharp}$, where $t_{\mathfrak{a}j} \in \mathrm{RV}_\infty$, such that $f \upharpoonright \mathfrak{a} = \bigcup_j f_{\mathfrak{a}j}$ and each $f_{\mathfrak{a}j}(\mathfrak{a})$ is either a point or an open disc.*

Proof. By compactness, there is a uniform finite bound N on the cardinalities of the fibers $f(a)$. For an open-polydisc code d, write $\mathfrak{a}_d$ for its polydisc and let $P(d)$ say that $\mathrm{rv} \circ (f \upharpoonright \mathfrak{a}_d)$ is constant and that the image of each of its single-valued rv-tagged branches is a point or an open disc. This is a first-order condition: use the finite disjunction over the possible numbers $0 \leq k \leq N$ of distinct tags, and express a point or an open disc by its usual uniform codes. Injectivity of rv on each fiber gives uniqueness of each tagged branch.

For $a \in A$, let $D_a \subseteq A$ be the complete type-definable set containing a. By Lemma 2.25, every open polydisc $\mathfrak{a}_d \subseteq D_a$ is $\ulcorner \mathfrak{a} \urcorner_d$-atomic. Lemma 2.29, over the ground base together with this disc parameter, therefore gives $P(d)$. If no finite part of the type of a had this property for every polydisc contained in it, compactness would produce an open-polydisc code d with $\mathfrak{a}_d \subseteq D_a$ and $\neg P(d)$, a contradiction. Thus there is a ground-definable set $A_a \subseteq A$ containing a such that $P(d)$ holds whenever $\mathfrak{a}_d \subseteq A_a$. A second application of compactness gives finitely many such sets covering A; take the partition they generate.

For a polydisc $\mathfrak{a}$ in a partition piece, choose its finitely many distinct tags $t_{\mathfrak{a}j} \in \mathrm{RV}_\infty$. The full graph of its jth branch is

$$\{(x, y) : x \in \mathfrak{a},\ y \in f(x),\ \mathrm{rv}(y) = t_{\mathfrak{a}j}\}.$$

It is $(\ulcorner \mathfrak{a} \urcorner, t_{\mathfrak{a}j})$-definable, the branches reconstruct $f \upharpoonright \mathfrak{a}$, and $P(d)$ gives the asserted images. □

Resolved referee R031 [Error] – The local branch functions need the disc parameter.
Original source line 925. The functions $f_{\mathfrak{a}j}$ must be allowed parameters $(\ulcorner \mathfrak{a} \urcorner, t_{\mathfrak{a}j})$, not just $t_{\mathfrak{a}j}$. Their domains are $\mathfrak{a}$, so literal $t_{\mathfrak{a}j}$-definability would imply that every such disc is $t_{\mathfrak{a}j}$-definable. Already for $f(a) = \{1\}$ on $A = \mathrm{VF}$, this is impossible for arbitrary subdiscs, since $t_{\mathfrak{a}j} = \mathrm{rv}(1)$ is fixed. The proof itself introduces $\ulcorner \mathfrak{a} \urcorner$, which explains the missing parameter. Also replace the appeal to the unary Lemma 2.28 by the corrected multidimensional Lemma 2.29, and explicitly formulate the uniform first-order property used in the compactness step.

Author resolution. The author approves explicitly naming the disc together with its RV tag in each full branch graph. The proof now invokes the corrected multidimensional Lemma 2.29 and states a uniform first-order property, using a finite bound on fiber size and the usual point and open-disc codes, to justify both compactness steps. The zero-tag and empty-fiber cases are retained.

Definition 2.31. Let $f : A \longrightarrow B$ be a bijection between two sets A and B, each with exactly one VF-coordinate. We say that f is *concentric* if, for every VF-fiber f_t of f and all open polydiscs $\mathfrak{a} \subseteq \mathrm{dom}(f_t)$, $f_t(\mathfrak{a})$ is also an open polydisc; if both f and f^{-1} are concentric then f has the *disc-to-disc property*.

Lemma 2.32 ([18, Proposition 3.19])**.** *Let $f : A \longrightarrow B$ be a definable bijection between two sets A and B, each with exactly one* VF*-coordinate. Then there is a definable finite partition $(A_i)_i$ of A such that every restriction $f \upharpoonright A_i$ has the disc-to-disc property.*

2.3. **Continuity and fiberwise properties.**

Definition 2.33. We set $\dim_{\mathrm{RV}}(\varnothing) = -\infty$. For a nonempty definable subset $U \subseteq \mathrm{RV}_\infty^m$, the RV*-dimension*, denoted by $\dim_{\mathrm{RV}}(U)$, is the smallest number k such that there is a definable finite-to-one function $f : U \longrightarrow \mathrm{RV}^k$ (RV^0 is taken to be the singleton $\{\infty\}$).

Resolved referee R164 [Clarification; new] – Dimension of the empty set.
Original source line 941. Specify $\dim_{\mathrm{VF}}(\varnothing) = \dim_{\mathrm{RV}}(\varnothing) = -\infty$ (or another negative convention) separately. The VF definition otherwise has no largest natural number for the empty set, whereas the literal RV definition gives it dimension 0. With that latter convention the boundary lemma fails when $n = 0$, since its boundary is empty but $0 < 0$ is false. Alternatively restrict that lemma to $n \geq 1$, while still specifying the empty VF dimension.

Author resolution. The author approves $\dim_{\mathrm{VF}}(\varnothing) = \dim_{\mathrm{RV}}(\varnothing) = -\infty$. Both definitions now state this convention separately and retain their original clauses for nonempty sets, including zero-coordinate cases.

Definition 2.34. Let A be a definable subset of VF^n. The RV-*boundary* of A, denoted by $\partial_{\mathrm{RV}} A$, is the definable subset of $\mathrm{rv}(A)$ such that $t \in \partial_{\mathrm{RV}} A$ if and only if $t^\sharp \cap A$ is a proper nonempty subset of $t^\sharp$. The definable set $\mathrm{rv}(A) \smallsetminus \partial_{\mathrm{RV}} A$, denoted by $\mathrm{int}_{\mathrm{RV}}(A)$, is called the RV-*interior* of A.

Resolved referee R032 [Typo] – Definability of the RV-boundary.
Original source line 945. Insert 'definable' before 'subset of VF^n'; without that assumption the boundary and interior need not be definable.

Author resolution. The author approves explicitly assuming that A is definable, so that its RV-boundary and RV-interior have the stated definability.

Obviously, $A \subseteq \mathrm{VF}^n$ is an RV-pullback if and only if $\partial_{\mathrm{RV}} A$ is empty.

Lemma 2.35. *Let A be a definable subset of VF^n. Then $\dim_{\mathrm{RV}}(\partial_{\mathrm{RV}} A) < n$.*

Proof. For $n = 0$, the boundary is empty and has dimension $-\infty$. For $n = 1$, take a finite Boolean disc decomposition of A. A disc containing 0 is an RV-pullback, whereas a disc avoiding 0 lies in one RV-disc. A partially met RV-fiber therefore contains a member of this finite disc family that avoids 0, so there are only finitely many such fibers.

For the inductive step, fix $i \in [n]$ and put $X_i = \mathrm{pr}_{\tilde{i}}(A)$ and $T_a = \partial_{\mathrm{RV}} A_a$ for $a \in X_i$. Each T_a is finite. For each $t \in T_a$, Corollary 2.21, over the parameters (a, t), gives a definable point in $t^\sharp$. By compactness there are finitely many definable partial choice functions covering all such pairs (a, t); order this list and use the first available choice to obtain a definable function $c(a, t) \in t^\sharp$. Set $f_i(a) = \{c(a, t) : t \in T_a\}$ if $T_a \neq \varnothing$, and $f_i(a) = \{0\}$ otherwise. Thus every fiber is finite and contains exactly one representative of each boundary tag when that boundary is nonempty; in particular $\mathrm{rv} \upharpoonright f_i(a)$ is injective.

First split X_i by the pattern of its zero coordinates, and apply Corollary 2.30 on the remaining coordinates of each piece. This gives a definable finite partition $(A_{ij})_j$ of X_i such that, whenever $t^\sharp \subseteq A_{ij}$, the finite set $\mathrm{rv}(f_i(a))$ is independent of $a \in t^\sharp$. The zero-pattern split allows t to have ∞ coordinates: after deleting them, $t^\sharp$ is an open polydisc in the remaining coordinates. Write $f_{ij} = f_i \upharpoonright A_{ij}$ and let $C_{ij}(t)$ be this common finite set for $t \in \mathrm{int}_{\mathrm{RV}}(A_{ij})$.

Regard each C_{ij} as its graph in RV_∞^n, retaining the input tags and placing its output tag in coordinate i. Put

$$C = \bigcup_{i,j} C_{ij}, \qquad B = \bigcup_{i,j} \{s \in \mathrm{rv}(A) : \mathrm{pr}_{\tilde{i}}(s) \in \partial_{\mathrm{RV}} A_{ij}\}.$$

Each graph C_{ij} is finite over its $n - 1$ input coordinates, so $\dim_{\mathrm{RV}}(C) < n$. By induction, $\dim_{\mathrm{RV}}(\partial_{\mathrm{RV}} A_{ij}) < n - 1$; with only one remaining coordinate, this gives $\dim_{\mathrm{RV}}(B) < n$. Finally, for a partially met RV-polydisc, start in A and change coordinates one at a time to reach a point outside A. The first exit identifies a boundary tag of a unary section. Its other tags either lie in

some $\partial_{\mathrm{RV}} A_{ij}$, placing the full tuple in B, or in $\mathrm{int}_{\mathrm{RV}}(A_{ij})$, placing it in C. Hence $\partial_{\mathrm{RV}} A \subseteq B \cup C$, as required. □

Resolved referee R033 [Gap] – RV-boundary proof needs uniform branches.
Original source line 962. When constructing f_{ij}, ensure that each fiber contains exactly one representative of each boundary RV-disc; injectivity of rv on these finite fibers is a hypothesis of Corollary 2.30. The sentence about constancy should mean that the finite set $\mathrm{rv}(f_{ij}(a))$ is independent of $a \in t^\sharp$, not that rv is constant on the union of all those finite sets. The argument also depends on the preceding corollary after its parameter and multidimensional gaps are repaired. A shorter alternative is the human referee's generic-lift argument: over a model containing the parameters, a tuple of full RV-dimension has a lift realizing one complete type, so its lift cannot meet A partially; state the dimension/type fact precisely if using this route.

Author resolution. The author approves choosing exactly one VF representative of each boundary RV tag and stating constancy of the finite RV-image set along each source RV fiber. The proof now splits zero-coordinate faces before applying Corollary 2.30, retains all input tags in the graphs, and gives the zero-dimensional base case and the coordinate-chain coverage argument.

Let $f : \mathrm{VF}^n \longrightarrow \mathrm{VF}^m$ be a definable function.

Lemma 2.36 ([17, Lemma 8.7])**.** *There is a definable closed set $A \subseteq \mathrm{VF}^n$ with $\dim_{\mathrm{VF}}(A) < n$ such that $f \upharpoonright (\mathrm{VF}^n \smallsetminus A)$ is continuous.*

Per the usual terminology, this lemma says that f is continuous *almost everywhere*.

Definition 2.37. In this definition, for a nonzero tuple $x \in \mathrm{VF}^k$ we set $\mathrm{val}(x) = \min_i \mathrm{val}(x_i)$, and we set $\mathrm{val}(0) = \infty$. This minimum convention is separate from the coordinatewise valuation image used in Terminology 2.39.

For any $a \in \mathrm{VF}^n$, we say that f is *differentiable at a* if there is a linear map $\lambda : \mathrm{VF}^n \longrightarrow \mathrm{VF}^m$ (of VF-vector spaces) such that, for any $\epsilon \in \Gamma$, if $b \in \mathrm{VF}^n \setminus \{0\}$ and $\mathrm{val}(b)$ is sufficiently large then

$$\mathrm{val}(f(a+b) - f(a) - \lambda(b)) - \mathrm{val}(b) > \epsilon.$$

It is straightforward to check that if such a linear function λ (represented by a matrix with entries in VF) exists then it is unique and hence is called the *derivative of f at a*.

Write $f = (f_1, \ldots, f_m)$. For $a = (a_i, a_{\tilde{i}}) \in \mathrm{VF}^n$, if the derivative of the function $f_j \upharpoonright (\mathrm{VF} \times a_{\tilde{i}})$ at a_i exists then we call it the *ijth partial derivative of f at a*. Whenever f is differentiable at a, the (j,i)-entry of its derivative matrix is this ijth partial derivative.

Resolved referee R034 [Clarification; revised] – Valuation of a tuple and the zero increment.
Original source line 980. Define $\mathrm{val}(b) = \min_i \mathrm{val}(b_i)$ for a nonzero tuple, with $\mathrm{val}(0) = \infty$, and require $b \neq 0$ in the difference quotient. Otherwise the display includes the undefined expression $\infty - \infty$ at $b = 0$. Later, where valuations of tuples are taken coordinatewise (Terminology 2.39), distinguish that use from this minimum convention. The input-first indexing of partial derivatives is legitimate, but please keep the corresponding matrix convention explicit.

Author resolution. The author approves the minimum coordinate valuation for differentiability, with $\mathrm{val}(0) = \infty$, and excludes the zero increment from the difference quotient. This avoids $\infty - \infty$. The input-first ijth partial-derivative convention is retained and its derivative-matrix position (j,i) is explicit. The separate boundedness convention remains coordinatewise.

We differentiate functions between arbitrary definable sets by "forgetting" the RV-coordinates. More precisely, let

$$f : \mathrm{VF}^n \times \mathrm{RV}^m \longrightarrow \mathrm{VF}^{n'} \times \mathrm{RV}^{m'}$$

be a definable function. For each fixed input RV-tuple t, generic local constancy of definable RV-valued maps [17, Lemma 8.9] implies that, outside a definable set of VF-dimension less than n, the output RV-tuple is constant on a neighborhood of each input a. If this tuple is s, then $\mathrm{dom}(f_{(t,s)})$ contains a neighborhood of a. At such a point (a,t), we define the partial derivatives of f to be those of this local VF-map $f_{(t,s)}$. If $n = n'$ and all the partial derivatives exist, the *Jacobian of f at (a,t)* is the determinant of the matrix whose (j,i)-entry is the ijth partial derivative, and is denoted by $\mathrm{Jcb}_{\mathrm{VF}}\, f(a,t)$.

Lemma 2.38. *Assume $n = n'$. The Jacobian of f exists and is a continuous function almost everywhere.*

Proof. First remove the definable locus where the output RV-tuple is not locally constant in the input VF-coordinates. On each resulting open fiber with both input and output RV-tuples fixed, extend the VF-map by zero outside its domain and apply [17, Corollary 9.9] to its partial derivatives. Their nonexistence and discontinuity loci are definable and have VF-dimension less than n in every such fiber. Retaining or projecting away RV-coordinates does not increase VF-dimension, so the combined exceptional locus still has VF-dimension less than n. Off this locus all partial derivatives, and hence their determinant, are continuous. In arity zero the Jacobian is the empty determinant 1. □

Resolved referee R035 [Gap] – Equal VF dimensions and generic RV constancy.
Original source line 993. State $n = n'$ in Lemma 2.38; otherwise the determinant called the Jacobian has not been defined. Moreover, the preceding existence of one full-dimensional fiber for each input t does not show that such fibers cover almost every input point. Use the standard generic local constancy of a definable map from VF^n to $\mathrm{RV}^{m'}$ first, and then apply the cited differentiability theorem on its open fibers. This provides the missing almost-everywhere coverage.

Author resolution. The author approves the square-dimension hypothesis $n = n'$ and the generic local-constancy argument for the output RV-labels. The proof now applies the cited partial-differentiability theorem on open fixed-label charts and explains the smaller-dimensional exceptional locus. The arity-zero Jacobian is the empty determinant 1.

Terminology 2.39. We say that a set $I \subseteq \Gamma_\infty^n$ is *γ-bounded*, where $\gamma \in \Gamma$, if it is contained in the box $[\gamma,\infty]^n$, and is *doubly γ-bounded* if it is contained in the box $[-\gamma,\gamma]^n$. More generally, let A be a subset of $\mathrm{VF}^n \times \mathrm{RV}_\infty^m \times \Gamma_\infty^l$ and

$$\mathrm{valim}(A) = \{(\mathrm{val}(a), \mathrm{vrv}(t), \gamma) \mid (a,t,\gamma) \in A\} \subseteq \Gamma_\infty^{n+m+l},$$

where $\mathrm{val}(a)$ and $\mathrm{vrv}(t)$ are taken coordinatewise. We say that A is *γ-bounded* if $\mathrm{valim}(A)$ is, and likewise for *doubly γ-bounded*. A set is *bounded* if it is γ-bounded for some $\gamma \in \Gamma$, and *doubly bounded* if it is doubly γ-bounded for some $\gamma \in \Gamma$. The notation A_Γ continues to mean projection to existing Γ-coordinates.

Resolved referee R036 [Clarification] – A valuation image is not a coordinate projection.
Original source line 1001. The notation A_Γ here conflicts with Notation 2.1, where it denotes projection to existing Γ-coordinates. Use a separate notation such as $\mathrm{valim}(A)$ for this coordinatewise valuation image. Also explicitly say that 'bounded' means γ-bounded for some γ, and similarly for 'doubly bounded'.

Author resolution. The author approves $\mathrm{valim}(A)$ for the coordinatewise valuation image, reserving A_Γ for projection to existing Γ-coordinates. The existential finite bound in "bounded" and "doubly bounded" is now explicit. This coordinatewise convention is distinct from the minimum tuple valuation used in differentiation.

Definition 2.40 (Contractions)**.** A function $f : A \longrightarrow B$ is rv-*contractible* if there is a (necessarily unique) function $f_\downarrow : \mathrm{rv}(A) \longrightarrow \mathrm{rv}(B)$, called the rv-*contraction* of f, such that

$$(\mathrm{rv} \upharpoonright B) \circ f = f_\downarrow \circ (\mathrm{rv} \upharpoonright A).$$

Similarly, it is res-*contractible* (respectively, val-*contractible*) if the same holds in terms of res (respectively, val or vrv, depending on the coordinates) instead of rv.

Lemma 2.41. *Let $U \subseteq \mathrm{RV}^k$ be a doubly bounded set and $f : U \longrightarrow \mathrm{RV}$ a definable function. Then $f(U)$ is also doubly bounded. The same holds if the codomain of f is Γ.*

Proof. For an RV-valued f, put $h = \mathrm{vrv} \circ f$; for a Γ-valued f, put $h = f$. We retain the induction on k, with the case $k = 0$ immediate. For $k > 1$ and $t \in \mathrm{pr}_1(U)$, the inductive hypothesis makes $h(U_t)$ doubly bounded. Its finite bound

$$\gamma_t = \sup\{|h(t, x)| \mid x \in U_t\}$$

exists by definable completeness of Γ, and the least-upper-bound formula makes $t \longmapsto \gamma_t$ definable. The projection $\mathrm{pr}_1(U)$ is doubly bounded, so the unary Γ-valued case bounds all γ_t and hence bounds $h(U)$. Thus both claims reduce to the case $k = 1$ and a definable function $g : U \longrightarrow \Gamma$. Then, by C-minimality, we may assume that g vrv-contracts to a function $g_\downarrow : \mathrm{vrv}(U) \longrightarrow \Gamma$. Since definable functions in Γ are piecewise $\mathbb{Q}$-linear, the range of $g_\downarrow$ must be doubly bounded. □

Resolved referee R037 [Gap] – Uniformity in the bounded RV-image lemma.
Original source line 1017. The induction on k must control the bounds uniformly in the remaining coordinates; boundedness on each fiber alone does not give a bound on their union. A precise route is to consider the relation of possible values $\mathrm{vrv}(f(u))$ over $\mathrm{vrv}(u) \in \Gamma^k$. Residue-field/value-group orthogonality makes each such fiber finite, uniformly; stable embeddedness and elimination in divisible ordered abelian groups then give finitely many piecewise rational-affine branches. These have bounded images on a bounded box. Include this justification, or an equivalent explicit uniform induction.

Author resolution. The author retains the original induction. Its fiber bounds are chosen definably as finite suprema of the absolute output values; the unary Γ-valued case then bounds this definable bound function uniformly. The proof now spells out that step, without replacing the induction by a relation of all input and output values.

Definition 2.42. Let $A \subseteq \mathrm{VF}^n$ and $f : A \longrightarrow \mathcal{P}(\mathrm{VF}^m)$ be a definable function. For $a \in \mathrm{VF}^n$ and $L \subseteq \mathrm{VF}^m$, we say that L is a *limit set of f at a*, written as $\lim_{A \to a} f \subseteq L$, if for every $\epsilon \in \Gamma$ there is a $\delta \in \Gamma$ such that if $c \in \mathfrak{o}(a, \delta) \cap (A \setminus \{a\})$ then

$$f(c) \subseteq \bigcup_{b \in L} \mathfrak{o}(b, \epsilon).$$

This is a local definition and imposes no global boundedness hypothesis. A finite limit set forces the union of the values $f(c)$ to be bounded on some punctured neighborhood of a. Whenever boundedness of the range is assumed, it means boundedness of $\bigcup_{c \in A} f(c)$.

A limit set L of f at a is *minimal* if no proper subset of L is a limit set of f at a.

Resolved referee R038 [Clarification; revised] – Simplify the limit-set definition.
Original source line 1046. Say explicitly that $\bigcup_{a \in A} f(a)$ is bounded. The auxiliary subset L' does no work: the displayed condition is equivalent to $f(c) \subseteq \bigcup_{b \in L} \mathfrak{o}(b, \epsilon)$. The following definition of continuity is applied to finitary functions without a global boundedness hypothesis, so the present definition needs a compatible extension. One can use the same formula for arbitrary correspondences whenever a finite affine limit exists, or formulate limits in $(\mathbb{P}^1(\mathrm{VF}))^m$ from the outset; local boundedness near the point suffices for affine local uses.

Author resolution. The author approves the local limit formula without a global range bound, using all of L in place of the redundant subfamily L'. A finite limit set supplies local boundedness on a punctured neighborhood. Any separately assumed range bound refers to the union of all values. Minimality and the puncture are unchanged.

Observe that if $\lim_{A\to a} f \subseteq L$ and $b \in L$ is not isolated in L then actually $\lim_{A\to a} f \subseteq L \smallsetminus b$. So in a minimal limit set every element is isolated. Moreover, if a minimal limit set L exists then its topological closure is unique:

Lemma 2.43 ([17, Lemma 9.2])**.** *Let $L_1, L_2 \subseteq \mathrm{VF}^m$ be two minimal limit sets of f at a. Then the closures of L_1, L_2 coincide.*

This lemma justifies writing $\lim_{A\to a} f = L$ when L is a closed (hence the unique) minimal limit set of f at a, in particular, when L is finite and minimal.

Let $A \subseteq \mathrm{VF}^n$ be a definable set with $\dim_{\mathrm{VF}}(A) = n$ and $f : A \longrightarrow \mathcal{P}(\mathrm{VF}^m)$ a definable finitary function. We say that f is *continuous* if $\lim_{A\to a} f = f(a)$ for all $a \in A$.

Lemma 2.44. *Suppose $n > 0$. Then f is continuous almost everywhere.*

Proof. This can be reduced to the familiar case that f is indeed a function into VF^m as follows. By Lemma 2.12 and compactness, there are a definable set U in RV and a definable function $g : A \times \mathrm{VF}^m \longrightarrow A \times U$ such that, for all $a \in A$, $\mathrm{pr}_A(g(a, b)) = a$ and $g \upharpoonright (a \times f(a))$ is injective. For each $t \in U$, let

$$A_t = \{a \in A \mid (a, t) \in g(a \times f(a))\}$$

and $f_t \subseteq f$ be the obvious t-definable function $A_t \longrightarrow \mathrm{VF}^m$. The discontinuity locus E of f is definable: the limit condition is first-order, and minimality of the finite set $f(a)$ can be tested by removing one of its elements at a time. Suppose for contradiction that $\dim_{\mathrm{VF}}(E) = n$. By Lemma 2.17, E contains a nonempty open polydisc. Apply generic local constancy [17, Lemma 8.9] to the finite label-set map

$$a \longmapsto g(a \times f(a))_{\mathrm{RV}}.$$

After shrinking to a nonempty open polydisc $P \subseteq E$, this set is a fixed finite set T. If T is empty, then f is the constant empty correspondence on P and is continuous there, a contradiction.

For each $t \in T$, the inverse branch f_t is defined on all of P. Extend it by zero outside A_t and apply Lemma 2.36. The finitely many branch-exception sets have union of VF-dimension less than n, so choose $a \in P$ outside their union. All branches are continuous at a. Their finite union has limit set $f(a)$; this limit set is minimal because the distinct values at a can be separated by sufficiently small discs and, since $n > 0$, the punctured polydisc still accumulates at a. Thus f is continuous at a, contradicting $P \subseteq E$. Hence $\dim_{\mathrm{VF}}(E) < n$. □

Resolved referee R039 [Gap; revised] – One continuous branch is not enough.
Original source line 1068. The argument finds one t for which A_t has full dimension and f_t is generically continuous. That alone does not account for all branches of f. Apply generic local constancy to the finite RV-label set $a \mapsto g(a \times f(a))_{\mathrm{RV}}$, then simultaneously apply generic continuity to its finitely many inverse branches on each neighborhood. To justify the global dimension conclusion, suppose the discontinuity locus had full dimension and choose an open polydisc in it where this label set is constant; the finite collection of branch-exception sets cannot fill that polydisc. The empty label set simply gives the constant empty correspondence and should be handled separately. This supplies the missing coverage argument.

Author resolution. The author approves the expanded proof and the restriction $n > 0$. The original ending uses the dimension principle that an RV-indexed definable union of sets of VF-dimension less than n still has dimension less than n. The expanded argument obtains the same coverage by making the

finite label set locally constant and treating all branches together, including the empty-label case. The positive-arity hypothesis is needed for the unchanged punctured limit convention.

Lemma 2.45 ([17, Lemma 9.5])**.** *Suppose that $f : \mathcal{M} \smallsetminus 0 \longrightarrow \mathcal{P}(A)$ is a definable finitary function, where A is a closed and bounded set in* VF*. Then there is a definable finite set $L \subseteq A$ such that $\lim_{\mathcal{M}\smallsetminus 0 \to 0} f = L$.*

We remark that the finite-limit theorem also holds in the coordinatewise projective line $(\mathbb{P}^1(\mathrm{VF}))^m$, with the valuation topology: if $A \subseteq \mathrm{VF}^m$ is not bounded, take its closure there and allow infinite coordinates in L. This is the projective version of the same cited theorem; no topological local compactness is assumed.

revision of the next few lemmas

Lemma 2.46 (Curve selection)**.** *Suppose that $\mathbb{S}$ is* VF*-generated. Let $A \subseteq \mathrm{VF}^n$ be definable and let b be a point in its closure in the coordinatewise projective line $(\mathbb{P}^1(\mathrm{VF}))^n$, with the valuation topology. Then there is a b-definable continuous finitary function $g : \mathcal{M} \setminus \{0\} \longrightarrow \mathcal{P}(A)$ whose values are nonempty and such that*

$$\lim_{\mathcal{M}\setminus\{0\} \longrightarrow 0} g = \{b\}.$$

Resolved referee R165 [Clarification; new] – Definability and nonempty values in curve selection.
Original source line 1081. State that A is definable. In the proof require $g(c) \neq \varnothing$ for every c (or at least on a punctured neighborhood of 0): "finitary" in the earlier definition allows empty values, and $g(c) \subseteq \mathfrak{o}(b, \mathrm{val}(c))$ alone is also satisfied by the identically empty correspondence. The algebraic-closure construction, once its base hypothesis is corrected below, supplies finite nonempty values and hence the stronger conclusion $\lim g = \{b\}$.

Author resolution. The author approves explicitly taking $A \subseteq \mathrm{VF}^n$ definable and requiring finite nonempty values at every input. The construction gives the stronger singleton limit $\{b\}$. Projective charts handle infinite coordinates without changing the affine target set of the curve.

Proof. Use a coordinatewise projective chart around b to reduce to the case $b \in \mathrm{VF}^n$: at an infinite coordinate use inversion and restrict A to the chart. These changes are definable over b and preserve convergence and continuity locally.

Naming the finite tuple b and a nonzero $c \in \mathcal{M}$ preserves VF-generation and the standing nontriviality of the ground valuation. Hence $\mathrm{acl}(\mathbb{S}, b, c)$ is a model of $\mathrm{ACVF}(0,0)$. Since $b \in \overline{A}$, the definable set $A \cap \mathfrak{o}(b, \mathrm{val}(c))$ is nonempty, so elementarity gives a point of that intersection algebraic over $(\mathbb{S}, b, c)$. Compactness supplies a b-definable finitary function g_0 on $\mathcal{M} \setminus \{0\}$ such that

$$\varnothing \neq g_0(c) \subseteq A \cap \mathfrak{o}(b, \mathrm{val}(c))$$

for every c. Thus g_0 converges to $\{b\}$, and nonempty values make this limit minimal.

By Lemma 2.44, with its one-dimensional source, g_0 is continuous outside a finite set. Choose a b-definable clopen disc $D \subseteq \mathcal{M}$ around 0 such that g_0 is continuous on $D \setminus \{0\}$. Also $\mathrm{acl}(\mathbb{S}, b)$ is a model, so A contains a finite nonempty b-definable set E. Define

$$g(c) = \begin{cases} g_0(c), & c \in D \setminus \{0\}, \\ E, & c \in \mathcal{M} \setminus D. \end{cases}$$

The two pieces are relatively clopen in $\mathcal{M} \setminus \{0\}$, so g is continuous, finite-valued and nonempty everywhere. Its limit at 0 is still $\{b\}$. Finally transport the construction back through the projective

chart. This avoids assuming that a definable value-group radius is the valuation of a definable scalar. □

Resolved referee R040 [Error] – Curve selection requires a restriction on the base.
Original source line 1088. The assertion is false for the arbitrary $\mathbb{S}$ allowed so far. Let K be a nontrivially valued algebraically closed base field, add an RV parameter t with $\mathrm{vrv}(t) = 0$ transcendental over its residue field, and put $A = \{(x, y) : y \neq 0, \mathrm{rv}(x/y) = t\}$. Then $(0, 0) \in \overline{A}$. A nonempty finite $\mathbb{S}$-definable choice in A at an input $c \in K \cap (\mathcal{M} \setminus \{0\})$ would have coordinates algebraic over K, t, c, hence in K by Lemma 2.13; their ratio cannot have leading term t. Even though finitary values may be empty, $b \in \lim g$ forces their support to accumulate at 0; by C-minimality that support contains a punctured neighborhood, whose defining radius lies in $\Gamma(K)$ since adjoining the residue parameter t does not enlarge definable values. It therefore contains such an input $c \in K$. Thus the claimed curve does not exist over that base. Impose VF-generation before this lemma (as already suggested in the human report), or allow explicitly specified extra VF representatives. Under VF-generation, the added nonzero $c \in \mathcal{M}$ makes the algebraic closure a model, and the displayed construction yields nonempty finite values converging to b itself. For the last rescaling step, first shrink to a disc whose radius is the valuation of a definable scalar; the original definable radius need not be realized by such a scalar.

Author resolution. The author approves VF-generation as a local hypothesis of this lemma, validating the algebraic-closure model argument. The continuous germ is extended by a constant finite nonempty set on a clopen complement, so no definable scalar realizing an arbitrary definable radius is assumed. Later geometric uses may temporarily enlarge the base; no global VF-generation assumption is imposed here.

This is an analogue of the highly useful *o*-minimal curve selection.

Remark 2.47. Although the Γ-sort is essentially an *o*-minimal group, curve selection fails due to the presence of the top element ∞. For example, the set $\Gamma \times (0, \infty) \subseteq \Gamma_\infty^2$ contains curves approaching the boundary point $(0, 0)$ or (∞, ∞) but no curves approaching the boundary point $(\infty, 0)$, because every definable one-parameter curve is piecewise rational-affine. Near a one-sided endpoint, one affine piece remains, and a positive affine coordinate cannot tend to 0 while another coordinate tends to ∞.

Resolved referee R166 [Typo; new] – Eventually affine curves in the value group.
Original source line 1094. Replace "all curves are lines" by "every definable one-parameter curve is piecewise rational-affine". Near a one-sided endpoint, one affine piece remains; a positive affine coordinate cannot tend to 0 while another coordinate tends to ∞. This is the precise reason the stated boundary point cannot be approached.

Author resolution. The author approves the precise piecewise rational-affine formulation. An eventual affine piece gives the stated obstruction to approaching $(\infty, 0)$; the example and the conclusion are unchanged.

Lemma 2.48. *Let $A \subseteq \mathrm{VF}^n$ be definable, closed and bounded, and let $f : A \longrightarrow \mathrm{VF}^m$ be definable and continuous. Then $f(A)$ is also closed and bounded.*

Proof. The conclusion is geometric, so we may temporarily enlarge the parameter base to a small VF-generated base over which all the data are definable. The standing nontriviality of the ground valuation is preserved. Over this base, and after naming any additional finite VF tuple, algebraic closure is a model of $\mathrm{ACVF}(0, 0)$. Elementarity and compactness therefore give finite nonempty definable choices in the nonempty families below. No choice over the original parameter base is asserted.

First let $b \in \overline{f(A)} \setminus f(A)$, where this closure is affine, and name b. For every $c \in \mathcal{M} \setminus \{0\}$ the set

$$\{x \in A : f(x) \in \mathfrak{o}(b, \mathrm{val}(c))\}$$

is nonempty. Applying the model argument over the enlarged base together with (b, c), and then compactness, gives a definable finitary function $F : \mathcal{M} \setminus \{0\} \longrightarrow \mathcal{P}(A)$ such that every $F(c)$ is nonempty and $f(F(c)) \subseteq \mathfrak{o}(b, \mathrm{val}(c))$. Lemma 2.45, in its finite-dimensional form, gives a finite minimal limit set $L \subseteq A$. This set is nonempty, since F has nonempty values arbitrarily close to 0. For every $a \in L$, minimality implies that values of F meet every neighborhood of a for inputs arbitrarily close to 0: otherwise a could be removed from L. Continuity at a and the displayed containment force $f(a) = b$, contradicting $b \notin f(A)$. Thus $f(A)$ is closed.

If $f(A)$ were unbounded, one coordinate f_i would be unbounded. For every $c \in \mathcal{M} \setminus \{0\}$ the definable set

$$\{x \in A : \mathrm{val}(f_i(x)) < -\mathrm{val}(c)\}$$

would be nonempty. The same model argument and compactness give finite nonempty choices $F(c)$ inside these sets. Again Lemma 2.45 supplies a nonempty finite minimal limit set $L \subseteq A$. Choose $a \in L$. Continuity makes f_i bounded on a neighborhood of a in A, while minimality makes $F(c)$ meet that neighborhood for arbitrarily small nonzero c. The inequality $\mathrm{val}(f_i(x)) < -\mathrm{val}(c)$ for all $x \in F(c)$ contradicts this local bound. Hence $f(A)$ is bounded as well. □

Resolved referee R041 [Gap] – Selecting and lifting the limiting curve.
Original source line 1104. If the image is unbounded but closed in affine space, its affine frontier need not contain a point outside it. Take the frontier in the coordinatewise projective line and allow an infinite coordinate. Also the existence of algebraic points in every fiber needs justification under the chosen parameter assumptions; for the curve pullback it is enough to include the curve parameter c in the algebraic closure and apply the model argument there. Preserve a nonempty finite-valued parametrization throughout and apply the limit lemma in its multidimensional form.

Author resolution. The author approves treating affine missing boundary points and unbounded output separately. Finite nonempty choices are justified by elementarity and compactness over a temporary VF-generated base. The finite-dimensional limit theorem and continuity then give both closedness and boundedness, without a global VF-generation assumption or an unjustified original-base choice.

Corollary 2.49. *If the function f in Lemma 2.48 is injective then it is a homeomorphism from A onto $f(A)$.*

Lemma 2.50 (The closed graph criterion for continuity)**.** *Let $A \subseteq \mathrm{VF}^n$ and $B \subseteq \mathrm{VF}^m$ be definable, with B closed in affine space. Write B^{p} for the closure of B in $(\mathbb{P}^1(\mathrm{VF}))^m$, with the valuation topology. A definable function $f : A \longrightarrow B$ is continuous if and only if its graph is closed in $A \times B^{\mathrm{p}}$. If B is bounded, then $B^{\mathrm{p}} = B$, so this is the usual relative closed-graph condition.*

Proof. The graph of a continuous map into the Hausdorff space B^{p} is closed, proving the forward implication.

Conversely, suppose the graph is closed but f is not continuous at $a \in A$. Choose a clopen projective polydisc U around the finite point $f(a)$ such that

$$D = \{x \in A : f(x) \notin U\}$$

has a in its closure. As in the preceding proof, temporarily enlarge the parameter base to a small VF-generated base containing the parameters of these data. This changes neither continuity nor graph closure. By Lemma 2.46, there is a definable continuous finitary function $C : \mathcal{M} \setminus \{0\} \longrightarrow \mathcal{P}(D)$ with nonempty values and limit $\{a\}$.

Apply the projective version of Lemma 2.45 to the finite-valued function $c \longmapsto f(C(c))$. It has a finite minimal limit set L, which is nonempty because all the values are nonempty. Every point of L belongs to the closed set $B^{\mathrm{p}} \setminus U$: minimality makes the image meet each neighborhood of such a point for inputs arbitrarily close to 0. Choose $b' \in L$. This same property, together with $C(c) \longrightarrow \{a\}$, shows that (a, b') belongs to the closure of the graph of f in $A \times B^{\mathrm{p}}$. Closedness of the graph gives $b' = f(a)$, contrary to $b' \notin U$. This proves continuity without a global VF-generation hypothesis. □

Resolved referee R042 [Gap; revised] – The compactified closed-graph criterion.
Original source line 1117. The parenthesis appears intended to impose the correct compactified-target hypothesis; make it explicit by taking B to be a closed definable subset of $(\mathbb{P}^1(\mathrm{VF}))^m$, and take graph closure in $A \times B$. The example $f(0) = 0$, $f(x) = 1/x$ for $x \neq 0$ has closed graph in affine VF^2 but is discontinuous at 0: this is a counterexample only to the unbounded affine-target version, not to the intended compactified statement. For the reverse implication, apply curve selection to the set of input points x with $f(x) \notin \mathfrak{b}$, approaching a; apply the finite-limit lemma to the resulting finite-valued image in B. A limit point b' lies outside the clopen neighborhood $\mathfrak{b}$, and (a, b') lies in the graph closure. Also, "projective line with the valuation topology" is more precise than a literal topological one-point compactification; local compactness is not assumed here.

Author resolution. The author approves making the intended projective ambient space explicit: the affine target is B, and graph closure is in $A \times B^{\mathrm{p}}$, with the valuation topology. The reverse proof selects bad inputs first and then takes a finite projective limit of their images. Temporary base enlargement supplies curve selection without changing the geometric conclusion or imposing global VF-generation.

Lemma 2.51. *Let $f : A \longrightarrow B$ be a definable bijection between two open subsets of* VF*. Suppose that B is bounded. Then f is weakly concentric, that is, for every $a \in A$ there is a $b \in \mathrm{VF}$ such that, for every sufficiently large $\gamma \in \Gamma$, $f(\mathfrak{o}(a, \gamma) \smallsetminus a) = \mathfrak{o}(b, \delta) \smallsetminus b$ for some $\delta \in \Gamma$.*

Note that, compared to Lemma 2.32, the assumption of this lemma is stronger and its conclusion weaker, but the point is that we do not need a partition to achieve it.

Proof. Fix $a \in A$. After translating the input and restricting to a small punctured disc about a, Lemma 2.45, applied with the closed bounded target $\overline{B}$, gives a finite minimal limit. Its cardinality is at most one by [17, Lemma 9.4]. It is nonempty because the function has a value at every point of the punctured disc. Write this limit as $\{b\}$.

By shrinking the punctured disc, exclude the at most one input for which $f(x) = b$. The valuation calculation in the proof of [17, Lemma 8.3], applied to the translated germ $f(x) - b$, gives a rational-affine law

$$\mathrm{val}(f(x) - b) = \rho(\mathrm{val}(x - a)), \qquad \rho(\gamma) = q\gamma + c,$$

for all sufficiently small nonzero $x - a$, where $q \in \mathbb{Q}_{>0}$ and $c \in \Gamma$. Indeed, unary polynomials have eventually monomial valuation, the definable germ selects one of the finitely many resulting valuation laws, and convergence to b forces positive slope.

By C-minimality, B contains a punctured neighborhood of b. On this neighborhood the inverse of f has a unique projective limit, using the projective finite-limit theorem and the same cardinality bound. That limit must be a, since $x \longrightarrow a$ implies $f(x) \longrightarrow b$ and the image avoids b on a sufficiently small punctured disc. Apply the same valuation calculation to the inverse to obtain a positive rational-affine law σ for its tail radii. Substituting $y = f(x)$ shows that $\sigma \circ \rho$ is the identity on a tail of Γ, so the two affine laws are inverse there.

Consequently, for every sufficiently large γ, with $\delta = \rho(\gamma)$, the image of the whole source thin annulus is exactly the whole target thin annulus:

$$f\big(\mathfrak{c}(a,\gamma) \setminus \mathfrak{o}(a,\gamma)\big) = \mathfrak{c}(b,\delta) \setminus \mathfrak{o}(b,\delta).$$

The forward inclusion is the law for f; the reverse inclusion follows by applying the inverse law to every point of the target annulus. Taking the unions over all radii greater than γ proves

$$f\big(\mathfrak{o}(a,\gamma) \setminus \{a\}\big) = \mathfrak{o}(b,\rho(\gamma)) \setminus \{b\},$$

as required. No assertion that $q = 1$ is needed. □

Resolved referee R043 [Gap; revised] – The annulus equality needs a proof.
Original source line 1132. Specify that A and B each have one VF-coordinate. The finite limit is a singleton $\{b\}$ by [17, Lemma 9.4]; nonemptiness follows because the values are nonempty on a punctured neighborhood. The equality of whole thin annuli needs more explanation. Here is a repair. The valuation calculation in the proof of [17, Lemma 8.3], applied to $x \mapsto \mathrm{val}(f(x) - b)$, gives

$$\mathrm{val}(f(x) - b) = q\,\mathrm{val}(x - a) + c \qquad (q \in \mathbb{Q}_{>0})$$

on a sufficiently small punctured neighborhood: each unary polynomial has eventually monomial valuation, and the limit forces positive slope. Remove the at most one exceptional input with $f(x) = b$. By C-minimality, B contains a punctured neighborhood of b. The inverse has a unique projective limit there, necessarily a, since points $x \longrightarrow a$ give $f(x) \longrightarrow b$. Apply the same valuation calculation to the inverse. The resulting two affine maps of tail radii are inverse, so every sufficiently small target shell consists exactly of images of its corresponding source shell. Taking their unions proves the asserted punctured-disc equality. Thus the lemma is repairable; an additional assertion that $q = 1$ is unnecessary.

Author resolution. The arity objection is withdrawn: the explicit subsets $A, B \subseteq \mathrm{VF}$ are already unary, and no amendment is needed. The author agrees that the original proof is quick and that the remaining comments spell out details. The expanded proof makes the singleton limit and the inverse tail-radius laws explicit, giving equality of whole thin annuli. The statement and proof strategy are retained; this is an expository expansion, not a correction of a false claim.

Definition 2.52. Let $p : A \longrightarrow \Gamma$ be a definable function. We say that p is an *$\mathfrak{o}$-partition* of A if, for every $a \in A$, the function p is constant on $\mathfrak{o}(a, p(a)) \cap A$.

This makes sense even when A has no VF-coordinates, in which case any definable function $A \longrightarrow \Gamma$ is an $\mathfrak{o}$-partition of A.

Lemma 2.53. *Let p be an $\mathfrak{o}$-partition of A. Suppose that A_{RV} is doubly bounded and A_t is closed and bounded for every $t \in A_{\mathrm{RV}}$. Then $p(A)$ is doubly bounded.*

Proof. First suppose that A has no RV-coordinates. The empty set is immediate. Choose $\eta \in \Gamma$ such that $A \subseteq \mathcal{O}^n_\eta$. If $p(a) < \eta$ for some $a \in A$, then $A \subseteq \mathfrak{o}(a, p(a))$, so the partition property makes p constant on A. Otherwise $p(A) \subseteq [\eta, \infty)$. In either case $p(A)$ is bounded below.

Suppose for contradiction that $p(A)$ is unbounded above. We may temporarily enlarge the parameter base to a small VF-generated base, as in Lemma 2.48; the desired bound is a geometric conclusion. For every $c \in \mathcal{M} \setminus \{0\}$ the definable set

$$A_{\mathrm{val}(c)} = \{x \in A : p(x) > \mathrm{val}(c)\}$$

is nonempty. Elementarity of the algebraic-closure model over this base together with c, followed by compactness, supplies a definable finitary function $F : \mathcal{M} \setminus \{0\} \longrightarrow \mathcal{P}(A)$ with finite nonempty values $F(c) \subseteq A_{\mathrm{val}(c)}$. Continuity of this choice is not needed.

By Lemma 2.45, F has a finite minimal limit set $L \subseteq A$, nonempty because its values are nonempty arbitrarily close to 0. Choose $e \in L$. Minimality implies that, for arbitrarily small

nonzero c, $F(c)$ meets $\mathfrak{o}(e, p(e))$. Choose such a c with $\mathrm{val}(c) > p(e)$ and $x \in F(c) \cap \mathfrak{o}(e, p(e))$. The partition property at e gives $p(x) = p(e)$, whereas the choice gives $p(x) > \mathrm{val}(c) > p(e)$, a contradiction. This proves the upper bound.

For the general case, each nonempty fiber image $p(A_t)$ is bounded above and below by the case just proved, with t temporarily named. Definable completeness in Γ gives finite endpoints

$$\alpha_t = \inf p(A_t), \qquad \beta_t = \sup p(A_t).$$

Their defining greatest-lower-bound and least-upper-bound formulas make these functions definable over the original parameter base. Thus

$$t \longmapsto \gamma_t = \max\{|\alpha_t|, |\beta_t|, 0\}$$

is a definable Γ-valued function on A_{RV}. By Lemma 2.41, its image is doubly bounded. A common upper bound for the γ_t bounds $p(A)$ in both directions, proving the lemma. □

Resolved referee R044 [Gap] – Bounds for an open-disc partition.
Original source line 1152. The lower bound has a short direct proof: choose η with $A \subseteq \mathcal{O}_\eta^n$. If $p(a) < \eta$ for some a, then $A \subseteq \mathfrak{o}(a, p(a))$, forcing p to be constant; otherwise $p(A) \subseteq [\eta, \infty)$. For the upper-bound argument, justify the nonempty finite choices in $A_{\mathrm{val}(c)}$ using the corrected curve-selection/model argument, and use the nonempty finite limit supplied by the limit lemma. In the general case, take a definable bound for each fiber image $p(A_t)$ by its definable endpoints in Γ, then apply Lemma 2.41; fiberwise boundedness by itself is not the uniform conclusion.

Author resolution. The author agrees that the original proof is quick and the comments spell out details. The expansion retains its lower-bound, limit-point contradiction and uniform-fiber-bound strategy. It gives the direct lower-bound calculation, justifies finite nonempty choices over a temporary base, and writes out the definable endpoint bound used with Lemma 2.41. The statement is unchanged.

This lemma, in its various incarnations, is crucial for the good behavior of motivic Fourier transform (see [8, § 11] and [20]). For essentially the same reason, the main construction of this paper depends heavily on it (often in combination with Lemma 2.41).

Lemma 2.54. *Let $A \subseteq \mathrm{VF}^n$ be a definable set. Suppose that, for each $a \in A_1$, the fiber $A_a \subseteq \mathrm{VF}^{n-1}$ is open (respectively, closed). Then there is a finite definable set $A' \subseteq A_1$ such that $A \cap ((A_1 \smallsetminus A') \times \mathrm{VF}^{n-1})$ is open (respectively, closed) in $(A_1 \smallsetminus A') \times \mathrm{VF}^{n-1}$.*

Proof. We prove the open case over an arbitrary definable unary base $I \subseteq \mathrm{VF}$, allowing empty fibers, with $A \subseteq I \times \mathrm{VF}^{n-1}$. The closed case then follows by taking the relative complement in $I \times \mathrm{VF}^{n-1}$. In the statement take $I = A_1$.

Put $X = I \times \mathrm{VF}^{n-1}$ and let

$$S = A \cap \mathrm{Cl}_X(X \setminus A).$$

Thus no point of S is interior to A relative to X. It is enough to show that S_1 is finite. For each $\gamma \in \Gamma$, set

$$T_\gamma = \{(a, x) \in S : \mathfrak{o}(x, \gamma) \subseteq A_a\}.$$

Openness of every fiber gives

$$S_1 = \bigcup_{\gamma \in \Gamma} (T_\gamma)_1.$$

If every $(T_\gamma)_1$ were finite, this definable Γ-indexed union would be finite as well: lift the index to RV and use the RV-indexed VF-dimension bound [17, Lemma 4.3]. Consequently, if S_1 is infinite, some $(T_\gamma)_1$ contains an open disc D.

For this geometric argument we may temporarily enlarge the parameter base to a small VF-generated base containing the data, as in Lemma 2.48. For every $a \in D$, the nonempty definable

fiber $(T_\gamma)_a$ has an algebraic point by elementarity of the algebraic-closure model over this base together with a. Compactness therefore gives a definable finitary function

$$F : D \longrightarrow \mathcal{P}(\mathrm{VF}^{n-1}), \qquad \varnothing \neq F(a) \subseteq (T_\gamma)_a.$$

By Lemma 2.44, choose $a_0 \in D$ at which F is continuous, and put $E = F(a_0)$. After shrinking D around a_0, continuity gives

$$F(a) \subseteq \bigcup_{e \in E} \mathfrak{o}(e, \gamma) \qquad (a \in D).$$

Here E is finite and nonempty. The finitely many definable sets

$$D_e = \{a \in D : F(a) \cap \mathfrak{o}(e, \gamma) \neq \varnothing\}, \qquad e \in E,$$

cover D. Hence one of them contains an open subdisc D'. Fix its index e. For each $a \in D'$, choose $x \in F(a) \cap \mathfrak{o}(e, \gamma)$. Since $(a, x) \in T_\gamma$ and intersecting open polydiscs of the same radius are equal,

$$\mathfrak{o}(e, \gamma) = \mathfrak{o}(x, \gamma) \subseteq A_a.$$

Thus $D' \times \mathfrak{o}(e, \gamma)$ is an open subset of X contained in A and meeting S, a contradiction. Therefore S_1 is finite. Away from S_1, every point of A is interior relative to X, which proves the open case and, by relative complementation, the closed case. □

Resolved referee R045 [Gap; revised] – The fiberwise openness proof needs reconstruction. *Original source line 1173.* The displayed proof contains genuine mistakes, but the conclusion has a repair. Retain $d = \dim_{\mathrm{VF}}(S) < n$ instead of replacing it by $n - 1$. Define

$$\alpha(a, x) = \min\{\beta \geq 0 : \mathfrak{o}(x, \beta) \subseteq A_a\} \quad ((a, x) \in S).$$

This minimum exists: for a nonempty complement it is the maximum of 0 and the supremum of the valuative distances from x to that complement; for a full fiber it is 0. The original unrestricted minimum fails for full fibers. If S_1 is infinite, choose a smooth algebraic chart of a stratum of S whose projection to the first coordinate is nonconstant. In characteristic zero, a separating coordinate projection, including the first coordinate, is generically étale; a local branch over an open polydisc is therefore definable and continuous. Pull α back to this chart and shrink to an open polydisc where it is constant, say ϵ, using generic local constancy of maps into Γ. Fix the remaining chart coordinates and shrink the first-coordinate disc D until the resulting section $a \mapsto (a, s(a)) \in S$ satisfies $s(a) \in \mathfrak{o}(s(a_0), \epsilon)$. Then

$$D \times \mathfrak{o}(s(a_0), \epsilon) \subseteq A,$$

contradicting $(a_0, s(a_0)) \in S$. This proves that S_1 is finite, including when $d < n - 1$. The contradiction concerns interior points of A, not an open polydisc inside S. For the closed case and the next proposition, formulate the lemma over a fixed definable base $I \subseteq \mathrm{VF}$, allowing empty fibers; passage between I and the actual projection costs only its finite unary boundary.

Author resolution. The author approves the independently reconstructed bad-locus proof. A definable family of valid radii and the RV-indexed union principle supply one radius on a whole disc of base points. Finite nonempty choices and unary generic continuity give an open subset of A meeting S, the required contradiction. No codimension-one assumption or minimum-radius choice is needed. The statement is retained, and working over a fixed unary base with empty fibers allowed justifies the closed case by relative complement.

Proposition 2.55. *Let A be as in Lemma 2.54 and $f : A \longrightarrow \mathrm{VF}$ a definable function such that for each $a \in A_1$, the induced function $f_a : A_a \longrightarrow \mathrm{VF}$ is continuous. Then there is a finite definable set $A' \subseteq A_1$ such that f is continuous on $\bigcup_{a \in A_1 \setminus A'} a \times A_a$.*

For the closed-graph argument, the projective line $\mathbb{P}^1(\mathrm{VF})$ is understood with the valuation topology, as in Lemma 2.50.

Proof. Put $I = A_1$ and write H_a for the graph of f_a. Let

$$G_a = \mathrm{Cl}_{\mathrm{VF}^{n-1}\times\mathbb{P}^1(\mathrm{VF})}(H_a), \qquad G = \bigcup_{a\in I}\{a\}\times G_a.$$

This family is definable: fiberwise closure is expressed uniformly by the valuative neighborhood formula in each affine chart. Every G_a is closed in $\mathrm{VF}^{n-1}\times\mathbb{P}^1(\mathrm{VF})$.

Apply the fixed-base version proved in Lemma 2.54, with empty fibers allowed, to G in each of the two standard affine charts of $\mathbb{P}^1(\mathrm{VF})$. Outside the union I' of the resulting two finite definable exceptional sets, G is closed in

$$(I\setminus I')\times\mathrm{VF}^{n-1}\times\mathbb{P}^1(\mathrm{VF}),$$

since closedness is local on this open chart cover. Fiberwise continuity gives

$$H_a = G_a\cap\big(A_a\times\mathbb{P}^1(\mathrm{VF})\big).$$

Consequently, the graph of the restricted function is closed relative to

$$\big(A\cap((I\setminus I')\times\mathrm{VF}^{n-1})\big)\times\mathbb{P}^1(\mathrm{VF}).$$

The closed-graph criterion (Lemma 2.50) proves the asserted continuity. This spells out the relative-closure step in the original implication. □

Resolved referee R046 [Gap; revised] – Relative graph closedness is insufficient for the cited lemma.

Original source line 1188. Continuity of f_a makes its graph closed in $A_a\times\mathbb{P}^1(\mathrm{VF})$, whereas the preceding closed-fiber lemma concerns ambient closed fibers. Define instead

$$G_a = \overline{\mathrm{graph}(f_a)}\subseteq\mathrm{VF}^{n-1}\times\mathbb{P}^1(\mathrm{VF}).$$

Use the preceding lemma in its fixed-base form over $I = A_1$, allowing empty fibers, in each of the two affine charts of $\mathbb{P}^1$. Equivalently, also discard the finite unary boundaries of the chart projections when applying the lemma as currently stated. Outside the union of these finite exceptional sets, G is relatively closed over I. Fiberwise continuity gives $\mathrm{graph}(f) = G\cap(A\times\mathbb{P}^1)$, so the graph is closed in $A\times\mathbb{P}^1$, and the compactified closed-graph criterion applies. This proves the proposition without an open/closed-fiber hypothesis on A_a; clarify the phrase 'as in Lemma 2.54' accordingly.

Author resolution. The author approves expanding the original implication through its relative-closure step. Ambient closures of the fiber graphs form a definable closed-fiber family; Lemma 2.54 applies in the two affine charts over the fixed unary base. Intersecting back with the domain gives relative graph closedness, so Lemma 2.50 gives continuity. The statement and its existing scope are retained. The target wording now explicitly uses the projective line with the valuation topology.

This is analogous to [4, Corollary 6.2.4] in the o-minimal environment and [22, Lemma 2.38] in the T-convex environment.

3. Hrushovski-Kazhdan style integral

Definition 3.1. The Grothendieck semigroup $\mathbf{K}_+\mathcal{C}$ of a category $\mathcal{C}$ endowed with a binary operation "$\smallsetminus$" and a binary relation "$\subseteq$" (subobject) is the free semigroup generated by the isomorphism classes of $\mathcal{C}$, subject to the usual scissor relation $[A\smallsetminus B]+[B]=[A]$, when $B\subseteq A$, where $[A]$, $[B]$ denote the isomorphism classes of the objects A, B, and "$\smallsetminus$" and "$\subseteq$" are compatible with isomorphisms between objects, usually they are just set subtraction and set inclusion. Sometimes $\mathcal{C}$ is also equipped with a binary operation (for example, cartesian product) that induces multiplication in $\mathbf{K}_+\mathcal{C}$, in which case $\mathbf{K}_+\mathcal{C}$ becomes a (commutative) semiring. The formal groupification of $\mathbf{K}_+\mathcal{C}$, which is then a ring, is denoted by $\mathbf{K}\mathcal{C}$.

Referee R047 [Clarification; revised] – Commutative Grothendieck construction.
Original source line 1199. Optional precision: call this the free *commutative monoid* on the isomorphism classes, subject to the scissor relations, with the empty object representing 0. The final phrase "which is then a ring" can be read as referring to the preceding case where multiplication has been supplied; one can make that qualification explicit. This is a convention clarification, not a defect in the subsequent Grothendieck constructions.

Definition 3.2. An RV-*fiber* of a definable set A is a set of the form A_a, where $a \in A_{\mathrm{VF}}$. The RV-*fiber dimension* of A is the maximum of the RV-dimensions of its RV-fibers and is denoted by $\dim^{\mathrm{fib}}_{\mathrm{RV}}(A)$.

Lemma 3.3 ([17, Lemma 4.13])**.** *Let $f : A \longrightarrow A'$ be a definable bijection. Then* $\dim^{\mathrm{fib}}_{\mathrm{RV}}(A) = \dim^{\mathrm{fib}}_{\mathrm{RV}}(A')$.

Definition 3.4 (VF-categories)**.** The objects of the category $\mathrm{VF}[k]$ are the definable sets of VF-dimension less than or equal to k and RV-fiber dimension 0 (that is, all the RV-fibers are finite). Any definable bijection between two such objects is a morphism of $\mathrm{VF}[k]$. Set $\mathrm{VF}_* = \bigcup_k \mathrm{VF}[k]$.

As soon as one considers adding volume forms to definable sets in VF, the question of ambient dimension arises and, consequently, one has to take "essential bijections" as morphisms.

Definition 3.5. An object of the category $\mu\mathrm{VF}[k]$ is a definable pair (A, ω), where $A \in \mathrm{VF}[k]$, $A_{\mathrm{VF}} \subseteq \mathrm{VF}^k$, and $\omega : A \longrightarrow \Gamma$ is a function, which is understood as a *definable Γ-volume form* on A. A *morphism* between two such objects (A, ω), (B, σ) is a definable *essential bijection* $F : A \longrightarrow B$, that is, a bijection that is defined outside definable subsets of A, B of VF-dimension less than k, such that, for almost all $x \in A$,

$$\omega(x) = \sigma(F(x)) + \mathrm{val}(\mathrm{Jcb}_{\mathrm{VF}} F(x)). \tag{3.1}$$

We also say that such an F is Γ-*measure-preserving*.

Notation 3.6. In [8], the category $\mu\mathrm{VF}[k]$ is denoted by $\mu_\Gamma\mathrm{VF}[k]$ to indicate that the volume forms take values in Γ as opposed to RV. Here the subscript "Γ" is dropped since we will not consider RV-volume forms at all.

In the definition above and other similar ones below, for the cases $k = 0$, the reader should interpret things such as VF^0 and how they interact with other things in a natural way. For instance, VF^0 may be treated as the empty tuple, the only definable set of VF-dimension less than 0 is the empty set, and $\mathrm{Jcb}_{\mathrm{VF}}$ is always 1 on sets that have no VF-coordinates. So $(A, \omega) \in \mu\mathrm{VF}[0]$ if and only if A is a finite definable set in RV_∞.

Set $\mu\mathrm{VF}[\leq k] = \coprod_{i \leq k} \mu\mathrm{VF}[i]$ and $\mu\mathrm{VF}[*] = \coprod_k \mu\mathrm{VF}[k]$; similarly for the other categories below (with or without volume forms).

Remark 3.7. Let $F : (A, \omega) \longrightarrow (B, \sigma)$ be a $\mu\mathrm{VF}[k]$-morphism. Our intention is that such an F should identify the two objects, that is, an isomorphism. However, if F is not defined everywhere in A then obviously it does not admit an inverse. We remedy this by introducing the following congruence relation $\sim$ on $\mu\mathrm{VF}[k]$. Let $G : (A, \omega) \longrightarrow (B, \sigma)$ be another $\mu\mathrm{VF}[k]$-morphism. Then $F \sim G$ if $F(a) = G(a)$ for all $a \in A$ outside a definable subset of VF-dimension $< k$. The morphisms of the quotient category $\mu\mathrm{VF}[k]/\!\sim$ have the form $[F]$, where F is a $\mu\mathrm{VF}[k]$-morphism. Clearly every $(\mu\mathrm{VF}[k]/\!\sim)$-morphism is an isomorphism and hence $\mu\mathrm{VF}[k]/\!\sim$ is a groupoid. In fact, all the categories of definable sets we shall work with should be and are groupoids.

It is certainly more convenient to work with representatives than equivalence classes. In the discussion below, this quotient category $\mu\mathrm{VF}[k]/\!\sim$ will almost never be needed except when it

comes to forming the Grothendieck semigroup or, by abuse of terminology, when we speak of two objects of $\mu\mathrm{VF}[k]$ being isomorphic.

Referee R167 [Typo; new] – Missing verb.
Original source line 1238. In the preceding paragraph, write "that is, *be* an isomorphism" after "should identify the two objects."

Definition 3.8 (RV-categories)**.** The objects of the category $\mathrm{RV}[k]$ are the pairs (U, f) with U a set in RV_∞ and $f : U \longrightarrow \mathrm{RV}^k$ a definable finite-to-one function. Given two such objects (U, f), (V, g), any definable bijection $F : U \longrightarrow V$ is a *morphism* of $\mathrm{RV}[k]$.

By Lemma 2.12, the two categories $\mathrm{VF}[0]$, $\mathrm{RV}[0]$ are actually equivalent, similarly for other such categories.

Notation 3.9. We emphasize that if (U, f) is an object of $\mathrm{RV}[k]$ then $f(U)$ is a subset of RV^k instead of RV_∞^k, while ∞ can occur in any coordinate of U. An object of $\mathrm{RV}[*]$ of the form (U, id) is often just written as U.

More generally, if $f : U \longrightarrow \mathrm{RV}_\infty^k$ is a definable finite-to-one function then (U, f) denote the obvious object of $\mathrm{RV}[\leq k]$. For example, the inclusion $\{\infty\} \longrightarrow \mathrm{RV}_\infty$ gives rise to an object of $\mathrm{RV}[0]$, the inclusion $\{(1, \infty)\} \longrightarrow \mathrm{RV}_\infty^2$ gives rise to an object of $\mathrm{RV}[1]$, and so on. Often f will be a coordinate projection (every object in $\mathrm{RV}[*]$ is isomorphic to an object of this form). In that case, $(U, \mathrm{pr}_{\leq k})$ is simply denoted by $U_{\leq k}$ and its class in $\mathbf{K}_+\,\mathrm{RV}[k]$ by $[U]_{\leq k}$, etc.

Referee R048 [Typo] – Agreement.
Original source line 1252. Change the verb "denote" to "denotes" in the sentence about (U, f).

Definition 3.10 (RES-categories)**.** The category $\mathrm{RES}[k]$ is the full subcategory of $\mathrm{RV}[k]$ such that $(U, f) \in \mathrm{RES}[k]$ if and only if $\mathrm{vrv}(U)$ is finite.

Notation 3.11. Every $\mathrm{RV}[k]$-morphism $F : (U, f) \longrightarrow (V, g)$ induces a definable finite-to-finite correspondence $F^\dagger \subseteq f(U) \times g(V)$, which may also be thought of as a finitary function $f(U) \longrightarrow \mathcal{P}(g(V))$. Recall the operator Jcb_Γ from Notation 2.8. For $u \in U$, we abbreviate $\mathrm{Jcb}_\Gamma\, F^\dagger(f(u), g \circ F(u))$ as $\mathrm{Jcb}_\Gamma\, F^\dagger(u)$

Referee R049 [Typo] – Missing punctuation.
Original source line 1260. Add a full stop after the abbreviation $\mathrm{Jcb}_\Gamma\, F^\dagger(u)$.

Definition 3.12 (RV- and RES-categories with Γ-volume forms)**.** An object of the category $\mu\mathrm{RV}[k]$ is a definable triple (U, f, ω), where (U, f) is an object of $\mathrm{RV}[k]$ and $\omega : U \longrightarrow \Gamma$ is a function, which is understood as a *definable Γ-volume form* on (U, f). A *morphism* between two such objects (U, f, ω), (V, g, σ) is an $\mathrm{RV}[k]$-morphism $F : (U, f) \longrightarrow (V, g)$ such that for every $u \in U$,

$$\omega(u) = (\sigma \circ F)(u) + \mathrm{Jcb}_\Gamma\, F^\dagger(u). \tag{3.2}$$

The category $\mu\mathrm{RES}[k]$ is the obvious full subcategory of $\mu\mathrm{RV}[k]$.

Definition 3.13 (Γ-categories)**.** The objects of the category $\Gamma[k]$ are the finite disjoint unions of definable subsets of Γ^k. A definable bijection between two such objects is a morphism of $\Gamma[k]$ if and only if it is the vrv-contraction of a definable bijection.

The category $\Gamma^{\mathrm{fin}}[k]$ is the full subcategory of $\Gamma[k]$ such that $I \in \Gamma^{\mathrm{fin}}[k]$ if and only if I is finite.

Remark 3.14. If $\gamma \in \Gamma$ is definable then it is in the divisible hull of $\Gamma(\mathbb{S})$. This does not mean that the definable set $\gamma^\sharp \subseteq \mathrm{RV}$ contains a definable point unless $\gamma \in \Gamma(\mathbb{S})$.

Remark 3.15. By [19, Remark 2.28], if a definable function between two sets in Γ is a vrv-contraction then it is piecewise $\mathbb{Z}$-affine (with constant terms of the form $\mathrm{vrv}(t)$, where $t \in \mathrm{RV}$ is definable, that is, $t \in \mathrm{RV}(\mathbb{S})$). Moreover, a definable bijection between two objects of $\Gamma[k]$ is a $\Gamma[k]$-morphism if and only if it is definably a piecewise $\mathrm{GL}_k(\mathbb{Z})$-transformation. The "if" direction is clear. For the "only if" direction, see [8, Lemma 10.1] or [19, Lemma 2.29].

Resolved referee R050 [Clarification] – Piecewise integral-affine behavior.
Original source line 1289. The first sentence needs "piecewise $\mathbb{Z}$-affine," not globally "$\mathbb{Z}$-linear." For example, $\gamma \mapsto |\gamma|$ is the vrv-contraction of the definable map $t \mapsto t$ for $\mathrm{vrv}(t) \geq 0$, $t \mapsto t^{-1}$ otherwise. Its two integral-linear formulas differ. Retain the specified restriction on the translation constants.

Author resolution. The author approves the piecewise $\mathbb{Z}$-affine formulation. The restriction on translation constants and the following piecewise $\mathrm{GL}_k(\mathbb{Z})$ characterization are retained.

Definition 3.16 (Γ-categories with volume forms)**.** An object of the category $\mu\Gamma[k]$ is a definable pair (I, ω), where $I \in \Gamma[k]$ and $\omega : I \longrightarrow \Gamma$ is a function. A $\mu\Gamma[k]$-morphism between two objects (I, ω), (J, σ) is a $\Gamma[k]$-morphism $F : I \longrightarrow J$ such that for all $\alpha \in I$,

$$\omega(\alpha) = \sigma(F(\alpha)) + \mathrm{Jcb}_\Gamma F(\alpha).$$

The category $\mu\Gamma^{\mathrm{fin}}[k]$ is the obvious full subcategory of $\mu\Gamma[k]$.

Notation 3.17. For each $(U, f, \omega) \in \mu\mathrm{RV}[k]$, write $\omega_f : U \longrightarrow \Gamma$ for the function given by $u \longmapsto \Sigma(\mathrm{vrv} \circ f)(u) + \omega(u)$. Similarly, for $(I, \sigma) \in \mu\Gamma[k]$, write $\sigma_I : I \longrightarrow \Gamma$ for the function given by $\gamma \longmapsto \Sigma\gamma + \sigma(\gamma)$.

There is a natural map $\Gamma[*] \longrightarrow \mathrm{RV}[*]$ given by $I \longmapsto (I^\sharp, \mathrm{id})$ (see Notation 2.7). This map induces a commutative diagram in the category of graded semirings:

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \mathbf{K}_+\,\Gamma^{\mathrm{fin}}[*] & \rightarrowtail & \mathbf{K}_+\,\mathrm{RES}[*] \\ \downarrow & & \downarrow \\ \mathbf{K}_+\,\Gamma[*] & \rightarrowtail & \mathbf{K}_+\,\mathrm{RV}[*] \end{array}$$

where all the arrows are monomorphisms.

Proof of the horizontal monomorphisms. It suffices to prove that an $\mathbb{S}$-definable bijection $F : I^\sharp \longrightarrow J^\sharp$ in $\mathrm{RV}[n]$ implies that I and J are isomorphic in $\Gamma[n]$, retaining all finite disjoint-union tags. The case $n = 0$ is immediate, so suppose $n > 0$.

For each $\alpha \in I$, the full fibre $\alpha^\sharp$ is a torsor for $(\Bbbk^\times)^n$ and has a unique residue-generic type. By residue-field/value-group orthogonality, $\mathrm{vrv} \circ F$ has finite image on that fibre, with its target tag included. Exactly one target fibre $\beta^\sharp$ receives its generic part. Its image has residue dimension n, since F is injective, and is therefore generic in $\beta^\sharp$. The same argument for F^{-1} shows that this assignment defines a bijection $h : I \longrightarrow J$. Definability of residue dimension in families makes h definable over $\mathbb{S}$. After trivializing the two fibres solely for the proof, the generic restriction of F is a birational map of residue tori: in characteristic zero, the constructible maps supplied by F and F^{-1} are rational inverses on dense open subsets.

Fix $\alpha \in I$, put $\beta = h(\alpha)$, and set

$$\Delta = \mathrm{vrv}(\mathrm{RV} \cap \mathrm{dcl}(\mathbb{S})), \qquad L = (\Delta + \textstyle\sum_i \mathbb{Z}\alpha_i + \sum_i \mathbb{Z}\beta_i)/\Delta.$$

The group L is finitely generated. Let D be the diagonalizable group over $\Bbbk$ with character group L. Its two diagonal representations have weights $\bar{\alpha}_i$ and $\bar{\beta}_i$. Every character $\chi : L \longrightarrow \Bbbk^\times$ extends to Γ/Δ, since $\Bbbk^\times$ is divisible. The resulting RV twist $u \longmapsto \chi(\mathrm{vrv}(u))u$ fixes the residue field, every

Gamma value, and every old-ground RV point. It preserves the RV group operations and residue addition, so relative RV quantifier elimination makes it preserve every $\mathbb{S}$-definable RV relation, including the graph of F. The birational map of the two residue tori is thus D-equivariant. The two actions have the same kernel, by that map and its inverse, and their joint kernel is trivial because all their weights generate L. Both representations are faithful.

By [23, Theorem 7.1 and Corollary 2.5], there is a matrix $M \in \mathrm{GL}_n(\mathbb{Z})$ with $\beta - M\alpha \in \Delta^n$. Choose $c_i \in \mathrm{RV} \cap \mathrm{dcl}(\mathbb{S})$ with these values. Then

$$H(u)_i = c_i \prod_j u_j^{M_{ij}}$$

is an $\mathbb{S}$-definable bijection of the full fibres at α and β. This replaces the generic birational map; it need not extend the given map on its dense open domain. Compactness supplies finitely many such formulas on a definable partition of I. Their full-preimage maps glue to a bijection contracting to h, so h is a $\Gamma[n]$-morphism. This proves the lower horizontal positive injection. The upper injection follows from the commuting square and the two vertical positive injections. □

Author resolution (C002). The author approved adding the original-ground proof of the horizontal positive monomorphisms, using the indicated Reichstein–Youssin result. No HK theorem is taken as an input. There is no corresponding referee item.

The map

$$\mathbf{K}_+\,\mathrm{RES}[*] \times \mathbf{K}_+\,\Gamma[*] \longrightarrow \mathbf{K}_+\,\mathrm{RV}[*]$$

determined by the assignment

$$([(U,f)],[I]) \longmapsto [(U \times I^\sharp, f \times \mathrm{id})] \tag{3.3}$$

is well-defined and is clearly $\mathbf{K}_+\,\Gamma^{\mathrm{fin}}[*]$-bilinear. Hence it induces a $\mathbf{K}_+\,\Gamma^{\mathrm{fin}}[*]$-linear map

$$\Psi : \mathbf{K}_+\,\mathrm{RES}[*] \otimes_{\mathbf{K}_+\,\Gamma^{\mathrm{fin}}[*]} \mathbf{K}_+\,\Gamma[*] \longrightarrow \mathbf{K}_+\,\mathrm{RV}[*], \tag{3.4}$$

which is a homomorphism of graded semirings. By the universal mapping property, groupifying a tensor product in the category of $\mathbf{K}_+\,\Gamma^{\mathrm{fin}}[*]$-semimodules is, up to isomorphism, the same as taking the corresponding tensor product in the category of $\mathbf{K}\,\Gamma^{\mathrm{fin}}[*]$-modules; the groupification of Ψ is still denoted by Ψ. Similarly, there is a $\mathbf{K}_+\,\mu\Gamma^{\mathrm{fin}}[*]$-linear map

$$\mu\Psi : \mathbf{K}_+\,\mu\mathrm{RES}[*] \otimes_{\mathbf{K}_+\,\mu\Gamma^{\mathrm{fin}}[*]} \mathbf{K}_+\,\mu\Gamma[*] \longrightarrow \mathbf{K}_+\,\mu\mathrm{RV}[*]. \tag{3.5}$$

We shall abbreviate $\otimes_{\mathbf{K}_+\,\Gamma^{\mathrm{fin}}[*]}$, $\otimes_{\mathbf{K}_+\,\mu\Gamma^{\mathrm{fin}}[*]}$ both as "$\otimes$" below when no confusion can arise.

Proposition 3.18 (Positive tensor presentation)**.** *Let T_+ and $T_{\mu,+}$ be the sources of Ψ and $\mu\Psi$, respectively. All definitions below use the original ground $\mathbb{S}$. For a* RES *object with underlying set X, put*

$$\Lambda_X = \{\delta \in \Gamma \cap \mathrm{dcl}^{\mathrm{eq}}(\mathbb{S}) : \exists\ \mathbb{S}\text{-definable } c : X \longrightarrow \delta^\sharp\}.$$

Let $\mathcal{C}$ be the semiring congruence on T_+ generated by

$$[\boldsymbol{X}]_r \otimes [U]_m \ \sim\ [\boldsymbol{X}]_r \otimes [U + \delta e_i]_m, \qquad \boldsymbol{X} \in \mathrm{RES}[r],\ U \in \Gamma[m],\ \delta \in \Lambda_X,$$

where $m \geq 1$ and i is a coordinate index. Let $\mathcal{C}_\mu$ be the semiring congruence on $T_{\mu,+}$ generated by

$$[\boldsymbol{X}]_r \otimes [(U,\sigma)]_m \ \sim\ [\boldsymbol{X}]_r \otimes [(U + \delta e_i, \sigma_\delta)]_m, \qquad \sigma_\delta(\eta) = \sigma(\eta - \delta e_i) - \delta,$$

with $\boldsymbol{X} = (X, f, \omega) \in \mu\mathrm{RES}[r]$ and the same admissibility condition $\delta \in \Lambda_X$. The homomorphisms Ψ and $\mu\Psi$ are surjective, with kernel congruences $\mathcal{C}$ and $\mathcal{C}_\mu$, respectively. They induce isomorphisms of graded semirings

$$T_+/\mathcal{C} \ \simeq\ \mathbf{K}_+\,\mathrm{RV}[*], \qquad T_{\mu,+}/\mathcal{C}_\mu \ \simeq\ \mathbf{K}_+\,\mu\mathrm{RV}[*].$$

Proof. The finite product normal form over the original ground partitions every RV[k] object into pieces isomorphic to $X \times U^\sharp$, where X has finite Gamma support and has a finite label of degree $k - m$, and $U \in \Gamma[m]$. For a measured object the combined weight on a RES factor has finite original-ground Gamma image. Partition by these values and use the shared finite measured Gamma factor in degree zero to transfer each constant weight to the Gamma factor. We may therefore normalize every RES combined weight to 0 and retain the whole weight as a definable function λ on its Gamma factor. This gives surjectivity of both positive tensor maps, including finite and degree-zero factors.

For an admissible δ, choose a witness $c : X \longrightarrow \delta^\sharp$. Multiplication of the ith free RV coordinate by $c(x)$ gives an original-ground definable bijection between the two product lifts; division by $c(x)$ is its inverse. Its Gamma-Jacobian is δ, so the prescribed target form σ_δ makes the map measured. Thus the displayed generating pairs lie in the respective kernels. The pair depends on δ, not on the choice of witness.

For the converse, work in one total degree k and represent the two positive tensors by finite disjoint unions of product objects. Let m be the largest Gamma arity on either side of a definable RV bijection F between the product unions. In total degree k, all maximal-arity factors have RES degree $k - m$. We induct on m.

At a full-rank Gamma type in a source product and a residue type in its RES factor, the angular normal form of the graph gives, on a product neighbourhood,

$$F(x, u) = \big(h(x), c(x)u^M\big), \qquad M \in \mathrm{GL}_m(\mathbb{Z}), \qquad \mathrm{vrv}(c(x)) = \boldsymbol{\delta} \text{ constant.}$$

Here the Gamma rank and the total degree force the target free arity and the RES degree to agree with those of the source. The residue output depends only on x. After fixing x, the generic full-fibre monomial calculation gives coefficients over $\mathbb{S}(x)$, which are retained as definable functions of x. Injectivity forces the square exponent matrix to be unimodular. Finite Gamma support makes the values of those coefficients constant after a residue partition, and their values are definable over the original ground. Whole-fibre surjectivity then forces h to be injective; shrinking and taking its image makes it a RES bijection. Product completeness and compactness extend these formulas to definable product neighbourhoods. No original-ground RV representative of $\boldsymbol{\delta}$ is chosen.

Compactness supplies finitely many such product neighbourhoods, with exceptions in finitely many proper original-ground integral-character hyperplanes. A branch with smaller target Gamma arity lies entirely over such hyperplanes. Apply the same construction to F^{-1} and reverse those matches too. A common finite Boolean partition of the source RES and Gamma factors selects disjoint product cells. The two-sided cut property gives product images and retains every original patch image, including the inverse cover. On each matched cell, the integral monomial part is already a Gamma morphism and the elementary pairs handle the coefficient translations one coordinate at a time.

Keep the matched target boxes whole and partition their complements by a finite product grid. These are positive tensor identities on both sides. Restricting F to the actual two complements supplies the residual comparison directly. Every nonempty residual maximal-arity Gamma factor is covered by the finite exceptional hyperplanes. Partition by the first applicable hyperplane. A primitive integral equation and a unimodular coordinate change put one coordinate at a fixed original-ground value. Finite-Gamma balancing transfers that coordinate into RES, lowering Gamma arity by one and preserving total degree. The old lower-arity factors already satisfy the smaller bound. Apply induction to the residual tensors and add the matched congruences. For $m = 0$, all Gamma factors are finite and are absorbed into RES, where the positive RES embedding into RV gives equality. Finally reassemble the finitely many total degrees. This proves the unmeasured kernel assertion without cancelling matched summands.

For the measured kernel, use the preceding normalization on both sides. A matched rectangle then satisfies

$$\lambda(\gamma) = \nu(M\gamma + \boldsymbol{\delta}).$$

The unimodular Gamma morphism and the elementary translated pairs respect these complete combined weights. Retain each parent's Gamma weight on every cell of the finite product grid. On the disjoint union of native charts, the forms glue to an original-ground definable form; the complement inherits this form, and the restricted map F preserves it. The two residual positive sums therefore present actual measured RV objects. In the hyperplane reduction, give the fixed finite Gamma prefix combined weight 0 and substitute its value into the remaining Gamma weight function. Balancing transfers its degree into RES while retaining the full remaining weight. At rank zero absorb the actual finite measured Gamma object with its entire form into measured RES. The same positive induction and finite-degree reassembly prove the measured kernel assertion.

Every step uses actual bijections, finite partitions, and positive semiring operations. Arithmetic in the Gamma-valued forms changes object data; it does not subtract semiring classes. The quotient isomorphisms follow from surjectivity and the kernel-congruence equalities, without additive cancellation or groupification. □

Author resolution (T001). The author approved replacing the tensor-isomorphism assertion by the positive quotient presentation above, with explicit coefficient-translation congruences and both proofs. No corresponding referee item is attached to this author-initiated correction.

Note that, however, [8, Proposition 10.10(2)] does not hold. One of the main motivations of this paper is to construct an alternative to be used in applications.

Notation 3.19. For simplicity, we often drop the constant volume form 0 from the notation. For instance, if $\boldsymbol{U}$ is an object of $\mathrm{RV}[*]$ then it may also denote the object $(\boldsymbol{U}, 0)$ of $\mu\mathrm{RV}[*]$ with the constant volume form 0.

Notation 3.20. Let $[1] \in \mathbf{K}_+\,\mathrm{RES}[1]$ be the class of the singleton $\{1\}$. The class of the singleton $\{1\}$ in $\mathbf{K}_+\,\mathrm{RES}[0]$ is the multiplicative identity of $\mathbf{K}_+\,\mathrm{RES}[*]$ and hence is simply denoted by 1. We have $[\mathrm{RV}^{\circ\circ}_{\infty}] = [\mathrm{RV}^{\circ\circ}] + 1$ in $\mathbf{K}_+\,\mathrm{RV}[{\leq}1]$.

Let I_{sp} be the (nonhomogeneous) semiring congruence relation on $\mathbf{K}_+\,\mathrm{RV}[*]$ generated by the pair $([1], [\mathrm{RV}^{\circ\circ}_{\infty}])$. Let

$$\boldsymbol{P} = [1] - [\mathrm{RV}^{\circ\circ}] \in \mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RV}[1].$$

The corresponding principal ideal of $\mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RV}[*]$ is thus generated by the element $\boldsymbol{P} - 1$.

Similarly, let $\mu\mathrm{I}_{\mathrm{sp}}$ be the semiring congruence relation on $\mathbf{K}_+\,\mu\mathrm{RV}[*]$ generated by the pair $([1], [\mathrm{RV}^{\circ\circ}])$, which is homogeneous, and the corresponding principal ideal of $\mathbf{K}\,\mu\mathrm{RV}[*]$ is generated by the element $\boldsymbol{P}$.

Resolved referee R051 [Typo] – Spelling of homogeneous.
Original source line 1358. In this notation, replace "nonhomogenous" and "homogenous" by "nonhomogeneous" and "homogeneous," respectively.

Author resolution. The author approves correcting the spellings to nonhomogeneous and homogeneous. The congruences and their generators are unchanged.

Notation 3.21. For each $\boldsymbol{U} = (U, f) \in \mathrm{RV}[k]$, let U_f be the set $\bigcup\{f(u)^\sharp \times u \mid u \in U\}$. Let $\mathbb{L}_{\leq k} : \mathrm{RV}[{\leq}k] \longrightarrow \mathrm{VF}[k]$ be the map given by $\boldsymbol{U} \longmapsto U_f$. Set $\mathbb{L} = \bigcup_k \mathbb{L}_{\leq k}$.

Let $\mu\mathbb{L}_k : \mu\mathrm{RV}[k] \longrightarrow \mu\mathrm{VF}[k]$ be the map given by $(\boldsymbol{U}, \omega) \longmapsto (\mathbb{L}\boldsymbol{U}, \mathbb{L}\omega)$, where $\mathbb{L}\omega$ is the obvious function on $\mathbb{L}\boldsymbol{U}$ induced by ω. Set $\mu\mathbb{L} = \bigoplus_k \mu\mathbb{L}_k$.

Suppose that $\mathbb{S}$ is (VF, Γ)-generated. The map $\mathbb{L}$ induces a surjective semiring homomorphism $\mathbf{K}_+ \mathrm{RV}[*] \longrightarrow \mathbf{K}_+ \mathrm{VF}_*$ and the map $\mu\mathbb{L}$ induces a surjective graded semiring homomorphism $\mathbf{K}_+ \mu\mathrm{RV}[*] \longrightarrow \mathbf{K}_+ \mu\mathrm{VF}[*]$, see [8, § 4, § 6] or [17, Corollaries 7.7, 10.6]; we use the same notation for these homomorphisms as well as their groupifications. We have

Resolved referee R053 [Error; revised] – Scope of the parameter hypothesis.
Original source line 1366. State here the (VF, Γ)-generation hypothesis used in Theorem 3.22, before asserting that lifting induces these homomorphisms. Without a parameter restriction, even well-definedness can fail. For example, let the parameters be generated by a trivially valued algebraically closed field C and a named $\tau \in \mathrm{RV}$ of positive value. The singleton objects $\{\tau\}$ and $\{1\}$ are isomorphic in $\mathrm{RV}[1]$. But $\tau^\sharp$ has no definable VF point: Lemma 2.13 places every such point in $\mathrm{acl}(C) \cap \mathrm{VF} = C$. In contrast, $1 + \mathcal{M}$ contains the definable point 1, so their lifts cannot be definably bijective. Moving the stated hypothesis forward removes this obstruction.

Author resolution. The author approves stating the (VF, Γ)-generation hypothesis before both homomorphism assertions. The lift on individual objects needs no such hypothesis. Under the standing nontrivial-ground-value-group assumption, take instead a small algebraically closed nontrivially valued subfield F and name $\tau \in \mathrm{RV}$ with $\mathrm{vrv}(\tau) \notin \Gamma(F)$. Lemma 2.13 puts every definable VF point over the generated structure in F. Thus $\tau^\sharp$ has no definable point, whereas $1^\sharp$ contains 1, although the singleton objects are isomorphic in $\mathrm{RV}[1]$.

$$\mathbb{L}([1]) = [1 + \mathcal{M}] = [\mathcal{M}] \quad \text{and} \quad \mathbb{L}([\mathrm{RV}^{\circ\circ}]) = [\mathcal{M} \smallsetminus 0],$$

and hence $\mathbb{L}(\boldsymbol{P} - 1) = 0$. Similarly, $\mu\mathbb{L}(\boldsymbol{P}) = 0$ since, as we have seen above, $\mathcal{M}$ and $\mathcal{M} \smallsetminus 0$ are in essential bijection. It so happens that these relations are the only ones needed to describe the kernels of $\mathbb{L}$ and $\mu\mathbb{L}$.

Theorem 3.22. *Suppose that $\mathbb{S}$ is (VF, Γ)-generated. For each $k \geq 0$ there is a canonical isomorphism of semigroups*

$$\int_+ : \mathbf{K}_+ \mathrm{VF}[k] \longrightarrow \mathbf{K}_+ \mathrm{RV}[{\leq}k]/\mathrm{I}_{\mathrm{sp}}$$

such that $\int_+[A] = [\boldsymbol{U}]/\mathrm{I}_{\mathrm{sp}}$ if and only if $[A] = [\mathbb{L}\boldsymbol{U}]$. These isomorphisms are compatible with the inductive systems. Passing to the colimit of the groupifications, we obtain a canonical isomorphism of rings

$$\int : \mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{VF}_* \longrightarrow \mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RV}[*]/(\boldsymbol{P} - 1).$$

Similarly, for each $k \geq 0$ there is a canonical isomorphism of semigroups

$$\int_+^\mu : \mathbf{K}_+ \mu\mathrm{VF}[k] \longrightarrow \mathbf{K}_+ \mu\mathrm{RV}[k]/\mu\mathrm{I}_{\mathrm{sp}}$$

such that $\int_+^\mu[\boldsymbol{A}] = [\boldsymbol{U}]/\mu\mathrm{I}_{\mathrm{sp}}$ if and only if $[\boldsymbol{A}] = [\mu\mathbb{L}\boldsymbol{U}]$.

Resolved referee R054 [Typo] – Measured integral notation.
Original source line 1386. The integral in this characterization should be $\int_+^\mu$, consistently with the immediately preceding display.

Author resolution. The author approves adding the measured superscript μ in this characterization. The measured congruence and the asserted equality of lift classes are unchanged.

Taking the direct sum of the groupifications yields a canonical isomorphism of graded rings

$$\int^\mu : \mathbf{K}\,\mu\mathrm{VF}[*] \longrightarrow \mathbf{K}\,\mu\mathrm{RV}[*]/(\boldsymbol{P}).$$

This is a combination of two main theorems, Theorems 8.8 and 8.29, of [8].

4. Uniform retraction to RES

Definition 4.1 (Dimension-free RES-categories)**.** The objects of the category RES are obtained from RES[∗] by forgetting the function f in the pair (U, f). Any definable bijection between two such objects is a morphism of RES.

Resolved referee R055 [Typo] – Agreement.
Original source line 1399. Change the verb "is" to "are" in the sentence beginning "The objects of the category RES."

Author resolution. The agreement typo is corrected under the author's standing instruction for clear corrections.

Remark 4.2. As the Γ-sort is an o-minimal group, there is the *geometric* o-minimal Euler characteristic $\chi_g : \mathbf{K}\,\Gamma[*] \longrightarrow \mathbb{Z}$. This is roughly constructed as follows. Choose a finite cell decomposition $X = \coprod_j C_j$ of a definable set $X \subseteq \Gamma^k$ and set

$$\chi_g(X) = \sum_j (-1)^{\dim C_j}.$$

The cell dimensions may vary, including dimension zero. This does not depend on the chosen partition of X and is invariant under definable bijections. It can also be shown that $\chi_g(X \cap [-\gamma, \gamma]^k)$ stabilizes as γ approaches $+\infty$. The induced map, denoted by $\chi_b : \mathbf{K}\,\Gamma[*] \longrightarrow \mathbb{Z}$, is the so-called *bounded* o-minimal Euler characteristic. Obviously the two maps χ_g, χ_b coincide on doubly bounded sets. On the other hand, $\chi_g((0, +\infty)) = -1$ whereas $\chi_b((0, +\infty)) = 0$. Both of them shall be denoted simply by χ when no distinction is needed.

Resolved referee R056 [Error] – Cell dimensions in the Euler characteristic.
Original source line 1407. The dimension of a cell need not equal the ambient k: a singleton in Γ^k already contradicts the stated decomposition into open k-cubes. The clean correction is to take a finite cell decomposition $X = \coprod_j C_j$ and define $\chi_g(X) = \sum_j (-1)^{\dim C_j}$. If a rectilinearization description is retained, use variable dimensions $d_j \leq k$, including $d_j = 0$.

Author resolution. Applied directly after checking the cell decomposition: the exponent is the dimension of each cell, including zero-dimensional cells, rather than the ambient dimension. The correction is applied under the author's standing authorization.

See [8, § 9] for more details, where χ_g is denoted by χ and χ_b by χ_c.

Notation 4.3. Let $[\mathbb{A}] \in \mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RES}$ denote the class of the affine line over the residue field. The class of the multiplicative torus $[\mathbb{A}] - 1$ over the residue field is written as $[\mathbb{G}_m]$; note that the multiplicative identity 1 of $\mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RES}$ is indeed the class $[1]$, but $[1]$ is not the multiplicative identity of the graded ring $\mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RES}[*]$.

In the graded ring, $[\mathbb{A}]$ denotes the homogeneous degree-one class $[\mathbb{G}_m] + [1] \in \mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RES}[1]$, where $[1]$ is the degree-one point class and the multiplicative identity is the degree-zero point class 1. Every graded localization by $[\mathbb{A}]$ below uses this homogeneous class. After forgetting the grading, the identity is $[\mathbb{A}] = [\mathbb{G}_m] + 1$.

Resolved referee R057 [Clarification] – Define the homogeneous affine-line class.
Original source line 1414. The graded and ungraded uses of $[\mathbb{A}]$ still need an explicit convention. In $\mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RES}[*]$ set $\mathbb{L}_1 = [\mathbb{G}_m] + [1] \in \mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RES}[1]$, whereas in $\mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RES}$ set $\mathbb{L} = [\mathbb{G}_m] + 1$. Specify that every graded localization by $[\mathbb{A}]$ below means localization by $\mathbb{L}_1$, and that $!I[*]$ is generated by homogeneous degree-one differences. This is not merely cosmetic: $[\mathbb{G}_m] + 1$ in the graded ring is inhomogeneous.

Author resolution. The homogeneous degree-one affine-line and point classes, the degree-zero unit, and the degree-one generators of the graded ideal are now explicit. This records the existing grading convention and is applied under the author's standing authorization.

Let $!I$ be the ideal of $\mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RES}$ generated by the elements $[\gamma^\sharp] - [\mathbb{G}_m]$, where $\gamma \in \Gamma$ is definable. The quotient ring $\mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RES}/!I$ is written as $!\mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RES}$. In the graded ring, $!I[*]$ is generated by the homogeneous degree-one differences $[\gamma^\sharp] - [\mathbb{G}_m] \in \mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RES}[1]$, and we set $!\mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RES}[*] = \mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RES}[*]/!I[*]$.

The ideal of $\mathbf{K}\,\mu\mathrm{RES}[*]$ generated by the elements

$$[(\mathbb{G}_m, \alpha + \beta)] - [(\alpha^\sharp, \beta)] \in \mathbf{K}\,\mu\mathrm{RES}[1],$$

where $\alpha, \beta \in \Gamma$ are definable, is denoted by $!\mu I[*]$, and the (graded) quotient ring $\mathbf{K}\,\mu\mathrm{RES}[*]/!\mu I[*]$ by $!\mathbf{K}\,\mu\mathrm{RES}[*]$.

The quotient maps from "$\mathbf{K}$" to "$!\mathbf{K}$" will all be denoted by ι, and will often be omitted when it is clear in the context that the latter one is meant. We will also use the same notation for elements when passing from the former to the latter.

Note that the category $\mu\mathrm{RES}[*]$ and the ring $!\mathbf{K}\,\mu\mathrm{RES}[*]$ will be dismissed after Proposition 4.7 as inadequate for our purpose, and a new construction is introduced thereafter.

4.1. **Without volume forms.** The discussion here more or less follows [9, § 2.5] (also see [8, Theorem 10.5]).

For $0 \leq l \leq n$, consider the maps

$$\epsilon_g^{n,l} : \mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RES}[n-l] \otimes_{\mathbb{Z}} \mathbf{K}\,\Gamma[l] \longrightarrow !\mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RES}[n]$$

given by

$$x \otimes y \longmapsto \chi_g(y) x [\mathbb{G}_m]^l. \tag{4.1}$$

The component maps are first defined on tensor products over $\mathbb{Z}$. Their sum respects the homogeneous balancing relations over $\mathbf{K}\,\Gamma^{\mathrm{fin}}[*]$ after passing to $!\mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RES}[*]$: a finite definable Gamma set is a disjoint union of its definable singleton values, and moving such a singleton between the two factors changes its contribution from $[\gamma^\sharp]$ to $[\mathbb{G}_m]$, whose difference vanishes in the target. The resulting tensor assignment also identifies the coefficient-translation pairs of Proposition 3.18. Indeed, if a RES coefficient R admits a definable map $R \longrightarrow \delta^\sharp$, the corresponding pair translates a single coordinate of the Γ factor by δ. Both χ_g and χ_b are invariant under that definable translation. Thus the degree-n sum descends through the kernel congruence of the surjection Ψ, giving a homomorphism

Resolved referee R058 [Clarification] – Tensor products of homogeneous pieces.
Original source line 1442. Strictly speaking, an individual homogeneous piece such as $\mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RES}[n-l]$ is not a module over the whole graded ring $\mathbf{K}\,\Gamma^{\mathrm{fin}}[*]$. Define the displayed component maps first on $\mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RES}[n-l] \otimes_{\mathbb{Z}} \mathbf{K}\,\Gamma[l]$, then show that their sum descends through the homogeneous balancing relations in the full graded tensor product. The quotient $!I[*]$ gives exactly the required compatibility.

Author resolution. The component maps are now explicitly over the integers; the subsequent sum is shown to respect the full graded balancing relations. This is a clarification of the construction, applied under the standing instruction for clear corrections.

$$\mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RV}[n] \longrightarrow !\mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RES}[n].$$

For later use, denote the resulting graded homomorphisms, before degree normalization, by

$$\widetilde{\mathbb{E}}_g, \widetilde{\mathbb{E}}_b : \mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RV}[*] \longrightarrow !\mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RES}[*], \qquad \widetilde{\mathbb{E}}_\chi\big(\Psi(x \otimes y)\big) = \chi(y) x [\mathbb{G}_m]^l \quad (y \in \mathbf{K}\,\Gamma[l]).$$

No further quotient of the RES target is required for this descent. Composing this with the homomorphism

$$\epsilon_g^{n,m} : !\mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RES}[n] \longrightarrow !\mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RES}[m] : x \longmapsto x[\mathbb{A}]^{m-n}$$

and taking the direct sum of the resulting homomorphisms over all n with $n \leq m$, we obtain a homomorphism

$$\epsilon_g^m : \mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RV}[\leq m] \longrightarrow !\mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RES}[m].$$

These homomorphisms ϵ_g^m, $m = 0, 1, \ldots$, are compatible in the obvious sense. Consequently, they give rise to a homomorphism

$$\mathbb{E}_g : \mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RV}[*] \longrightarrow !\mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RES}[*][[\mathbb{A}]^{-1}]$$

whose range is precisely the zeroth piece $(!\mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RES}[*][[\mathbb{A}]^{-1}])_0$ of the $\mathbb{Z}$-graded ring on the righthand side. We have

$$\mathbb{E}_g([\mathrm{RV}^{\circ\circ}] + 1 - [1]) = -[\mathbb{G}_m][\mathbb{A}]^{-1} + 1 - [1][\mathbb{A}]^{-1} = 0. \tag{4.2}$$

All terms have degree zero: the degree-one point maps to $[1][\mathbb{A}]^{-1}$. The cancellation uses the homogeneous identity $[\mathbb{A}] = [\mathbb{G}_m] + [1]$.

Resolved referee R059 [Error] – Missing degree-one point factor.
Original source line 1461. In the graded target, $\mathbb{E}_g([1]) = [1][\mathbb{A}]^{-1}$, not $[\mathbb{A}]^{-1}$. Thus the correct computation is $-[\mathbb{G}_m][\mathbb{A}]^{-1} + 1 - [1][\mathbb{A}]^{-1} = 0$, using the homogeneous identity $[\mathbb{A}] = [\mathbb{G}_m] + [1]$. As written, the final term has degree -1, while the first two have degree 0. The formula $\mathbb{E}_g([1]) = [\mathbb{A}]^{-1}$ becomes correct only after forgetting the grading.

Author resolution. The missing degree-one point factor is restored. The corrected cancellation follows from the homogeneous affine-line identity; its algebraic calculation is checked in Lean.

Thus $\mathbb{E}_g$ induces an eponymous homomorphism

$$\mathbb{E}_g : \mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RV}[*]/(\boldsymbol{P} - 1) \longrightarrow !\mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RES}[*][[\mathbb{A}]^{-1}].$$

There is a parallel construction, where we replace χ_g with χ_b and $[\mathbb{A}]^{-1}$ with $[1]^{-1}$. The latter replacement is needed so to make $(\boldsymbol{P} - 1)$ vanish as in (4.2). The resulting homomorphism is

$$\mathbb{E}_b : \mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RV}[*]/(\boldsymbol{P} - 1) \longrightarrow !\mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RES}[*][[1]^{-1}], \tag{4.3}$$

whose range is precisely the zeroth piece $(!\mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RES}[*][[1]^{-1}])_0$.

Remark 4.4. The zeroth graded piece $(!\mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RES}[*][[\mathbb{A}]^{-1}])_0$ of $!\mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RES}[*][[\mathbb{A}]^{-1}]$ is canonically isomorphic to the colimit of the groups $!\mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RES}[n]$ with the transition morphisms $\epsilon_g^{n,m}$, which is actually what appears in the construction above. So there is a natural homomorphism from $(!\mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RES}[*][[\mathbb{A}]^{-1}])_0$ to the similar-looking ring $!\mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RES}[[\mathbb{A}]^{-1}]$, induced by the assignment $x \longmapsto x[\mathbb{A}]^{-n}$ for $x \in !\mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RES}[n]$. Note that this homomorphism is not surjective.

Resolved referee R060 [Error; revised] – The asserted injection is false.
Original source line 1474. The natural homomorphism in this sentence need not be injective, already over an untwisted residue field $\mathbb{C}$. To distinguish the two constructions precisely, let R_n be the Grothendieck group of complex constructible sets of dimension at most n, with scissor relations imposed *within that category*, and set $R = \bigoplus_{n\geq 0} R_n$. This is the graded RES ring in the untwisted case; R_n is not by definition the nth dimension-filtration subgroup of the ordinary Grothendieck ring. Let $\mathbb{L}_1 = [\mathbb{A}^1]_1$. Ito–Miura–Okawa–Ueda give smooth projective threefolds X, Y that are not stably birational but satisfy $([X] - [Y])\mathbb{L} = 0$ in the ordinary ring (Theorems 1.1 and 1.3). Thus $z = ([X]_3 - [Y]_3)\mathbb{L}_1^{-3}$ maps to zero in $K_0(\mathrm{Var}_{\mathbb{C}})[\mathbb{L}^{-1}]$. Yet $z \neq 0$: for every $m \geq 0$, the additive invariant on R_{3+m} recording its top-dimensional birational classes distinguishes $X \times \mathbb{A}^m$ and $Y \times \mathbb{A}^m$. Hence no homogeneous power of $\mathbb{L}_1$ kills the numerator. To fit the paper's parameter conventions, take the full algebraically closed Puiseux

field over $\mathbb{C}$ as the parameter field. Every definable value then has a named RV lift, so all $!I$ generators already vanish and $\mathrm{RES}[n]$ identifies with the indicated constructible-set category. Replace "injective homomorphism" by "natural homomorphism." The comparison of $\mathbb{E}_g$ with $\mathbb{E}_b$ uses only that natural map, and the point-localized identification in the next paragraph is unaffected.

Author resolution. The construction supplies the natural comparison map, and no later argument here uses its injectivity. The independent top-dimensional obstruction is recorded in the section review; the point-localized isomorphism is unchanged.

Similarly, there is an injective homomorphism $(!\mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RES}[*][[1]^{-1}])_0 \longrightarrow !\mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RES}[[1]^{-1}] \cong !\mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RES}$, and this is indeed an isomorphism.

If the codomain of $\mathbb{E}_b$ is changed to $!\mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RES}[[\mathbb{A}]^{-1}]$ in the obvious way then it may be compared with $\mathbb{E}_g$. They are different since

$$\mathbb{E}_b([1]) = 1 \quad \text{and} \quad \mathbb{E}_g([1]) = \mathbb{E}_g([\mathrm{RV}^{\circ\circ}]) + 1 = -[\mathbb{G}_m][\mathbb{A}]^{-1} + 1 = [\mathbb{A}]^{-1}. \tag{4.4}$$

We can equalize them by forcing $[\mathbb{A}] = 1$ (hence $\mathbb{E}_g(x \otimes y) = \mathbb{E}_b(x \otimes y) = 0$ for homogeneous $y \in \mathbf{K}\,\Gamma[l]$ with $l > 0$). The (complex version of the) resulting homomorphism is indeed the one constructed in [9, (2.5.7)].

The homomorphism $\mathbb{E}_b$ will be used in constructing the motivic Milnor fiber below, but not $\mathbb{E}_g$. It is not that $\mathbb{E}_g$ would not work; it is just that, conceptually, $\mathbb{E}_b$ is a better choice, see Remarks 4.16 and 8.14.

Resolved referee R168 [Typo; new] – Missing article.
Original source line 1485. Write "used in constructing *the* motivic Milnor fiber below."

Author resolution. The missing article is inserted under the author's standing instruction for clear corrections.

4.2. **With volume forms.** Let $\mathrm{FN}(\Gamma, \mathbb{Z})$ be the set of functions $f : \Gamma \longrightarrow \mathbb{Z}$ such that the range of f is finite and $f^{-1}(m)$ is definable for every $m \in \mathbb{Z}$. Addition in $\mathrm{FN}(\Gamma, \mathbb{Z})$ is defined in the obvious way. Multiplication in $\mathrm{FN}(\Gamma, \mathbb{Z})$ is given by the convolution product as follows. For $f, g \in \mathrm{FN}(\Gamma, \mathbb{Z})$ and $\gamma \in \Gamma$, let h_γ be the function $\Gamma \longrightarrow \mathbb{Z}$ given by $\alpha \longmapsto f(\alpha)g(\gamma - \alpha)$. The range of h_γ is obviously finite. For each $m \in \mathbb{Z}$, $h_\gamma^{-1}(m)$ is a finite disjoint union of sets of the form

$$f^{-1}(m') \cap (\gamma - g^{-1}(m'')),$$

where $m'm'' = m$, and hence is γ-definable. Let

$$h_\gamma^* = \sum_m m\chi(h_\gamma^{-1}(m)) \in \mathbb{Z}$$

and $f * g : \Gamma \longrightarrow \mathbb{Z}$ be the function given by $\gamma \longmapsto h_\gamma^*$. It is not hard to see that, by o-minimality in the Γ-sort, $f * g = g * f$ and it belongs to $\mathrm{FN}(\Gamma, \mathbb{Z})$. Thus $\mathrm{FN}(\Gamma, \mathbb{Z})$ is a commutative ring. Its multiplicative identity is p_0. Associativity is checked on the additive generators in Notation 4.5. Writing $rq_\beta = \eta r$, the mixed r, q, q check reduces to $\eta^2 = -\eta$, which holds for both $\eta = -1$ and $\eta = 0$; the other generator triples follow directly from the displayed rules.

Resolved referee R061 [Clarification; revised] – Associativity of convolution.
Original source line 1501. Optional proof detail: add that p_0 is the multiplicative identity and that associativity follows by checking the additive generators in Notation 4.5. For example, writing $rq_\beta = \eta r$, the only nontrivial r, q, q check reduces to $\eta^2 = -\eta$, which holds for both $\eta = -1$ and $\eta = 0$. The ring assertion is correct for both choices of χ.

Author resolution. The identity and generator associativity check are now explicit. This supplies an omitted justification without changing either convolution product.

Notation 4.5. In $\mathrm{FN}(\Gamma,\mathbb{Z})$, let r be the constant function 1 and, for each definable element $\gamma\in\Gamma$, let p_γ, q_γ be the characteristic functions of γ, (γ,∞), respectively. By o-minimality, $\mathrm{FN}(\Gamma,\mathbb{Z})$ is generated as a $\mathbb{Z}$-module by elements of the forms r, p_γ, q_γ. We have the following equalities:

$$rp_\beta = r,\quad p_\alpha p_\beta = p_{\alpha+\beta},\quad p_\alpha q_\beta = q_{\alpha+\beta},\quad q_\alpha q_\beta = -q_{\alpha+\beta}.$$

In addition,

- if $\chi=\chi_g$ then $r^2 = rq_\beta = -r$,
- if $\chi=\chi_b$ then $r^2 = r$ and $rq_\beta = 0$.

Remark 4.6. For each $\boldsymbol{I}=(I,\mu)\in\mu\Gamma[k]$, let $\mu_I : I\longrightarrow\Gamma$ be the function given by $\gamma\longmapsto\mu(\gamma)+\Sigma\gamma$ and $\lambda_{\boldsymbol{I}}:\Gamma\longrightarrow\mathbb{Z}$ the function given by $\gamma\longmapsto\chi(\mu_I^{-1}(\gamma))$. By o-minimality, the range of $\lambda_{\boldsymbol{I}}$ is finite and, for every $m\in\mathbb{Z}$, $\lambda_{\boldsymbol{I}}^{-1}(m)$ is definable. So $\lambda_{\boldsymbol{I}}\in\mathrm{FN}(\Gamma,\mathbb{Z})$. If $F:(I,\mu)\longrightarrow(J,\sigma)$ is a $\mu\Gamma[k]$-morphism then F restricts to a bijection from $\mu_I^{-1}(\gamma)$ to $\sigma_J^{-1}(\gamma)$ for every $\gamma\in\Gamma$ and hence $\lambda_{\boldsymbol{I}}=\lambda_{\boldsymbol{J}}$ and we may write $\lambda_{\boldsymbol{I}}$ as $\lambda_{[\boldsymbol{I}]}$. Let $\boldsymbol{J}=(J,\sigma)\in\mu\Gamma[l]$. If $k=l$ then clearly $\lambda_{[\boldsymbol{I}]}+\lambda_{[\boldsymbol{J}]}=\lambda_{[\boldsymbol{I}]+[\boldsymbol{J}]}$. An easy computation shows that, for every $\gamma\in\Gamma$,

$$(\lambda_{[\boldsymbol{I}]}*\lambda_{[\boldsymbol{J}]})(\gamma)=\chi((\mu\sigma)^{-1}_{I\times J}(\gamma)),$$

where $\mu\sigma: I\times J\longrightarrow\Gamma$ is the function given by $(\alpha,\beta)\longmapsto\mu(\alpha)+\sigma(\beta)$, and hence $\lambda_{[\boldsymbol{I}]}*\lambda_{[\boldsymbol{J}]}=\lambda_{[\boldsymbol{I}][\boldsymbol{J}]}$. Put $\Gamma_{\mathrm{def}}=\Gamma\cap\mathrm{dcl}^{\mathrm{eq}}(\mathbb{S})$ and let $\mathbb{Z}[\Gamma_{\mathrm{def}}]$ be its group ring over $\mathbb{Z}$, viewed as the subring of $\mathrm{FN}(\Gamma,\mathbb{Z})$ spanned by p_γ for all $\gamma\in\Gamma_{\mathrm{def}}$. The degree-zero objects have definable constant weights, so $\mathbf{K}\,\mu\Gamma[0]\cong\mathbb{Z}[\Gamma_{\mathrm{def}}]$. It follows that the map

Resolved referee R062 [Error] – The group ring uses definable value-group constants.
Original source line 1520. The degree-zero coefficient group is the group of *definable* elements of Γ, not necessarily $\Gamma(\mathbb{S})$. With the present conventions, put $\Gamma_{\mathrm{def}}=\Gamma\cap\mathrm{dcl}^{\mathrm{eq}}(\mathbb{S})$ and replace $\mathbb{Z}\Gamma$ throughout this construction by $\mathbb{Z}[\Gamma_{\mathrm{def}}]$; in the usual valued-field-generated setting $\Gamma_{\mathrm{def}}=\mathbb{Q}\otimes\Gamma(\mathbb{S})$. For example, over $\mathbb{C}((t))$, the singleton object of $\mu\Gamma[0]$ with constant volume form $\mathrm{val}(t)/2$ is allowed and maps to $p_{1/2}$, although $\Gamma(\mathbb{S})=\mathbb{Z}$. Thus the stated target misses legitimate degree-zero classes. This distinction is already acknowledged in the remark following Definition 3.13.

Author resolution. Degree-zero objects permit all definable constant weights. The coefficient group is now consistently the group of definable Gamma elements, as required by the earlier Gamma-category convention.

$$\lambda:\mathbf{K}\,\mu\Gamma[*]\longrightarrow\mathbb{Z}[\Gamma_{\mathrm{def}}]\oplus X\,\mathrm{FN}(\Gamma,\mathbb{Z})[X]$$

determined by the assignment

$$[\boldsymbol{I}]\longmapsto\lambda_{[\boldsymbol{I}]}X^k,\quad \boldsymbol{I}\in\mu\Gamma[k],$$

is a graded ring homomorphism. Of course, there are two such homomorphisms λ_g and λ_b, corresponding to the two choices $\chi=\chi_g$ and $\chi=\chi_b$.

We claim that the assignments for $k\geq 1$

$$p_\gamma X^k\longmapsto[\mathbb{G}_m]^{k-1}[(\mathbb{G}_m,\gamma)],\quad q_\gamma X^k\longmapsto[\mathbb{G}_m]^{k-1}[(\{1\},\gamma)],\quad rX^k\longmapsto 0 \tag{4.5}$$

induce a graded ring homomorphism

$$\psi:\mathbb{Z}[\Gamma_{\mathrm{def}}]\oplus X\,\mathrm{FN}(\Gamma,\mathbb{Z})[X]\longrightarrow{}!\mathbf{K}\,\mu\mathrm{RES}[*]/([\mathbb{A}]).$$

Note that $\mathbb{Z}[\Gamma_{\mathrm{def}}]$ may be regarded as a subring of $\mathbf{K}\,\mu\mathrm{RES}[0]$ by identifying p_γ with $[(\infty,\gamma)]$, which is the intended interpretation of the first assignment for $k=0$. The $q_\gamma X^k$ and rX^k assignments apply only for $k\geq 1$. For the claim, it suffices to check that ψ obeys the equational constraints for the generators above in Notation 4.5, which are all straightforward (the equality $\psi(q_\alpha X^k)\psi(q_\beta X^l)=\psi(-q_{\alpha+\beta}X^{k+l})\quad(k,l\geq 1)$ holds since $[\mathbb{A}]=[\mathbb{G}_m]+[1]=0$ is forced).

Resolved referee R063 [Typo] – Restore the degrees in the multiplicativity check.
Original source line 1544. The symbols q_α alone are not degree-zero elements of the displayed domain. State the check as $\psi(q_\alpha X^k)\psi(q_\beta X^l) = \psi(-q_{\alpha+\beta}X^{k+l})$ for $k, l \geq 1$. Also state explicitly that the second and third assignments in (4.5) apply only for $k \geq 1$; the separate interpretation at $k = 0$ applies to p_γ.

Author resolution. The positive-degree domain of the ray and constant assignments and the degrees in the multiplicativity check are now explicit.

Let $\mathfrak{h}$ denote the element $[(\mathrm{RV}^{\circ\circ}, -\mathrm{vrv})] \in \mathbf{K}\,\mu\mathrm{RV}[1]$.

Proposition 4.7. *There are two graded ring homomorphisms*

$$\mu\mathbb{E}_g, \mu\mathbb{E}_b : \mathbf{K}\,\mu\mathrm{RV}[*] \longrightarrow {!}\mathbf{K}\,\mu\mathrm{RES}[*]/([\mathbb{A}])$$

such that

- $\boldsymbol{P} \in \mathbf{K}\,\mu\mathrm{RV}[1]$ *vanishes under both of them,*
- *for all* $x \in \mathbf{K}\,\mu\mathrm{RES}[*]$, $\mu\mathbb{E}_g(x) = \mu\mathbb{E}_b(x) = x/([\mathbb{A}])$,
- *they are distinguished by* $\mu\mathbb{E}_g(\mathfrak{h}) = +[1]/([\mathbb{A}])$ *and* $\mu\mathbb{E}_b(\mathfrak{h}) = 0$.

Resolved referee R064 [Error] – Sign of the geometric retraction on h.
Original source line 1560. The construction gives the opposite sign in the third bullet. For $\boldsymbol{I} = ((0,\infty), -\mathrm{id})$, the corrected weight μ_I is identically zero, so $\lambda_g([\boldsymbol{I}]) = -p_0X$. Consequently $\mu\mathbb{E}_g(\mathfrak{h}) = \psi(-p_0X) = -[\mathbb{G}_m] = +[1]$ modulo $([\mathbb{A}])$. The bounded value is indeed zero. Replace $-[1]/([\mathbb{A}])$ by $+[1]/([\mathbb{A}])$. This confirms the sign concern in the supplied human referee report; repeating the sign printed in the cited HK theorem does not fix its incompatibility with the present definitions.

Author resolution. The sign is corrected directly from the stated construction: the corrected weight is zero, the geometric ray contributes $-p_0X$, and its image is $-[\mathbb{G}_m] = +[1]$ modulo the affine-line class. The bounded value remains zero.

Proof. The product map

$$(\iota/([\mathbb{A}])) \times (\psi \circ \lambda) : \mathbf{K}\,\mu\mathrm{RES}[*] \times \mathbf{K}\,\mu\Gamma[*] \longrightarrow {!}\mathbf{K}\,\mu\mathrm{RES}[*]/([\mathbb{A}])$$

is $\mathbf{K}\,\mu\Gamma^{\mathrm{fin}}[*]$-bilinear (because of the ideal ${!}\mu I[*]$ in the target). It also identifies the measured coefficient-translation pairs of Proposition 3.18. For a translation $\eta = \gamma + \delta e_i$ of (I, σ), the target volume form is

$$\sigma_\delta(\eta) = \sigma(\eta - \delta e_i) - \delta.$$

Consequently

$$\sigma_\delta(\eta) + \Sigma\eta = \sigma(\gamma) + \Sigma\gamma.$$

The corrected-weight fibers are therefore definably bijective, so their two Euler characteristics agree and λ has the same value on the pair. The balanced product map thus descends through the kernel congruence of the surjection $\mu\Psi$, giving the desired graded homomorphisms. To compute their values, use the explicit tensor preimages

$$\mu\Psi\big([1] \otimes 1 - 1 \otimes [(0,\infty)]\big) = \boldsymbol{P}, \qquad \mu\Psi\big(1 \otimes [((0,\infty), -\mathrm{id})]\big) = \mathfrak{h}.$$

These formulas use preimages under the product map. For the value on $\mathfrak{h}$, the corrected weight on $((0,\infty), -\mathrm{id})$ is zero, so

$$\lambda_g([((0,\infty), -\mathrm{id})]) = -p_0X, \qquad \mu\mathbb{E}_g(\mathfrak{h}) = \psi(-p_0X) = -[\mathbb{G}_m] = +[1] \pmod{([\mathbb{A}])}.$$

For χ_b the open ray has characteristic zero, giving $\mu\mathbb{E}_b(\mathfrak{h}) = 0$.

Finally, [1] is nonzero in the target. After forgetting degree and volume forms, choose auxiliary RV representatives for the finitely many value fibers of each RES object. Normalization and quantifier elimination give pure residue-field definable sets, and hence a homomorphism to the

Grothendieck ring of pure $\Bbbk$-definable sets modulo the affine-line class $\mathbb{L}$. The fiber relations vanish under this homomorphism, $[\mathbb{A}]$ maps to $\mathbb{L}$, and $[1]$ maps to 1. The latter quotient is nonzero: any proposed equality $1 = 0$ uses only finitely many formulas, parameters and definable bijections. By the Lefschetz principle these data specialize to an algebraic closure of a finite field, with all parameters in some $\mathbb{F}_q$. A definable bijective relation over $\mathbb{F}_q$ induces a bijection on its $\mathbb{F}_q$-points. Counting these points modulo q preserves the defining relations, sends $\mathbb{L}$ to 0 and sends 1 to 1, a contradiction. Thus the two displayed values on $\mathfrak{h}$ are distinct.

Resolved referee R065 [Typo] – Agreement.
Original source line 1570. Change the final verb "follow" to "follows," since the subject is "The existence."

Author resolution. The subject–verb agreement is corrected under the author's standing instruction for clear corrections.

□

The discussion above is more or less an expanded version of the proof of [8, Theorem 10.11].

Remark 4.8. Alternatively, for $\chi = \chi_g$, we may replace $rX^k \longmapsto 0$ in (4.5) with $rX^k \longmapsto [\mathbb{G}_m]^{k-1}[1]$, that is, sending rX^k and q_0X^k to the same element. Let J be the enlargement of $!\mu I[*]$ by the elements $[1] - [(\{1\}, \gamma)] \in \mathbf{K}\,\mu\mathrm{RES}[1]$. Then ψ is still a graded ring homomorphism with this enlarged quotient. Consequently, for instance, we can construct a ring homomorphism

$$\mathbf{K}\,\mu\mathrm{RV}[*] \longrightarrow \mathbf{K}\,\mu\mathrm{RES}[*]/(J + ([\mathbb{A}])) \xrightarrow{\phi} !\mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RES}[*]/([\mathbb{A}]), \tag{4.6}$$

where the homomorphism ϕ is induced by the obvious forgetful functor.

Resolved referee R066 [Clarification; revised] – Name the enlarged quotient.
Original source line 1580. Optional notation clarification: the preceding sentence already stipulates enlargement of $!\mu I[*]$. In the alternative construction, name the enlarged ideal J and write the middle term of (4.6) as $\mathbf{K}\,\mu\mathrm{RES}[*]/(J + ([\mathbb{A}]))$, so that the old and enlarged quotients are visibly distinguished. Read with that stipulated enlargement, the construction is consistent. The original assignment $rX^k \mapsto 0$ needs no such additional relations.

Author resolution. The already stipulated enlarged ideal is named J and the alternative target displays J explicitly; no additional relation is imposed on the original construction.

We shall not, however, pursue this further, since taking the quotient by the ideal $([\mathbb{A}])$ is detrimental to our purpose here. To avoid it, we need to work with the categories of doubly bounded objects.

Definition 4.9 (Doubly bounded RV-categories)**.** An object $(U, f) \in \mathrm{RV}[k]$ is *doubly bounded* if U is. Denote the full subcategory of $\mathrm{RV}[k]$ of doubly bounded objects by $\mathrm{RV}^{\mathrm{db}}[k]$, and similarly for the categories $\mu\mathrm{RV}^{\mathrm{db}}[k]$, $\mu\Gamma^{\mathrm{db}}[k]$.

Remark 4.10. By Lemma 2.41, if $(U, f, \omega) \in \mu\mathrm{RV}^{\mathrm{db}}[k]$ then $f(U)$, $\omega(U)$ are both doubly bounded as well. The product construction gives a homomorphism

$$\mu\Psi^{\mathrm{db}} : \mathbf{K}_+\,\mu\mathrm{RES}[*] \otimes \mathbf{K}_+\,\mu\Gamma^{\mathrm{db}}[*] \longrightarrow \mathbf{K}_+\,\mu\mathrm{RV}^{\mathrm{db}}[*].$$

We use it below to compute images of explicit tensor classes. The bounded retraction itself is obtained by restricting the already constructed graded map $\widetilde{\mathbb{E}}_b$ after forgetting volume forms.

Notation 4.11. Let $\mathrm{FN}^{\mathrm{db}}(\Gamma, \mathbb{Z})$ be the subgroup of $\mathrm{FN}(\Gamma, \mathbb{Z})$ consisting of functions whose nonzero locus is doubly bounded. For each definable $\gamma \in \Gamma$, set

$$o_\gamma = \begin{cases} \mathbf{1}_{(0,\gamma)}, & \gamma > 0, \\ \mathbf{1}_{(\gamma,0)}, & \gamma < 0, \\ -p_0, & \gamma = 0. \end{cases}$$

As a $\mathbb{Z}$-module, $\mathrm{FN}^{\mathrm{db}}(\Gamma, \mathbb{Z})$ is generated by p_γ, o_γ. For $\gamma > 0$ we have $o_\gamma = q_0 - q_\gamma - p_\gamma$, and for $\gamma < 0$ we have $o_\gamma = q_\gamma - q_0 - p_0$. The convention $o_0 = -p_0$ is a convention for functions; it does not identify o_0 with the characteristic function of the empty interval $(0, 0)$. The convolution products are given by the following cases.

Resolved referee R067 [Error] – Negative interval generators and bounded support.
Original source line 1600. For $\gamma < 0$, the interval $(0, \gamma)$ is empty, so the definition as written cannot yield the claimed generators or quotient: the relation $o_\gamma + p_0$ would even kill the unit p_0. Define $o_\gamma = \mathbf{1}_{(\gamma,0)}$ when $\gamma < 0$, retaining $o_\gamma = \mathbf{1}_{(0,\gamma)}$ when $\gamma > 0$ and $o_0 = -p_0$. Also define $\mathrm{FN}^{\mathrm{db}}(\Gamma, \mathbb{Z})$ explicitly as the subgroup of functions whose nonzero locus is doubly bounded. These conventions make the subsequent formulas meaningful.

Author resolution. The bounded nonzero-support convention and both signs of the interval are now explicit, including the separate function convention at zero. The literal negative interval cannot supply the intended generator.

For $\beta \neq 0$, put $a = \min(\alpha, \alpha + \beta)$ and $b = \max(\alpha, \alpha + \beta)$. Then $p_\alpha o_\beta$ is the characteristic function of (a, b), and

$$p_\alpha o_\beta = \begin{cases} o_b - o_a - p_a, & 0 \leq a < b, \\ o_a - o_b - p_b, & a < b \leq 0, \\ o_a + o_b + p_0, & a < 0 < b. \end{cases}$$

For $\beta = 0$, $p_\alpha o_0 = -p_\alpha$. Also,

$$o_\alpha o_\beta = \begin{cases} -o_{\alpha+\beta}, & \alpha, \beta \geq 0 \text{ or } \alpha, \beta \leq 0, \\ -o_\alpha - o_\beta - p_0, & \alpha < 0 < \beta \text{ or } \beta < 0 < \alpha. \end{cases}$$

Resolved referee R068 [Clarification] – Specify which interval identity applies.
Original source line 1605. After correcting the negative-interval convention, the alternatives can be made unambiguous as follows. Set $a = \min(\alpha, \alpha + \beta)$ and $b = \max(\alpha, \alpha + \beta)$. For $\beta \neq 0$, $p_\alpha o_\beta$ is the characteristic function of (a, b): it is $o_b - o_a - p_a$ if $0 \leq a < b$, $o_a - o_b - p_b$ if $a < b \leq 0$, and $o_a + o_b + p_0$ if $a < 0 < b$. For $\beta = 0$ it equals $-p_\alpha$. Likewise $o_\alpha o_\beta = -o_{\alpha+\beta}$ when $\alpha, \beta \geq 0$ or $\alpha, \beta \leq 0$, and equals $-o_\alpha - o_\beta - p_0$ when α and β have opposite strict signs.

Author resolution. The original alternatives are now assigned their sign and endpoint cases, with the zero interval parameter treated separately.

Notation 4.12. The homomorphism

$$\lambda : \mathbf{K}\,\mu\Gamma^{\mathrm{db}}[*] \longrightarrow \mathbb{Z}[\Gamma_{\mathrm{def}}] \oplus X\,\mathrm{FN}^{\mathrm{db}}(\Gamma, \mathbb{Z})[X]$$

is constructed as before (there is only one such homomorphism now since χ_g, χ_b agree on doubly bounded sets).

Notation 4.13. Recall that $\mathrm{RV}^{\circ\circ}_\gamma = \mathrm{rv}(\mathcal{M}_\gamma \smallsetminus 0)$ (Notation 2.5). Let D_{RV} consist of the nonnegative definable γ such that $\gamma^\sharp$ contains an $\mathbb{S}$-definable point. For each $\gamma \in D_{\mathrm{RV}}$, let

$$\boldsymbol{P}_\gamma = [\mathrm{RV}^{\circ\circ} \smallsetminus \mathrm{RV}^{\circ\circ}_\gamma] + [\{t_\gamma\}] - [1] \in \mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RV}^{\mathrm{db}}[1],$$

where $t_\gamma \in \gamma^\sharp$ is any definable point. It also stands for the corresponding element in $\mathbf{K}\,\mu\mathrm{RV}^{\mathrm{db}}[1]$ (with the constant volume form 0). Note that, although $[\{t_\gamma\}] = [1]$ in $\mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RV}^{\mathrm{db}}[1]$, $[\{t_\gamma\}] \neq [1]$ in $\mathbf{K}\,\mu\mathrm{RV}^{\mathrm{db}}[1]$ unless $\gamma = 0$.

Resolved referee R069 [Error] – The radius must admit a definable RV lift.
Original source line 1621. Not every definable γ admits the definable point t_γ required here. Restrict the definition to nonnegative γ for which $\gamma^\sharp$ contains an $\mathbb{S}$-definable point, equivalently $\gamma \in \mathrm{vrv}(\mathrm{RV}(\mathrm{dcl}\,\mathbb{S}))$. In the later valued-field-generated setting this is the value group of the parameter field, rather than its divisible hull. For example, over $\mathbb{C}((t))$, $\gamma = 1/2$ is definable but there is no definable RV element of that value. Make the same restriction in the generating set of $(\boldsymbol{P}_\Gamma)$. The later specialization to integral radii should refer back to this restriction.

Author resolution. The author approved the restriction to nonnegative radii admitting an RV lift definable over the original parameter base. The set D_{RV} now indexes both the generators and the generated ideal.

Clearly $\boldsymbol{P}_\gamma$ does not depend on the choice of $t_\gamma \in \gamma^\sharp$. The ideal of $\mathbf{K}\,\mu\mathrm{RV}^{\mathrm{db}}[*]$ generated by the elements $\boldsymbol{P}_\gamma$ with $\gamma \in D_{\mathrm{RV}}$ is denoted by $(\boldsymbol{P}_\Gamma)$. A definable Gamma value need not have a definable RV lift, as already noted after Definition 3.13. All choices are made over the original parameter base. The images of $(\boldsymbol{P}_\Gamma)$ under the obvious forgetful homomorphisms

$$\mathbf{K}\,\mu\mathrm{RV}^{\mathrm{db}}[*] \longrightarrow \mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RV}[*], \quad \mathbf{K}\,\mu\mathrm{RV}^{\mathrm{db}}[*] \longrightarrow \mathbf{K}\,\mu\mathrm{RV}[*]$$

are contained in $(\boldsymbol{P} - 1)$, $(\boldsymbol{P})$, respectively.

Resolved referee R070 [Typo] – Closing punctuation.
Original source line 1627. End this sentence with a full stop, not a comma.

Author resolution. The sentence now ends with a full stop.

Remark 4.14. Let $!P$ denote the ideal of $\mathrm{FN}^{\mathrm{db}}(\Gamma, \mathbb{Z})$ generated by the elements $p_\gamma - p_0$, $o_\gamma + p_0$. By the computation in Notation 4.11, $\mathrm{FN}^{\mathrm{db}}(\Gamma, \mathbb{Z})/!P \cong \mathbb{Z}$; the quotient homomorphism is denoted by χ because a simple computation shows that if $\boldsymbol{I} = (I, \mu) \in \mu\Gamma^{\mathrm{db}}[*]$ then indeed $\lambda_{\boldsymbol{I}}/!P = \chi(I)$. Now it is straightforward to check that the assignments

$$p_\gamma X^k \longmapsto [\mathbb{G}_m]^k, \quad o_\gamma X^k \longmapsto -[\mathbb{G}_m]^k \tag{4.7}$$

induce a graded ring homomorphism

$$\psi^{\mathrm{db}} : \mathbb{Z}[\Gamma_{\mathrm{def}}] \oplus X\,\mathrm{FN}^{\mathrm{db}}(\Gamma, \mathbb{Z})[X] \longrightarrow !\mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RES}[*].$$

In a nutshell, the homomorphism $\psi^{\mathrm{db}} \circ \lambda$ is a "forgetful" map given by $[(I, \mu)] \longmapsto \chi(I)[\mathbb{G}_m]^k$, $(I, \mu) \in \mu\Gamma^{\mathrm{db}}[k]$.

The forgetful homomorphism $\phi : \mathbf{K}\,\mu\mathrm{RES}[*] \longrightarrow !\mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RES}[*]$ is similar to the one in (4.6).

Proposition 4.15. *There is a graded ring homomorphism*

$$\mu\mathbb{E}^{\mathrm{db}} : \mathbf{K}\,\mu\mathrm{RV}^{\mathrm{db}}[*] \longrightarrow !\mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RES}[*]$$

such that $(\boldsymbol{P}_\Gamma)$ *vanishes and, for all* $x \in \mathbf{K}\,\mu\mathrm{RES}[*]$, $\mu\mathbb{E}^{\mathrm{db}}(x) = \phi(x)$.

Proof. Let $F : \mathbf{K}\,\mu\mathrm{RV}^{\mathrm{db}}[*] \longrightarrow \mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RV}[*]$ be the forgetful homomorphism and set

$$\mu\mathbb{E}^{\mathrm{db}} = \widetilde{\mathbb{E}}_b \circ F.$$

This is graded, and its restriction to $\mathbf{K}\,\mu\mathrm{RES}[*]$ is ϕ. On the bounded tensor product its assignment is $\phi \times (\psi^{\mathrm{db}} \circ \lambda)$, by Remark 4.14. Thus it remains to compute the radius generators. If $\gamma = 0$,

the annulus is empty and the value-zero singleton classes $[\{t_0\}]$ and $[1]$ agree, so $\boldsymbol{P}_0 = 0$. For an indexed radius $\gamma > 0$, we have

$$\mu\Psi^{\mathrm{db}}\big(1 \otimes [(0,\gamma)] + 1 \otimes [\{\gamma\}] + [\{t_\gamma\}] \otimes 1 - [1] \otimes 1\big) = \boldsymbol{P}_\gamma.$$

Its image under $\phi \otimes (\psi^{\mathrm{db}} \circ \lambda)$ is

$$\chi((0,\gamma))[\mathbb{G}_m] + \chi(\{\gamma\})[\mathbb{G}_m] + [1] - [1] = -[\mathbb{G}_m] + [\mathbb{G}_m] = 0.$$

The open-interval-plus-endpoint expansion is used only for $\gamma > 0$.

Resolved referee R071 [Error] – The zero-radius case in the proof.
Original source line 1657. The displayed decomposition and its vanishing computation apply only for $\gamma > 0$. At $\gamma = 0$, $\boldsymbol{P}_0 = 0$, but the displayed right side leaves the nonzero term $[\{0\}]$ in the $\Gamma[1]$ factor, whose image is $[\mathbb{G}_m]$. Handle $\gamma = 0$ separately, and for $\gamma > 0$ write the calculation explicitly: $\chi((0,\gamma))[\mathbb{G}_m] + \chi(\{\gamma\})[\mathbb{G}_m] + [1] - [1] = -[\mathbb{G}_m] + [\mathbb{G}_m] = 0$. The artificial convention $o_0 = -p_0$ concerns functions; it does not change the actual class of the empty interval $(0,0)$.

Author resolution. The zero generator is handled directly, and the interval-plus-endpoint calculation is restricted to positive radii. The intended bounded retraction is unchanged.

□

The composition of $\mu\mathbb{E}^{\mathrm{db}}$ with the obvious forgetful homomorphism $!\mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RES}[*] \longrightarrow !\mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RES}$ is denoted by $\mathbb{E}^{\diamond}$. By Remark 4.14, the diagram commutes:

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \mathbf{K}\,\mu\mathrm{RV}^{\mathrm{db}}[*] & \longrightarrow & \mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RV}[*] \\ & {\scriptstyle \mathbb{E}^{\diamond}} \searrow \quad \swarrow {\scriptstyle \mathbb{E}_b} & \\ & !\mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RES} & \end{array} \tag{4.8}$$

Here the arrow labelled $\mathbb{E}_b$ means the quotient map $\mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RV}[*] \longrightarrow \mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RV}[*]/(\boldsymbol{P} - 1)$, followed by (4.3) and the degree-zero point-localized identification in Remark 4.4.

Resolved referee R072 [Clarification; revised] – Identify the map labelled E_b.
Original source line 1665. Optional clarification of the diagram's shorthand: the right arrow is the quotient map $\mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RV}[*] \longrightarrow \mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RV}[*]/(\boldsymbol{P} - 1)$, followed by (4.3) and the degree-zero identification $(!\mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RES}[*][[1]^{-1}])_0 \cong !\mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RES}$ from Remark 4.4. This is a valid composite. Its point-localized identification is unaffected by the affine-localized injectivity issue noted above.

Author resolution. The valid composite represented by the diagram arrow is now spelled out. The diagram is retained.

This provides an alternative and more direct (but less comprehensive) construction of $\mathbb{E}^{\diamond}$.

Remark 4.16. Changing $!\mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RES}$ to $!\mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RES}[[\mathbb{A}]^{-1}]$ in (4.8), we see that $\mathbb{E}_g$ does not commute with $\mathbb{E}^{\diamond}$: by (4.4),

$$\mathbb{E}_g([1]) = [\mathbb{A}]^{-1} \quad \text{whereas} \quad \mathbb{E}^{\diamond}([1]) = \mathbb{E}_b([1]) = 1.$$

This is but an example of a general phenomenon, see Remark 7.28.

We can certainly redefine $\mathbb{E}^{\diamond}$ as the composition of $\mu\mathbb{E}^{\mathrm{db}}$ with the homomorphism $!\mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RES}[*] \longrightarrow !\mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RES}[[\mathbb{A}]^{-1}]$ implicit in Remark 4.4 and thereby make it compatible with $\mathbb{E}_g$, but as we have mentioned above, $\mathbb{E}_b$ is ultimately a better choice; see Remark 8.14.

5. Interlude: Reduced cross-section and Fubini theorems

A *cross-section* of Γ is a group homomorphism $\mathrm{csn} : \Gamma \longrightarrow \mathrm{VF}^\times$ such that $\mathrm{val} \circ \mathrm{csn} = \mathrm{id}$. The corresponding *reduced cross-section* of Γ is the function

$$\overline{\mathrm{csn}} = \mathrm{rv} \circ \mathrm{csn} : \Gamma \longrightarrow \mathrm{RV}^\times.$$

These are usually augmented by $\mathrm{csn}(\infty) = 0$ and $\overline{\mathrm{csn}}(\infty) = \infty$.

We can add a reduced cross-section $\overline{\mathrm{csn}}$ to the language $\mathcal{L}_{\mathrm{RV}}$, denoted by $\mathcal{L}^\dagger_{\mathrm{RV}}$ the extension, and consider the corresponding integration theory; this has been worked out in [19]. We shall, however, only need a few facts about definable sets in RV in this setting. Strictly speaking, this extra ingredient is not really needed, but it does help simplify certain computations.

Referee R073 [Typo] – Verb form.
Original source line 1687. Replace "denoted by $\mathcal{L}^\dagger_{\mathrm{RV}}$ the extension" by "denote the extension by $\mathcal{L}^\dagger_{\mathrm{RV}}$". This correction from the human report remains outstanding.

In this section we work in an $\mathcal{L}^\dagger_{\mathrm{RV}}$-expansion $\mathbb{U}^\dagger$ of $\mathbb{U}$. Definability, if unqualified, is interpreted accordingly.

Referee R074 [Clarification; revised] – Parameter base for the expansion.
Original source line 1689. Specify separately the original parameter base $\mathbb{S}$ and the base used for the $\mathcal{L}^\dagger_{\mathrm{RV}}$ expansion. For the original-language definability assertions below, one needs the appropriate closure under the reduced section. For example, if $a \in \mathrm{RV}(\mathbb{S})$ has value α, then $\{a/\overline{\mathrm{csn}}(\alpha)\}$ is expanded-language definable and has value 0, but need not be original-language definable over $\mathbb{S}$ if the section introduces a new residue coefficient. Closing the original base under the section would also change its Galois group. The intended two-base convention should therefore be explicit.

Definition 5.1. A *Γ-partition* of a definable set A in RV is a definable function $p : A \longrightarrow \Gamma^l_\infty$ such that, for all $\gamma \in \Gamma^l_\infty$, $\mathrm{vrv}(A_\gamma)$ is a singleton and is $\overline{\mathrm{csn}}(\gamma)$-$\mathcal{L}_{\mathrm{RV}}$-definable. If p is a Γ-partition of A then the *$\mathrm{RV}^\dagger$-dimension* of p, denoted by $\dim_{\mathrm{RV}^\dagger}(p)$, is the number $\max\{\dim_{\mathrm{RV}}(A_\gamma) \mid \gamma \in \Gamma^l_\infty\}$.

Referee R075 [Typo; revised] – Definition of a Gamma-partition.
Original source line 1693. Restrict the condition to $\gamma \in p(A)$, since fibers outside the image are empty. The original-language definability condition should apply to A_γ itself, not merely to $\mathrm{vrv}(A_\gamma)$: write "A_γ is $\mathbb{S} \cup \{\overline{\mathrm{csn}}(\gamma)\}$-$\mathcal{L}_{\mathrm{RV}}$-definable and $\mathrm{vrv}(A_\gamma)$ is a singleton." This is the fiber whose original RV-dimension is used in the next sentence.

Lemma 5.2 ([19, Lemma 3.2])**.** *If p_1, p_2 are Γ-partitions of A then* $\dim_{\mathrm{RV}^\dagger}(p_1) = \dim_{\mathrm{RV}^\dagger}(p_2)$.

So the $\mathrm{RV}^\dagger$-dimension $\dim_{\mathrm{RV}}(A)$ of a definable set A in RV may be defined as the $\mathrm{RV}^\dagger$-dimension of any Γ-partition of A. It may also be shown that there is a definable finite-to-one function $f : A \longrightarrow \mathrm{RV}^k \times \Gamma^l_\infty$ if and only if there is a definable function $f : A \longrightarrow \mathrm{RV}^k$ such that all fibers of f are of $\mathrm{RV}^\dagger$-dimension 0 if and only if $\dim_{\mathrm{RV}^\dagger}(A) \leq k$.

Referee R076 [Typo; revised] – Dimension notation.
Original source line 1699. The first $\dim_{\mathrm{RV}}(A)$ should be $\dim_{\mathrm{RV}^\dagger}(A)$, as noted in the human report. A reference to the existence of Γ-partitions would also make the definition self-contained.

Definition 5.3 ($\mathrm{RV}^\dagger$-categories)**.** The objects of the category $\mathrm{RV}^\dagger[k]$ are the pairs (U, f) with U a set in RV_∞ and $f : U \longrightarrow \mathrm{RV}^k$ a definable function such that $\dim_{\mathrm{RV}^\dagger}(U_t) = 0$ for all $t \in \mathrm{RV}^k$. For two such objects (U, f), (V, g), any definable bijection $F : U \longrightarrow V$ is a *morphism* of $\mathrm{RV}^\dagger[k]$.

The categories $\mathrm{RES}^\dagger[k]$, $\mathrm{RES}^\dagger$ are formulated similar to $\mathrm{RES}[k]$, RES.

Referee R077 [Typo] – Adverb.
Original source line 1705. Replace "are formulated similar to" by "are formulated similarly to".

Definition 5.4. The *twistback* function $\mathrm{tbk} : \mathrm{RV} \longrightarrow \mathbb{k}$ is given by $u \longmapsto u/\overline{\mathrm{csn}}(\mathrm{vrv}(u))$, where $\infty/\infty = 0$. For any set $U \subseteq \mathrm{RV}_\infty^n$ and $\gamma \in \Gamma_\infty^n$, the set $\mathrm{tbk}(U_\gamma) \subseteq \mathbb{k}^n$ is called the *γ-twistback* of U. If $\mathrm{tbk}(U_\gamma) = \mathrm{tbk}(U_{\gamma'})$ for all $\gamma, \gamma' \in \mathrm{vrv}(U)$ then U is called a *twistoid*, in which case we simply write $\mathrm{tbk}(U)$ for the unique twistback.

Referee R078 [Typo] – Domain of twistback.
Original source line 1710. The displayed domain should be RV_∞, since the definition includes the value at ∞ and is immediately applied to subsets of RV_∞^n. This correction from the human report remains outstanding.

Lemma 5.5 ([19, Corollaries 2.23, 3.4])**.** *Every definable set in Γ is $\mathcal{L}_{\mathrm{RV}}$-definable and every definable set in RV with $\mathrm{vrv}(U)$ finite is $\overline{\mathrm{csn}}(\mathrm{vrv}(U))$-$\mathcal{L}_{\mathrm{RV}}$-definable.*

Referee R079 [Typo] – Unnamed set in the lemma.
Original source line 1714. Write "every definable set U in RV with $\mathrm{vrv}(U)$ finite". Currently the symbol U has not been introduced in this statement. The original-language definability claims also require the parameter convention requested above.

Lemma 5.6 ([19, Lemma 3.3])**.** *Let $U \subseteq \mathrm{RV}^n$ be a definable set and $\mathrm{vrv}(U) = D$. Then there is a definable finite partition $(D_i)_i$ of D such that each $U_i = U \cap D_i^\sharp$ is a definable twistoid and the corresponding twistback is $\mathcal{L}_{\mathrm{RV}}$-definable.*

A definable finite partition $(U_i)_i$ of U is called a *twistoid decomposition* of U if every U_i is a twistoid. For instance, the partition $(U_i)_i$ of U induced by the partition $(D_i)_i$ of D above is a *Γ-cohesive* twistoid decomposition, which, by Lemma 5.5, is $\mathcal{L}_{\mathrm{RV}}$-definable if U is.

Terminology 5.7. For any object $\boldsymbol{U} = (U, f) \in \mathrm{RV}^\dagger[*]$, by a "twistoid decomposition of $\boldsymbol{U}$" we actually mean a twistoid decomposition $(V_i)_i$ of the graph of the function f. In that case, clearly $(U_i)_i = (\mathrm{pr}_U(V_i))_i$ is a twistoid decomposition of U. For convenience, we shall refer to $(U_i)_i$ as a twistoid decomposition of $\boldsymbol{U}$.

Let $(U_i)_i$ be a twistoid decomposition of $\boldsymbol{U} = (U, f) \in \mathrm{RV}^\dagger[*]$. Set

$$\mathbb{E}_b^\dagger(\boldsymbol{U}) = \sum_i \chi_b(\mathrm{vrv}(U_i))[\mathrm{tbk}(U_i)] \in \mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RES}^\dagger. \tag{5.1}$$

Proposition 5.8 ([19, Propositions 3.21, 3.30])**.** *The assignment (5.1) does not depend on the choice of the twistoid decomposition and is invariant on isomorphism classes. The resulting map*

$$\mathbb{E}_b^\dagger : \mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RV}^\dagger[*] \longrightarrow \mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RES}^\dagger$$

is a ring homomorphism that vanishes on the ideal $(\boldsymbol{P} - 1)$.

We consider $\mathrm{RV}[*]$ as a subcategory of $\mathrm{RV}^\dagger[*]$ and denote the induced homomorphism between the Grothendieck rings by

$$\Lambda : \mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RV}[*] \longrightarrow \mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RV}^\dagger[*].$$

In the current environment, the transition from "$\mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RES}^\dagger$" to "$!\mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RES}^\dagger$" is superfluous since we already have $[\gamma^\sharp] = [\mathbb{G}_m]$ in $\mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RES}^\dagger$ for all definable $\gamma \in \Gamma$ (every element in $\mathbf{K}_+\,\mathrm{RES}^\dagger$ is represented by a definable set in $\mathbb{k}$). So there is a natural homomorphism $!\mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RES} \longrightarrow \mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RES}^\dagger$, which is also

denoted by Λ. It then follows from Proposition 3.18, more precisely, the correspondence (3.3), that we have a commutative diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RV}[*] & \xrightarrow{\mathbb{E}_b} & !\mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RES} \\ \Lambda\downarrow & & \downarrow\Lambda \\ \mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RV}^\dagger[*] & \xrightarrow[\mathbb{E}_b^\dagger]{} & \mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RES}^\dagger \end{array} \tag{5.2}$$

Remark 5.9. We may replace χ_b with χ_g and $[\mathrm{tbk}(U_i)]$ with $[\mathrm{tbk}(U_i)][\mathbb{A}]^{-n}$ (assuming $\boldsymbol{U} \in \mathrm{RV}^\dagger[n]$) in (5.1) and thereby obtain a ring homomorphism

$$\mathbb{E}_g^\dagger : \mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RV}^\dagger[*] \longrightarrow \mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RES}^\dagger[[\mathbb{A}]^{-1}]$$

that also vanishes on the ideal $(\boldsymbol{P}-1)$. The diagram (5.2) still commutes if $\mathbb{E}_b$, $\mathbb{E}_b^\dagger$ are replaced by $\mathbb{E}_g$, $\mathbb{E}_g^\dagger$.

One main advantage of $\mathbb{E}_b^\dagger$ over $\mathbb{E}_b$ is that it makes computations much easier, essentially because we can use twistoid decompositions given by Lemma 5.6 instead of "tensor decompositions" given by Proposition 3.18. To make (5.1) work for $\mathbb{E}_b$ as intended, though, we need a special kind of twistoid decompositions:

Definition 5.10. Suppose that $(U_i)_i$ is an $\mathcal{L}_{\mathrm{RV}}$-definable twistoid decomposition of U. If, for each i, there is an $\mathcal{L}_{\mathrm{RV}}$-definable bijection $U_i \longrightarrow V_i \times I_i^\sharp$, where $\mathrm{vrv}(V_i)$ is a singleton and $I_i \in \Gamma[*]$, such that its vrv-contraction is a bijection and its graph is a twistoid as well, then we say that $(U_i)_i$ is *bipolar*. Naturally U is a *bipolar twistoid* if it admits a trivial bipolar twistoid decomposition.

Remark 5.11. The point of Definition 5.10 is this: Suppose that $\boldsymbol{U} = (U, f) \in \mathrm{RV}[n]$ and $(U_i)_i$ is a bipolar twistoid decomposition of U, as witnessed by bijections $U_i \longrightarrow V_i \times I_i^\sharp$ with $I_i \in \Gamma[l_i]$. By dimension theory, for each i, there is an $\mathcal{L}_{\mathrm{RV}}$-definable finite-to-one function $g_i : V_i \longrightarrow \mathrm{RV}^{n-l_i}$, that is, $(V_i, g_i) \in \mathrm{RES}[n-l_i]$. Let γ_i be a definable element in $\mathrm{vrv}(U_i)$. Since U_{i,γ_i} is $\mathcal{L}_{\mathrm{RV}}$-definably bijective to $V_i \times \alpha_i^\sharp$ for some definable $\alpha_i \in I_i$, we see that, in $!\mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RES}$

$$[U_{i,\gamma_i}] = [V_i][\alpha_i^\sharp] = [V_i][\mathbb{G}_m]^{l_i}.$$

So, by the construction of $\mathbb{E}_b$ and bipolarity,

$$\mathbb{E}_b([\boldsymbol{U}]) = \sum_i \chi_b(I_i)[V_i][\mathbb{G}_m]^{l_i} = \sum_i \chi_b(\mathrm{vrv}(U_i))[U_{i,\gamma_i}]. \tag{5.3}$$

Observe that this does not really follow without some stronger condition such as bipolarity.

Referee R169 [Clarification; new] – Scope of the sampled value fibers.
Original source line 1778. The second expression presupposes that each $\mathrm{vrv}(U_i)$ contains a definable point. This is automatic over the later Puiseux base, but not over every base allowed here: over a trivially valued algebraically closed base, $U = \mathrm{RV}^{\circ\circ}$ is bipolar and $\mathrm{vrv}(U) = (0, \infty)$ contains no definable point. The first, tensor-product expression is still valid (and is 0 in this example). State the sampled-fiber formula subject to the existence of the chosen γ_i, or add the nontrivial definable value-group hypothesis when invoking it. This is a scope issue, not a counterexample to $\mathbb{E}_b$.

Obviously a Γ-cohesive twistoid decomposition of a bipolar twistoid is also bipolar. There is indeed an abundant supply of bipolar twistoid decompositions:

Lemma 5.12. *Every $\mathcal{L}_{\mathrm{RV}}$-definable set $U \subseteq \mathrm{RV}^n$ admits a Γ-cohesive twistoid decomposition that is also bipolar.*

Proof. This follows from [8, Lemmas 3.21, 3.25]. In more detail, the proof of [8, Lemmas 3.21] shows that the definable finite partition $(D_i)_i$ given by Lemma 5.6 can be refined so as to make the following condition hold: each $U_i = U \cap D_i^\sharp$ is of the form $\{t \in D_i^\sharp \mid N_i t \in W_i\}$, where N_i is a $k \times n$ matrix over $\mathbb{Z}$ and W_i is a definable subset of $\alpha_i^\sharp$ for some $\alpha_i \in \Gamma^k$. Next, there exists a matrix $M_i \in \mathrm{GL}_n(\mathbb{Z})$ such that $N_i M_i$ is in lower echelon form (in general M_i is not a product of "standard" column operations since $\mathbb{Z}$ is not a field, but such an invertible matrix exists over any principal ideal domain). Observe that if $N_i M_i$ does not have zero columns then D_i must be a singleton. At any rate, the set $M_i^{-1} U_i$ must be of the form $\mathrm{pr}_{\leq m}(M_i^{-1} U_i) \times I_i^\sharp \subseteq \mathrm{RV}^n$, where $n - m$ is the number of zero columns in $N_i M_i$ and $\mathrm{vrv}(\mathrm{pr}_{\leq m}(M_i^{-1} U_i))$ is a singleton.

Referee R080 [Error] – Integer column operations.
Original source line 1789. The parenthetical assertion about $\mathbb{Z}$ is incorrect: every matrix in $\mathrm{GL}_n(\mathbb{Z})$ is a product of elementary integer column additions, column interchanges, and sign changes. One may simply invoke column Hermite reduction to obtain $N_i M_i = (C_i\ 0)$ with C_i of full column rank. Then $C_i\,\mathrm{vrv}(v) = \alpha_i$ determines the first coordinates uniquely, which supplies the asserted product decomposition. Also, the cited item 3.25 of [8] is a corollary, and "Lemmas 3.21" should be "Lemma 3.21".

□

5.1. **Tropical motivic Fubini theorem.** In this subsection we work in the field $\tilde{\mathbb{C}}$ of complex Puiseux series, considered as an elementary substructure of $\mathbb{U}$, and take the parameter space to be the substructure $\mathbb{S} = \mathbb{C}(\!(t)\!)$. The value group Γ is identified with $\mathbb{Q}$. As an elementary substructure of $\mathbb{U}^\dagger$, $\tilde{\mathbb{C}}$ is denoted by $\tilde{\mathbb{C}}^\dagger$. We reiterate that the reduced cross-section $\overline{\mathrm{csn}}$ is not something of central interest, it is just an (implicit) computational tool.

Referee R081 [Clarification; revised] – Normalization and language in the Puiseux setting.
Original source line 1796. For the Puiseux computation, explicitly normalize $\overline{\mathrm{csn}}(1) = \mathrm{rv}(t)$ and choose compatible roots. Retain the distinction already introduced above: unadorned categories use the original language over $\mathbb{C}((t))$, while daggered categories use the expansion. A normalized reduced section makes the compatible roots of t definable in the expanded language, so this distinction is necessary to retain monodromy.

Remark 5.13. We may think of the profinite group $\hat{\mu}$ as the Galois group $\mathrm{Gal}(\tilde{\mathbb{C}}\,/\mathbb{C}(\!(t)\!))$, since they are canonically isomorphic. For each element $\xi = (\xi_n)_n \in \hat{\mu}$, the assignment $n \longmapsto \xi_n t^{1/n}$ indeed induces a reduced cross-section $\overline{\mathrm{csn}}_\xi : \mathbb{Q} \longrightarrow \mathrm{RV}$, and the map given by $\xi \longmapsto \overline{\mathrm{csn}}_\xi$ is indeed a bijection between $\hat{\mu}$ and the set Ω of reduced cross-sections $\overline{\mathrm{csn}} : \mathbb{Q} \longrightarrow \mathrm{RV}$ with $\overline{\mathrm{csn}}(1) = \mathrm{rv}(t)$; in other words, $\hat{\mu}$ acts freely and transitively on Ω via multiplication in the obvious way.

Referee R082 [Typo] – Formula for a reduced section.
Original source line 1799. The assignment should be $1/n \mapsto \mathrm{rv}(\xi_n t^{1/n})$; the present $n \mapsto \xi_n t^{1/n}$ has the wrong input and takes values in VF, rather than RV. Equivalently, write $\overline{\mathrm{csn}}_\xi(a/n) = \mathrm{rv}(\xi_n^a t^{a/n})$ and mention the compatibility that makes this independent of the fraction.

Here is a slightly different perspective on $\hat{\mu}$. By the structural theory of valued fields (in particular, [5, Lemma 5.3.2]), an element $\sigma \in \mathrm{Gal}(\tilde{\mathbb{C}}\,/\mathbb{C}(\!(t)\!))$ is in the ramification subgroup if and only if it fixes RV pointwise. But it can be easily checked that every $\sigma \in \mathrm{Gal}(\tilde{\mathbb{C}}\,/\mathbb{C}(\!(t)\!))$ moves some element of RV unless $\sigma = \mathrm{id}$. So $\mathrm{Gal}(\tilde{\mathbb{C}}\,/\mathbb{C}(\!(t)\!)) \cong \hat{\mu}$ may be identified with $\mathrm{Aut}(\mathrm{RV}/\mathrm{RV}(\mathbb{C}(\!(t)\!)))$, the group of model-theoretic automorphisms, where $\mathrm{RV}(\mathbb{C}(\!(t)\!))$ is equal to the subgroup generated by $\mathrm{rv}(t)$ over $\Bbbk^\times$.

Notation 5.14. The presence of $\overline{\mathrm{csn}}$ induces an intrinsic isomorphism $\mathrm{RV} \cong \Bbbk^\times \oplus \mathbb{Q}$. Consequently, $\mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RES}^\dagger \cong \mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{Var}_{\mathbb{C}}$. Let $\phi : \mathbf{K}^{\hat{\mu}}\,\mathrm{Var}_{\mathbb{C}} \longrightarrow \mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{Var}_{\mathbb{C}}$ be the obvious forgetful homomorphism. Using the twistback function tbk as in [9, § 4.3], we construct an isomorphism

$$\Theta : !\mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RES} \longrightarrow \mathbf{K}^{\hat{\mu}}\,\mathrm{Var}_{\mathbb{C}} \tag{5.4}$$

such that $\phi \circ \Theta = \Lambda$. By the discussion in Remark 5.11, if U is a bipolar twistoid then the class $[U_\gamma] \in !\mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RES}$ is invariant for definable $\gamma \in \mathrm{vrv}(U)$, and hence it makes sense to denote the class $\Theta([U_\gamma]) \in \mathbf{K}^{\hat{\mu}}\,\mathrm{Var}_{\mathbb{C}}$ by $[\mathrm{tbk}(U)]^{\hat{\mu}}$. In general, for any $\boldsymbol{U} = (U, f) \in \mathrm{RV}[*]$, we may write

$$(\Theta \circ \mathbb{E}_b)([\boldsymbol{U}]) = \sum_i \chi_b(\mathrm{vrv}(U_i))[\mathrm{tbk}(U_i)]^{\hat{\mu}} \in \mathbf{K}^{\hat{\mu}}\,\mathrm{Var}_{\mathbb{C}}, \tag{5.5}$$

where $(U_i)_i$ is any bipolar twistoid decomposition of U.

Notation 5.15. The *motivic volume operator* is the composition

$$\mathrm{Vol} : \mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{VF}_* \xrightarrow{\int} \mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RV}[*]/(\boldsymbol{P}-1) \xrightarrow{\mathbb{E}_b} !\mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RES} \xrightarrow{\Theta} \mathbf{K}^{\hat{\mu}}\,\mathrm{Var}_{\mathbb{C}}.$$

For each $\gamma \in \mathbb{Q}^n$, let $A_\gamma \in \mathrm{VF}_*$ and $\boldsymbol{U}_\gamma \in \mathrm{RV}[*]$ such that $\int [A_\gamma] = [\boldsymbol{U}_\gamma]/(\boldsymbol{P}-1)$, which we think of as holding at the semiring level. Suppose that $A = \bigcup_{\gamma \in \mathbb{Q}^n} \gamma^\sharp \times A_\gamma \in \mathrm{VF}_*$, that is, A is definable, for instance, there could be a definable set $B \subseteq \mathrm{VF}^n$ such that $A_\gamma = B \cap \gamma^\sharp$ for all $\gamma \in \mathbb{Q}^n$. For ease of notation, we take each $\boldsymbol{U}_\gamma$ to be simply a definable set U_γ in RV and assume, by compactness, $U = \bigcup_{\gamma \in \mathbb{Q}^n} \gamma^\sharp \times U_\gamma$ is definable as well. By Lemma 5.12 and compactness again, there is a definable finite partition $(D_i)_i$ of $\mathrm{vrv}(U)$ such that

Referee R083 [Clarification; revised] – Uniform representatives and compactness.
Original source line 1825. Make this compactness step precise by first interpreting the family in a saturated elementary extension. Apply Theorem 3.22 over $\mathbb{S} \cup \{\gamma\}$ there, uniformize the representatives together with their finite bijection witnesses, and then restrict to the Puiseux model. Compactness cannot be applied just to an arbitrary list of representatives chosen at rational points. Also distinguish the valued-field fibers $\mathrm{val}^{-1}(\gamma)$ used in A from the leading-term fibers $\mathrm{vrv}^{-1}(\gamma)$ used in U.

- every set $U \cap D_i^\sharp$ is a bipolar twistoid,
- the sets $E_i = \mathrm{pr}_{\leq n}(D_i)$ form a partition of $\mathbb{Q}^n$,
- for all $\gamma, \gamma' \in E_i$, $\chi_b(D_{i,\gamma}) = \chi_b(D_{i,\gamma'})$.

Referee R084 [Error] – Projected pieces need not form a partition.
Original source line 1830. The second bullet cannot in general hold together with the first. For example, use the constant family $U_\gamma = \{1, 2\,\mathrm{rv}(t), 3\,\mathrm{rv}(t)\}$. In $U = \bigcup_\gamma \gamma^\sharp \times U_\gamma$, the twistbacks at internal values 0 and 1 have respectively one and two points in the last coordinate. Thus they must lie in different twistoid pieces, whose projections to the base overlap at every γ. Use a separately indexed base partition $(E_a)_a$, subordinate to the projections of all D_i, such that every contribution indexed by i is constant on each E_a. Then define v_a by summing all those contributions. Include a base piece for empty fibers when necessary.

It follows that the map $\mathbb{Q}^n \longrightarrow \mathbf{K}^{\hat{\mu}}\,\mathrm{Var}_{\mathbb{C}}$ given by

$$\gamma \longmapsto \mathrm{Vol}([A_\gamma]) = \sum_i \chi_b(D_{i,\gamma})[\mathrm{tbk}(U_\gamma \cap D_{i,\gamma}^\sharp)]^{\hat{\mu}} \tag{5.6}$$

is constant over each E_i, which we denote by v_i, and hence

$$\mathrm{Vol}([A]) = \sum_i \chi_b(E_i) v_i [\mathbb{G}_m]^n.$$

This is essentially the content of the tropical motivic Fubini theorem of [11].

Referee R085 [Clarification; revised] – The extra torus factor.
Original source line 1839. This correctly formulated target is an inflated-family identity: $A = \bigcup_\gamma \mathrm{val}^{-1}(\gamma) \times A_\gamma$. It has an additional factor $[\mathbb{G}_m]^n$ compared with the usual tropical Fubini identity for a set B and its tropical fibers. State this scope explicitly. To deduce $\mathrm{Vol}(B) = \int \mathrm{Vol}(B \cap \mathrm{val}^{-1}(\gamma))\, d\chi_b$, a compatible relative decomposition is still needed; cancellation of $[\mathbb{G}_m]^n$ in the Grothendieck ring is not justified. Compare [11, Theorem 3.1.3].

Remark 5.16. The definable sets E_i may be viewed as rational polyhedrons in $\mathbb{R}^n$, that is, intersections of closed half spaces in $\mathbb{R}^n$ defined by linear equations with rational coefficients and (definable) constant terms. In general they are not cones, in other words, some of the constant terms may be nonzero (every element in $\mathbb{Q}$ is definable). This issue is moot, however, if the parameter space is $\mathbb{S} = \mathbb{C}$, since in that case the only definable element in $\mathbb{Q}$ is 0. This is needed for the applications in the motivic Donaldson-Thomas theory in [11].

Referee R086 [Error] – Polyhedra versus constructible polyhedral sets.
Original source line 1844. A definable set in Γ^n need not be an intersection of closed half-spaces; $(0, 1)$ is already a counterexample. Replace this by "finite Boolean combinations of rational polyhedra", or refine to relatively open rational polyhedral cells. Also say inequalities, rather than equations, when defining half-spaces. Over the trivially valued base the defining linear conditions are homogeneous, but the resulting pieces can be relatively open cones or Boolean combinations of cones. This is the convention used in [11, § 2.2].

5.2. **Fubini theorem.** Let $A, A' \in \mathrm{VF}_*$ and $f : A \longrightarrow B$, $f' : A' \longrightarrow B$ be definable functions. Write the fibers $f^{-1}(b)$, $b \in B$, as A_b, similarly for $f'^{-1}(b)$. The purpose of this subsection is to prove the following result.

Theorem 5.17. *If, for all $b \in B$, there are b-definable objects $\boldsymbol{U}_b, \boldsymbol{U}'_b \in \mathrm{RV}[*]$ such that $[A_b] = [\mathbb{L}\boldsymbol{U}_b]$, $[A'_b] = [\mathbb{L}\boldsymbol{U}'_b]$, and $\mathbb{E}_b([\boldsymbol{U}_b]) = \mathbb{E}_b([\boldsymbol{U}'_b])$, then $\mathbb{E}_b(\int[A]) = \mathbb{E}_b(\int[A'])$.*

Referee R087 [Clarification; revised] – Witnesses for the lifting equalities.
Original source line 1852. Specify that $[A_b] = [\mathbb{L}\boldsymbol{U}_b]$ and its primed analogue hold at the semiring level, equivalently through b-definable bijections, as required by the replacement of total spaces in the proof. If ring equalities are intended instead, include and uniformize their stabilization objects before cancelling them at the end. The saturated interpretation of b is already covered by the standing convention, and the coefficient base is clarified in Remark 5.18. Also make explicit that the ground base satisfies the (VF, Γ)-generation hypothesis of Theorem 3.22, which is needed for the displayed conclusion involving $\int$.

Remark 5.18. Suppose that B is a set in VF, or more generally, for every $b \in B$, the substructure $\mathbb{S}\langle b\rangle$ generated by it over $\mathbb{S}$ is VF-generated. The latter condition holds if, for instance, there is a definable bijection $B \longrightarrow B'$ with B' a set in VF. Then the hypothesis of the theorem can be simply reformulated as $\mathbb{E}_b(\int[A_b]) = \mathbb{E}_b(\int[A'_b])$. This equality is construed over $\mathbb{S}\langle b\rangle$, which makes sense since $\mathbb{S}\langle b\rangle$ is VF-generated (recall the provisions of Theorem 3.22).

As in § 5.1, we are mainly interested in applying this result in $\tilde{\mathbb{C}}$ with $\mathbb{S} = \mathbb{C}(\!(t)\!)$, in which case $\mathbb{S}\langle b\rangle = \mathbb{C}(\!(t)\!)(b)$ is an algebraic extension of $\mathbb{C}(\!(t)\!)$ and the conclusion of the theorem may take the form $\mathrm{Vol}([A]) = \mathrm{Vol}([A'])$; however, it is clearly not enough to test the hypothesis just inside $\tilde{\mathbb{C}}$.

Take $\mathbb{S} = \mathbb{C}(\!(t)\!)$ and $b \in B$ in $\mathbb{U}$. Denote the algebraic closure of the residue field $\Bbbk(\mathbb{C}(\!(t)\!)(b))$ by $\mathbb{C}_b$. Let r_b be the $\mathbb{Q}$-rank of the value group $\Gamma(\mathbb{C}(\!(t)\!)(b))$. Then, working in the algebraic closure of $\mathbb{C}(\!(t)\!)(b)$ (this is indeed the smallest model of $\mathrm{ACVF}(0,0)$ that contains $\mathbb{C}(\!(t)\!)(b)$), we can construct, similar to Θ, an isomorphism

$$\Theta_b : !\mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RES} \longrightarrow \mathbf{K}^{\hat{\mu}^{r_b}}\,\mathrm{Var}_{\mathbb{C}_b}.$$

Referee R088 [Error; revised] – Arithmetic residue descent is missing.
Original source line 1862. The proposed twistback/base-change comparison does not retain residue-field descent for arbitrary b. Take a unit b with residue s transcendental over $\mathbb{C}$, endowed with the Gauss valuation. Then $k(\mathbb{C}((t))(b)) = \mathbb{C}(s)$ and its value group is $\mathbb{Z}$. The residue object $\{z : z^2 = s\}$ has a nontrivial arithmetic Galois action over $\mathbb{C}(s)$, but its base change to $\mathbb{C}_b$ is two points with trivial tame-inertia action. Their classes are distinguished before base change by the arithmetic Galois representation on cohomology. Thus the proposed comparison with only $\hat{\mu}^{r_b}$-action is not an isomorphism. Keep $!\mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RES}$ over $\mathbb{S}\langle b\rangle$, or construct a target retaining residue-field descent as well as inertia. Taking an algebraic closure as the ambient model does not enlarge the definability base.

Setting $\mathrm{Vol}_b = \Theta_b \circ \mathbb{E}_b \circ \int$, the hypothesis of the theorem can then be equivalently reformulated as $\mathrm{Vol}_b([A_b]) = \mathrm{Vol}_b([A'_b])$ for all $b \in B$. Since this construction is not really needed, we omit the details. Only note that if $\mathbb{C}(\!(t)\!)(b)$ is an unramified extension of $\mathbb{C}(\!(t)\!)$ then Θ_b lands in $\mathbf{K}^{\hat{\mu}}\,\mathrm{Var}_{\mathbb{C}_b}$ and hence it is essentially the same as Θ. It will also be clear from the proof that one can test the hypothesis only for those $b \in B$ that generate such unramified extensions (because ultimately the task can be reduced to checking a relation among certain objects of RES whose projection into Γ is in $\mathbb{Z} = \Gamma(\mathbb{S})$).

Referee R089 [Error] – The unramified-only test is false as stated.
Original source line 1863. The last assertion has a simple counterexample in the general definable setting of the theorem. Put $B = \{b : b^2 = t\}$, $A = B$, $f = \mathrm{id}_B$, and $A' = \varnothing$. Every point of B generates a ramified quadratic extension of $\mathbb{C}((t))$, so the proposed test only at unramified points is vacuous. Nevertheless $\mathrm{Vol}(A)$ is the nonzero class of the two-element monodromy set, whose ordinary Euler characteristic is 2. Delete this assertion, or state and prove a different test on a specifically constructed auxiliary residue base. It cannot be imposed directly on the original points $b \in B$.

The following fact shall be needed:

Lemma 5.19. *Let $F_i(x) = F_i(x_1, \dots, x_n)$ be a finite list of polynomials with coefficients in $\mathrm{VF}(\mathbb{S})$. Let $A \subseteq \mathrm{VF}^n$ be a definable set. Then there is a definable bijection $T : A \longrightarrow A^\flat$ such that $A^\flat$ is an RV-pullback and every composite function $F_i \circ T^{-1}$ is rv-contractible, that is, for each i there is a commutative diagram*

$$\begin{array}{ccccc} A^\flat & \xrightarrow{T^{-1}} & A & \xrightarrow{F_i} & \mathrm{VF} \\ {\scriptstyle \mathrm{rv}}\downarrow & & & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle \mathrm{rv}} \\ \mathrm{rv}(A^\flat) & & \xrightarrow[(F_i\circ T^{-1})_\downarrow]{} & & \mathrm{RV}_\infty \end{array}$$

This lemma follows from [17, Theorem 5.5], cited as Lemma 6.16 below, where T may be taken to be a so-called special bijection, as in Definition 6.11 but much simpler (we shall not need this here, though, because no volume forms are involved).

Proof of Theorem 5.17. By partitioning B if necessary, it is enough to prove the claim either when f, f' are both surjective or when f is surjective and A' is empty. We will deal with the first case, the second being similar but simpler (just skip all the steps that involve A' in the argument below).

By compactness, there is a definable finite partition $(B_i)_i$ of B such that, for each i, the objects $\boldsymbol{U}_b$, $\boldsymbol{U}'_b$ are defined uniformly over $b \in B_i$. Let $\xi_i(x, y)$, $\xi'_i(x, y')$ be quantifier-free formulas such that $\xi_i(b, y)$, $\xi'_i(b, y')$ define the objects $\boldsymbol{U}_b$, $\boldsymbol{U}'_b$ for each $b \in B_i$, respectively.

Suppose that B is a set in VF. Applying Lemma 5.19 to the top terms $F(x)$ of $\xi_i(x, y)$, $\xi'_i(x, y')$ (recall Convention 2.9), we obtain a definable bijection $T_i : B_i \longrightarrow B_i^\flat$ as described. So, to show the claim, we may replace B with any $B_i^\flat$, and thereby assume that B is an RV-pullback and for

each $b \in B$, the objects $\boldsymbol{U}_b$, $\boldsymbol{U}'_b$ depend on $\mathrm{rv}(b)$ instead of b itself; henceforth $\boldsymbol{U}_b$, $\boldsymbol{U}'_b$ are denoted by $U_{\mathrm{rv}(b)}$, $U'_{\mathrm{rv}(b)}$ (as above, for ease of notation, we take them to be simply definable sets in RV). In fact, by Theorem 3.22, setting $S = \mathrm{rv}(B)$, we may just assume that $A = \bigcup_{t\in S} \mathbb{L}U_t \times t^\sharp$ and f is the obvious coordinate projection. Similarly $A' = \bigcup_{t\in S} \mathbb{L}U'_t \times t^\sharp$.

Of course, in general, B has RV-coordinates. But the same arrangement can be made by first applying the argument above to each fiber B_t, $t \in \mathrm{pr}_{\mathrm{RV}}(B)$, and then compactness. Without loss of generality, we just take A, A', B to be sets in VF.

Referee R090 [Gap] – RV coordinates cannot simply be discarded.
Original source line 1894. The fiberwise argument retains the RV-parameter t; compactness makes the resulting maps uniform but does not remove that coordinate. In particular an infinite RV-set does not admit a definable injection into a power of VF (see [8, Lemma 3.41]). Thus the asserted reduction to A, A', B all lying in VF needs a separate argument. A possible repair is to carry the RV-coordinates and the finite-to-one structure maps throughout the proof, checking that all total spaces remain objects of the relevant categories; otherwise restrict the theorem to a VF base and prove the extra coding needed for its total spaces.

Write $U = \mathrm{rv}(A)$, $D = \mathrm{val}(A)$, $U' = \mathrm{rv}(A')$, $D' = \mathrm{val}(A')$, and $E = \mathrm{val}(B)$. Since Γ is stably embedded, upon further partitioning of S, we may assume that $\mathrm{vrv}(U_t)$ depends on $\mathrm{vrv}(t)$ instead of $t \in S$ itself, and hence may be written as $D_{\mathrm{vrv}(t)}$; similarly, we may write $\mathrm{vrv}(U'_t)$ as $D'_{\mathrm{vrv}(t)}$.

Referee R091 [Clarification; revised] – Justification of the value-parameter dependence.
Original source line 1896. The finite partition asserted here is compatible with the usual parameter-control argument, but stable embeddedness alone is not its justification. Use $\mathrm{dcl}(\mathbb{S}, t)\cap\Gamma = \mathrm{span}_{\mathbb{Q}}(\mathrm{dcl}(\mathbb{S})\cap \Gamma, \mathrm{vrv}(t))$, together with the piecewise rational-affine description of definable value-group data. After finitely partitioning S, this gives the required dependence only on $\mathrm{vrv}(t)$. This is the precise replacement for the justification requested in the human report; it does not contradict the assertion after partitioning.

For each $t \in S$, let $(D_{\mathrm{vrv}(t),i})_i$ be a definable finite partition of $D_{\mathrm{vrv}(t)}$ as given by Lemma 5.12, that is, $(U_{t,i})_i = (U_t \cap D^\sharp_{\mathrm{vrv}(t),i})_i$ is a bipolar and Γ-cohesive twistoid decomposition of U_t. Again, the notation $(D_{\mathrm{vrv}(t),i})_i$ makes sense because the partition only depends on $\mathrm{vrv}(t)$; in fact, we may even assume so for the vrv-contractions of the witness bijections as required by Definition 5.10. Then, by compactness and o-minimality, we are further reduced to the case that $(D_{\gamma,i})_i$ is uniformly defined over $\gamma \in E$, and $(\chi_b(D_{\gamma,i}))_i$ does not depend on $\gamma \in E$ at all and hence may be simply written as $(e_i)_i$. Let $D_i = \bigcup_{\gamma\in E} D_{i,\gamma} \times \gamma$. So $\chi_b(D_i) = e_i\chi_b(E)$. All this is just a more elaborate version of what we did before (5.6).

Referee R092 [Typo; revised] – Order of the subscripts.
Original source line 1898. Use $D_{\gamma,i}$ consistently: the definition of D_i changes it to $D_{i,\gamma}$, and the primed paragraph makes the same switch. In the final refinement paragraph below, replace $(D'_{i'})'_i$ by $(D'_{i'})_{i'}$.

Similarly we obtain a bipolar and Γ-cohesive twistoid decomposition $(U'_{t,i'})_{i'} = (U'_t \cap D'^\sharp_{\mathrm{vrv}(t),i'})_{i'}$ of U'_t, uniformly defined over $\gamma \in E$, such that $e_{i'} = \chi_b(D'_{\gamma,i'})$ do not depend on $\gamma \in E$ and hence $\chi_b(D'_{i'}) = e_{i'}\chi_b(E)$, where $D'_{i'} = \bigcup_{\gamma\in E} D'_{i',\gamma} \times \gamma$.

Applying Lemma 5.12 again to U, U' and refining $(D_i)_i$, $(D'_{i'})_{i'}$ if necessary, we may now assume that $(U_i)_i = (U \cap D^\sharp_i)_i$, $(U'_{i'})_{i'} = (U' \cap D'^\sharp_{i'})_{i'}$ are bipolar and Γ-cohesive twistoid decompositions of U, U', respectively. They induce two twistoid decompositions of S (not necessarily bipolar, which we do not need). Refining $(D_i)_i$, $(D'_{i'})'_i$ one last time, we may assume that both induce the same decomposition of S after all and hence, replacing S with one of the pieces, S itself is a twistoid.

Referee R093 [Clarification; revised] – Explain the common refinement.
Original source line 1902. The common refinement can be justified more explicitly. First refine the value-group base so that the relevant projections of the U_i to S have the same value support. Their common Boolean refinement then consists of twistoids. Restrict each U_i to a selected base piece; it remains a twistoid, with a fixed twistback projecting onto that base twistback. Apply Lemma 5.12 to these restrictions using Γ-cohesive refinements. Their projections to the selected base are now Γ-cohesive, so a final value-group refinement makes each surviving projection surjective. On that final refinement, also re-establish constancy of the fiber Euler characteristics $\chi_b(D_{\gamma,i})$. This supplies the compatibility used in the next paragraph; the earlier objection should not be read as an obstruction to the existence of the refinement.

Remark 5.20. The witness bijection for U_i as a bipolar twistoid is in general unrelated to those for $U_{t,i}$, $t \in S$, since parameterized bipolar twistoids over a base may not even form a single bipolar twistoid. But our argument will not require this.

Let $\gamma_i \in \mathrm{vrv}(U_i)$, $\gamma_{i'} \in \mathrm{vrv}(U'_{i'})$ be definable elements such that $\mathrm{pr}_E(\gamma_i) = \mathrm{pr}_E(\gamma_{i'})$ for all i, i'. Set $\dot{U}_i = U_{i,\gamma_i}$ and $\dot{U}'_{i'} = U'_{i',\gamma_{i'}}$. So $\mathrm{pr}_S(\dot{U}_i) = \mathrm{pr}_S(\dot{U}'_{i'})$ for all i, i', which we denote by $\dot{S}$.

Denote by I, I' the sets of indices i, i'. Set $J = I \uplus I'$. For each $j \in J$, let $V_j = \dot{U}_j$ if $j \in I$ and $V_j = \dot{U}'_j$ otherwise. Set

$$J_1 = \{i \in I \mid e_i > 0\} \cup \{i' \in I' \mid e_{i'} < 0\},$$
$$J_2 = \{i \in I \mid e_i < 0\} \cup \{i' \in I' \mid e_{i'} > 0\},$$

and for $j \in J$, $\tilde{e}_j = |e_j|$.

By (5.3), we have $\mathbb{E}_b(\int[A]) = \chi_b(E)\sum_{i\in I} e_i[\dot{U}_i]$ and $\mathbb{E}_b(\int[A']) = \chi_b(E)\sum_{i'\in I'} e_{i'}[\dot{U}'_{i'}]$. Thus, to prove the theorem, it is enough to show that $\sum_{j\in J_1}\tilde{e}_j[V_j] = \sum_{j\in J_2}\tilde{e}_j[V_j]$ in $!\mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RES}$. Since both sides can be understood in $\mathbf{K}_+\,\mathrm{RES}$, it is enough to show that the following condition holds.

Test 5.21. There are objects $W_1, W_2, X \in \mathrm{RES}$ such that

- $[W_1] = \sum_{j\in J_1}\tilde{e}_j[V_j] + [X]$ and $[W_2] = \sum_{j\in J_2}\tilde{e}_j[V_j] + [X]$ in $\mathbf{K}_+\,\mathrm{RES}$,
- $([W_1], [W_2])$ is in the semiring congruence relation $\mathcal{E}_{sc}$ on $\mathbf{K}_+\,\mathrm{RES}$ generated by pairs of the form $([\gamma^\sharp \times Z], [\mathbb{G}_m^n \times Z])$, where $Z \in \mathrm{RES}$ and $\gamma \in \Gamma^n$ is definable (we allow $n = 0$, which gives the pairs (Z, Z)).

What the second item means is that if we close off the set $\mathcal{A}$ of these pairs $([\gamma^\sharp \times Z], [\mathbb{G}_m^n \times Z])$ by applying inductively the six conditions, namely identity (since each stage needs to be accumulative), the three equivalence conditions (symmetry, reflexivity, and transitivity), and the two semiring congruence conditions (if $([X], [Y])$ is already in at some stage then, for any $[Z] \in \mathbf{K}_+\,\mathrm{RES}$, $([X \uplus Z], [Y \uplus Z])$ and $([X \times Z], [Y \times Z])$ are thrown in at the next stage), then $([W_1], [W_2])$ appears at some stage. Actually it is clear that reflexivity is redundant. We show that, beyond $\mathcal{A}$, product is also redundant, as follows.

Remark 5.22. There are in general more than one way to inductively construct an element $([X], [Y])$ in $\mathcal{E}_{sc}$. Each inductive construction of $([X], [Y])$ may be represented by a finite graph T, partitioned into levels (numbered inversely), such that

- every vertex is an element in $\mathcal{E}_{sc}$, in particular, there is only one vertex in the top level, which is $([X], [Y])$ itself, and the bottom vertices are all elements in $\mathcal{A}$,
- each vertex above level 0 has 1 or 2 (the latter only for transitivity) labeled edges connecting it with vertices in the level below, with the labels indicating how it is constructed from these latter vertices,

- each vertex below the top level is connected via an edge with a vertex in the level above (this is for efficiency, that is, no redundant vertices for the construction).

We call T a *construction graph* of $([X],[Y])$, and the number of levels in it its *height*. Observe that, for any construction graph T of $([X],[Y])$ and any $[Z] \in \mathbf{K}_+$ RES, if we replace every vertex $([X'],[Y'])$ of T with $([X' \times Z],[Y' \times Z])$ then the resulting graph is a construction graph for $([X \times Z],[Y \times Z])$. Let $\rho([X],[Y])$ be the least natural number such that there is a construction graph for $([X],[Y])$ of height $\rho([X],[Y])$; let T be such a construction graph. We claim that T may be chosen so that none of its edges is a product. This is vacuous if $\rho([X],[Y]) = 0$ and is clear if $\rho([X],[Y]) = 1$. For $\rho([X],[Y]) > 1$, note that if $([X'],[Y'])$, $([X''],[Y''])$ are the (possibly identical) vertices in level $\rho([X],[Y]) - 1$ of T then

$$\max(\rho([X'],[Y']), \rho([X''],[Y''])) = \rho([X],[Y]) - 1.$$

Also, if the edge going into $([X],[Y])$ is a product then, by what we have just observed, there would be a construction graph of $([X],[Y])$ of height $\rho([X],[Y]) - 1$, contradicting the choice of $\rho([X],[Y])$. So the desired conclusion follows from a routine induction on $\rho([X],[Y])$.

Referee R094 [Typo; revised] – Height convention.
Original source line 1955. Define height as the maximum level number, equivalently the number of levels minus one, to agree with the induction and the indices $\rho - 1$ below. The product-free construction argument is otherwise valid. At the start of the remark, replace "There are in general more than one way" by "There is in general more than one way".

We need this seemingly obscure fact so as to be able to apply compactness uniformly over a base below.

Remark 5.23. The semiring congruence relation $\mathcal{E}_{sc}$ may also be constructed "without the brackets," that is, it may be expressed as an equivalence relation $\mathcal{E}^*_{sc}$ on the objects of RES that is generated from the set of definable pairs of the form $(\gamma^\sharp \times Z, \mathbb{G}_m^n \times Z')$, where $Z \cong Z'$ in RES, via the six conditions. However, if T is a construction graph of $([X],[Y])$ then simply deleting the brackets from the vertices of T does not give us a graph that witnesses $(X,Y) \in \mathcal{E}^*_{sc}$. There are two issues. The first is transitivity, that is, if $([X],[Y])$ and $([Y'],[Z])$ are in $\mathcal{E}_{sc}$ with $[Y] = [Y']$ then of course so is $([X],[Z])$, but to conclude $(X,Z) \in \mathcal{E}^*_{sc}$ from $(X,Y),(Y',Z) \in \mathcal{E}^*_{sc}$ we must add a middle step (Y,Y'), justified by $Y \cong Y'$ in RES, and apply transitivity twice. The second is similar: we can now translate T into a graph that witnesses $(X',Y') \in \mathcal{E}^*_{sc}$, but only with $[X'] = [X]$ and $[Y'] = [Y]$. But then, adding at most two levels on top, we arrive at a *construction graph* T^* of $(X,Y) \in \mathcal{E}^*_{sc}$. Moreover, if T is product-free as given above then T^* is also product-free, in the obvious sense.

The reason that we opt for working with T^* instead of T is that it can be described by an $\mathcal{L}_{\mathrm{RV}}$-formula and thereby makes itself amenable to compactness.

Finally, by the assumption, we have $\sum_{j\in J_1} \tilde{e}_j[V_{j,t}] = \sum_{j\in J_2} \tilde{e}_j[V_{j,t}]$ in $!\mathbf{K}$ RES for every $t \in \dot{S}$. For each $t \in \dot{S}$, we can choose t-definable objects $W_{1,t}$, $W_{2,t}$, X_t of RES with respect to which Test 5.21 holds, as witnessed by a product-free construction graph T^*_t. By compactness, there is a definable finite partition $(\dot{S}_i)_i$ of $\dot{S}$ such that, for each i, the graph T^*_t is uniformly defined over $t \in \dot{S}_i$ by an $\mathcal{L}_{\mathrm{RV}}$-formula; without loss of generality, we may assume this partition is trivial. Moreover, if level 0 of T^*_t consists of definable pairs of the forms $(\gamma^\sharp \times Z_t, \mathbb{G}_m^n \times Z'_t)$ then Z_t, Z'_t in general depend on t, but $\gamma^\sharp$ does not, and neither do other Γ-data over t, such as $\mathrm{vrv}(Z_t)$, $\mathrm{vrv}(\dot{U}'_t)$, and $\mathrm{vrv}(V_t)$ (of course they do depend on $\mathrm{vrv}(\dot{S})$). Let

Referee R095 [Gap; revised] – Descent from VF parameters to RV parameters.
Original source line 1966. The earlier application of Lemma 5.19 makes the objects depend only on $t = \mathrm{rv}(b)$, but it does not yet make the equality witnesses t-definable. One way to repair this is to uniformize the full finite witness data over b before choosing T: include the fiberwise bipolar decompositions, their sampled value fibers, and the product-free congruence graphs constructed above. Apply the lemma to every valued-field top term occurring in those formulas, not just the object formulas. Then the witnesses themselves depend on $\mathrm{rv}(b)$, and the required relation over t follows. Finally, refine the base finitely so that all the auxiliary Γ-data are constant on each piece. In the list of such data, $\dot{U}'_t$ and V_t have not been defined; use the actual indexed objects, for example $V_{j,t}$.

$$W_1 = \bigcup_{t\in\dot{S}} W_{1,t}, \quad W_2 = \bigcup_{t\in\dot{S}} W_{2,t}, \quad X = \bigcup_{t\in\dot{S}} X_t.$$

Thus, and this is why we have taken effort to find product-free construction graphs above, the union $\bigcup_{t\in\dot{S}} T_t^*$ is indeed a construction graph of (W_1, W_2). So Test 5.21 holds with respect to W_1, W_2, and X. So $\mathbb{E}_b(\int[A]) = \mathbb{E}_b(\int[A'])$. □

Corollary 5.24. *In $\tilde{\mathbb{C}}$ with $\mathbb{S} = \mathbb{C}(\!(t)\!)$, if f is a morphism of varieties over $\mathbb{C}$ with $\mathrm{Vol}_b([A_b]) = 0$ for all $b \in B$ then $\mathrm{Vol}([A]) = 0$.*

6. Special covariant bijections

From here on, we also assume that the substructure $\mathbb{S}$ of parameters is VF-generated. So every definable disc contains a definable point (Lemma 2.20). Another simple fact we shall occasionally use is that if $\gamma \in \Gamma$ is definable then there is a $\gamma' \geq \gamma$ such that $\gamma'^\sharp$ contains a definable point.

6.1. Invariance and covariance.

Definition 6.1. For $\gamma \in \Gamma$, let $\pi_\gamma : \mathrm{VF} \longrightarrow \mathrm{VF}/\mathcal{M}_\gamma$ be the quotient map. If $\gamma = (\gamma_1, \ldots, \gamma_n) \in \Gamma^n$ then π_γ denotes the product of the maps π_{γ_i}.

Let $\alpha \in \Gamma^n$ and $\beta \in \Gamma^m$. We say that a function $f : A \longrightarrow B$ with $A \subseteq \mathrm{VF}^n$ and $B \subseteq \mathrm{VF}^m$ is *(α, β)-covariant* if it (π_α, π_β)-contracts to a function $f_\downarrow : \pi_\alpha(A) \longrightarrow \pi_\beta(B)$, that is, $\pi_\beta \circ f = f_\downarrow \circ \pi_\alpha$. For simplicity, we shall often suppress parameters in notation and refer to (α, β)-covariant functions as $(\alpha, -)$-covariant or $(-, \beta)$-covariant or just covariant functions.

A set in VF is *α-invariant* if its characteristic function is $(\alpha, 0)$-covariant.

More generally, for sets A, B with RV-coordinates, a function $f : A \longrightarrow B$ is *covariant* if every one of its VF-fibers is covariant (recall Terminology 2.6). Similarly, a set is *invariant* if every one of its VF-fibers is invariant.

Definition 6.2. A definable function $f : A \longrightarrow B$ is *proper covariant* if

- the sets A_{VF}, $f(A)_{\mathrm{VF}}$ are bounded and the sets A_{RV}, $f(A)_{\mathrm{RV}}$ are doubly bounded,
- for each VF-fiber f_t of f there is a t-definable tuple $(\alpha_t, \beta_t) \in \Gamma$ such that f_t is (α_t, β_t)-covariant, $\mathrm{dom}(f_t)$ is α_t-invariant, and $\mathrm{ran}(f_t)$ is β_t-invariant.

A definable set A is *proper invariant* if A_{VF} is bounded, A_{RV} is doubly bounded, and for each VF-fiber A_t of A there is a t-definable tuple $\alpha_t \in \Gamma$ such that A_t is α_t-invariant.

Note that covariance makes sense even when the domain or the range of the function f has no VF-coordinates, in which case the contraction $f_\downarrow$ would be the empty function. In particular, if B is a subset of RV^m or even $\mathcal{P}(\mathrm{RV}^m)$ then f being proper covariant simply means that every $f^{-1}(x)$ is proper invariant. Then A being proper invariant may also be construed as the condition that its projection into the RV-coordinates is proper covariant.

Referee R098 [Error] – Fiberwise invariance does not supply global bounds.
Original source line 2008. The asserted characterization drops the global boundedness conditions in Definition 6.2. For example, let $A = 1^\sharp \times \mathrm{RV}$ and let $f : A \longrightarrow \mathrm{RV}$ be the second projection. Every fiber $f^{-1}(t)$ is proper invariant (over t), but $A_{\mathrm{RV}} = \mathrm{RV}$ is not doubly bounded, so f is not proper covariant. Retain the boundedness requirements explicitly, or formulate this as a characterization under those requirements. Also, when the target has no VF-coordinates the relevant contraction is a map to the singleton empty tuple; it is not the empty function unless its domain is empty. The extension to powerset-valued functions should specify separately which boundedness condition is imposed on their RV-valued relation.

Example 6.3. A proper invariant set is not required to be doubly bounded. However, if $\boldsymbol{U} \in \mathrm{RV}^{\mathrm{db}}[*]$ then $\mathbb{L}\boldsymbol{U}$ is indeed a doubly bounded proper invariant set.

Remark 6.4. In defining proper covariance above, if A is closed then there is no need to demand that $f(A)_{\mathrm{RV}}$ be doubly bounded, because it is implied by the other conditions, as follows. There is an $\mathfrak{o}$-partition $p : A \longrightarrow \Gamma$ such that, for each open polydisc $\mathfrak{b}$ in question, that is, for each open polydisc $\mathfrak{b} \subseteq A$ of the form $\mathfrak{o}(a, p(a))$, $f(\mathfrak{b})$ lies in the range of some VF-fiber of f. By Lemma 2.53, $p(A)$ is doubly bounded. So the definable surjection $A \longrightarrow \mathrm{vrv}(f(A)_{\mathrm{RV}})$ induced by f satisfies the assumption of Lemma 6.22 below. So $f(A)_{\mathrm{RV}}$ is doubly bounded.

Lemma 6.5. *Let A be a definable set such that A_{VF} is bounded and A_{RV} is doubly bounded. Then A is proper invariant if and only if A is clopen.*

Proof. The "only if" direction is clear. For the "if" direction, since every VF-fiber of A is open, there is an obvious $\mathfrak{o}$-partition $p : A \longrightarrow \Gamma$. Since every VF-fiber of A is also closed, by Lemma 2.53, $p(A)$ is doubly bounded. The claim follows. □

Lemma 6.6. *If A, B are proper invariant subsets of $\mathrm{VF}^n \times \mathrm{RV}^m$ then $A \cap B$, $\mathrm{RVH}(A) \smallsetminus A$, and $B \smallsetminus A$ are also proper invariant.*

Proof. Clearly $(A \cap B)_{\mathrm{VF}}$ is bounded, $(A \cap B)_{\mathrm{RV}}$ is doubly bounded, and every VF-fiber of $A \cap B$ is clopen; similarly for the other cases. So this follows from Lemma 6.5.

Referee R099 [Clarification] – Explain the RV-hull case.
Original source line 2030. The assertion for $\mathrm{RVH}(A) \setminus A$ additionally needs the fact that $\mathrm{RVH}(A)$ is proper invariant. This follows directly: if a fiber A_t is δ-invariant, then its RV-hull is also δ-invariant (in each coordinate an RV-disc of radius at least δ meeting A_t is contained in a δ-ball already in A_t; larger discs are themselves δ-invariant). Boundedness is preserved by taking the RV-hull. Stating this fact explicitly also justifies the later applications to $\mathrm{RVH}(A)$.

□

Lemma 6.7. *Let $f : A \longrightarrow B$ be a definable continuous surjection between two proper invariant sets such that every $\mathrm{dom}(f_t)$ is open. If every $\mathrm{ran}(f_t)$ is clopen then f is proper covariant. If f is bijective then the same holds under the weaker assumption that every $\mathrm{ran}(f_t)$ is open.*

Proof. For every $(r, s) \in f_{\mathrm{RV}}$ and every $b \in \mathrm{ran}(f_{r,s})$, let

$$q(b, r, s) = \min\{\beta \in \Gamma \mid \mathfrak{o}((b, s), \beta) \subseteq \mathrm{ran}(f_{r,s})\}.$$

The definable function q is clearly an $\mathfrak{o}$-partition of its domain, which, by the assumption, is closed. By Lemma 2.53, $\mathrm{ran}(q)$ is doubly bounded by, say, $\beta \in \Gamma^+$. By continuity, there is another $\mathfrak{o}$-partition $p : A \longrightarrow \Gamma$ such that, for every open polydisc $\mathfrak{b} \subseteq A$ in question, $f(\mathfrak{b})$ lies in an open polydisc of radius β. By Lemmas 6.5 and 2.53 again, $p(A)$ is doubly bounded as well. It follows that f is proper covariant.

For the second claim, since f is bijective, for each $(b,s) \in B$ there is only one $f_{r,s}$ with $(b,r,s) \in \mathrm{ran}(f_{r,s})$. So the parameter r is redundant in the definition of q, and q is simply an $\mathfrak{o}$-partition of B. The rest of the argument is the same.

Referee R100 [Clarification] – Make the partition radii construction explicit.
Original source line 2043. In the first paragraph take p small enough in geometric size that its balls also lie in a single $\mathrm{dom}(f_{r,s})$; continuity of the separate $f_{r,s}$ alone does not express that requirement. In the bijective case the unique $r = r(b,s)$ is not literally a redundant coordinate: it is a definable function of (b,s), locally constant because the sets $\mathrm{ran}(f_{r,s})$ are open. Hence q descends to an $\mathfrak{o}$-partition of the closed set B, and Lemma 2.53 applies. This is the missing justification for the last paragraph.

□

Lemma 6.8. *If $f : A \longrightarrow B$ is a proper covariant surjection then both A and B are proper invariant. If, in addition, f is continuous and bijective then f is a proper covariant homeomorphism, which just means that f^{-1} is also proper covariant and continuous. Moreover, in that case, if A' is a proper invariant subset of A then $f \restriction A'$ is a proper covariant homeomorphism as well.*

Proof. Since f_{RV} is doubly bounded, by Lemma 2.41, for all sufficiently large $\epsilon \in \Gamma$, every VF-fiber f_t of f is (ϵ, β_t)-covariant (but not necessarily (ϵ,ϵ)-covariant) and $\mathrm{dom}(f_t)$, $\mathrm{ran}(f_t)$ are both ϵ-invariant. The first claim follows.

For the second claim, since $\mathrm{dom}(f_t)$ is clopen, by Corollary 2.49, every f_t is a homeomorphism. Since $\mathrm{ran}(f_t)$ is open, it follows from the continuity of f^{-1}, as in the proof of Lemma 6.7, that every f_t^{-1} is (δ,ϵ)-covariant for all sufficiently large $\delta > \epsilon$.

For the third claim, clearly every $\mathrm{dom}(f_t) \cap A'$ is clopen and, since f_t is a homeomorphism, every $\mathrm{ran}(f_t) \cap f(A')$ is clopen too. This is sufficient for the proof of (the first claim of) Lemma 6.7 to go through. By the second claim, then, $f \restriction A'$ is a proper covariant homeomorphism. □

Lemma 6.9. *If $f : A \longrightarrow B$ and $g : B \longrightarrow C$ are proper covariant homeomorphisms then $g \circ f$ is also a proper covariant homeomorphism.*

Proof. By Lemma 6.8, we just need to show that $g \circ f$ is proper covariant. Then, by Lemma 6.7, we are reduced to showing that the domain and range of every VF-fiber of $g \circ f$ are open. Arguing as in the proofs of Lemmas 6.7 and 6.8, we see that there are $\epsilon, \epsilon', \epsilon'' \in \Gamma$, each one sufficiently larger than the next, such that every VF-fiber of f is (ϵ,ϵ')-covariant and every VF-fiber of g is (ϵ',ϵ'')-covariant. It follows that the domain of every VF-fiber of $g \circ f$ is ϵ-invariant and hence is clopen. Since the same holds for $(g \circ f)^{-1}$, the range of every VF-fiber of $g \circ f$ is clopen as well. □

Convention 6.10. The trivial-looking operation we describe here is actually quite crucial for understanding the discussion below, especially those passages that involve special covariant bijections (defined below). For each definable set A, let

$$\mathbf{c}(A) = \{(a, \mathrm{rv}(a), t) \mid (a,t) \in A \text{ and } a \in A_{\mathrm{VF}}\}.$$

The obvious definable bijection $\mathbf{c} : A \longrightarrow \mathbf{c}(A)$ is referred to as the *regularization* of A.

Observe that, for a proper invariant set A, $\mathbf{c}(A)$ is proper invariant if and only if A_{VF} is doubly bounded. Going forward, when A is doubly bounded and proper invariant, it is often more convenient or even necessary to substitute $\mathbf{c}(A)$ for A. Whether such a substitution has been performed (tacitly) or not should be clear in the context (or rather, it is always performed).

6.2. **Proper covariant bijections that are special.**

Definition 6.11. Let A be a doubly bounded proper invariant set or, more generally, a finite disjoint union of such sets, regularized in the sense of Convention 6.10. Suppose that the first

coordinate of A is a VF-coordinate (of course nothing is special about the first VF-coordinate, we choose it simply for ease of notation).

Let $C \subseteq \mathrm{RVH}(A)$ be an RV-pullback. Let

$$\lambda : \mathrm{pr}_{>1}(C \cap A) \longrightarrow \mathrm{VF}$$

be a definable continuous function whose graph is contained in C, that is, for each RV-polydisc $\mathfrak{p} \subseteq C$, λ restricts to a function

$$\lambda_{\mathfrak{p}} : \mathrm{pr}_{>1}(\mathfrak{p} \cap A) \longrightarrow \mathrm{pr}_1(\mathfrak{p}).$$

Suppose that there is an $\mathrm{rv}(\mathfrak{p})$-definable tuple $(\alpha_{\mathfrak{p}}, \beta_{\mathfrak{p}}) \in \Gamma$ such that $\mathfrak{p} \cap A$ is $(\alpha_{\mathfrak{p}}, \beta_{\mathfrak{p}})$-invariant and $\lambda_{\mathfrak{p}}$ is $(\beta_{\mathfrak{p}}, \alpha_{\mathfrak{p}})$-covariant. Choose a definable $\gamma \in \Gamma_0^+$ such that there is a definable point $t \in \gamma^\sharp$ and for all $\mathfrak{p}$,

$$\gamma_{\mathfrak{p}} \coloneqq \mathrm{rad}(\mathrm{pr}_1(\mathfrak{p})) + \gamma \geq \alpha_{\mathfrak{p}};$$

the existence of such a γ is guaranteed by Lemma 2.41 and the assumption that $\mathbb{S}$ is VF-generated. For each $\mathfrak{p}$, set

$$t_{\mathfrak{p}} = t \cdot \mathrm{rv}(\mathrm{pr}_1(\mathfrak{p})) \in \mathrm{RV}.$$

Then the *centripetal transformation η on A with respect to λ* is given by

$$\text{(CT)} \qquad \begin{cases} \eta(a,x) = (a - \lambda(x), x), & \text{if } (a,x) \in \mathfrak{p} \cap A \text{ and } \pi_{\gamma_{\mathfrak{p}}}(a) \neq \pi_{\gamma_{\mathfrak{p}}}(\lambda(x)), \\ \eta(a,x) = (t_{\mathfrak{p}}, x), & \text{if } (a,x) \in \mathfrak{p} \cap A \text{ and } \pi_{\gamma_{\mathfrak{p}}}(a) = \pi_{\gamma_{\mathfrak{p}}}(\lambda(x)), \\ \eta = \mathrm{id}, & \text{on } A \smallsetminus C. \end{cases}$$

Observe that $\eta(A)$ is doubly bounded. The function λ is called the *focus* of η, the RV-pullback C the *locus* of λ (or η), and the pair (γ, t) the *aperture* of λ (or η). Note that if (γ, t) is the aperture of λ then every other pair (γ', t') of this form with $\gamma' \geq \gamma$ could be an aperture of λ as well, so the aperture of λ must be given as a part of λ itself. Actually, all the data above should be regarded as part of λ, including the tuples $(\alpha_{\mathfrak{p}}, \beta_{\mathfrak{p}})$.

A *special covariant transformation* T on A is an alternating composition of centripetal transformations and regularizations. The *length* of such a special covariant transformation T, denoted by $\mathrm{lh}(T)$, is the number of centripetal transformations in it.

Choose a definable point $c \in t^\sharp$ (again, this is possible since $\mathbb{S}$ is assumed to be VF-generated). If $(a,x) \in \mathfrak{p} \cap A$ and $\pi_{\gamma_{\mathfrak{p}}}(a) = \pi_{\gamma_{\mathfrak{p}}}(\lambda(x))$ then $(\lambda(x), x) \in \mathfrak{p} \cap A$. Thus the second clause of (CT) may be changed to

$$\eta(a,x) = (a - \lambda(x) + \lambda(x)c, x).$$

If so, the images from the first two clauses of (CT) may overlap, but we take their disjoint union and thereby always assume that the resulting function $\eta^\flat$ is injective. In so doing, a special covariant transformation may be *lifted* to a *special covariant bijection* $T^\flat$ on A. This of course does depend on the choice of the definable point $c \in t^\sharp$. The image of $T^\flat$ is often denoted by $A^\flat$.

The formulation of a special covariant bijection here is considerably more complicated than that of a special bijection in [17, Definition 5.1]. A special covariant bijection is a special bijection if all of the apertures are $(\infty, 0)$ in the obvious sense or the second clause of (CT) does not occur. The extra generality is needed to achieve better control in transforming one proper invariant set into another.

Remark 6.12. If we change the aperture (γ, t) of η to (γ', t') with $\gamma' > \gamma$ and write the resulting centripetal transformation as η' then every open polydisc $\mathfrak{b} \subseteq \eta(A) \smallsetminus \eta'(A)$ of radius $\alpha_{\mathfrak{p}}$, where $\mathfrak{p}$ is the RV-polydisc that contains $\eta^{-1}(\mathfrak{b})$, has an extra RV-coordinate $t_{\mathfrak{p}}$ that is contracted from open discs of radius $\gamma_{\mathfrak{p}}$ in the first VF-coordinate of A. Each of these open polydiscs has a counterpart

in $\eta'(A) \smallsetminus \eta(A)$, in which $t_{\mathfrak{p}}$ is replaced by $(\mathcal{M}_{\gamma_{\mathfrak{p}}} \smallsetminus \mathcal{M}_{\gamma'_{\mathfrak{p}}}) \cup t'_{\mathfrak{p}}$. On the other hand, $\eta(A) = \eta'(A)$ if and only if the second clause of (CT) does not occur.

Remark 6.13. Suppose that A is proper δ-invariant but is not doubly bounded. Then, by definition, there are no special covariant transformations on A. We can prepare A, though, as follows. Choose a definable point $t_\delta \in \delta^\sharp$. For each open polydisc $\mathfrak{b}_1 \times \ldots \times \mathfrak{b}_n \times t \subseteq A$ of radius δ, if $\mathfrak{b}_i = \mathcal{M}_\delta$ then replace it with t_δ. The resulting definable set, or rather, the resulting finite disjoint union of definable sets, is doubly bounded and remains δ-invariant. We may and do regard this operation as a centripetal transformation with respect to the constant focus map 0.

Referee R101 [Gap; revised] – Choose an attainable radius and spell out the lift.
Original source line 2132. A definable $\delta \in \Gamma$ need not admit a definable $t_\delta \in \delta^\sharp$; for example, over $\mathbb{C}((t))$ one may take $\delta = \mathrm{val}(t)/2$. The opening paragraph only guarantees attainability after increasing the radius. First replace δ by an attainable $\delta' \geq \delta$, which preserves invariance. Distinguish the contracted preparation, which replaces $\mathcal{M}_{\delta'}$ by the RV-point $t_{\delta'}$, from its bijective lift $x \mapsto x + c$, where $\mathrm{rv}(c) = t_{\delta'}$; its image is $t^\sharp_{\delta'}$. Carry disjoint-union tags to distinguish overlaps with the other pieces. This translation is the additional preparation rule at the zero-centered piece; it is not obtained by substituting the focus 0 into the expression in Definition 6.11 $\lambda(x)c$. This distinction is needed when Proposition 6.19 calls the preparation a special covariant bijection.

Lemma 6.14. *Special covariant bijections are partially differentiable proper covariant homeomorphisms with the constant Jacobian* 1.

Proof. In the notation of Definition 6.11, since $\mathrm{pr}_{>1}(C \cap A)$ is clopen (implied by proper invariance and Lemma 6.5) and λ is continuous, arguing as in the proof of Lemma 6.7, we see that for all sufficiently large $\epsilon \in \Gamma$ there is an even larger $\delta \in \Gamma$ such that the image under λ of any open polydisc of radius δ contained in $\mathrm{pr}_{>1}(C \cap A)$ is contained in an open disc of radius ϵ. Thus, for all RV-polydisc $\mathfrak{p} \subseteq C$, the image under the lifted centripetal transformation $\eta^\flat$ of any open polydisc of radius $(\gamma_{\mathfrak{p}}, \delta)$ contained in $\mathfrak{p} \cap A$ is again an open polydisc of radius $(\gamma_{\mathfrak{p}}, \delta)$. This means that $\eta^\flat(A)$ is proper invariant and, moreover, the domain and range of every VF-fiber of $\eta^\flat$ are clopen. More generally, since the RV-coordinates are carried along by centripetal transformations, it is not hard to see that this actually holds for all special covariant bijections. Now the claim follows from Lemmas 6.7 and 6.8 (that the Jacobian is 1 everywhere is obvious). □

Referee R102 [Error] – The everywhere Jacobian assertion fails under composition.
Original source line 2139. The constant-Jacobian assertion is false for the stated class of continuous covariant foci: partial derivatives do not obey the chain rule at every point. Here is a counterexample within Definition 6.11, using only its first clause. Choose a definable $d \neq 0$ with $\delta = \mathrm{val}(d) > 0$, put $\epsilon = 2\delta$, and let $A = (1 + \mathcal{M}_\epsilon)^3$, with coordinates (a, x, y) and the stipulated constant regularization tags. Define

$$h(x,y) = \begin{cases} -x, & \mathrm{val}(x) < \mathrm{val}(y), \\ 0, & \mathrm{val}(x) \geq \mathrm{val}(y). \end{cases}$$

The function h is continuous and 1-Lipschitz for the maximum norm, and all its partial derivatives exist; at $(0,0)$ they are $(-1,0)$. Apply three centripetal transformations, first in x, then in y, then in a, with respective focus maps

$$2 - d - a, \qquad 2 - d - a, \qquad 1 - d + h(x - d, y - d).$$

Here the x, y in the last focus are the already transformed coordinates. The successive domains are product polydiscs with centers $(1,1,1)$, $(1,d,1)$, and $(1,d,d)$ and radius ϵ. All three foci lie in the target coordinate's RV-disc, are continuous and (ϵ,ϵ)-covariant, and admit aperture $(\epsilon, \mathrm{rv}(d^2))$. Every

transformed difference has valuation $\delta < \epsilon$, so the second clause of (CT) never occurs. Thus these are permitted special covariant bijections.

Writing $(u, v, w) = (a - 1, x - 1, y - 1)$, their composite, after subtracting its constant output center (d, d, d), is

$$(u, v, w) \longmapsto \big(u - h(v + u, w + u),\ v + u,\ w + u\big).$$

Since $h(t, t) = 0$, $h(t, 0) = -t$, and $h(0, t) = 0$, its partial-Jacobian matrix at the origin is

$$\begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 & 0 \\ 1 & 1 & 0 \\ 1 & 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix},$$

whose determinant is 0, although every individual transformation has determinant 1 everywhere. This does not contradict the almost-everywhere change-of-variables formula. One repair is to state Jacobian 1 only almost everywhere and check all later uses; another is to require total differentiability of the foci, with a corresponding strengthened existence proof. An almost-everywhere repair is not automatic for the standard-contraction setup below, which explicitly demands constant Jacobian 1. The relevant chain rule in [17, Lemma 9.7] requires total differentiability; almost-everywhere partial differentiability by itself cannot justify the present claim.

So calling them "special proper covariant bijections" may seem more appropriate, but the verbosity is somewhat confusing.

Remark 6.15. Let (A, ω), (B, σ) be objects of $\mu\mathrm{VF}[k]$ and $F : A \longrightarrow B$ a special covariant bijection. Then F represents a $\mu\mathrm{VF}[k]$-isomorphism if $\omega(x) = \sigma(F(x))$ for all $x \in A$ outside a definable subset of VF-dimension less than k (recall Remark 3.7).

Lemma 6.16 ([17, Theorem 5.5])**.** *Suppose that A is a definable set in* VF *and $f : A \longrightarrow \mathcal{P}(\mathrm{RV}^m)$ is a definable function. Then there is a special bijection T on A such that $A^\flat$ is an* RV*-pullback and the function $f \circ T^{-1}$ is* rv*-contractible.*

Referee R103 [Clarification] – Explain the extension of the cited preparation theorem.
Original source line 2153. The cited theorem is a polynomial-term preparation statement, whereas this lemma allows an arbitrary definable relation $f \subseteq A \times \mathrm{RV}^m$. Add the short deduction: take a quantifier-free defining formula for that relation, simultaneously prepare its finitely many occurring VF-polynomials (also those defining A), and observe that the truth value of the resulting formula is constant on each transformed RV-polydisc for every RV-parameter. This gives precisely the asserted powerset-valued contraction. See the quantifier-free-formula argument in [17, Theorem 5.5 and Corollary 5.6].

Remark 6.17. The proof of Lemma 6.16 in [17] actually shows that for every definable set A, there is a special bijection T on $\mathrm{RVH}(A)$ such that $A^\flat$ is an RV-pullback. In the present context, for reasons that will become clear, we would like to extend this result, using special covariant bijections on proper invariant sets A. This is not guaranteed by Lemma 6.16 since the focus maps in T are not required to be (suitably) covariant within each RV-polydisc; except when $A_{\mathrm{VF}} \subseteq \mathrm{VF}$, in which case the covariance requirement is half vacuous and it is easy to see how to turn T into a special covariant bijection whose components all have the same aperture. The technique underlying such a modification could be generalized so as to be applicable in other similar situations, see Terminology 6.18 below.

Terminology 6.18. Often in a construction there is obstructing data that is contained in finitely many distinct definable open discs $\mathfrak{a}_i$, all of the same radius, and is presented in the form of a definable function $f : A \longrightarrow \mathrm{VF}$ with A a set in VF and $\mathfrak{a}_i \subseteq \mathrm{pr}_1(A)$. Then the *FMT procedure* may be applied to circumvent the difficulties, which is simply this: choose a definable point a_i in each $\mathfrak{a}_i$ and replace f with another function $f' : A \longrightarrow \mathrm{VF}$ given by $(a, b) \longmapsto f(a_i, b)$ if $a \in \mathfrak{a}_i$ and

$(a,b) \longmapsto f(a,b)$ otherwise, now the construction over each $\mathfrak{a}_i$ depends on a_i and hence no longer varies.

Referee R104 [Gap] – FMT needs a product domain.
Original source line 2161. The replacement $f(a,b) \mapsto f(a_i,b)$ is not defined from the hypotheses as written: $(a,b) \in A$ and $a, a_i \in \mathfrak{a}_i$ do not imply $(a_i,b) \in A$. Require that $A \cap (\mathfrak{a}_i \times \mathrm{VF}^{n-1}) = \mathfrak{a}_i \times A_{a_i}$ (with RV-coordinates carried along), or explicitly require the corresponding domain inclusion for each replacement. The later uses of FMT must verify this condition for the current focus-map domain, not just for the original A.

Proposition 6.19. *Let H be a proper invariant* RV*-pullback, not necessarily doubly bounded, and $(A_i)_i$ a definable finite partition of H such that each A_i is proper invariant. Then there is a special covariant bijection T on H such that*

- *every $T \upharpoonright A_i$ is indeed a special covariant bijection,*
- *every $A_i^\flat \subseteq H^\flat$ is a doubly bounded* RV*-pullback.*

Proof. To begin with, by Remark 6.13, we may assume that H is doubly bounded. It is equivalent and less cumbersome to construct a special covariant transformation such that its lift is as required (see the last paragraph of this proof). To that end, we proceed by induction on n, where $H_{\mathrm{VF}} \subseteq \mathrm{VF}^n$. The base case $n = 1$ follows from Lemma 6.16 and the discussion in Remark 6.17.

For the inductive step, let $A_{i1} = \mathrm{pr}_1(A_i)$ and $H_1 = \mathrm{pr}_1(H)$. By Lemma 6.6, we may assume that $(A_{i1})_i$ form a partition of H_1. For each $a \in H_1$, the inductive hypothesis gives an a-definable special covariant transformation T_a on H_a such that every $T_a \upharpoonright A_{ia}$ is a special covariant transformation and every $T_a(A_{ia}) \subseteq T_a(H_a)$ is an RV-pullback. Our goal then is to fuse together these transformations T_a so to obtain one special covariant transformation on H as desired. This is in general not possible without first modifying H_1 in a suitable way, which constitutes the bulk of the work below.

Referee R105 [Clarification] – Refine the projected partition explicitly.
Original source line 2178. The projections $\mathrm{pr}_1(A_i)$ need not be disjoint. Replace them by the Boolean atoms of the finite family $(\mathrm{pr}_1(A_i))_i$, and restrict each original piece over these atoms. Several nonempty pieces can still have the same first-coordinate projection; group them over that atom instead of treating the projected family as a disjoint partition indexed by the original i. The subsequent fiberwise induction can then be stated without changing the original partition problem.

Let U_{ak} enumerate the loci of the components of T_a, λ_{ak} the corresponding continuous focus maps, and (γ_{ak}, t_{ak}) their apertures; for each RV-polydisc $\mathfrak{q} \subseteq U_{ak}$, the map $\lambda_{ak\mathfrak{q}}$ is $(\alpha_{ak\mathfrak{q}}, \beta_{ak\mathfrak{q}})$-covariant. By compactness, there is a definable set $V \subseteq \mathrm{VF} \times \mathrm{RV}^l$ such that $\mathrm{pr}_1(V) = H_1$ and, for each $a \in H_1$, the set V_a contains the following RV-data of T_a:

- $\mathrm{rv}(T_a \upharpoonright A_{ia})$, $\mathrm{rv}(T_a)$, and $\mathrm{rv}(U_{ak})$,
- the VF-coordinates targeted by the focus maps λ_{ak},
- the a-definable apertures (γ_{ak}, t_{ak}),
- the $(a, \mathrm{rv}(\mathfrak{q}))$-definable tuples $(\alpha_{ak\mathfrak{q}}, \beta_{ak\mathfrak{q}})$;

the set $\mathrm{rv}(T_a)$ is determined by other data in this list and hence is redundant, but we add it in anyway for clarity. Note that V is doubly bounded but not necessarily proper invariant.

Referee R106 [Gap; revised] – Bounded fiber data need not be uniformly bounded.
Original source line 2188. Compactness of the choices does not establish that V is doubly bounded. Even on $H_1 = 1^\sharp$, the definable function $\gamma(a) = \mathrm{val}(a-1)$ for $a \neq 1$, with $\gamma(1) = 0$, is unbounded. These can actually be aperture data: on the second coordinate of $H = (1^\sharp)^2$, take the constant focus 1, the aperture $(\gamma(a), \mathrm{rv}(a-1))$ for $a \neq 1$, and $(0,1)$ for $a = 1$. All the separate transformations are permitted, but their collected aperture data are unbounded. This does not show that a bounded choice is impossible;

it shows that the asserted bound needs a choice argument. A possible repair is to postpone it until the finitely many exceptional discs have been frozen by FMT, and then prove that all the data factor through a doubly bounded RV-base. Definable fiberwise bounds and Lemma 2.41 can then give a uniform bound.

Let $\phi(x, y)$ be a quantifier-free formula that defines V and $G_i(x)$ enumerate its top terms. By Lemma 6.16, there is a special bijection $R : H_1 \longrightarrow H_1^\flat$ such that each $A_{i1}^\flat \subseteq H_1^\flat$ is an RV-pullback and every function $G_i \circ R^{-1}$ is rv-contractible. This implies that, for every RV-polydisc $\mathfrak{p} \subseteq H_1^\flat$, the RV-data V_a is constant over $a \in R^{-1}(\mathfrak{p})$. Also, since H_1 is an RV-pullback of RV-fiber dimension 0, by C-minimality and Lemma 3.3, each focus map in R consists of only finitely many points.

Fix a sufficiently large definable $\delta \in \Gamma$ such that every A_i is proper δ-invariant. Then there is an algebraic set of open discs $\mathfrak{a}_j \subseteq H_1$ of radius δ such that the restriction of R to $H_1 \smallsetminus \bigcup_j \mathfrak{a}_j$ is actually a special covariant bijection — the reason simply being that, after deleting all the discs $\mathfrak{a}_j$, each focus map in R lies outside the set in question. Each $\mathfrak{a}_j$ contains an $\ulcorner \mathfrak{a}_j \urcorner$-definable point a_j and, for all $a, a' \in \mathfrak{a}_j$ and every A_i, we have $A_{ia} = A_{ia'}$ (because A_i is δ-invariant). It follows that, over each $\mathfrak{a}_j$, we can use the same transformation T_{a_j} to achieve the desired effect. This is the first instance where FMT is applied, namely to T, and then R is adjusted so that every $\mathfrak{a}_j$ is mapped to the same RV-disc $t_\delta^\sharp$, where $t_\delta \in \delta^\sharp$ is a chosen definable point.

Therefore, we may assume that R is a special covariant bijection whose components all have the same aperture (δ, t_δ).

By compactness, there is a definable finite partition of H_1 such that, over each piece, the focus maps λ_{ak} are uniformly defined by formulas $\lambda_k(a, y, z)$. By C-minimality, there are only finitely many open discs $\mathfrak{a}_i \subseteq H_1$ of radius δ that are split by this partition. Thus, by FMT again, we may assume that the partition is indeed trivial. Since R induces a special covariant bijection on H, we may actually assume that R is trivial as well.

Referee R107 [Clarification; revised] – Explain uniformization after FMT.
Original source line 2201. Here "trivial" presumably means that one global definition of the focus maps suffices. Explain the finite gluing step: FMT makes the formula-choice pieces clopen, but does not by itself ensure that an operation on one piece extends by the identity as a permitted centripetal transformation, whose locus must be an RV-pullback. Include the finite formula-choice partition among the sets prepared by R, pad shorter transformations by identities, and glue the focus definitions over the resulting RV-pullback pieces, checking their loci. This is the intended uniformization. Similarly, taking R to be trivial means replacing H by its transformed image and transporting the entire partition and all fiberwise data along R.

Over each $t^\sharp \subseteq H_1$, we can now write U_{ak} as U_{tk}, $\alpha_{ak\mathfrak{q}}$ as $\alpha_{k\mathfrak{q}}$ (the first RV-coordinate of $\mathfrak{q}$ is actually t), and so on. We are almost ready to fuse together the transformations T_a over $a \in t^\sharp$. The remaining problem is that, for any $a, a' \in t^\sharp$, although the two focus maps $\lambda_{a1\mathfrak{q}}$, $\lambda_{a'1\mathfrak{q}}$ are both $(\alpha_{1\mathfrak{q}}, \beta_{1\mathfrak{q}})$-covariant, the images of the same open polydisc of radius $\alpha_{1\mathfrak{q}}$ may lie in two distinct open discs of radius $\beta_{1\mathfrak{q}}$. To solve this problem, consider an open polydisc $\mathfrak{p}$ of radius $\alpha_{1\mathfrak{q}}$ that is contained in $\mathrm{dom}(\lambda_{a1\mathfrak{q}})$ for some (hence all) $a \in t^\sharp$. For each $b \in \mathfrak{p}$, let $\lambda_{1b} : t^\sharp \longrightarrow \mathrm{VF}$ be the function defined by $\lambda_1(x, b, z)$. By C-minimality and Corollary 2.30, there are a b-definable finite set $C_b \subseteq \mathrm{VF}$ and, for any $a \in t^\sharp \smallsetminus C_b$, an open disc $\mathfrak{a}_a \subseteq t^\sharp \smallsetminus C_b$ around a such that $\lambda_{1b}(\mathfrak{a}_a)$ lies in an open disc of radius $\beta_{1\mathfrak{q}}$. Since for any other $a' \in \mathfrak{a}_a$, $\lambda_{a'1\mathfrak{q}}(\mathfrak{p})$ also lies in an open disc of radius $\beta_{1\mathfrak{q}}$, we see that $\lambda_1(\mathfrak{a}_a \times \mathfrak{p})$ lies in an open disc of radius $\beta_{1\mathfrak{q}}$, where λ_1 stands for the function defined by $\lambda_1(x, y, z)$. Therefore, we may assume that the finite set C_b is actually $\ulcorner \mathfrak{p} \urcorner$-definable. But then, by Lemma 2.18, it is even definable, that is, it does not depend on $\mathfrak{p}$ (or rather it works for all $\mathfrak{p}$). By compactness and FMT, we may assume that there is an $\mathfrak{o}$-partition $p : \mathrm{dom}(\lambda_1) \longrightarrow \Gamma$ such that, for each open polydisc $\mathfrak{b}$ in question, $\lambda_1(\mathfrak{b})$ lies in a disc of radius $\beta_{1\mathfrak{q}}$, where $\mathfrak{q}$ is related to $\mathfrak{b}$ in the obvious way. By Lemma 2.53, the image of p is doubly bounded and, by Lemma 2.41,

there is a definable $\gamma_1 \in \Gamma$ with $\gamma_1 \geq \gamma_{t1}$ for all $t \in \mathrm{rv}(H_1)$. We may choose such a γ_1 together with a definable point $t_1 \in \gamma_1^\sharp$ (see the opening paragraph of this section). All this means that λ_1 can serve as the focus map of a centripetal transformation T_1 on H of aperture (γ_1, t_1). To ensure that λ_1 is continuous, we can appeal to Proposition 2.55 and, once again, FMT.

Referee R108 [Clarification; revised] – Use a canonical exceptional set before eliminating ball parameters.
Original source line 2204. Use a canonical exceptional set instead of an arbitrary chosen C_b. With the other RV labels z fixed, let $E_{\mathfrak{p},z}$ consist of the a at which no neighborhood $\mathfrak{a}$ has $\lambda_1(\mathfrak{a}\times\mathfrak{p})$ contained in one radius-$\beta_{1\mathfrak{q}}$ disc. Covariance on $\mathfrak{p}$ shows that $E_{\mathfrak{p},z} \subseteq C_b$ for every $b \in \mathfrak{p}$, so this is a finite set definable from the polydisc code and the RV labels. Lemma 2.18 removes the polydisc code from algebraic dependence; Lemma 2.13 then removes the remaining RV labels. The union of the uniformly definable family $(E_{\mathfrak{p},z})$ is contained in $\mathrm{acl}(\mathbb{S})$, and hence is finite by compactness. This supplies the common finite exceptional set needed for FMT. Algebraicity of each separate chosen C_b would not on its own make that choice independent of $\mathfrak{p}$.

At this point the proof would be complete if we could repeat the procedure above for λ_2, and so on. We still have a small issue, namely some part of the locus U_{a2} may have disappeared because the aperture of λ_{a1} is bumped up to (γ_1, t_1); see Remark 6.12. It is not hard to see that the inductive hypothesis may be applied to the RV-pullback W contained in $T_1(H)$ that corresponds to the missing locus, ignoring the coordinate of W that was targeted by T_1, because the missing locus must have one less VF-coordinate and its intersection with each $T_1(A_i)$ is proper invariant. □

Referee R109 [Gap] – Complete the aperture-change induction.
Original source line 2207. The final paragraph leaves the induction unfinished: the text does not construct the replacement transformations on the part created when an aperture increases, nor explain why the remaining loci still define valid transformations. The useful precise assertion would be that the affected part W is a pullback under a projection forgetting the newly released VF-coordinate, that every $W \cap T_1(A_i)$ is a pullback under the same projection, and that the projected sets are proper invariant. Then apply the $(n-1)$-dimensional induction to that projected partition, lift its transformations while carrying the released coordinate along, and verify compatibility with the remaining loci. Give the explicit projection/factorization and the finite induction on the remaining components. Merely saying that the old missing locus has one fewer VF-coordinate does not prove these facts for $W \subseteq T_1(H)$.

This proposition can indeed be applied to any proper invariant set A against its RV-hull $\mathrm{RVH}(A)$, without specifying a partition of $\mathrm{RVH}(A)$ as required, because, by Lemma 6.6, $\mathrm{RVH}(A) \smallsetminus A$ is proper invariant too.

Remark 6.20. As in the statement of Lemma 6.16 above, if $f : H \longrightarrow \mathcal{P}(\mathrm{RV}^m)$ is a proper covariant function then we can demand as a clause of the conclusion of Proposition 6.19 that the function $f \circ T^{-1}$ be rv-contractible, which would follow if it is simply included as a clause of the inductive hypothesis in the proof.

Let A be a definable set and $\omega : A \longrightarrow \Gamma$ a definable function. We say that the definable pair $\boldsymbol{A} = (A, \omega)$ is *proper invariant* if A is proper invariant and ω is proper covariant, that is, every fiber A_γ is proper invariant.

Lemma 6.21. *Suppose that A is an* RV*-pullback and $(A_i)_i$ is a definable finite partition of A such that each $\boldsymbol{A}_i = (A_i, \omega \upharpoonright A_i)$ is proper invariant. Then there is a special covariant bijection T as given in Proposition 6.19 such that $\omega \circ T^{-1}$ is* rv*-contractible. In particular, if $\boldsymbol{A}_i \in \mu\mathrm{VF}[k]$ then T induces a morphism $\boldsymbol{A}_i \longrightarrow \mu\mathbb{L}(\boldsymbol{U}_i, \pi_i)$, where $(\boldsymbol{U}_i, \pi_i) \in \mu\mathrm{RV}^{\mathrm{db}}[k]$.*

Proof. We view ω as a definable function $A \longrightarrow \mathcal{P}(\mathrm{RV})$. By Proposition 6.19, there is a special covariant bijection T on A such that, for each i, $T \upharpoonright A_i$ is a special covariant bijection and $A_i^\flat$ is an RV-pullback. Moreover, applying Remark 6.20, we get that each function $\sigma_i \coloneqq (\omega \circ T^{-1}) \upharpoonright A_i^\flat$ is constant on every RV-polydisc in $A_i^\flat$ and hence induces a function $\pi_i : \mathrm{rv}(A_i^\flat) \longrightarrow \Gamma$. Now, if $\boldsymbol{A}_i \in \mu\mathrm{VF}[k]$ then, by Lemma 3.3, $\boldsymbol{U}_i \coloneqq \mathrm{rv}(A_i^\flat)_{\leq k} \in \mathrm{RV}^{\mathbb{db}}[k]$ (recall Notation 3.9). We see that $(\boldsymbol{U}_i, \pi_i)$ is as required because, by Remark 6.15, $\boldsymbol{A}_i$ is isomorphic to $(\mathbb{L}\boldsymbol{U}_i, \sigma_i)$, □

Referee R110 [Typo] – Sentence-ending punctuation.
Original source line 2222. Replace the final comma after "$(\mathbb{L}\boldsymbol{U}_i, \sigma_i)$" by a full stop.

As above, this lemma may be applied to any proper invariant object $(A, \omega) \in \mu\mathrm{VF}[k]$, since the object $(\mathrm{RVH}(A) \smallsetminus A, 0) \in \mu\mathrm{VF}[k]$ is also proper invariant.

Referee R170 [Error; new] – The RV-hull can create infinite RV-fibers.
Original source line 2225. The auxiliary complement need not belong to $\mu\mathrm{VF}[k]$. For a definable $\delta > 0$, put $U = \{t \in \mathrm{RV} : 0 < \mathrm{vrv}(t) < \delta\}$ and

$$A = \{(x, t) \in (1 + \mathcal{M}) \times U : t = \mathrm{rv}(x - 1)\}.$$

With constant volume form 0, this is a proper δ-invariant object of $\mu\mathrm{VF}[1]$: each RV-fiber over x has at most one point. Its regularization merely adds the constant tag $\mathrm{rv}(x) = 1$. However,

$$\mathrm{RVH}(A) = (1 + \mathcal{M}) \times U,$$

and the fiber of $\mathrm{RVH}(A) \setminus A$ over $x = 1$ is the infinite set U. Thus the complement is not in $\mathrm{VF}[1]$. The application of the lemma is nevertheless repairable: delete "$\in \mu\mathrm{VF}[k]$" for this auxiliary piece. The lemma permits arbitrary proper invariant pieces, and only its "in particular" conclusion requires the selected original piece (A, ω) to lie in $\mu\mathrm{VF}[k]$.

Lemma 6.22. *Let A be a definable set with A_{VF} bounded and A_{RV} doubly bounded. Let $f : A \longrightarrow \Gamma$ be a definable function that is constant on $A \cap \mathfrak{a}$ for all open polydiscs $\mathfrak{a}$ of radius $\gamma \in \Gamma$. Then $f(A)$ is doubly bounded.*

Proof. Observe that, without loss of generality, we can replace A with its γ-tubular neighborhood and thereby assume that (A, f) is indeed proper invariant. By Lemma 6.21, f factors through a doubly bounded definable set in RV. So, by Lemma 2.41, $f(A)$ must be doubly bounded. □

Corollary 6.23. *If (A, ω) is proper invariant then $\omega(A)$ is doubly bounded.*

Proof. We have seen this many times above: as a consequence of Lemma 2.53, for all sufficiently large $\beta \in \Gamma$, every fiber A_γ of ω is β-invariant. So the claim is immediate by Lemma 6.22. □

6.3. **Standard contractions.**

Definition 6.24. Let $A \subseteq \mathrm{VF}^n \times \mathrm{RV}^m$, $B \subseteq \mathrm{VF}^n \times \mathrm{RV}^{m'}$ be definable sets. A definable bijection $G : A \longrightarrow B$ is *relatively unary*, or more precisely, *relatively unary in the (i, j)-coordinate*, where $i, j \in [n]$, if $(\mathrm{pr}_{\tilde{j}} \circ G)(x) = \mathrm{pr}_{\tilde{i}}(x)$ for all $x \in A$. If, in addition, $G \upharpoonright A_a$ is also a special covariant bijection for every $a \in \mathrm{pr}_{\tilde{i}}(A)$ then G is *relatively special covariant* in the (i, j)-coordinate.

Let $\boldsymbol{U} = (U, f)$, $\boldsymbol{V} = (V, g)$ be objects of $\mathrm{RV}[k]$. A morphism $F : \boldsymbol{U} \longrightarrow \boldsymbol{V}$ is *relatively unary in the (i, j)-coordinate*, where $i, j \in [k]$, if $(\mathrm{pr}_{\tilde{j}} \circ g \circ F)(u) = (\mathrm{pr}_{\tilde{i}} \circ f)(u)$ for all $u \in U$.

Alternatively, for simplicity, we may take $i = j$ in this definition and stipulate that the condition in question holds up to coordinate permutations.

Since identity functions are relatively unary in any coordinate, if a bijection is piecewise (over a definable finite partition) a composition of relatively unary bijections then it is indeed a composition of relatively unary bijections.

Example 6.25. Every special covariant bijection T of length 1 is relatively special covariant, but clearly not vice versa (to begin with, the relevant data is not necessarily uniform across the fibers in each RV-polydisc).

Let $A \subseteq \mathrm{VF}^n \times \mathrm{RV}^m$ be a proper invariant set. Let $i \in [n]$ and $T_i : A \longrightarrow A^\flat$ be a proper covariant bijection that is

- relatively unary in the (i,i)-coordinate (up to coordinate permutations),
- partially differentiable with the constant Jacobian 1.

Moreover, the RV-coordinates of A are passed on to $A^\flat$ via T_i in the obvious way (the simplest example is that T_i is the regularization of A). Adjusting T_i by way of Remark 6.13 if necessary, we take A and $A^\flat$ to be both doubly bounded. By Lemma 6.8, $A^\flat$ is proper invariant as well, and T_i is a proper covariant homeomorphism. Suppose that, for all $a \in A_{\tilde{i}}$ and all $t \in (A_a)_{\mathrm{RV}}$, the image $T_i(A_{a,t}) \subseteq A^\flat_{a,t}$ of the fiber $A_{a,t} \subseteq A$ is an RV-pullback. Let

Referee R111 [Error] – Continuity is missing from the standard-contraction hypotheses. *Original source line 2263.* Lemma 6.8 only gives a homeomorphism if continuity has already been assumed. Proper covariance plus everywhere partial differentiability and Jacobian 1 does not imply continuity. For example, put

$$q(x,y) = \begin{cases} x/y, & y \neq 0 \text{ and } \mathrm{val}(x) \geq \mathrm{val}(y), \\ 0, & \text{otherwise.} \end{cases}$$

This bounded function has every partial derivative everywhere, but $q(t,t) = 1$ for $t \neq 0$ and $q(0,0) = 0$. For a definable $0 \neq d \in \mathcal{M}$, the map

$$T(a,x,y) = \big(a + dq(x-1, y-1), x, y\big)$$

on $A = (1+\mathcal{M})^3$ is a relatively unary proper covariant bijection $A \longrightarrow A$, with constant partial Jacobian 1 and RV-pullback fibers, yet is discontinuous at $(1,1,1)$. All regularization tags are constant, so forgetting or retaining them does not change this example. Add "continuous" to the hypotheses on T_i before invoking Lemma 6.8.

$$A_{-i} = \bigcup_{a \in A_{\tilde{i}}} a \times (A^\flat_a)_{\mathrm{RV}} \subseteq \mathrm{VF}^{n-1} \times \mathrm{RV}^{m_i},$$

which is doubly bounded and proper invariant, and we think of it as obtained from $A^\flat$ by "rv-contracting" the VF-coordinate in question. Also, under Convention 6.10, $A^\flat$ can be "fully recovered" from A_{-i}. Let $\hat{T}_i : A \longrightarrow A_{-i}$ be the function induced by T_i.

For any $j \in [n-1]$, we repeat the above setup on A_{-i} with respect to the jth VF-coordinate, and thereby obtain a doubly bounded proper invariant set $A_{-j} \subseteq \mathrm{VF}^{n-2} \times \mathrm{RV}^{m_j}$ and a function $\hat{T}_j : A_{-i} \longrightarrow A_{-j}$ that is induced by a relatively unary, partially differentiable, proper covariant homeomorphism $T_j : A^\flat \longrightarrow A^{\flat\flat}$ (the VF-coordinate in $A^\flat$ that gets rv-contracted in A_{-i} is simply carried along by T_j). Continuing thus, a sequence of such homeomorphisms $T_{\sigma(1)}, \ldots, T_{\sigma(n)}$ and a corresponding function $\hat{T}_\sigma : A \longrightarrow \mathrm{RV}^l$ result, where σ is the permutation of $[n]$ in question. The composition $T_{\sigma(n)} \circ \ldots \circ T_{\sigma(1)}$, which is referred to as the *lift* of $\hat{T}_\sigma$, is denoted by T_σ. By Lemma 6.9, T_σ is a proper covariant homeomorphism. Also note that T_σ^{-1} is rv-contractible.

Definition 6.26. The function $\hat{T}_\sigma$, or the set $\hat{T}_\sigma(A)$, is called a *standard contraction* of A.

Lemma 6.27. *Every proper invariant set $A \subseteq \mathrm{VF}^n \times \mathrm{RV}^m$ admits a standard contraction with respect to any permutation σ of $[n]$.*

Proof. We first remark that, although the lift of a standard contraction is in effect a more general (or rather less stringent) notion than that of a special covariant bijection, for existence, it is enough to exhibit a special covariant bijection that is also the lift of a standard contraction. To that end, the proof of Proposition 6.19 almost works. The issue is that a standard contraction is required to transform fiberwise a VF-coordinate into an RV-pullback in one fell swoop and subsequently carry the result in the RV-coordinates, whereas in a special covariant bijection one is allowed to come back to modify the same VF-coordinate many times over. We can of course simply add a clause in the inductive hypothesis to fulfill the new requirement. In that case, the special covariant bijection induced by R there — let us call it R^* here — should also be made to comply. This needs work: it is clear how to transform fiberwise the first VF-coordinate into an RV-pullback on top of R^*, but continuity is not automatic. Fortunately, it is only for convenience that R^* is carried out in the beginning, that is, we may equivalently graft the RV-coordinates of $\mathrm{ran}(R)$ onto A directly in the obvious way (strictly speaking this operation is not allowed in a special covariant bijection, and that is why we cannot really opt for it in the proof of Proposition 6.19) and carry out R^* in the end. With this modification, the same construction yields a standard contraction as desired. □

Referee R112 [Gap] – Check the deferred transformation and fixed order.
Original source line 2283. To complete this existence argument, explicitly define the grafting map $a \mapsto (a, \tau(a))$, where τ records the RV-coordinates produced by R, and show that its fibers are uniformly invariant, so grafting is a proper covariant homeomorphism. Then specify the transported relatively unary maps while R^* is deferred, and verify that each already contracted VF-coordinate is subsequently only carried along. These are the conditions defining a standard contraction; the last sentence currently asserts rather than establishes them. This proof also depends on resolving the aperture-change induction above.

Remark 6.28. Suppose that there is a $k \in 0 \cup [m]$ such that $(A_a)_{\leq k} \in \mathrm{RV}^{\mathrm{db}}[k]$ for every $a \in A_{\mathrm{VF}}$. If $k = 0$ then this just means $A \in \mathrm{VF}_*$. By Lemma 3.3, $\hat{T}_\sigma(A)_{\leq n+k}$ is an object of $\mathrm{RV}^{\mathrm{db}}[n+k]$. Let $\boldsymbol{A} = (A, \omega)$ be a proper invariant pair such that the proper covariant function $\omega : A \longrightarrow \Gamma$ induces a function $\omega_{\hat{T}_\sigma}$ on $\hat{T}_\sigma(A)$ via T_σ, which just means that $\omega \circ T_\sigma^{-1}$ is invariant on RV-polydiscs. Then the function $\hat{T}_\sigma$, or the object

$$\hat{T}_\sigma(\boldsymbol{A})_{\leq n+k} = (\hat{T}_\sigma(A), \omega_{\hat{T}_\sigma})_{\leq n+k} \in \mu\mathrm{RV}^{\mathrm{db}}[n+k],$$

is understood as a *standard contraction* of $\boldsymbol{A}$. Using Lemma 6.27 instead of Proposition 6.19 in the proof of Lemma 6.21, we see that such a $\hat{T}_\sigma$ does exist. Moreover, if we set $A^\sharp = \bigcup_{a \in A_{\mathrm{VF}}} a \times \mathbb{L}(A_a)_{\leq k}$, which is a proper invariant object of VF_*, and denote the proper covariant function on $A^\sharp$ induced by ω still by ω, then T_σ indeed induces a $\mu\mathrm{VF}[n+k]$-morphism

$$(A^\sharp, \omega) \longrightarrow \mu\mathbb{L}\hat{T}_\sigma(\boldsymbol{A})_{\leq n+k}$$

that can be written as a composition of relatively unary proper covariant homeomorphisms.

Here k is dubbed the *head start* of $\hat{T}_\sigma$, which is usually implicit in the sequel. In fact, it never has to be anything other than 0 except in Lemma 7.14, and can be circumvented even there. This seemingly needless gadget only serves to make the discussion more streamlined: if $A \in \mathrm{VF}_*$ then the intermediate steps of a standard contraction of A may or may not result in objects of VF_* and hence the definition cannot be formulated entirely within VF_*.

6.4. **Lifting from RV to VF.**

Lemma 6.29. *Every morphism in* $\mathrm{RV}[k]$ *can be written as a composition of relatively unary morphisms, similarly in* $\mu\mathrm{RV}[k]$, $\mathrm{RV}^{\mathrm{db}}[k]$, *and* $\mu\mathrm{RV}^{\mathrm{db}}[k]$.

Proof. It is enough to show this piecewise, and the situation can be simplified accordingly step by step. Let $F : (U, f) \longrightarrow (V, g)$ be an $\mathrm{RV}[k]$-morphism. The idea is to adjust $f(u)$ towards $g(F(u))$, simultaneously for all $u \in U$, one coordinate at a time, and the issue is how to stay in $\mathrm{RV}[k]$, that is, how to make the adjusted f remain finite-to-one along the way. To that end, we proceed by induction on $n = \dim_{\mathrm{RV}}(U)$ and, without loss of generality, may take $F = \mathrm{id}$. The base case $n = 0$ is straightforward and is left to the reader. For the inductive step, we may assume that both $\mathrm{pr}_{\leq n} \upharpoonright f(U)$ and $\mathrm{pr}_{\leq n} \upharpoonright g(V)$ are finite-to-one. Let $f' = \mathrm{pr}_{\leq n} \circ f$ and $g' = \mathrm{pr}_{\leq n} \circ g$. Since, as in the base case, the two obvious $\mathrm{RV}[k]$-morphisms

$$(U, f) \longrightarrow (U \times 1, f' \times 1), \quad (U \times 1, g' \times 1) \longrightarrow (U, g)$$

are compositions of relatively unary morphisms, it is enough to show that $(U, f') \longrightarrow (U, g')$ is such a morphism as well. So we may assume $n = k$.

Write $\dot{U} = f(U)$ and $\ddot{U} = g(U)$. For each $t \in \dot{U}_{<n}$ and each $i \in [n]$, let $F^{\dagger}_{t,i} : \dot{U}_t \longrightarrow \mathcal{P}(\ddot{U}_i)$ be the definable finitary function induced by $F^{\dagger}$ (recall Notation 3.11). Then, by Lemma 2.15, there is a t-algebraic subset $B_{t,i} \subseteq \ddot{U}_i \subseteq \mathrm{RV}$ such that every fiber of $F^{\dagger}_{t,i}$ over an element in $\ddot{U}_i \smallsetminus B_{t,i}$ is finite; denote by $W_{t,i} \subseteq \dot{U}$ the union of such fibers. Indeed, by the compactness argument thereof, $B_{t,i}$ can be defined uniformly. Let $U_{t,i}$ be the set of those $u \in f^{-1}(t \times W_{t,i})$ such that $g(u)_i \notin B_{t,i}$, and $f'_{t,i} : U_{t,i} \longrightarrow \mathrm{RV}^n$ the function given by $u \longmapsto (t, g(u)_i)$, which is finite-to-one. Let $U_i = \bigcup_t U_{t,i}$ and $f'_i = \bigcup_t f'_{t,i}$. Then $(U_i, f \upharpoonright U_i) \longrightarrow (U_i, f'_i)$ is a relatively unary $\mathrm{RV}[n]$-morphism. By applying the inductive hypothesis fiberwise to $(U_i, f'_i) \longrightarrow (U_i, g \upharpoonright U_i)$ in the obvious sense, we may actually assume $U_i = \emptyset$, for every $i \in [n]$. Now, since $F^{\dagger}(\dot{U}_t) \subseteq \prod_{i \in [n]} B_{t,i}$, which is finite, we must have $\dim_{\mathrm{RV}}(U) < n$. So the claim follows from the inductive hypothesis.

If F is indeed a $\mu\mathrm{RV}[k]$-morphism then it is straightforward to equip the object in each intermediate step with a volume form so that the map in question becomes a $\mu\mathrm{RV}[k]$-morphism. The other cases are rather similar.

Referee R114 [Clarification] – Give the intermediate volume form.
Original source line 2323. For an intermediate finite-to-one coordinate map $h : U \longrightarrow \mathrm{RV}^k$, the required volume form is explicitly

$$\omega_h(u) = \omega(u) + \Sigma\,\mathrm{vrv}(f(u)) - \Sigma\,\mathrm{vrv}(h(u)).$$

Thus $\omega_h + \Sigma\,\mathrm{vrv} \circ h = \omega + \Sigma\,\mathrm{vrv} \circ f$, and the volume identities telescope through the composition. If f' has only $n < k$ coordinates, write $f' \times \mathbf{1}_{k-n}$ in the displayed intermediate objects to make the ambient degree unambiguous.

□

Lemma 6.30. *Let U, V be sets in* RV *and $f : U \longrightarrow \mathcal{P}(V)$ a definable finitary function. Then there is a definable finitary function $f^{\sharp} : U^{\sharp} \longrightarrow \mathcal{P}(V^{\sharp})$ that* rv*-contracts to f. Moreover, for every $(u, v) \in f$, $f^{\sharp}_{u,v} \coloneqq (u, v)^{\sharp} \cap f^{\sharp}$ is a partially differentiable function $u^{\sharp} \longrightarrow v^{\sharp}$.*

Similar to Definition 6.11, this is another place where we need the property that every algebraic RV-disc contains an algebraic point, and the easiest way to achieve this is to assume that the substructure $\mathbb{S}$ is VF-generated, which validates the repeated use of Lemma 2.20 below.

Proof. We proceed by induction on $\dim_{\mathrm{RV}}(U) = n$. For the base case $n = 0$, U is finite and hence, for every $u \in U$, the RV-polydisc $u^{\sharp}$ contains a u-definable point, and similarly for every element in $f(u) \subseteq V$. So lifting f as desired is trivial. For the inductive step, we may assume that $\mathrm{pr}_{\leq n} \upharpoonright U$ is finite-to-one. Let $U' = \mathrm{pr}_{\leq n}(U)$ and $f' : U' \longrightarrow \mathcal{P}(V)$ be the definable finitary function induced by f. Observe that if f' can be lifted as desired then f can be lifted (again trivially) as desired as well. So, without loss of generality, $U \subseteq \mathrm{RV}^n$. By Lemma 2.20 and compactness, there is indeed

a definable finitary function $f^\sharp : U^\sharp \longrightarrow \mathcal{P}(V^\sharp)$ that rv-contracts to f. By Lemma 2.38, every $f^\sharp_{u,v}$ is partially differentiable almost everywhere. By Lemma 2.35, the RV-boundary of the differential locus is of RV-dimension less than n. The lemma follows. □

Referee R115 [Gap] – Supply the single-valued lift and exceptional-locus induction.
Original source line 2336. Spell out two steps hidden here. For $a \in U^\sharp$, centers are chosen over the full VF-tuple a, not over an arbitrary nonalgebraic $u \in U$: the RV-elements in $f(\mathrm{rv}(a))$ are algebraic over a, so the center lemma and compactness give a finite a-definable family meeting their RV-polydiscs. To obtain one output in each RV-polydisc, average the finitely many chosen points in that polydisc (coordinatewise); residue characteristic 0 ensures the average remains in it. Finally remove the RV-hull of the nondifferentiability locus, prove that its RV-parameter set has dimension $< n$, and replace the lift over that whole set by the inductively constructed one. The dimension bound on a boundary alone is not the construction of an everywhere partially differentiable lift.

Let $F : \boldsymbol{U} \longrightarrow \boldsymbol{V}$ be an RV$[k]$-morphism, where $\boldsymbol{U} = (U, f)$ and $\boldsymbol{V} = (V, g)$. If $F^\sharp : \mathbb{L}\boldsymbol{U} \longrightarrow \mathbb{L}\boldsymbol{V}$ is a definable bijection that rv-contracts to the function $U_f \longrightarrow V_g$ induced by F (recall Notation 3.21) then it is called a *lift* of F. We shall also think of the finite-to-finite correspondence $F^\dagger$ as the rv-contraction of such a lift.

Lemma 6.31 ([8, Lemma 6.3])**.** *There is a lift $F^\sharp$ of F such that*

$$\mathrm{val}(\mathrm{Jcb}_{\mathrm{VF}}\, F^\sharp(a,u)) = \mathrm{Jcb}_\Gamma\, F^\dagger(u), \quad \text{for all } (a,u) \in \mathbb{L}\boldsymbol{U}. \tag{6.1}$$

See [17, Corollary 7.7] for an alternative proof (the weaker qualifier "for almost all $(a,u) \in \mathbb{L}\boldsymbol{U}$" there may be upgraded to "for all $(a,u) \in \mathbb{L}\boldsymbol{U}$" here by appealing to Lemma 2.35 at suitable places).

Remark 6.32. Let $t, s \in \mathrm{RV}$ such that the RV-discs $t^\sharp$, $s^\sharp$ contain definable points. It is easy to see that for any definable $c \in \mathrm{VF}^\times$ with $\mathrm{val}(c) = \mathrm{vrv}(s/t)$, there is a definable bijection $f : t^\sharp \longrightarrow s^\sharp$ such that $\frac{d}{dx} f = c$.

Lemma 6.33. *Every μRV$[k]$-morphism $F : (\boldsymbol{U}, \omega) \longrightarrow (\boldsymbol{V}, \sigma)$ admits a lift*

$$F^\sharp : \mu\mathbb{L}(\boldsymbol{U}, \omega) \longrightarrow \mu\mathbb{L}(\boldsymbol{V}, \sigma)$$

that is piecewise a composition of partially differentiable relatively unary μVF$[k]$-morphisms. Moreover, if F is a $\mu\mathrm{RV}^{\mathrm{dp}}[k]$-morphism then every component of the composition is a proper covariant homeomorphism and hence so is $F^\sharp$.

Proof. We do induction on $\dim_{\mathrm{RV}}(U) = n$. For the base case $n = 0$, we may assume that U is just a singleton and F is relatively unary. Since every RV-disc $t^\sharp$ involved contains a t-definable point, it is easy to lift F as desired by applying Remark 6.32 in the coordinate in question.

For the inductive step, again, we may assume that $f' = \mathrm{pr}_{\leq n} \circ f$, $g' = \mathrm{pr}_{\leq n} \circ g$ are finite-to-one. Write $\boldsymbol{U}' = (U, f')$ and $\boldsymbol{V}' = (V, g')$. By Lemma 6.30, there is a definable partially differentiable finitary function that rv-contracts to the finitary function $f(U)_{\leq n} \longrightarrow \mathcal{P}(f(U)_{>n})$. This means that the obvious μRV$[k]$-morphism $(\boldsymbol{U}, \omega) \longrightarrow (\boldsymbol{U}' \times 1, \omega')$ can be lifted as desired by applying Remark 6.32 fiberwise as in the base case above, and similarly for the obvious μRV$[k]$-morphism $(\boldsymbol{V}' \times 1, \sigma') \longrightarrow (\boldsymbol{V}, \sigma)$. Thus we are reduced to the case $n = k$. By Lemma 6.29, we may assume that F is relative unary. Then, applying Lemma 6.31 fiberwise in the obvious way, we can lift F to a relatively unary bijection. By Lemmas 2.38 and 2.35, the lift is partially differentiable outside a definable subset of RV-dimension less than k, and the restriction is indeed a μVF$[k]$-morphism due to the condition (6.1). So we are done by the inductive hypothesis.

The second claim is a consequence of Lemmas 6.7, 6.8, and 6.9.

Referee R116 [Gap; revised] – The continuous lifting conclusion needs an additional check. *Original source line 2373.* The preceding construction establishes partial differentiability, whereas the cited covariance/homeomorphism lemmas require continuity as an input. Partial differentiability does not imply continuity, as the example at the standard-contraction setup shows. In the generic lifting step also remove the RV-hull of the noncontinuity locus, using Lemma 2.36 together with Lemma 2.35; formulate the induction so that it constructs continuous branches as well. For the finitary center functions, do this uniformly for all the finitely many RV-indexed branches: the projection of their bad locus to VF still has dimension $< n$, so its whole RV-hull is indexed by an RV set of dimension $< n$. The resulting pieces are whole RV-pullbacks, hence clopen, and their continuous lifts glue. Check these center functions when forming the triangular corrections as well. Also change "relative unary" in the preceding paragraph to "relatively unary". This is a proposed completion of the proof, not a counterexample to the lifting statement.

□

Definition 6.34. The subcategory $\mu\mathrm{VF}^{\diamond}[k]$ of $\mu\mathrm{VF}[k]$ consists of the proper invariant objects and the morphisms that are compositions of relatively unary proper covariant homeomorphisms.

Remark 6.35. Obviously the composition law holds in $\mu\mathrm{VF}^{\diamond}[k]$ and hence it is indeed a category. Moreover, every morphism in it is an honest bijection, as opposed to merely an essential bijection, and is in effect required to admit an inverse. Thus, $\mu\mathrm{VF}^{\diamond}[k]$ is already a groupoid and there is no need to pass to a quotient category as in Remark 3.7. On the other hand, Proposition 6.19, Lemma 6.14, and Remark 6.28 give various constructions of nontrivial morphisms.

Remark 6.36. The main reason that we need the lift in Lemma 6.33 to be in that particular form is that, as it will become clear, we are forced to work with explicit compositions of relatively unary proper covariant morphisms, due to the failure of generalizing Lemma 6.38 below to higher dimensions; see [18, § 1] for further explanation.

Every definable bijection between definable sets with the same number of VF-coordinates is a composition of relatively unary bijections, see [18, Lemma 5.6]. It is certainly more satisfying to simply take proper covariant homeomorphisms as morphisms in $\mu\mathrm{VF}^{\diamond}[k]$ and then show that they are all indeed compositions of relatively unary proper covariant homeomorphisms. We suspect this is not true, although it does not seem straightforward to come up with a counterexample.

Corollary 6.37. *The lifting maps $\mu\mathbb{L}_k$ induce surjective homomorphisms, which are often simply denoted by $\mu\mathbb{L}$, between the Grothendieck semigroups*

$$\mathbf{K}_+\,\mu\mathrm{RV}^{\mathrm{db}}[k] \twoheadrightarrow \mathbf{K}_+\,\mu\mathrm{VF}^{\diamond}[k].$$

Proof. By Lemma 6.33, every $\mu\mathrm{RV}^{\mathrm{db}}[k]$-morphism can be lifted to a $\mu\mathrm{VF}^{\diamond}[k]$-morphism. Thus, $\mu\mathbb{L}_k$ induces a map on the isomorphism classes, which is easily seen to be a semigroup homomorphism. By Lemma 6.21 (see the remark thereafter) or Remark 6.28, this homomorphism is surjective. □

Lemma 6.38. *Let $f : (A, \omega) \longrightarrow (B, \sigma)$ be a $\mu\mathrm{VF}^{\diamond}[1]$-morphism. Then there are special covariant bijections $T_A : A \longrightarrow A^{\flat}$, $T_B : B \longrightarrow B^{\flat}$ such that $A^{\flat}$, $B^{\flat}$ are doubly bounded* RV*-pullbacks and the functions $f^{\flat}$, $f^{\flat}_{\downarrow}$ are bijective in the diagram*

$$\begin{array}{ccccc} A & \xrightarrow{T_A} & A^{\flat} & \xrightarrow{\mathrm{rv}} & \mathrm{rv}(A^{\flat}) \\ {\scriptstyle f}\downarrow & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle f^{\flat}} & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle f^{\flat}_{\downarrow}} \\ B & \xrightarrow[T_B]{} & B^{\flat} & \xrightarrow[\mathrm{rv}]{} & \mathrm{rv}(B^{\flat}) \end{array}$$

where the second square commutes (but not necessarily the first one, although it fails at only finitely many points). Moreover, $\omega' = \omega \circ T_A^{-1}$ *and* $\sigma' = \sigma \circ T_B^{-1}$ *are both* rv*-contractible, and* $f^\flat_\downarrow$ *is a* $\mu\mathrm{RV}^{\mathrm{db}}[1]$*-morphism* $(\mathrm{rv}(A^\flat), \omega')_1 \longrightarrow (\mathrm{rv}(B^\flat), \sigma')_1$ *(recall Notation 3.9).*

Proof. This is a variation of [18, Lemma 5.2] adapted to the current environment and can be established by modifying two special bijections T'_A, T'_B as constructed in the proof thereof as follows.

By Lemma 6.21, we may assume that A, B are doubly bounded RV-pullbacks and ω, σ are already rv-contractible. By Lemmas 2.13 and 3.3, each focus map in T'_A consists of an algebraic set of focus points, similarly for the focus maps in T'_B. We think of these focus points as contained in A, B. Each one of the focus maps may produce 0 in the VF-coordinate in the resulting set, but this is not allowed in a special covariant bijection. To remedy this, we choose pairwise disjoint open discs of sufficiently large definable radii such that each of them contains exactly one focus point and the volume forms ω, σ are constant on them. By the construction in the proof of [18, Lemma 5.2], f has the disc-to-disc property outside these open discs. Inside these discs, by Lemma 2.51, the radii may be chosen so that f is weakly concentric at the focus points. In particular, since $f^\flat$ rv-contracts to a bijection, these open discs can be paired up via the induced bijection in question. At this point it is not hard to see how to modify T'_A, T'_B according to the second clause of (CT). The first claim follows. For the second claim, since the volume forms ω', σ' are rv-contractible, we can use the disc-to-disc property (or weak concentricity for the exceptional discs) to gauge the difference of the radii of the RV-discs in question against the constant valuation of the differentials, and this shows that ω', σ' do match under $f^\flat_\downarrow$ in the required sense. □

Referee R117 [Gap] – Record the radius and volume compatibility in the unary matching.
Original source line 2420. The final volume comparison should be written explicitly. For each pair of matched RV-discs $\mathfrak{p}, \mathfrak{q}$, prove

$$\omega'(\mathfrak{p}) - \sigma'(\mathfrak{q}) = \mathrm{rad}(\mathfrak{q}) - \mathrm{rad}(\mathfrak{p}) = \mathrm{val}(f'(a))$$

at a generic point a of the corresponding original source disc. The first equality is exactly the required Γ-Jacobian identity. For the exceptional discs this requires choosing paired aperture radii compatibly with the weakly concentric image, rather than choosing the radii independently. Also distinguish the already constructed conjugation using T'_A, T'_B from the desired modified $f^\flat$ in the sentence "since $f^\flat$ RV-contracts to a bijection"; as written this uses the intended conclusion before defining the modification. Give the finite-point adjustment explicitly and verify that it does not change the constant volume forms.

7. Integrating proper invariant sets

7.1. **Annular blowups.** Recall that we write RV to mean the RV-sort without the element ∞, and RV_∞ otherwise, although quite often the difference is immaterial and it does not matter which set RV stands for. In the definition below, this difference does matter, in particular, $\mathrm{RV}^{\circ\circ}$ denotes the set $\mathrm{rv}(\mathcal{M} \smallsetminus 0)$.

Notation 7.1. Recall from Notation 2.5 that the set $\mathrm{rv}(\mathcal{M}_\gamma \smallsetminus 0)$ is denoted by $\mathrm{RV}^{\circ\circ}_\gamma$. For $\gamma \in \Gamma^+$ and $t \in \gamma^\sharp$, write

$$\mathrm{RV}^{\circ\circ}(t)_\gamma = (\mathrm{RV}^{\circ\circ} \smallsetminus \mathrm{RV}^{\circ\circ}_\gamma) \uplus t;$$

if $\gamma = \infty$ then $\mathrm{RV}^{\circ\circ}(t)_\gamma = \mathrm{RV}^{\circ\circ}_\infty$ and if $\gamma = 0$ then $\mathrm{RV}^{\circ\circ}(1)_\gamma = 1 \in \mathrm{RV}$.

Referee R118 [Typo; revised] – Zero aperture not fully defined.
Original source line 2433. The next definition permits any definable t with $\mathrm{vrv}(t) = 0$, whereas the zero-aperture convention here specifies only $t = 1$. Either set $\mathrm{RV}^{\circ\circ}(t)_0 = t$ for every such t, or require $t = 1$ at aperture zero. The singleton notation itself is legitimate under Notation 2.1.

Definition 7.2. Let $\boldsymbol{U} = (U, f, \omega)$ be an object of $\mu\mathrm{RV}[k]$, where $k > 0$, such that the function $\mathrm{pr}_{\tilde{j}} \restriction f(U)$ is finite-to-one for some $j \in [k]$. Write $f = (f_1, \ldots, f_k)$. Let $t \in \mathrm{RV}_\infty$ be a definable element with $\tau = \mathrm{vrv}(t)$ nonnegative. An *elementary annular blowup* of $\boldsymbol{U}$ in the jth coordinate of *aperture* (τ, t) is the triple $\boldsymbol{U}^\flat = (U^\flat, f^\flat, \omega^\flat)$, where $U^\flat = U \times \mathrm{RV}^{\circ\circ}(t)_\tau$ and for every $(u, s) \in U^\flat$,

$$f_i^\flat(u, s) = f_i(u) \text{ for } i \neq j, \quad f_j^\flat(u, s) = s f_j(u), \quad \omega^\flat(u, s) = \omega(u).$$

Referee R119 [Error] – Infinite aperture leaves the stated category.
Original source line 2445. Restrict the annular construction used below to $t \in \mathrm{RV}$ and finite $\tau \geq 0$. As written, $t = \infty$ is allowed, but $\mathrm{RV}^{\circ\circ}(\infty)_\infty = \mathrm{rv}(\mathcal{M})$ contains ∞; consequently $f^\flat$ takes an ∞-value and is not a map into RV^k, as required in Definition 3.8. Its nonzero part also has unbounded valuation, contradicting the next assertion about $\mu\mathrm{RV}^{\mathrm{db}}[k]$. The infinite-aperture comparison with ordinary blowups should be stated separately, with its different grading convention.

Let $\boldsymbol{V} = (V, g, \sigma)$ be another object of $\mu\mathrm{RV}[k]$ and $C_i \subseteq V$ finitely many pairwise disjoint definable sets. Each triple

$$\boldsymbol{C}_i = (C_i, g \restriction C_i, \sigma \restriction C_i) \in \mu\mathrm{RV}[k]$$

is referred to as a *subobject* of $\boldsymbol{V}$. Suppose that $F_i : \boldsymbol{U}_i \longrightarrow \boldsymbol{C}_i$ is a $\mu\mathrm{RV}[k]$-morphism and $\boldsymbol{U}_i^\flat$ is an elementary annular blowup of $\boldsymbol{U}_i$. Let $C = \bigcup_i C_i$, $\boldsymbol{C} = \bigcup_i \boldsymbol{C}_i$, and $F = \biguplus_i F_i$. Then the object $(\boldsymbol{V} \smallsetminus \boldsymbol{C}) \uplus \biguplus_i \boldsymbol{U}_i^\flat$ is an *annular blowup of $\boldsymbol{V}$ via F*, denoted by $\boldsymbol{V}_F^\flat$. The subscript F is usually dropped. The object $\boldsymbol{C}$ (or the set C) is referred to as the *locus* of $\boldsymbol{V}_F^\flat$.

An *annular blowup of length n* is a composition of n annular blowups.

Remark 7.3. An elementary annular blowup could be an elementary blowup (see [18, Definition 6.1]) if the aperture is allowed to be (∞, ∞). If there is an elementary annular blowup of $\boldsymbol{U}$ then, *a posteriori*, $\dim_{\mathrm{RV}}(U) < k$. For any coordinate of $f(U)$, there is at most one elementary blowup of $\boldsymbol{U}$, whereas there could be many annular elementary blowups of $\boldsymbol{U}$. We should have included the coordinate that is blown up as a part of the data. However, in context, either this is clear or it does not need to be spelled out, and we shall suppress mention of it for ease of notation.

Remark 7.4. Clearly if $\boldsymbol{U} \in \mu\mathrm{RV}^{\mathrm{db}}[k]$ then $\boldsymbol{U}^\flat \in \mu\mathrm{RV}^{\mathrm{db}}[k]$ too. We shall only consider annular blowups in $\mu\mathrm{RV}^{\mathrm{db}}[k]$ (then, for simplicity, they will just be referred to as blowups). This notion is dual to that of a special covariant bijection. As a matter of fact, to make this duality precise is essentially what is left to do for the rest of our main construction.

For the next few lemmas, let $\boldsymbol{U} = (U, f, \omega)$ and $\boldsymbol{V} = (V, g, \sigma)$ be objects of $\mu\mathrm{RV}^{\mathrm{db}}[k]$.

Lemma 7.5. *Suppose that $[\boldsymbol{U}] = [\boldsymbol{V}]$ and $\boldsymbol{U}^\flat$, $\boldsymbol{V}^\flat$ are elementary blowups of $\boldsymbol{U}$, $\boldsymbol{V}$ in the kth coordinate. Then there are blowups $\boldsymbol{U}^{\flat\flat}$, $\boldsymbol{V}^{\flat\flat}$ of $\boldsymbol{U}^\flat$, $\boldsymbol{V}^\flat$ of length 1 such that $[\boldsymbol{U}^{\flat\flat}] = [\boldsymbol{V}^{\flat\flat}]$.*

Proof. Let (ρ, r), (τ, t) be the apertures of $\boldsymbol{U}^\flat$, $\boldsymbol{V}^\flat$, respectively. If $\rho = \tau$ then clearly any morphism $\boldsymbol{U} \longrightarrow \boldsymbol{V}$ induces a morphism $\boldsymbol{U}^\flat \longrightarrow \boldsymbol{V}^\flat$. So we may assume $\rho' := \tau - \rho > 0$. Choose a definable element $r' \in \rho'^\sharp$. Let $W = U \times r$ and $\boldsymbol{W}$ be the corresponding subobject of $\boldsymbol{U}^\flat$. Then it is easy to see that the blowup $\boldsymbol{U}^{\flat\flat}$ of $\boldsymbol{U}^\flat$ with locus $\boldsymbol{W}$ and aperture (ρ', r') is isomorphic to $\boldsymbol{V}^\flat$.

Referee R120 [Clarification; revised] – Explicit common refinement.
Original source line 2479. For completeness, the stated equal lengths can be obtained by taking an empty-locus blowup on the $\boldsymbol{V}^\flat$ side; the definition already permits this identity operation. If $\rho = \tau$, take it on both sides. When $\rho < \tau$, take $r' = t/r$. Multiply the second-stage annular parameter by r, send its distinguished endpoint to t, and use the original isomorphism on U. The total valuation in (3.2) is then preserved. This makes the short common-refinement construction explicit.

□

Corollary 7.6. *Let $F : \boldsymbol{U} \longrightarrow \boldsymbol{V}$ be a morphism and $\boldsymbol{U}^\flat$, $\boldsymbol{V}^\flat$ blowups of $\boldsymbol{U}$, $\boldsymbol{V}$ of length 1. Then there are blowups $\boldsymbol{U}^{\flat\flat}$, $\boldsymbol{V}^{\flat\flat}$ of $\boldsymbol{U}^\flat$, $\boldsymbol{V}^\flat$ of length 1 such that $[\boldsymbol{U}^{\flat\flat}] = [\boldsymbol{V}^{\flat\flat}]$.*

Proof. Let C, D be the loci of $\boldsymbol{U}^\flat$, $\boldsymbol{V}^\flat$, respectively. By Lemma 7.5, we can make the claim hold by restricting the loci of $\boldsymbol{U}^\flat$, $\boldsymbol{V}^\flat$ to $C \cap F^{-1}(D)$, $F(C) \cap D$. But in the meantime we can also blow up $\boldsymbol{U}^\flat$, $\boldsymbol{V}^\flat$ at the loci $F^{-1}(D) \smallsetminus C$, $F(C) \smallsetminus D$ using the apertures induced by those on $D \smallsetminus F(C)$, $C \smallsetminus F^{-1}(D)$, respectively. Then the resulting compounded blowups of $\boldsymbol{U}^\flat$, $\boldsymbol{V}^\flat$ of length 1 are as desired. □

This corollary also holds in $\mathrm{RV}[k]$, which is essentially the only thing that the otherwise formal proof of [17, Lemma 6.5] depends on. Thus, the same proof yields the following analogue in the present context:

Referee R121 [Typo] – Wrong cited paper.
Original source line 2490. Replace `Yin:special:trans` by `Yin:int:acvf` in this citation: the common-refinement result is Lemma 6.5 of *Integration in algebraically closed valued fields* (2011). Section 6 of *Special transformations* concerns elimination of field quantifiers. This issue from the supplied human report is still present.

Lemma 7.7. *If $[\boldsymbol{U}] = [\boldsymbol{V}]$ and $\boldsymbol{U}_1$, $\boldsymbol{V}_1$ are blowups of $\boldsymbol{U}$, $\boldsymbol{V}$ of lengths m, n, respectively, then there are blowups $\boldsymbol{U}_2$, $\boldsymbol{V}_2$ of $\boldsymbol{U}_1$, $\boldsymbol{V}_1$ of lengths n, m, respectively, such that $[\boldsymbol{U}_2] = [\boldsymbol{V}_2]$.*

Corollary 7.8. *Suppose that $[\boldsymbol{U}] = [\boldsymbol{U}']$ and $[\boldsymbol{V}] = [\boldsymbol{V}']$. If there are isomorphic blowups of $\boldsymbol{U}$, $\boldsymbol{V}$ then there are isomorphic blowups of $\boldsymbol{U}'$, $\boldsymbol{V}'$.*

Definition 7.9. Let $\mu\mathrm{D}_{\mathrm{sp}}[k]$ be the set of pairs $(\boldsymbol{U}, \boldsymbol{V})$ of objects of $\mu\mathrm{RV}^{\mathrm{db}}[k]$ such that there exist isomorphic blowups $\boldsymbol{U}^\flat$, $\boldsymbol{V}^\flat$. Let $\mu\mathrm{D}_{\mathrm{sp}}[*] = \bigoplus_k \mu\mathrm{D}_{\mathrm{sp}}[k]$.

We will just write $\mu\mathrm{D}_{\mathrm{sp}}$ for all these sets when there is no danger of confusion. By Corollary 7.8, they may be regarded as binary relations on isomorphism classes.

Lemma 7.10. *$\mu\mathrm{D}_{\mathrm{sp}}[k]$ is a semigroup congruence relation and $\mu\mathrm{D}_{\mathrm{sp}}[*]$ is a semiring congruence relation.*

Proof. This is an easy consequence of Lemma 7.7 (the proof of [17, Lemma 6.8], which uses [17, Lemma 6.5], contains more details).

Referee R122 [Typo] – Same bibliographic correction.
Original source line 2511. Both references in this sentence should again use `Yin:int:acvf`; its Lemmas 6.8 and 6.5 are the congruence and common-refinement results being used.

□

Let T be a special covariant bijection on $\mathbb{L}(U, f)$. Denote the object $(\mathbb{L}(U, f)^\flat_{\mathrm{RV}})_{\leq k} \in \mathrm{RV}^{\mathrm{db}}[k]$ by $(U_T)_{\leq k}$ and the object $(U_T, \omega_T)_{\leq k} \in \mu\mathrm{RV}^{\mathrm{db}}[k]$ by $\boldsymbol{U}_T$, where $\omega_T : U_T \longrightarrow \mathrm{RV}$ is the volume form induced by ω.

Referee R123 [Typo] – Wrong codomain for the volume form.
Original source line 2516. Replace $\omega_T : U_T \longrightarrow \mathrm{RV}$ by $\omega_T : U_T \longrightarrow \Gamma$. Throughout this paper the volume forms are Γ-valued; see Definition 3.12.

Lemma 7.11. *The object $\boldsymbol{U}_T$ is isomorphic to a blowup of $\boldsymbol{U}$ of the same length as T.*

Proof. By induction on the length $\mathrm{lh}(T)$ of T and Lemma 7.7, this is immediately reduced to the case $\mathrm{lh}(T) = 1$. Without loss of generality, we may assume that the locus of T is indeed $\mathbb{L}(U, f)$. Then it is clear how to construct an (elementary) blowup of $\boldsymbol{U}$ as desired, using the aperture provided by T.

Referee R171 [Clarification; new] – Why the proposed elementary blowup is allowed.
Original source line 2523. The required finite-to-one projection condition has a short verification worth inserting. Suppose the focus is in coordinate j, fix $r \in f(U)_{\tilde{j}}$ and a representative $a \in r^\sharp$, and vary u with $f_{\tilde{j}}(u) = r$. The focus gives a definable function $u \mapsto \lambda(a, u)$ from an RV-set into VF, so its image is finite. Since $\mathrm{rv}(\lambda(a, u)) = f_j(u)$, there are only finitely many possible $f_j(u)$ over r. Thus $\mathrm{pr}_{\tilde{j}} \upharpoonright f(U)$ is finite-to-one, exactly as required by Definition 7.2. The annular parameter is then the translated leading term divided by $f_j(u)$, with the distinguished endpoint retaining its extra tag.

□

Lemma 7.12. *Let $\boldsymbol{U}^\flat$ be a blowup of $\boldsymbol{U}$. Then $\mu\mathbb{L}\boldsymbol{U}^\flat$ is isomorphic to $\mu\mathbb{L}\boldsymbol{U}$ in $\mu\mathrm{VF}^\diamond[k]$.*

Proof. By induction on the length l of $\boldsymbol{U}^\flat$, this is immediately reduced to the case $l = 1$. We may assume that $\boldsymbol{U}^\flat$ is an elementary blowup in the first coordinate. Let (τ, t) be the aperture of $\boldsymbol{U}^\flat$. Fix a definable point $c \in t^\sharp$. For $u \in U$ and $a \in f(u)_1^\sharp$, every RV-disc in $f(u)_1^\sharp$ contains an a-algebraic point b_a; moreover, by Lemma 6.30, these points may be chosen uniformly via a partially differentiable finitary function. Thus, there is a continuous (fiberwise) additive translation, with respect to the points b_a and $b_a - cb_a$, between the two sets in question, which is a $\mu\mathrm{VF}^\diamond[k]$-morphism by Lemmas 6.7 and 6.8.

Referee R124 [Clarification; revised] – Specify the lift and its tags.
Original source line 2532. Write the chosen center as $b = b(a, u) \in f_1(u)^\sharp$; the phrase "every RV-disc in $f(u)_1^\sharp$" should simply refer to this disc. The lift can be written explicitly: send x to $x - b$ when $\mathrm{val}(x-b) \leq \mathrm{val}(b)+\tau$, and to $x-b+cb$ otherwise. The latter branch fills the extra copy of $(tf_1(u))^\sharp$; retain the two tags as already stipulated in Definition 6.11. On each branch this is a triangular translation of Jacobian 1. To justify the asserted continuity, use the strengthened version of Lemma 6.30 with continuous as well as partially differentiable center branches (see the remark at that lemma). This supplies the input needed for Lemmas 6.7 and 6.8.

□

Lemma 7.13. *Let $[\boldsymbol{A}] = [\boldsymbol{B}]$ in $\mathbf{K}_+\,\mu\mathrm{VF}^\diamond[1]$ and $\boldsymbol{U}, \boldsymbol{V} \in \mu\mathrm{RV}^{\mathrm{db}}[1]$ be standard contractions of $\boldsymbol{A}$, $\boldsymbol{B}$, respectively. Then $([\boldsymbol{U}], [\boldsymbol{V}]) \in \mu\mathrm{D}_{\mathrm{sp}}$.*

Proof. This is immediate by Lemmas 6.38 (applied to $\mu\mathbb{L}\boldsymbol{U}$, $\mu\mathbb{L}\boldsymbol{V}$) and 7.11. □

Lemma 7.14. *Let A', A'' be definable sets with $A'_{\mathrm{VF}} = A''_{\mathrm{VF}} = A \subseteq \mathrm{VF}^n$ and ω', ω'' definable functions from A', A'' into Γ, respectively. Write $\boldsymbol{A}' = (A', \omega')$ and $\boldsymbol{A}'' = (A'', \omega'')$. Suppose that $\boldsymbol{A}'$, $\boldsymbol{A}''$ are proper invariant and there is a $k \in \mathbb{N}$ such that for every $a \in A$,*

$$([(A'_a, \omega')]_{\leq k}, [(A''_a, \omega'')]_{\leq k}) \in \mu\mathrm{D}_{\mathrm{sp}}. \tag{7.1}$$

Let $\hat{T}_\sigma$, $\hat{R}_\sigma$ be standard contractions of $\boldsymbol{A}'$, $\boldsymbol{A}''$, respectively. Then

$$([\hat{T}_\sigma(\boldsymbol{A}')]_{\leq n+k}, [\hat{R}_\sigma(\boldsymbol{A}'')]_{\leq n+k}) \in \mu\mathrm{D}_{\mathrm{sp}}.$$

Note that condition (7.1) makes sense only over the substructure $\mathbb{S}\langle a\rangle$.

Proof. By induction on n, this is immediately reduced to the case $n = 1$. So assume $A \subseteq \mathrm{VF}$. Using Proposition 6.19 and FMT, we can construct a special covariant bijection $F : A \longrightarrow A^\sharp$, as in the proof of [18, Lemma 6.14], such that for all RV-polydisc $\mathfrak{p} \subseteq A^\sharp$ and all $a_1, a_2 \in F^{-1}(\mathfrak{p})$,

$$\omega' \upharpoonright A'_{a_1} = \omega' \upharpoonright A'_{a_2} \quad \text{and} \quad \omega'' \upharpoonright A''_{a_1} = \omega'' \upharpoonright A''_{a_2}.$$

Therefore, using Lemma 7.13 in place of [18, Corollary 6.11], that proof goes through here with virtually no changes, and the additional computations involving Jcb_Γ are all straightforward. (Also consult the proof of [21, Lemma 5.36], which is in a different environment but is formally the same and is written down with more details.)

Referee R125 [Gap; revised] – Verify the bounded version of witness constancy.
Original source line 2562. The displayed equalities, read as equalities of functions, already imply equality of the underlying RV-fibers. The cited proof of [18, Lemma 6.14] additionally makes the blowup witnesses constant on each contracted disc. Please explain how its third condition is maintained here: after FMT, the loci, finite apertures, and comparison isomorphisms must be given by data independent of $a \in F^{-1}(\mathfrak{p})$. This is what lets the fiberwise congruences descend to the contracted RV-parameters. The old proof supplies the strategy, but the proper-covariant, finite-aperture implementation is the point requiring verification.

□

Corollary 7.15. *Let $\boldsymbol{A}', \boldsymbol{A}'' \in \mu\mathrm{VF}^\diamond[n]$ and suppose that there is a morphism $F : \boldsymbol{A}' \longrightarrow \boldsymbol{A}''$ that is relatively unary in the ith* VF*-coordinate. Then for any permutation σ of $[n]$ with $\sigma(1) = i$ and any standard contractions $\hat{T}_\sigma$, $\hat{R}_\sigma$ of $\boldsymbol{A}'$, $\boldsymbol{A}''$,*

$$([\hat{T}_\sigma(\boldsymbol{A}')]_{\leq n}, [\hat{R}_\sigma(\boldsymbol{A}'')]_{\leq n}) \in \mu\mathrm{D}_{\mathrm{sp}}.$$

Proof. Note that, since F is differentiable outside a definable subset of VF-dimension less than n, it may not induce a morphism $\boldsymbol{A}'_a \longrightarrow \boldsymbol{A}''_a$ for every $a \in \mathrm{pr}_{\tilde{i}}(A)$. Nevertheless, for all sufficiently large $\delta \in \Gamma^+$, both A' and $\hat{T}_{\sigma(1)}(A')$ are δ-invariant. This means that for all $a \in \mathrm{pr}_{\tilde{i}}(A)$ there is a $b \in \mathrm{pr}_{\tilde{i}}(A)$ such that they are contained in the same open polydisc of radius δ, and F indeed induces a morphism $\boldsymbol{A}'_b \longrightarrow \boldsymbol{A}''_b$, and $\hat{T}_{\sigma(1)}(A')_a = \hat{T}_{\sigma(1)}(A')_b$. Thus, the claim follows immediately from Lemmas 7.13 and 7.14.

Referee R126 [Gap; revised] – Use a common radius on both sides.
Original source line 2573. Here A has not been defined; use the common base $\mathrm{pr}_{\tilde{i}}(A') = \mathrm{pr}_{\tilde{i}}(A'')$. Choose δ for both first-stage contracted pairs, including their induced volume forms, and for $\boldsymbol{A}'$ and $\boldsymbol{A}''$. Let the bad set include failures of differentiability and of the measure identity. The parameters with a positive-dimensional bad unary fiber have dimension at most $n-2$, so every open base polydisc contains a good b. The two contracted fibers at a and b then agree on both sides, and the unary kernel lemma applies at b. These additions supply the claimed reduction; invariance of the first side alone is insufficient.

□

7.2. 2-cells.

Definition 7.16 (val-affine and rv-affine)**.** Let $\mathfrak{a}$ be an open disc and $f : \mathfrak{a} \longrightarrow \mathrm{VF}$ an injection. We say that f is val-*affine* if there is a (necessarily unique) $\gamma \in \Gamma$, called the *shift* of f, such that, for all $a, a' \in \mathfrak{a}$,

$$\mathrm{val}(f(a) - f(a')) = \gamma + \mathrm{val}(a - a').$$

We say that f is rv-*affine* if there is a (necessarily unique) $t \in \mathrm{RV}$, called the *slope* of f, such that, for all $a, a' \in \mathfrak{a}$,

$$\mathrm{rv}(f(a) - f(a')) = t\,\mathrm{rv}(a - a').$$

Definition 7.17. Let $A \subseteq \mathrm{VF}^2$ be a definable set such that $\mathfrak{a}_1 := \mathrm{pr}_1(A)$ and $\mathfrak{a}_2 := \mathrm{pr}_2(A)$ are both open discs. Let $f : \mathfrak{a}_1 \longrightarrow \mathfrak{a}_2$ be a definable bijection that has the disc-to-disc property. We say that f is *balanced in A* if f is actually rv-affine and there are $t_1, t_2 \in \mathrm{RV}_\infty$, called the *paradigms* of f, such that, for every $a \in \mathfrak{a}_1$,

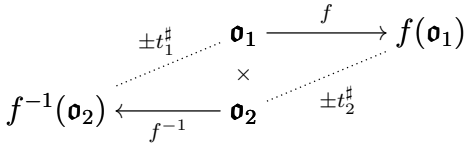
$$A_a = t_2^\sharp + f(a) \quad \text{and} \quad f^{-1}(A_a) = a - t_1^\sharp.$$

Remark 7.18. Suppose that f is balanced in A with paradigms t_1, t_2. If one of the paradigms is ∞ then the other one must be ∞. In this case A is just the (graph of the) bijection f itself.

Assume that t_1, t_2 are not ∞. Let $\mathfrak{B}_1$, $\mathfrak{B}_2$ be the sets of closed subdiscs of $\mathfrak{a}_1$, $\mathfrak{a}_2$ of radii $\mathrm{vrv}(t_1)$, $\mathrm{vrv}(t_2)$, respectively. Let $a_1 \in \mathfrak{b}_1 \in \mathfrak{B}_1$ and $\mathfrak{o}_1$ be the maximal open subdisc of $\mathfrak{b}_1$ containing a_1. Let $\mathfrak{b}_2 \in \mathfrak{B}_2$ be the smallest closed disc containing the open disc $\mathfrak{o}_2 := A_{a_1}$. Then, for all $a_2 \in \mathfrak{o}_2$, we have

$$\mathfrak{o}_2 = t_2^\sharp + f(\mathfrak{o}_1) = A_{a_1} \quad \text{and} \quad A_{a_2} = f^{-1}(\mathfrak{o}_2) + t_1^\sharp = \mathfrak{o}_1.$$

This internal symmetry of A is illustrated by the following diagram:



Since f is rv-affine, we see that its slope must be $-t_2/t_1$.

Let $\mathrm{Tor}(\ulcorner \mathfrak{b}_1 \urcorner)$, $\mathrm{Tor}(\ulcorner \mathfrak{b}_1 \urcorner)$ denote the sets of the maximal open subdiscs of $\mathfrak{b}_1$, $\mathfrak{b}_1$. These may be viewed as $\Bbbk$-torsors and as such are equipped with much of the structure of $\Bbbk$. Then the set $A \cap (\mathfrak{b}_1 \times \mathfrak{b}_2)$ may be thought of as the "line" in $\mathrm{Tor}(\ulcorner \mathfrak{b}_1 \urcorner) \times \mathrm{Tor}(\ulcorner \mathfrak{b}_2 \urcorner)$ given by the equation

Referee R127 [Typo] – Repeated ball index.
Original source line 2614. In the opening sentence, the second $\mathrm{Tor}(\ulcorner \mathfrak{b}_1 \urcorner)$ should be $\mathrm{Tor}(\ulcorner \mathfrak{b}_2 \urcorner)$, and the second $\mathfrak{b}_1$ should likewise be $\mathfrak{b}_2$. The same typographical correction was requested in the supplied human report.

$$x_2 = -\tfrac{t_2}{t_1}(x_1 - \ulcorner \mathfrak{o}_1 \urcorner) + (\ulcorner \mathfrak{o}_2 \urcorner - t_2).$$

Referee R128 [Error] – Incorrect intercept of the torsor line.
Original source line 2617. The line describing A must pass through $(\ulcorner \mathfrak{o}_1 \urcorner, \ulcorner \mathfrak{o}_2 \urcorner)$. The displayed formula instead gives $\ulcorner \mathfrak{o}_2 \urcorner - t_2$ at $x_1 = \ulcorner \mathfrak{o}_1 \urcorner$. Remove the term $-t_2$: the required equation is $x_2 = -(t_2/t_1)(x_1 - \ulcorner \mathfrak{o}_1 \urcorner) + \ulcorner \mathfrak{o}_2 \urcorner$. The printed equation describes the induced graph of f, before translation by t_2. For example, when $f = \mathrm{id}$ and $A = \{(x, y) : \mathrm{rv}(y - x) = t_2\}$ on a suitable pair of discs, the required residue line is $y = x + t_2$, not the diagonal.

Thus, by Lemma 6.38, the obvious bijection between $A_1 \times t_2^\sharp$ and $t_1^\sharp \times A_2$ is the lift of an $\mathrm{RV}^{\mathrm{db}}[2]$-morphism modulo special covariant bijections; see Lemma 7.21 below for details.

Definition 7.19. We say that a set A is a *1-cell* if it is either an open disc contained in a single RV-disc or a point in VF. We say that A is a *2-cell* if

- A is a subset of VF^2 contained in a single RV-polydisc and A_1 is a 1-cell,
- there is a function $\epsilon : A_1 \longrightarrow \mathrm{VF}$ and a $t \in \mathrm{RV}$ such that, for every $a \in A_1$, $A_a = t^\sharp + \epsilon(a)$,
- one of the following three possibilities occurs:
  - ϵ is constant,
  - ϵ is injective, has the disc-to-disc property, and $\mathrm{rad}(\epsilon(A_1)) \geq \mathrm{vrv}(t)$,
  - ϵ is balanced in A.

The function ϵ is called the *positioning function* of A and the element t the *paradigm* of A.

More generally, a set A with exactly one VF-coordinate is a *1-cell* if, for each $t \in A_{\mathrm{RV}}$, A_t is a 1-cell in the above sense; the parameterized version of the notion of a 2-cell is formulated in the same way.

Lemma 7.20. *Let $A \subseteq \mathrm{VF}^2$ be a proper invariant set. Then there is a standard contraction $\hat{T}_\sigma$ of A such that A_s is a 2-cell for every $s \in \hat{T}_\sigma(A)$.*

Proof. This is a variation of [18, Lemma 4.8]. The proof of the latter proceeds by constructing a positioning function $\epsilon_{(t,s)}$ in each VF-fiber, which heavily relies on the use of standard contractions in the preceding auxiliary results, namely [18, Lemmas 4.2, 4.4]. It still goes through here, provided that FMT is applied at suitable places to cut out finitely many exceptional open discs in the first coordinate at which the desired properties of $\epsilon_{(t,s)}$ do not hold, as we have done above, say, in the proof of Proposition 6.19.

Referee R130 [Gap] – The cited cell lemma has a weaker affine condition.
Original source line 2643. The cited proof produces a val-affine positioning function, whereas Definition 7.17 now requires an rv-affine one. The implication is not automatic: for definable $\delta > 0$, the bijection of $\mathcal{M}$ given by $x \mapsto 2x$ when $\mathrm{val}(x) \geq \delta$ and $x \mapsto x$ otherwise preserves all valuations of differences but has no single RV-slope. Please supply the refinement or replacement of the positioning functions that gives the stronger condition, and verify that the fibers, paradigms, and proper covariance are preserved. Identifying the exceptional discs and explaining the FMT modification is necessary here; the older lemma plus the phrase *at suitable places* does not supply this new step. An economical alternative, if only the Γ-Jacobian computation is used, is to retain the older val-affine definition and replace the assertions about a single RV-slope and a torsor line by the corresponding valuation-shift statement.

□

We also remark that Lemma 7.20 holds fiberwise for proper invariant sets $A \subseteq \mathrm{VF}^n$ with $n \geq 2$, that is, there is a standard contraction $\hat{T}_\sigma$ of A such that for every $(a, s) \in \hat{T}_{\sigma(2)}(A)$, $\hat{T}^{-1}_{\sigma(2)}(a, s)$ is of the form $a \times C$, where C is a 2-cell. This follows from Lemma 7.20 and the argument in the proof of Lemma 6.27 (Lemma 7.20 serves as the base case and hence, in the inductive step, we can assume that $\hat{T}_{\sigma(2)}$ is already as desired fiberwise).

Referee R131 [Clarification; revised] – Cumulative-contraction notation.
Original source line 2646. For clarity, specify that $\hat{T}_{\sigma(2)}$ here denotes the cumulative contraction of the first two coordinates. With the stage-map notation of the definition, write $P = \hat{T}_{\sigma(2)} \circ \hat{T}_{\sigma(1)}$ and use $P(A)$ and $P^{-1}(a, s)$. This is only a notation clarification.

For the next two lemmas, let 12, 21 denote the permutations of [2] and $\boldsymbol{A} = (A, \omega) \in \mu\mathrm{VF}^{\diamond}[2]$.

Lemma 7.21. *Suppose that $A \subseteq \mathrm{VF}^2$ is a 2-cell and ω is constant. Then there are standard contractions $\hat{T}_{12}$, $\hat{R}_{21}$ of $\boldsymbol{A}$ such that $[\hat{T}_{12}(\boldsymbol{A})]_{\leq 2} = [\hat{R}_{21}(\boldsymbol{A})]_{\leq 2}$.*

Proof. All we need to do is to check that the maps constructed in the proof of [18, Lemma 5.7] are indeed $\mu\mathrm{RV}^{\mathrm{dp}}[2]$-morphisms. By inspection of that proof, we see that there are two cases: A is a product of two open discs or the positioning function ϵ in question is balanced in A with nonzero paradigms t_1, t_2. The first case is obvious since we can simply use the identity map. In the second case, a morphism between the standard contractions can be easily constructed using ϵ (we could also cite Lemma 6.38, but the situation here is much simpler), and the requirement on Jcb_Γ is satisfied since the slope of the rv-affine function ϵ is $-t_2/t_1$ (see the last paragraph of Remark 7.18 for further explanation).

Referee R132 [Clarification; revised] – Explicit balanced-cell comparison.
Original source line 2656. Here is an explicit completion of the Jacobian check. Put $\gamma = \mathrm{vrv}(t_2) - \mathrm{vrv}(t_1)$. For order 12, first use $(x, y) \mapsto (x - \epsilon^{-1}(y), y)$, whose image is $t_1^\sharp \times A_2$; for order 21, use $(x, y) \mapsto (x, y - \epsilon(x))$, whose image is $A_1 \times t_2^\sharp$. The translated coordinates have the fixed leading terms t_1, t_2, so finite apertures chosen strictly beyond their radii make the exceptional CT clause unnecessary on these sets. Apply Lemma 6.38 to ϵ with constant volume forms 0 on A_1 and $-\gamma$ on A_2. It gives compatible unary contractions and an RV-map ψ with $\mathrm{Jcb}_\Gamma \psi = \gamma$. Keeping all auxiliary tags, the map $(u, t_2) \mapsto (t_1, \psi(u))$ between the product contractions has Γ-Jacobian $\gamma + \mathrm{vrv}(t_1) - \mathrm{vrv}(t_2) = 0$. This proves the desired measure comparison, conditional on that unary lemma. The same calculation uses only the valuation-affine shift, so it also supports the weaker-definition alternative mentioned above.

□

Lemma 7.22. *There are a morphism $\boldsymbol{A} \longrightarrow \boldsymbol{A}^*$, relatively unary in both coordinates, and two standard contractions $\hat{T}_{12}$, $\hat{R}_{21}$ of $\boldsymbol{A}^*$ such that $[\hat{T}_{12}(\boldsymbol{A}^*)]_{\leq 2} = [\hat{R}_{21}(\boldsymbol{A}^*)]_{\leq 2}$.*

Proof. This follows from Lemmas 7.20, 7.21, and compactness (see the proof of [18, Corollary 5.8] for a bit more details).

Referee R133 [Gap; revised] – Apply the available volume-form preparation.
Original source line 2663. Please spell out the preparation of ω and the definition of $\boldsymbol{A}^*$. Lemma 7.21 assumes a constant form on each cell. The preparation tools in Remark 6.20, Lemma 6.21, and Remark 6.28 are relevant: arrange proper covariant RV-data through which ω factors, and carry these data through the cell construction. Then A^* is the graph of the resulting cell-parameter map, with the transported volume form. Verify that these parameters have proper invariant fibers and doubly bounded range, so the parameter-adjoining map and its inverse are proper covariant. This is the additional check needed to turn the cited ordinary cell partition into a morphism in the present category.

□

Lemma 7.23. *Let $\boldsymbol{A} = (A, \omega) \in \mu\mathrm{VF}^\diamond[n]$. Let $i, j \in [n]$ with $i \neq j$ and σ_1, σ_2 be permutations of $[n]$ such that*

$$\sigma_1(1) = \sigma_2(2) = i, \quad \sigma_1(2) = \sigma_2(1) = j, \quad \sigma_1 \restriction \{3, \dots, n\} = \sigma_2 \restriction \{3, \dots, n\}.$$

Then, for any standard contractions $\hat{T}_{\sigma_1}$, $\hat{T}_{\sigma_2}$ of $\boldsymbol{A}$,

$$([\hat{T}_{\sigma_1}(\boldsymbol{A})]_{\leq n}, [\hat{T}_{\sigma_2}(\boldsymbol{A})]_{\leq n}) \in \mu\mathrm{D}_{\mathrm{sp}}.$$

Proof. Let ij, ji denote the permutations of $\{i, j\}$ and $E = [n] \smallsetminus \{i, j\}$. By compactness and Lemma 7.14, it is enough to show that for all $a \in A_E$ and all standard contractions $\hat{T}_{ij}$, $\hat{T}_{ji}$ of $\boldsymbol{A}_a = (A_a, \omega \restriction A_a)$,

$$([\hat{T}_{ij}(\boldsymbol{A}_a)]_{\leq 2}, [\hat{T}_{ji}(\boldsymbol{A}_a)]_{\leq 2}) \in \mu\mathrm{D}_{\mathrm{sp}}.$$

By Corollary 7.15 and Lemma 7.14, it is enough to find a morphism $\boldsymbol{A}_a \longrightarrow \boldsymbol{B}$, relatively unary in both coordinates, and standard contractions $\hat{R}_{ij}$, $\hat{R}_{ji}$ of $\boldsymbol{B}$ such that $[\hat{R}_{ij}(\boldsymbol{B})]_{\leq 2} = [\hat{R}_{ji}(\boldsymbol{B})]_{\leq 2}$. This is just Lemma 7.22. □

7.3. **The kernel of $\mu\mathbb{L}$ and the bounded integral.** The following proposition is the culmination of the preceding technicalities, it identifies the congruence relation $\mu\mathrm{D}_{\mathrm{sp}}$ with that induced by $\mu\mathbb{L}$.

Proposition 7.24. *For $\boldsymbol{U}, \boldsymbol{V} \in \mu\mathrm{RV}^{\mathrm{db}}[k]$,*

$$[\mu\mathbb{L}\boldsymbol{U}] = [\mu\mathbb{L}\boldsymbol{V}] \text{ in } \mathbf{K}_+\,\mu\mathrm{VF}^\diamond[k] \quad \text{if and only if} \quad ([\boldsymbol{U}], [\boldsymbol{V}]) \in \mu\mathrm{D}_{\mathrm{sp}}.$$

Proof. The "if" direction simply follows from Lemma 7.12 and Corollary 6.37.

For the "only if" direction, we proceed by induction on k. The base case $k = 1$ is of course Lemma 7.13. For the inductive step, let

$$\mu\mathbb{L}\boldsymbol{U} = \boldsymbol{B}_1 \xrightarrow{G_1} \boldsymbol{B}_2 \cdots \boldsymbol{B}_l \xrightarrow{G_l} \boldsymbol{B}_{l+1} = \mu\mathbb{L}\boldsymbol{V}$$

be a sequence of relatively unary $\mu\mathrm{VF}^{\diamond}[k]$-morphisms, which exist by definition. For each $j \leq l-2$, we can choose five standard contractions

$$[\boldsymbol{U}_j]_{\leq k}, \quad [\boldsymbol{U}_{j+1}]_{\leq k}, \quad [\boldsymbol{U}'_{j+1}]_{\leq k}, \quad [\boldsymbol{U}''_{j+1}]_{\leq k}, \quad [\boldsymbol{U}_{j+2}]_{\leq k}$$

of $\boldsymbol{B}_j$, $\boldsymbol{B}_{j+1}$, $\boldsymbol{B}_{j+1}$, $\boldsymbol{B}_{j+1}$, $\boldsymbol{B}_{j+2}$ with the permutations σ_j, σ_{j+1}, σ'_{j+1}, σ''_{j+1}, σ_{j+2} of $[k]$, respectively, such that

- $\sigma_{j+1}(1)$ and $\sigma_{j+1}(2)$ are the VF-coordinates targeted by G_j and G_{j+1}, respectively,
- $\sigma''_{j+1}(1)$ and $\sigma''_{j+1}(2)$ are the VF-coordinates targeted by G_{j+1} and G_{j+2}, respectively,
- $\sigma_j = \sigma_{j+1}$, $\sigma''_{j+1} = \sigma_{j+2}$, and $\sigma'_{j+1}(1) = \sigma''_{j+1}(1)$,
- the relation between σ_{j+1} and σ'_{j+1} is as described in Lemma 7.23.

Referee R134 [Error] – Incomplete chain and impossible permutation choices.
Original source line 2720. Two bookkeeping repairs are required. First, consecutive relatively unary maps can target the same coordinate; then the first or second bullet would assign the same value to positions 1 and 2 of a permutation. Compose such consecutive maps before choosing the permutations. Second, $j \leq l-2$ only connects contractions through $\boldsymbol{B}_l$, not through the last arrow to $\boldsymbol{B}_{l+1}$, and for $l = 1, 2$ there are no comparisons at all. Handle the short chains and the last arrow explicitly using Corollary 7.15, and compare the endpoint contractions with the tautological contractions of $\mu\mathbb{L}\boldsymbol{U}$ and $\mu\mathbb{L}\boldsymbol{V}$. Alternatively, first prove independence of the complete contraction order and then apply that corollary successively to all G_j. Also record the immediate degree-zero case, since the proposition and the next theorem include $k = 0$.

By Corollary 7.15 and Lemma 7.23, all the adjacent pairs of these standard contractions are indeed $\mu\mathrm{D}_{\mathrm{sp}}$-congruent, except $([\boldsymbol{U}'_{j+1}]_{\leq k}, [\boldsymbol{U}''_{j+1}]_{\leq k})$. Since we can choose $[\boldsymbol{U}'_{j+1}]_{\leq k}$, $[\boldsymbol{U}''_{j+1}]_{\leq k}$ so that they start with the same contraction in the first targeted VF-coordinate of $\boldsymbol{B}_{j+1}$, the resulting sets from this step are the same. Thus, applying the inductive hypothesis in each fiber over the just contracted coordinate, we see that this last pair is also $\mu\mathrm{D}_{\mathrm{sp}}$-congruent. This completes the "only if" direction.

Referee R135 [Gap; revised] – Induction after an RV contraction requires descent.
Original source line 2721. Make the parameter base and the final gluing explicit. The new parameter after the first contraction lies in RV, and adjoining it need not leave $\mathbb{S}$ VF-generated; the intermediate contracted object can also have positive head start. Work instead with the lifted intermediate object, fix a VF-representative a of its first leading term, and apply induction to the remaining fibers over $\mathbb{S}\langle a\rangle$. These fibers still have finite RV-fibers and degree $k-1$. To descend, form the two families $\bigcup_a a \times U_{\mathrm{rv}(a)}$ and $\bigcup_a a \times V_{\mathrm{rv}(a)}$ of the final RV-outputs (with the first leading coordinate omitted from each output). Lemma 7.14, with one VF-coordinate and head start $k-1$, then glues their fiberwise congruences; tautologically contracting a recovers the two full outputs. This repair depends on the uniform-witness step discussed at that lemma.

□

Remark 7.25. Proposition 7.24 shows that the kernel of $\mu\mathbb{L}$ in $\mathbf{K}_+\,\mu\mathrm{RV}^{\mathrm{db}}[*]$ is generated by the pairs $([1], [\mathrm{RV}^{\circ\circ}(t)_\gamma])$, where $\gamma \in \Gamma$ and $t \in \gamma^\sharp$ are definable (Notation 7.1), and hence the corresponding ideal of the graded ring $\mathbf{K}\,\mu\mathrm{RV}^{\mathrm{db}}[*]$ is $(\boldsymbol{P}_\Gamma)$ (Notation 4.13).

Referee R136 [Clarification] – Show the generator calculation and restrict the aperture.
Original source line 2725. Here γ must be nonnegative, as in Notation 7.1. The passage from arbitrary elementary blowups to these degree-one generators has a short useful verification. For a blowup in coordinate j, put $\boldsymbol{W} = (U, f_{\tilde{j}}, \omega + \mathrm{vrv}(f_j)) \in \mu\mathrm{RV}^{\mathrm{db}}[k-1]$. The measure condition gives $\boldsymbol{U} \simeq \boldsymbol{W} \times (1,0)$ and $\boldsymbol{U}^\flat \simeq \boldsymbol{W} \times (\mathrm{RV}^{\circ\circ}(t)_\gamma, 0)$. Hence $[\boldsymbol{U}^\flat] - [\boldsymbol{U}] = [\boldsymbol{W}]\boldsymbol{P}_\gamma$. This proves the claimed ideal description by additivity and iteration, once Proposition 7.24 is established.

Theorem 7.26. *For each $k \geq 0$ there is a canonical isomorphism of Grothendieck semigroups*

$$\int_+^\diamond : \mathbf{K}_+\,\mu\mathrm{VF}^\diamond[k] \longrightarrow \mathbf{K}_+\,\mu\mathrm{RV}^{\mathrm{db}}[k]/\mu\mathrm{D}_{\mathrm{sp}}$$

such that $\int_+^\diamond[\boldsymbol{A}] = [\boldsymbol{U}]/\mu\mathrm{D}_{\mathrm{sp}}$ if and only if $[\boldsymbol{A}] = [\mu\mathbb{L}\boldsymbol{U}]$. Taking the direct sum of the groupifications yields a canonical isomorphism of graded rings

$$\int^\diamond : \mathbf{K}\,\mu\mathrm{VF}^\diamond[*] \longrightarrow \mathbf{K}\,\mu\mathrm{RV}^{\mathrm{db}}[*]/(\boldsymbol{P}_\Gamma).$$

Proof. This is immediate by Corollary 6.37 and Proposition 7.24. □

Corollary 7.27. *The diagram (1.2) commutes.*

Proof. Note that, in (1.2), the first horizontal arrow is induced by the obvious forgetful functor (it exists because the morphisms in $\mu\mathrm{VF}^\diamond[*]$ are bijections instead of essential bijections, see Remark 6.35), the second horizontal arrow is induced by the subcategory relation, and the reason that the bottom row exists is given in Notation 4.13. That the upper half of the diagram commutes is then simply a consequence of the fact that image of $[\boldsymbol{A}]$ under any of the three integrals can be represented by a standard contraction of $\boldsymbol{A}$. The rest of it is just a combination of (4.8) and Proposition 4.7.

Referee R137 [Typo] – Proof refers to a deleted half of the diagram.
Original source line 2749. The current Figure 1.2 has only the two integral squares; the additional row involving retractions is commented out in the source. Replace *the upper half of the diagram* by *both squares* and delete the final sentence about *the rest*. The standard-contraction argument already proves commutativity of the entire displayed diagram. Also insert *the* in *the fact that the image*. This obsolete-diagram issue from the human report remains unresolved.

□

Remark 7.28. We may define the motivic volume operator in Notation 5.15 using $\mathbb{E}_g$ instead of $\mathbb{E}_b$ (of course $[\mathbb{A}]$ will have to be inverted, see Remark 4.4). For proper invariant objects, this only changes the image by a factor. To see this, first note that Theorem 7.26 (or rather Corollary 6.37) shows that every proper invariant object $A \in \mathrm{VF}_*$ with $\dim_{\mathrm{VF}}(A) = n$ is isomorphic to an object of the form $\mathbb{L}\boldsymbol{U}$ with $(\boldsymbol{U}, 0) \in \mu\mathrm{RV}^{\mathrm{db}}[n]$. Therefore, in light of the isomorphism $\mu\Psi$ in (3.5) and the defining conditions of $\mathbb{E}_g$, $\mathbb{E}_b$ in § 4.1, we have

$$\mathbb{E}_g\Big(\int [A]\Big) = \mathbb{E}_b\Big(\int [A]\Big)[\mathbb{A}]^{-n}. \tag{7.2}$$

8. Motivic Milnor fiber

We begin with a very brief discussion on specialization to henselian subfields. Let $\mathbb{M}$ be a VF-generated substructure. Recall that $\mathbb{S}$ is a part of the language and hence all other substructures

contain it. If $X \subseteq \mathrm{VF}^n \times \mathrm{RV}^m$ is a definable (and hence quantifier-free definable) set then the *trace* of X in $\mathbb{M}$, denoted by $X(\mathbb{M})$, is the set of $\mathbb{M}$-rational points of X, that is,

$$X(\mathbb{M}) = X \cap (\mathrm{VF}(\mathbb{M})^n \times \mathrm{RV}(\mathbb{M})^m).$$

Such a trace is also called a *constructible set* in $\mathbb{M}$ since it is indeed quantifier-free definable in $\mathbb{M}$. Note that, however, if $f : X \longrightarrow \Gamma$ is a definable function then the image $f(X(\mathbb{M}))$ is not necessarily a set in $\Gamma(\mathbb{M})$, but rather a set in the divisible hull $\mathbb{Q} \otimes \Gamma(\mathbb{M})$ of $\Gamma(\mathbb{M})$. For instance, if $\mathbb{M} = \mathbb{C}(\!(t)\!)$ then $\Gamma(\mathbb{M}) = \mathbb{Z}$ and hence $\gamma \in \Gamma$ is definable if and only if $\gamma \in \mathbb{Q} \otimes \Gamma(\mathbb{M}) = \mathbb{Q}$. On the other hand, if X is a set in Γ and f is a piecewise $\mathrm{GL}_k(\mathbb{Z})$-transformation on X with constant $\Gamma(\mathbb{M})$-terms then $f(X(\mathbb{M}))$ is of course a set in $\Gamma(\mathbb{M})$; this is the situation in the Γ-categories (see Remark 3.15).

If $\mathbb{M}$ is definably closed and $\Gamma(\mathbb{M})$ is nontrivial, or equivalently (see Lemma 2.11), the valued field $(\mathrm{VF}(\mathbb{M}), \mathcal{O}(\mathbb{M}))$ is henselian, then $\mathbb{M}$ is *functionally closed*, that is, for any definable set X and any definable function f on X, the image $f(X(\mathbb{M}))$ is a set that is definable in $\mathbb{M}$ (which then, ex post facto, is constructible in $\mathbb{M}$). This is all we need to deduce the results below.

Referee R138 [Error; revised] – Henselian definability is not quantifier-free constructibility. *Original source line 2775.* The parenthetical assertion is false, as already observed in the supplied human report. For $\mathbb{M} = \mathbb{C}(\!(t)\!)$ and $f(x) = x^2$, the image $f(\mathrm{VF}(\mathbb{M}))$ is the set of squares. It is definable in $\mathbb{M}$, but is neither the trace of the ambient image $f(\mathrm{VF}) = \mathrm{VF}$ nor quantifier-free definable in the stated language: on nonzero elements it detects parity of the valuation. Henselianity gives closure under ambient definable functions with values in the home sorts, not quantifier elimination in the henselian substructure. Delete the constructibility claim. The home-sort restriction is already implicit in Terminology 2.3; the preceding paragraph correctly treats Γ-valued functions separately. The later RV-bijection arguments need only the valid statement that a definable bijection and its inverse preserve $\mathrm{RV}(\mathbb{M})$.

8.1. **Piecewise retraction to RES.** As in § 5.1, from here on, we work in the field $\tilde{\mathbb{C}}$ of complex Puiseux series (with an implicit reduced cross-section) and take $\mathbb{S} = \mathbb{C}(\!(t)\!)$. The value group Γ is identified with $\mathbb{Q}$. We also consider the family of henselian subfields $\mathbb{C}(\!(t^{1/m})\!)$, $m \in \mathbb{Z}^+$, regarded as substructures. The value group $\Gamma(\mathbb{C}(\!(t^{1/m})\!))$ is identified with $m^{-1}\mathbb{Z}$.

Notation 8.1. For any ring R, let $R[T^{\mathbb{Q}}]$ denote the ring of Puiseux polynomials over R, that is, the group ring of $\mathbb{Q}$ over R.

Let $\mathbf{K}^{\hat{\mu}}\operatorname{Var}_{\mathbb{C}}[[\mathbb{A}]^{-1}][T, T^{-1}]$ be the obvious subring of $\mathbf{K}^{\hat{\mu}}\operatorname{Var}_{\mathbb{C}}[[\mathbb{A}]^{-1}][T^{\mathbb{Q}}]$. The canonical image of $\mathbf{K}^{\hat{\mu}}\operatorname{Var}_{\mathbb{C}}[T^{\mathbb{Q}}]$ in $\mathbf{K}^{\hat{\mu}}\operatorname{Var}_{\mathbb{C}}[[\mathbb{A}]^{-1}][T^{\mathbb{Q}}]$ is just denoted as such. The assignment $T \longmapsto [\mathbb{A}]$ determines a ring homomorphism

$$\boldsymbol{\eta} : \mathbf{K}^{\hat{\mu}}\operatorname{Var}_{\mathbb{C}}[[\mathbb{A}]^{-1}][T, T^{-1}] \longrightarrow \mathbf{K}^{\hat{\mu}}\operatorname{Var}_{\mathbb{C}}[[\mathbb{A}]^{-1}]. \tag{8.1}$$

Recall Notations 3.17 and 5.14. Let $\boldsymbol{U} = (U, f, \omega) \in \mu\mathrm{RV}^{\mathrm{db}}[k]$. In particular, if $f = (f_1, \dots, f_n)$, we have introduced the shorthand

$$\omega_f : x \in U \longmapsto \omega(x) + \sum_{i=1}^{n} \mathrm{vrv}(f_i(x)).$$

The image $\omega_f(U_\gamma)$ is finite for every $\gamma \in \mathrm{vrv}(U)$, because the $\Bbbk$-sort and the Γ-sort are orthogonal to each other. It follows that there is a bipolar twistoid decomposition $(U_i)_i$ of U such that each restriction $\omega_f \upharpoonright U_i$ vrv-contracts to a function $\sigma_i : I_i = \mathrm{vrv}(U_i) \longrightarrow \Gamma$. Write $I_{i,m}$ for the set $I_i(m^{-1}\mathbb{Z})$ of $m^{-1}\mathbb{Z}$-rational points of I_i. We assign to $\boldsymbol{U}$ the expression

$$h_m(\boldsymbol{U}) = \sum_i [\mathrm{tbk}(U_i)]^{\hat{\mu}} \sum_{\gamma \in I_{i,m}} T^{-m\sigma_i(\gamma)}, \tag{8.2}$$

which is a finite sum and hence belongs to $\mathbf{K}^{\hat{\mu}}\operatorname{Var}_{\mathbb{C}}[[\mathbb{A}]^{-1}][T^{\mathbb{Q}}]$.

If $\boldsymbol{U}$ is already of the form $(V,g,\omega')\times(I,\sigma)\in\mu\mathrm{RES}[i]\times\mu\Gamma^{\mathrm{db}}[j]$, where $\operatorname{vrv}(g)$ is a singleton, $\operatorname{vrv}(V)\in m^{-1}\mathbb{Z}$, and ω'_g is constant, then clearly

$$h_m(\boldsymbol{U})=\Theta([V])T^{-m\omega'_g}\cdot[\mathbb{G}_m]^j\sum_{\gamma\in I_m}T^{-m(\sigma(\gamma)+\Sigma\gamma)};$$

note that if $\operatorname{vrv}(V)\notin m^{-1}\mathbb{Z}$ then simply $h_m(\boldsymbol{U})=0$. In light of the isomorphism $\mu\Psi^{\mathrm{db}}$ in Remark 4.10, we may as well take this as the definition of h_m, which is essentially how it is done in [9, § 8.2]. Computationally, though, (8.2) is more effective.

Referee R139 [Clarification] – Partition the RES factor by its valuation.
Original source line 2836. The condition $\operatorname{vrv}(V)\in m^{-1}\mathbb{Z}$ is not well-typed: $\operatorname{vrv}(V)$ is a finite set of tuples, and the hypothesis that $\operatorname{vrv}(g)$ is a singleton does not make $\operatorname{vrv}(V)$ a singleton. First partition V by its finitely many valuation tuples, say $\operatorname{vrv}(V)=\{\delta\}$ on each piece. Then use $\delta\in(m^{-1}\mathbb{Z})^r$ in the displayed formula and assign zero to the other pieces. This also resolves the corresponding outstanding point in the human report.

The "piecewise retraction" formula (8.2) is indeed quite similar to the "uniform retraction" formula (5.5). The difference is just that the coefficient $\chi_b(I_i)$ in the latter is replaced in the former by a formal "counting" sum $\sum_{\gamma\in I_{i,m}}T^{-m\sigma_i(\gamma)}$ that also takes the volume form into account. As mentioned in Remark 5.11, that the "uniform retraction" formula does not depend on the choice of the bipolar twistoid decomposition is simply a consequence of the construction of $\mathbb{E}_b$ itself. The same holds for the "piecewise retraction" formula, but we do need an argument.

Lemma 8.2. *The assignment (8.2) does not depend on the choice of the bipolar twistoid decomposition and is invariant on isomorphism classes.*

Proof. Let $\boldsymbol{V}=(V,g,\pi)\in\mu\mathrm{RV}^{\mathrm{db}}[k]$ and $f:U\longrightarrow V$ be a $\mu\mathrm{RV}^{\mathrm{db}}[k]$-morphism. Let $D=(U_i)_i$, $E=(V_i)_i$ be bipolar twistoid decompositions of U, V satisfying the condition above. We need to show that $h_m(\boldsymbol{U})$, which depends on D, and $h_m(\boldsymbol{V})$, which depends on E, are equal.

Referee R140 [Typo] – The letter f has two incompatible meanings.
Original source line 2845. Rename the isomorphism $f:U\longrightarrow V$ to F throughout this proof. The symbol f already denotes the structural map in $\boldsymbol{U}=(U,f,\omega)$; expressions such as ω_f must continue to refer to that structural map.

This is clear if $\boldsymbol{U}=\boldsymbol{V}$, and E is trivial (so U is already a bipolar twistoid and ω_f already vrv-contracts to a function on $\operatorname{vrv}(U)$), and D is Γ-cohesive or $\operatorname{vrv}(U_i)=\operatorname{vrv}(U_j)$ for all i, j. The case that $\boldsymbol{U}=\boldsymbol{V}$ and D is a refinement of E follows easily from this since there is a refinement $(U_{ij})_{ij}$ of D such that $(U_{ij})_j$ is a Γ-cohesive twistoid decomposition of U_i and $\operatorname{vrv}(U_{ij})=\operatorname{vrv}(U_{i'j})$ for all i, i'. Finally, if ω_f, π_g both vrv-contract to a function and f vrv-contracts to a bijection then, by Lemma 5.12, we may assume that U, V are already bipolar twistoids. In that case the desired equality follows because $\mathbb{C}(\!(t^{1/m})\!)$ is functionally closed.

For the general case, we first remark that the image $\operatorname{vrv}(f(U_\gamma))$ is finite for every $\gamma\in\operatorname{vrv}(U)$. It then follows from Lemmas 5.6 and 5.12 that there is a twistoid decomposition $(f_i)_i$ of f such that every f_i is a $\mu\mathrm{RV}^{\mathrm{db}}[k]$-morphism as in the last special case considered above and, moreover, is compatible with D, E in the obvious sense, in other words, the domains and ranges of these f_i induce bipolar refinements of D, E. The result follows. □

Referee R141 [Clarification; revised] – Explain lattice and weight preservation.
Original source line 2849. In the special case with a bijective valuation contraction $\bar{F}$, spell out the two identities needed for the counting argument: $\bar{F}(I\cap(m^{-1}\mathbb{Z})^r)=J\cap(m^{-1}\mathbb{Z})^s$ and $\omega_f=\pi_g\circ F$. The first

follows from closure of $\mathrm{RV}(\mathbb{C}((t^{1/m})))$ under F and F^{-1}; the second follows from the Γ-Jacobian condition. The induced maps on each residue fiber are equivariant, so their classes agree under Θ. This supplies the currently omitted bridge from functional closure to equality of the weighted, equivariant sums.

Thus, h_m may be viewed as a map on $\mathbf{K}_+\,\mu\mathrm{RV}^{\mathrm{db}}[k]$. It is now routine to check that we have in effect constructed a ring homomorphism

$$\boldsymbol{h}_m : \mathbf{K}\,\mu\mathrm{RV}^{\mathrm{db}}[*] \longrightarrow \mathbf{K}^{\hat{\mu}}\,\mathrm{Var}_{\mathbb{C}}[[\mathbb{A}]^{-1}][T^{\mathbb{Q}}].$$

Let $\mathbf{K}^{\natural}_m\,\mu\mathrm{RV}^{\mathrm{db}}[*]$ denote the subring $(\boldsymbol{h}_m)^{-1}(\mathbf{K}^{\hat{\mu}}\,\mathrm{Var}_{\mathbb{C}}[[\mathbb{A}]^{-1}][T,T^{-1}])$ of $\mathbf{K}\,\mu\mathrm{RV}^{\mathrm{db}}[*]$.

Lemma 8.3. *The homomorphism*

$$\boldsymbol{\eta}\circ\boldsymbol{h}_m : \mathbf{K}^{\natural}_m\,\mu\mathrm{RV}^{\mathrm{db}}[*] \longrightarrow \mathbf{K}^{\hat{\mu}}\,\mathrm{Var}_{\mathbb{C}}[[\mathbb{A}]^{-1}]$$

vanishes on $(\boldsymbol{P}_\Gamma)$.

Note that the ideal $(\boldsymbol{P}_\Gamma)$ of $\mathbf{K}\,\mu\mathrm{RV}^{\mathrm{db}}[*]$ in Notation 4.13 is now generated by the elements $\boldsymbol{P}_\gamma$ with $\gamma\in\mathbb{Z}$ (because the point t_γ there needs to be definable, which is possible only if $\gamma\in\mathbb{Z}$ in the current setting).

Referee R142 [Typo] – The generator radius is nonnegative.
Original source line 2865. Replace $\gamma\in\mathbb{Z}$ here and at the beginning of the proof by $\gamma\in\mathbb{Z}_{\geq 0}$, or by $\gamma\in\mathbb{Z}_{>0}$ after discarding the zero generator. Notation 4.13 defines $\boldsymbol{P}_\gamma$ only for nonnegative radii; the subsequent sum from 1 to $m\gamma$ uses this restriction.

Proof. For $\gamma\in\mathbb{Z}$, the image of $[\mathrm{RV}^{\circ\circ}\smallsetminus\mathrm{RV}^{\circ\circ}_\gamma]+[\{t_\gamma\}]$ under $\boldsymbol{h}_m$ in $\mathbf{K}^{\hat{\mu}}\,\mathrm{Var}_{\mathbb{C}}[[\mathbb{A}]^{-1}][T,T^{-1}]$ is

$$([\mathbb{A}]-1)\sum_{i=1}^{m\gamma}T^{-i}+T^{-m\gamma},$$

which, after passing to $\mathbf{K}^{\hat{\mu}}\,\mathrm{Var}_{\mathbb{C}}[[\mathbb{A}]^{-1}]$ via $\boldsymbol{\eta}$, becomes $1=\boldsymbol{\eta}(\boldsymbol{h}_m([1]))$. □

Referee R172 [Clarification; new] – Specify the ideal inside the natural subring.
Original source line 2873. The ideal $J=(\boldsymbol{P}_\Gamma)$ was defined in the full ring $B=\mathbf{K}\,\mu\mathrm{RV}^{\mathrm{db}}[*]$, whereas $\boldsymbol{\eta}\boldsymbol{h}_m$ has domain $B^{\natural}_m$. Interpret "vanishes on J" as vanishing on $J\cap B^{\natural}_m$, and use this intersection in the quotient notation below. The displayed generator computation extends to that intersection as follows. The polynomials $p_\gamma=\boldsymbol{h}_m(\boldsymbol{P}_\gamma)$ have integer exponents. Decompose the Puiseux polynomial ring by exponent classes in $\mathbb{Q}/\mathbb{Z}$, and let pr_0 retain its integer-exponent part. If $x=\sum_j a_j\boldsymbol{P}_{\gamma_j}\in B^{\natural}_m$, then

$$\boldsymbol{h}_m(x)=\sum_j \mathrm{pr}_0(\boldsymbol{h}_m(a_j))p_{\gamma_j}.$$

Applying $\boldsymbol{\eta}$ gives zero by the displayed calculation. This supplies the small algebraic step needed when the coefficients a_j themselves lie outside $B^{\natural}_m$.

Remark 8.4. If $\boldsymbol{U}=(U,f,l)\in\mu\mathrm{RV}^{\mathrm{db}}[*]$ with $l\in m^{-1}\mathbb{Z}$ (constant volume form) then the exponents in (8.2) are all integers and hence $[\boldsymbol{U}]\in\mathbf{K}^{\natural}_m\,\mu\mathrm{RV}^{\mathrm{db}}[*]$. Actually we shall only need the case $l=0$.

The ring $\bigcap_{m\in\mathbb{Z}^+}\mathbf{K}^{\natural}_m\,\mu\mathrm{RV}^{\mathrm{db}}[*]$ is denoted by $\mathbf{K}^{\natural}\,\mu\mathrm{RV}^{\mathrm{db}}[*]$.

If $\boldsymbol{A}=(A,l)\in\mu\mathrm{VF}^{\diamond}[*]$ with l constant then $\int^{\diamond}[\boldsymbol{A}]$ may be expressed as $[(U,f,l)]/(\boldsymbol{P}_\Gamma)$, and hence if $l\in\mathbb{Z}$ then $\int^{\diamond}[\boldsymbol{A}]$ belongs to $\mathbf{K}^{\natural}\,\mu\mathrm{RV}^{\mathrm{db}}[*]/(\boldsymbol{P}_\Gamma)$. In that case, by Lemma 8.3, for every $m\in\mathbb{Z}^+$, the expression $(\boldsymbol{\eta}\circ\boldsymbol{h}_m\circ\int^{\diamond})([\boldsymbol{A}])$ designates a unique element in $\mathbf{K}^{\hat{\mu}}\,\mathrm{Var}_{\mathbb{C}}[[\mathbb{A}]^{-1}]$.

Denote by RES_m the full subcategory of RES such that $U \in \mathrm{RES}_m$ if and only if every $\gamma \in \mathrm{vrv}(U)$ is a tuple in $m^{-1}\mathbb{Z}$, or equivalently, $U \in \mathrm{RES}_m$ if and only if the action on U of the kernel of the canonical projection $\hat{\mu} \longrightarrow \mu_m$ is trivial.

Let $\beta = (\beta_1, \ldots, \beta_n) \in (m^{-1}\mathbb{Z})^n$ and $A \subseteq \mathcal{O}^n \times \mathrm{RV}^l$ be a proper β-invariant definable set such that $\mathrm{pr}_{\mathrm{VF}} \restriction A$ is finite-to-one. Then there is a set

$$A[m;\beta] \subseteq \prod_i \mathbb{C}[t^{1/m}]/t^{\beta_i+1/m} \times \mathrm{RV}(\mathbb{C}(\!(t^{1/m})\!))^l$$

such that, for every $t \in \mathrm{RV}(\mathbb{C}(\!(t^{1/m})\!))^l$, the VF-fiber $A_t(\mathbb{C}(\!(t^{1/m})\!))$ is, under the obvious quotient map, the preimage of the fiber $A[m;\beta]_t$. Note that $\mathrm{pr}_{\mathrm{VF}} \restriction A[m;\beta]$ is still finite-to-one, for otherwise, by the β-invariance of A, $\mathrm{pr}_{\mathrm{VF}} \restriction A$ would fail to be finite-to-one. We can think of $\mathbb{C}[t^{1/m}]/t^{\beta_i+1/m}$ as the object $\prod_{0\le\gamma\le\beta_i} \gamma^\sharp$ of RES_m. Then, since every element in the value group $\mathbb{Q}$ is definable and $\mathrm{vrv}(A[m;\beta])$ is doubly bounded, it follows that $A[m;\beta]$ is indeed a finite disjoint union of definable sets in RV (no extra parameters other than those in $\mathbb{S} = \mathbb{C}(\!(t)\!)$ are needed) and hence, as such, is an object of RES_m (see [9, § 4.2] for more details).

Referee R143 [Error; revised] – Truncated coefficient spaces need zero coefficients.
Original source line 2891. Take $\beta_i \ge 0$, and replace the asserted coefficient space by

$$\prod_{\substack{\gamma\in m^{-1}\mathbb{Z}\\ 0\le\gamma\le\beta_i}} (\gamma^\sharp \cup \{0_\gamma\}).$$

Here 0_γ denotes the zero of the one-dimensional residue vector space. By the manuscript's convention $\gamma^\sharp = \mathrm{vrv}^{-1}(\gamma)$ excludes zero, so the displayed product in the text allows no vanishing coefficients and is not the truncated polynomial space. The lattice restriction on the index is also necessary to make the product finite. Interpret the definition of RES_m accordingly when a coordinate is zero. More explicitly, in the preceding definition of RES_m, allow coordinates equal to $\infty = \mathrm{rv}(0)$ in addition to coordinates with valuation in $m^{-1}\mathbb{Z}$: the kernel of $\hat{\mu} \longrightarrow \mu_m$ fixes these zeros too.

Lemma 8.5 ([9, Lemma 4.2.1])**.** *Let $\beta' \in (m^{-1}\mathbb{Z})^n$ with $\beta_i \le \beta'_i$ for all i. Then*

$$[A[m;\beta']] = [A[m;\beta]][\mathbb{A}]^{m\Sigma(\beta'-\beta)} \in \mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RES}_m. \tag{8.3}$$

Referee R144 [Error; revised] – The truncation relation requires the affine-action quotient.
Original source line 2898. The equality generally fails in the raw ring $\mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RES}_m$. Take $A = \mathcal{O}$, $m = 2$, $\beta = 0$ and $\beta' = 1/2$. Then $A[2;0]$ is a trivial affine line, whereas $A[2;1/2]$ is its product with a line carrying the sign action of μ_2. The μ_2-fixed loci of the asserted left and right sides have classes $[\mathbb{A}]$ and $[\mathbb{A}]^2$, respectively, distinguished for example by their Hodge polynomials. The equality is valid after imposing $[\gamma^\sharp] = [\mathbb{G}_m]$: put it in $!\mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RES}_m$, and define $\tilde{A}[m]$ in its localization below. In the proof of the cited Hrushovski–Loeser Lemma 4.2.1, averaging a section makes that section equivariant, but does not turn the remaining linear fiber action into the trivial action; this is precisely why the quotient is needed.

Thus the element $[A[m;\beta]][\mathbb{A}]^{-m\Sigma\beta}$ in $\mathbf{K}\,\mathrm{RES}_m[[\mathbb{A}]^{-1}]$ does not depend on β; we denote it by $\tilde{A}[m]$.

The localization of Θ at $[\mathbb{A}]$ is still denoted by Θ.

Lemma 8.6. *Suppose that $(A,0) \in \mu\mathrm{VF}^\diamond[n]$. Then, in $\mathbf{K}^{\hat{\mu}}\,\mathrm{Var}_{\mathbb{C}}[[\mathbb{A}]^{-1}]$,*

$$(\boldsymbol{\eta} \circ \boldsymbol{h}_m)\Big(\int^\diamond [(A,0)]\Big) = \Theta(\tilde{A}[m]).$$

Referee R145 [Clarification] – The right-hand side has only been defined inside O.
Original source line 2909. The definition of $\tilde{A}[m]$ above assumes $A \subseteq \mathcal{O}^n \times \mathrm{RV}^l$, whereas this lemma allows an arbitrary proper invariant object, whose field projection need only be bounded. Either add the assumption $A \subseteq \mathcal{O}^n \times \mathrm{RV}^l$ (which suffices for the application), or first extend the definition using finite Laurent-polynomial truncations beginning at a common lower valuation bound. A scaling into $\mathcal{O}^n$ must also account for its Jacobian and cannot simply retain the zero volume form.

Proof. By Lemma 6.21, there exists a special covariant bijection $F : (A, 0) \longrightarrow (\mathbb{L}\boldsymbol{U}, 0)$, where $\boldsymbol{U} \in \mathrm{RV}^{\mathrm{db}}[*]$. Observe that we can choose apertures (γ_i, t_i) with $\gamma_i \in m^{-1}\mathbb{Z}$ so that F induces a definable bijection between $A[m;\beta]$ and $\mathbb{L}\boldsymbol{U}[m;\beta]$ for all sufficiently large β; it is for this purpose that each γ_i needs to lie in $m^{-1}\mathbb{Z}$, due to the second clause of (CT) and the mandatory regularizations in Definition 6.11. Thus, we may assume that A is already of the form $\mathbb{L}\boldsymbol{U}$. Let D be a Γ-cohesive bipolar twistoid decomposition of $\boldsymbol{U}$. Since both sides respect finite disjoint union of proper β-invariant definable sets, we may further assume that D is actually trivial or even $\mathrm{vrv}(\boldsymbol{U})$ is a singleton. Then the equality follows from a simple computation. □

Referee R146 [Gap; revised] – The singleton reduction needs the fixed-m trace.
Original source line 2912. Finite additivity cannot reduce an arbitrary positive-dimensional $\mathrm{vrv}(\boldsymbol{U})$ to a singleton. For the fixed integer m, first restrict to the finite set $\mathrm{vrv}(U) \cap (m^{-1}\mathbb{Z})^r$: the remaining pieces contribute neither to h_m nor to the $\mathbb{C}(\!(t^{1/m})\!)$-truncation. On a remaining fiber, let $\alpha_i = \mathrm{vrv}(f_i(u))$, after refining so these are constant, and take $\beta_i \geq \alpha_i$. There are $m(\beta_i - \alpha_i)$ free coefficients following the prescribed leading term in coordinate i. Thus its normalized class is

$$\Theta([U_\gamma])\,[\mathbb{A}]^{-m\sum_i \alpha_i},$$

which is precisely its contribution to $\boldsymbol{\eta h}_m$. This calculation uses the affine-action quotient noted above. For definability, the apertures can be chosen in $\mathbb{Z}_{\geq 0}$, a cofinal subset of $m^{-1}\mathbb{Z}$, so the required points t_i remain definable over $\mathbb{C}(\!(t)\!)$. This integrality observation does not settle the preceding truncation-compatibility step; see the separate remark on that step.

Referee R173 [Gap; new] – Integral apertures do not ensure equal-cutoff truncation compatibility.
Original source line 2912. The first reduction needs a separate argument. Choosing integral apertures does not by itself make an allowed special covariant bijection induce equal-cutoff truncations for every sufficiently large vector β. For example, take $m = 1$ and

$$A = (1 + t + \mathcal{M}_2) \times (t + \mathcal{M}_3), \qquad \lambda(y) = t^{-1}y.$$

The focus satisfies the required $(3, 2)$-covariance. With aperture $(2, \mathrm{rv}(t^2))$, every point uses the first clause of (CT), because $\mathrm{val}(x - \lambda(y)) = 1$. Following this shear by two constant-focus transformations yields a permitted preparation

$$F(x, y) = (x - t^{-1}y - t + t^2,\ y - t + t^3)$$

onto the RV-pullback $(t^2 + \mathcal{M}_2) \times (t^3 + \mathcal{M}_3)$; the additional foci are $t - t^2$ and $t - t^3$, with sufficiently large integral apertures. All regularization labels are constant on these sets. For every integer $N > 3$, the inputs $(1 + t, t)$ and $(1 + t, t + t^{N+1})$ have the same (N, N)-truncation, but their first output coordinates differ by $-t^N$. Thus this F induces no such truncation map for arbitrarily large diagonal cutoffs. Compatible anisotropic cutoffs do exist for this example, namely $\beta_y \geq \beta_x + 1$. Prove invariance of the normalized truncation class using compatible cutoffs for each centripetal step and its inverse, or strengthen the preparation lemma to provide the needed compatibility. This example identifies a missing step in the proof; it does not disprove the lemma's coefficient identity or rule out a better choice of F.

8.1.1. *Bounded version.* Although not needed, we can extend the construction above to the category $\mu\mathrm{RV}^{\mathrm{bd}}[*]$; this category is formulated as $\mu\mathrm{RV}^{\mathrm{db}}[*]$, but with doubly bounded objects replaced by bounded ones.

Let $\mathbf{K}^{\hat{\mu}}\operatorname{Var}_{\mathbb{C}}[[\mathbb{A}]^{-1}][T^{\mathbb{Q}}]_{\mathrm{loc}}$ be the localization of $\mathbf{K}^{\hat{\mu}}\operatorname{Var}_{\mathbb{C}}[[\mathbb{A}]^{-1}][T^{\mathbb{Q}}]$ by the multiplicative family generated by the elements $1-T^{-i}$, $i\in\mathbb{Z}^{+}$. The ring $\mathbf{K}^{\hat{\mu}}\operatorname{Var}_{\mathbb{C}}[[\mathbb{A}]^{-1}][T,T^{-1}]_{\mathrm{loc}}$ is the localization of $\mathbf{K}^{\hat{\mu}}\operatorname{Var}_{\mathbb{C}}[[\mathbb{A}]^{-1}][T,T^{-1}]$ by the same multiplicative family. Similarly one defines the ring $\mathbf{K}^{\hat{\mu}}\operatorname{Var}_{\mathbb{C}}[[\mathbb{A}]^{-1}]_{\mathrm{loc}}$ with respect to the multiplicative family generated by the elements $1-[\mathbb{A}]^{-i}$, $i\in\mathbb{Z}^{+}$. As in (8.1), the assignment the $T\longmapsto[\mathbb{A}]$ determines a ring homomorphism

Referee R147 [Typo] – Duplicated article.
Original source line 2918. Replace "the assignment the $T\longmapsto[\mathbb{A}]$" by "the assignment $T\longmapsto[\mathbb{A}]$". The symbol T here is the weight variable used in h_m; using a different letter from the later zeta variable would also make the two operations easier to distinguish.

$$\boldsymbol{\eta}_{\mathrm{loc}}:\mathbf{K}^{\hat{\mu}}\operatorname{Var}_{\mathbb{C}}[[\mathbb{A}]^{-1}][T,T^{-1}]_{\mathrm{loc}}\longrightarrow\mathbf{K}^{\hat{\mu}}\operatorname{Var}_{\mathbb{C}}[[\mathbb{A}]^{-1}]_{\mathrm{loc}}. \tag{8.4}$$

We assign to each $\boldsymbol{U}=(U,f,\omega)\in\mu\mathrm{RV}^{\mathrm{bd}}[k]$ the same expression as in (8.2), which is now a formal Laurent series in $T^{-1/l}$ for some integer $l>0$, because each σ_i is piecewise $\mathbb{Q}$-linear and its graph is bounded. By [9, Lemma 8.2.1], if $l=1$ then the series belongs to $\mathbf{K}^{\hat{\mu}}\operatorname{Var}_{\mathbb{C}}[[\mathbb{A}]^{-1}][T,T^{-1}]_{\mathrm{loc}}$ and hence, in general, it belongs to $\mathbf{K}^{\hat{\mu}}\operatorname{Var}_{\mathbb{C}}[[\mathbb{A}]^{-1}][T^{\mathbb{Q}}]_{\mathrm{loc}}$ (consider any isomorphism of $\tilde{\mathbb{C}}$ that fixes $\mathbb{C}$ and sends $1/l$ to 1). So the assignment yields a ring homomorphism $\boldsymbol{h}_{\mathrm{loc},m}$ and consequently a subring $\mathbf{K}^{\natural}_{m}\,\mu\mathrm{RV}^{\mathrm{bd}}[*]$.

Referee R148 [Error] – Bounded support does not imply summability.
Original source line 2924. This extension is not defined on the declared category. Take $\boldsymbol{U}=(\mathrm{RV}^{\circ\circ},\mathrm{id},-\mathrm{vrv})$. It is bounded in the stated sense, but $\omega_f=0$, and the proposed expression is

$$([\mathbb{A}]-1)\sum_{i>0}1,$$

which is not a formal Laurent series. Even assuming the graph of the weight is bounded below would not make its level sets finite. One needs a genuine summability condition, for example that the weight ω_f is bounded below and its sublevel sets on the relevant valuation lattice are finite, together with a proof that the resulting class of objects is compatible with the chosen morphisms and quotient. The cited Hrushovski–Loeser Lemma 8.2.1 concerns the sum-of-coordinates weight on a set bounded below and does not justify arbitrary ω. Since this subsection is expressly unused, deleting this extension and the corresponding arrows is a safe alternative. Finally, clarify that "sends $1/l$ to 1 refers to the induced map on the value group, or write $t^{1/l}\mapsto t$: it cannot refer to field scalars in $\mathbb{C}$. To clear rational exponents without changing the parameter field, simply substitute $S=T^{1/l}$ and use that $1-S^{-a}$ divides $1-S^{-al}=1-T^{-a}$.

Lemma 8.7. *The homomorphism*

$$\boldsymbol{\eta}_{\mathrm{loc}}\circ\boldsymbol{h}_{\mathrm{loc},m}:\mathbf{K}^{\natural}_{m}\,\mu\mathrm{RV}^{\mathrm{bd}}[*]\longrightarrow\mathbf{K}^{\hat{\mu}}\operatorname{Var}_{\mathbb{C}}[[\mathbb{A}]^{-1}]_{\mathrm{loc}}$$

vanishes on $(\boldsymbol{P})$.

Proof. The image of $[\mathrm{RV}^{\circ\circ}]$ in $\mathbf{K}^{\hat{\mu}}\operatorname{Var}_{\mathbb{C}}[[\mathbb{A}]^{-1}][T,T^{-1}]_{\mathrm{loc}}$ is

$$([\mathbb{A}]-1)\sum_{i>0}T^{-i}=([\mathbb{A}]-1)/(T-1)$$

and hence, after passing to $\mathbf{K}^{\hat{\mu}}\operatorname{Var}_{\mathbb{C}}[[\mathbb{A}]^{-1}]_{\mathrm{loc}}$ via $\boldsymbol{\eta}_{\mathrm{loc}}$, it becomes $1=\boldsymbol{\eta}_{\mathrm{loc}}(\boldsymbol{h}_{\mathrm{loc},m}([1]))$. □

8.2. **Constructing motivic Milnor fiber.** Finally, we proceed to replicate the construction in [9, § 8] so to recover the motivic zeta function with coefficients in $\mathbf{K}^{\hat{\mu}}\operatorname{Var}_{\mathbb{C}}[[\mathbb{A}]^{-1}]$ (this is the purpose of Lemma 8.6) and the corresponding motivic Milnor fiber.

Referee R149 [Typo] – Missing as.
Original source line 2948. Replace "so to recover" by "so as to recover". The subsection title would read more naturally as "Constructing the motivic Milnor fiber".

Let X be a smooth connected complex algebraic variety of dimension d and $f : X \longrightarrow \mathbb{A}^1$ a nonconstant regular function. Suppose that $0 \in X(\mathbb{C}) \cap f^{-1}(0)$ is singular. For $m \geq 1$, we consider the set of truncated arcs

Referee R150 [Clarification] – Critical point of f, not singular point of X.
Original source line 2950. Since X is assumed smooth, the phrase "$0 \in X(\mathbb{C}) \cap f^{-1}(0)$ is singular" needs qualification. Write "let $0 \in f^{-1}(0)$ be a critical point of f, that is, $df_0 = 0$". This avoids identifying a critical point with a singular point of the ambient variety, and handles a nonreduced zero fiber without ambiguity.

$$\mathcal{X}_m = \{\varphi \in X(\mathbb{C}[t]/(t^{m+1})) \mid f(\varphi) = t^m \mod t^{m+1}\}, \tag{8.5}$$

Referee R151 [Error] – The local arc space still omits its base point.
Original source line 2953. Add $\varphi(0) = 0$ to the defining conditions. As written, $\mathcal{X}_m$ includes jets based at every point of $f^{-1}(0)$, whereas $\mathcal{X}_f$ is the tube at the chosen point. For example, with $X = \mathbb{A}^1$ and $f(x) = x^2(x-1)$, the chosen point 0 is critical and there is no local jet of order $m = 1$ there, but the displayed definition includes the jet $1 + t$ based at 1. Thus equation (8.7) is false with the present definition. This correction was already requested in the human report and remains outstanding.

which may be viewed in a natural way as the set of closed points of an algebraic variety over $\mathbb{C}$ that carries a natural μ_m-action, and the so-called *nonarchimedean Milnor fiber*

$$\mathcal{X}_f = \{x \in X(\mathcal{M}) \mid \operatorname{rv}(f(x)) = \operatorname{rv}(t)\}.$$

Note that $\mathcal{X}_f$ may be constructed in an affine neighborhood of 0 and hence is indeed a (quantifier-free) definable set. Moreover, it is β-invariant for every $\beta \geq 1$. Therefore, $\mathcal{X}_f$ may be regarded as an object of $\mu\mathrm{VF}^{\diamond}[*]$ equipped with the constant volume form 0. The *motivic zeta function* of f is then the power series

Referee R152 [Gap] – Use an etale chart to obtain a proper invariant object.
Original source line 2958. For a general smooth X, $X(\mathcal{M})$ is not literal scheme notation, since $\mathcal{M}$ is not a unital ring; define it as $\mathrm{red}^{-1}(0) \subseteq X(\mathcal{O})$. More substantially, embedding an affine neighborhood into $\mathbb{A}^N$ does not make this tube open in VF^N when $N > d$, so it does not establish proper invariance as defined earlier. Choose an étale coordinate map $q : (X, 0) \longrightarrow (\mathbb{A}^d, 0)$. Henselian lifting identifies the tube at 0 with $\mathcal{M}^d$; in these coordinates the function is defined by an étale algebraic germ and is 1-Lipschitz on the tube, which gives the asserted β-invariance for $\beta \geq 1$. Use the volume form $q^*(dx_1 \wedge \cdots \wedge dx_d)$, whose chart transitions have Jacobian of valuation zero on the tube. State this reduction before assigning the constant volume form 0.

$$Z_f(T) = \sum_{m \in \mathbb{Z}^+} \left(\boldsymbol{\eta} \circ \boldsymbol{h}_m \circ \int^{\diamond}\right)([\mathcal{X}_f])T^m \in \mathbf{K}^{\hat{\mu}}\operatorname{Var}_{\mathbb{C}}[[\mathbb{A}]^{-1}][\![T]\!]. \tag{8.6}$$

By Remark 8.4 and Lemma 8.6, we have, in $\mathbf{K}^{\hat{\mu}}\operatorname{Var}_{\mathbb{C}}[[\mathbb{A}]^{-1}]$,

$$\Big(\boldsymbol{\eta}\circ\boldsymbol{h}_m\circ\int^{\diamond}\Big)([\mathcal{X}_f])=\Theta(\tilde{\mathcal{X}}_f[m])=[\mathcal{X}_m][\mathbb{A}]^{-md}, \tag{8.7}$$

where the second equality follows if we change the variable t to $t^{1/m}$ in (8.5) (see the discussion in [9, § 6.2] for detail). This shows that the coefficients of $Z_f(T)$ may also be written as $[\mathcal{X}_m][\mathbb{A}]^{-md}$, which is how they are usually defined.

Referee R153 [Clarification] – Give the equivariant coefficient comparison.
Original source line 2966. After correcting $\varphi(0)=0$, put $s=t^{1/m}$ and choose $\beta=(1,\dots,1)$. The truncation is modulo s^{m+1} and $\operatorname{rv}(f(x))=\operatorname{rv}(t)$ becomes $f(x)\equiv s^m \pmod{s^{m+1}}$. Hence $\mathcal{X}_f[m;\beta]$ is exactly the corrected m-jet variety. The action $s\mapsto\zeta s$, $\zeta\in\mu_m$, is the usual action on those jets, and the normalization is $[\mathbb{A}]^{-m\sum_i\beta_i}=[\mathbb{A}]^{-md}$. Including these sentences proves both the factor and equivariance without leaving the crucial comparison to a general section reference.

Remark 8.8. One of the key steps of the main construction in [9, § 8] is to show (8.7), see [9, Proposition 8.3.1], but with $\int^{\diamond}$ replaced by $\int$. This, and a few other statements in [9, § 8], rely on a tensor decomposition of the ring $\mathbf{K}\operatorname{volRV}[*]$, as claimed in [8, Proposition 10.10(2)]. We have pointed out above that, unfortunately, this result does not hold.

Notation 8.9. Let $\mathbf{K}^{\hat{\mu}}\operatorname{Var}_{\mathbb{C}}[[\mathbb{A}]^{-1}][T]_{\dagger}$ be the localization of $\mathbf{K}^{\hat{\mu}}\operatorname{Var}_{\mathbb{C}}[[\mathbb{A}]^{-1}][T]$ by the multiplicative family generated by the elements $1-[\mathbb{A}]^aT^b$, where $a\in\mathbb{Z}$ and $b\in\mathbb{Z}^+$; it may be regarded as a subring of $\mathbf{K}^{\hat{\mu}}\operatorname{Var}_{\mathbb{C}}[[\mathbb{A}]^{-1}][\![T]\!]$.

It is known that $Z_f(T)$ belongs to $\mathbf{K}^{\hat{\mu}}\operatorname{Var}_{\mathbb{C}}[[\mathbb{A}]^{-1}][T]_{\dagger}$ and, letting "T go to infinity" as described in [9, § 8.4], we get a limit

$$\mathscr{S}_f:=-\lim_{T\to\infty}Z_f(T)\in\mathbf{K}^{\hat{\mu}}\operatorname{Var}_{\mathbb{C}}[[\mathbb{A}]^{-1}],$$

which is understood as the *motivic Milnor fiber* attached to f.

Remark 8.10. Recall the homomorphism $\mathbb{E}^{\diamond}$ from (4.8). By Lemma 5.12 and Notation 5.14, we can construct the homomorphism

$$\Theta\circ\mathbb{E}^{\diamond}:\mathbf{K}\,\mu\mathrm{RV}^{\mathrm{db}}[*]\longrightarrow\mathbf{K}^{\hat{\mu}}\operatorname{Var}_{\mathbb{C}}$$

simply using the expression in (5.5) with respect to bipolar twistoid decompositions.

Theorem 8.11. $\mathscr{S}_f=(\Theta\circ\mathbb{E}^{\diamond}\circ\int^{\diamond})([\mathcal{X}_f])$.

Proof. Let $[\boldsymbol{U}]=[(U,f,l)]\in\mathbf{K}^{\natural}\,\mu\mathrm{RV}^{\mathrm{db}}[*]$ with $l\in\mathbb{Z}$ and consider the zeta function

$$Z([\boldsymbol{U}])(T)=\sum_{m\in\mathbb{Z}^+}(\boldsymbol{\eta}\circ\boldsymbol{h}_m)([\boldsymbol{U}])T^m\in\mathbf{K}^{\hat{\mu}}\operatorname{Var}_{\mathbb{C}}[[\mathbb{A}]^{-1}][\![T]\!]. \tag{8.8}$$

If $[\boldsymbol{U}]/(\boldsymbol{P}_\Gamma)=\int^{\diamond}([\mathcal{X}_f])$ then this is $Z_f(T)$. Thus it is enough to show that $Z([\boldsymbol{U}])(T)$ belongs to $\mathbf{K}^{\hat{\mu}}\operatorname{Var}_{\mathbb{C}}[[\mathbb{A}]^{-1}][T]_{\dagger}$, and $\lim_{T\to\infty}Z([\boldsymbol{U}])(T)$ exists and equals $-(\Theta\circ\mathbb{E}^{\diamond})([\boldsymbol{U}])$.

Without loss of generality, we may assume that U is already a bipolar twistoid and the function $l_f:U\longrightarrow\Gamma$ (Notation 3.17) vrv-contracts to a function $\sigma:I=\operatorname{vrv}(U)\longrightarrow\Gamma$. Set $v=[\operatorname{tbk}(U)]^{\hat{\mu}}$. Then

$$(\Theta\circ\mathbb{E}^{\diamond})([\boldsymbol{U}])=\chi(I)v.$$

Let $Z(v)(T) = \sum_{m\in\mathbb{Z}^+} vT^m$. This is an element in $\mathbf{K}^{\hat{\mu}}\operatorname{Var}_{\mathbb{C}}[[\mathbb{A}]^{-1}][T]_\dagger$ and $\lim_{T\to\infty} Z(v)(T) = -v$. Write $I_m = I(m^{-1}\mathbb{Z})$ and let

$$Z(\sigma)(T) = \sum_{m\in\mathbb{Z}^+}\sum_{\gamma\in I_m} [\mathbb{A}]^{-m\sigma(\gamma)}T^m.$$

By Remark 3.15, σ is $\mathbb{Z}$-linear. So, by [9, Proposition 8.5.2], $Z(\sigma)(T)$ is in $\mathbf{K}^{\hat{\mu}}\operatorname{Var}_{\mathbb{C}}[[\mathbb{A}]^{-1}][T]_\dagger$ and $\lim_{T\to\infty} Z(\sigma)(T) = -\chi(I)$. Since $Z([\boldsymbol{U}])(T)$ is the Hadamard product of $Z(v)(T)$ and $Z(\sigma)(T)$, by [9, Lemma 8.4.1], $\lim_{T\to\infty} Z([\boldsymbol{U}])(T) = -\chi(I)v$.

Referee R154 [Typo] – The cited result is a lemma.
Original source line 3009. The reference is *Lemma* 8.5.2 of Hrushovski–Loeser, not Proposition 8.5.2. Its hypothesis is piecewise integral-affine weight, including an integral constant term. Make this explicit here: l_f is the valuation of the definable RV-map $u \mapsto \mathrm{rv}(t)^l \prod_j f_j(u)$, so Remark 3.15 gives that hypothesis after finite refinement. Since I is doubly bounded, the lemma applies directly. In this particular proof the Hadamard-product step can also be replaced by the simpler identity $Z([\boldsymbol{U}]) = v\,Z(\sigma)$.

□

Remark 8.12. The construction above no longer needs to go through this additional localization process "loc" employed throughout [9, § 8].

Remark 8.13. Using $\boldsymbol{\eta}_{\mathrm{loc}} \circ \boldsymbol{h}_{\mathrm{loc},m}$ instead of $\boldsymbol{\eta} \circ \boldsymbol{h}_m$, we can define the zeta function $Z([\boldsymbol{U}])(T)$ for every $[\boldsymbol{U}] \in \mathbf{K}^\natural\,\mu\mathrm{RV}^{\mathrm{bd}}[*]$, and the proof of Theorem 8.11 shows that $\lim_{T\to\infty} Z([\boldsymbol{U}])(T)$ exists and belongs to $\mathbf{K}^{\hat{\mu}}\operatorname{Var}_{\mathbb{C}}[[\mathbb{A}]^{-1}]_{\mathrm{loc}}$. This and Lemma 8.7 gives the right half of the diagram (1.3). However, we are not claiming that $\lim_{T\to\infty} Z([\boldsymbol{U}])(T)$ equals $(\Theta\circ\mathbb{E}_b)([\boldsymbol{U}])$, which is reflected in the fact that there is no commutative relation between the left and right columns in (1.3). In fact, they are clearly not equal, as seen for example by considering $\boldsymbol{U} = \mathrm{RV}^{\circ\circ}$ (then the first value is -1 and the second one is 0). Such a failure explains the need to introduce an interpolant, such as the composite map $-\lim\circ Z\circ\int^\diamond$, in (1.3), for which Theorem 8.11 may be formulated and proven.

Referee R155 [Gap; revised] – The bounded zeta claim has no established domain.
Original source line 3019. The claim for every element of $\mathbf{K}^\natural\,\mu\mathrm{RV}^{\mathrm{bd}}[*]$ cannot follow from the proof of Theorem 8.11: the proposed $\boldsymbol{h}_{\mathrm{loc},m}$ is not defined on all bounded objects, as the counterexample in § 8.1.1 shows, and that proof uses a doubly bounded valuation set with an integral-affine weight. After repairing the summability domain, give a separate uniform rationality and finite-limit argument, or omit this remark and the right-hand part of diagram (1.3). The numerical example in the present paragraph is correct: $\lim Z([\mathrm{RV}^{\circ\circ}]) = -1$ whereas $\Theta\mathbb{E}_b([\mathrm{RV}^{\circ\circ}]) = 0$. With the diagram's $-\lim$ convention the former value is $+1$, which still distinguishes the maps.

Remark 8.14. The expression $(\Theta\circ\mathbb{E}^\diamond)([\boldsymbol{U}])$, as an element in $\mathbf{K}^{\hat{\mu}}\operatorname{Var}_{\mathbb{C}}[[\mathbb{A}]^{-1}]$, does not actually involve $[\mathbb{A}]^{-1}$. Still, since the coefficients of $Z([\boldsymbol{U}])(T)$ does involve $[\mathbb{A}]^{-1}$ and it is a fact that the natural homomorphism $\mathbf{K}^{\hat{\mu}}\operatorname{Var}_{\mathbb{C}} \longrightarrow \mathbf{K}^{\hat{\mu}}\operatorname{Var}_{\mathbb{C}}[[\mathbb{A}]^{-1}]$ is not injective, we cannot really take the motivic Milnor fiber $\mathscr{S}_f$ of f in $\mathbf{K}^{\hat{\mu}}\operatorname{Var}_{\mathbb{C}}$, at least not if $\mathscr{S}_f$ is viewed as something obtained through $Z_f(T)$. It is this point of view that forces us to work with an integral whose target only involves doubly bounded sets in RV, namely $\int^\diamond$, instead of $\int$, so as to facilitate the computation of the coefficients of $Z_f(T)$, and consequently with the nonarchimedean Milnor fiber $\mathscr{X}_f$, which is proper invariant, instead of, perhaps, the more obvious definable set

Referee R156 [Typo] – Agreement and a missing source for noninjectivity.
Original source line 3024. Replace "the coefficients … does involve" by "the coefficients … do involve". For the noninjectivity assertion, cite Borisov, *The class of the affine line is a zero divisor in*

the Grothendieck ring, arXiv:1412.6194. His nonequivariant example remains nonzero after giving it the trivial $\hat{\mu}$-action, because forgetting the action is a left inverse to the trivial-action inclusion.

$$\mathcal{X}_t = \{x \in X(\mathcal{M}) \mid f(x) = t\},$$

which is not proper invariant. This set $\mathcal{X}_t$ may be understood as containing the $\tilde{\mathbb{C}}$-rational points of the analytic Milnor fiber introduced in [13] (see Remark 8.15 below for more) and does play a role in [9] (but not in this paper).

On the other hand, in light of Theorem 8.11, we can forego the zeta function point of view and recover $\mathscr{S}_f$ directly as $(\Theta \circ \mathbb{E}^\diamond \circ \int^\diamond)([\mathcal{X}_f])$. In that case there is truly no need to invert $[\mathbb{A}]$. In fact, we can also recover $\mathscr{S}_f$ directly as $\mathrm{Vol}([\mathcal{X}_f])$ (Notation 5.15), the result is the same because the left half of the diagram (1.2) commutes (Corollary 7.27).

Remark 8.15. For any $t' \in \mathrm{rv}(t)^\sharp$, there exists an immediate automorphism σ of $\tilde{\mathbb{C}}$ over $\mathbb{C}$ with $\sigma(t') = t$, where "immediate" just means that σ fixes $\mathrm{RV}(\tilde{\mathbb{C}})$ pointwise. Therefore, $\int[\mathcal{X}_{t'}] = \int[\mathcal{X}_t]$. Since $\mathcal{X}_f = \bigcup_{t' \in \mathrm{rv}(t)^\sharp} \mathcal{X}_{t'}$, it follows from compactness that

$$\int[\mathcal{X}_f] = \int[\mathrm{rv}(t)^\sharp] \int[\mathcal{X}_t] = [1] \int[\mathcal{X}_t].$$

Referee R157 [Gap] – Uniformity and parameter descent in the last compactness argument.
Original source line 3039. The immediate-automorphism observation is useful, but the displayed product formula needs a uniform argument over the fixed parameter field. An automorphism sending t' to t fixes $\mathbb{C}$ and RV, but generally does not fix $\mathbb{S} = \mathbb{C}(\!(t)\!)$. Explain how the fiber equalities are represented by finite special-bijection/blowup witnesses over the appropriate base, how these witnesses vary definably with t', and why they are available for parameters in a sufficiently saturated extension before applying compactness. Pointwise equality only for the Puiseux-series points does not by itself give that compactness conclusion. One possible route is to carry out the construction first over the henselization of $\mathbb{C}(t)$, then prove the required uniformity and base-change statement. The parallel sketch in Hrushovski–Loeser, Corollary 4.2.3, is relevant but does not replace the missing details requested in the human report. This is a proof gap, not a counterexample to the final motivic-volume identity.

Since $\mathbb{E}_b([1]) = 1$, this and Remark 8.14 show that

$$\mathscr{S}_f = \mathrm{Vol}([\mathcal{X}_f]) = \mathrm{Vol}([\mathcal{X}_t]).$$

This is first shown in [12], but without taking the $\hat{\mu}$-actions into account, and also in [11, 7]. The arguments there all rely on resolution of singularities as well as other algebro-geometric machineries.

Referee R158 [Typo] – Uncountable noun.
Original source line 3046. Replace "other algebro-geometric machineries" by "other algebro-geometric machinery".

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Referee R159 [Clarification] – Update the published Fichou–Yin reference.
Original source line 3083. This paper has appeared as G. Fichou and Y. Yin, *Motivic integration and Milnor fiber*, J. Eur. Math. Soc. **24** (2022), 1617–1678, DOI 10.4171/JEMS/1123. Update the preprint-only citation if this bibliography is intended to be current.

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Referee R160 [Clarification] – Update the published Loeser–Wyss reference.
Original source line 3101. Replace the preprint-only entry by F. Loeser and D. Wyss, *Motivic integration on the Hitchin fibration*, Algebraic Geometry **8** (2021), 196–230, DOI 10.14231/AG-2021-004. The current entry also lacks its final full stop.

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Referee R161 [Typo] – Incorrect arXiv year.
Original source line 3130. The cited version arXiv:1006.1393v1 was submitted on 7 June *2010*, not in 2009. Use 2010 for this arXiv reference, or distinguish an earlier manuscript date explicitly.

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(A. Forey) D-MATH, ETH Zürich, Rämistrasse 101, CH-8092 Zürich, Switzerland
Email address: arthur.forey@math.ethz.ch

(Y. Yin) Pasadena, California
Email address: yimu.yin@hotmail.com